

*Our 12th Step Responsibility —  
Are We Going to Any Length?*

**THE FIFTY-SEVENTH ANNUAL MEETING  
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE  
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

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*2007  
Final Report*

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## Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use respects our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications and with media (press, radio, TV, etc.).

## 57<sup>TH</sup> ANNUAL General Service Conference



"Our Twelfth Step—carrying the message—is the basic service that the A.A. Fellowship gives; this is our principal aim and the main reason for our existence. Therefore, A.A. is more than a set of principles; it is a society of alcoholics in action. We must carry the message, else we ourselves can wither and those who haven't been given the truth may die."

*(The A.A. Service Manual, p. S1)*

These opening lines from A.A.'s Legacy of Service were written by Bill W. in 1951 — and were just as timely 56 years later when A.A.'s 57th General Service Conference met with the theme "Our 12th Step Responsibility — Are We Going to Any Length?"

Throughout the Conference, which met at the Crowne Plaza Times Square, New York, April 22-28, presentations and sharing sessions re-examined the Twelfth Step call — in relation to the past, where we are now and the outlook for the future. Presentation/discussion topics addressed such subjects as inclu-

siveness in A.A., our primary purpose, working with wet drunks, and whether we are resting on our laurels.

The 134 members who make up the General Service Conference consist of delegates from the 93 service areas of the U.S. and Canada, Class A (nonalcoholic) and Class B (alcoholic) trustees, and directors and staff of the two corporate boards — A.A. World Services, Inc. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

Conference officially began Sunday afternoon with the roll call, followed by Greetings from Darryl Miller, delegate chairperson. Allen Ault, Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee gave the Keynote address.

The 57th Conference was chaired by Leonard Blumenthal (non-alcoholic), chairman of the board, Greg Muth, G.S.O.'s general manager, and Darryl Miller (Kentucky), the delegate chairperson.

Rick Walker, G.S.O. staff, was the Conference coordinator. Working behind the scenes, staff and support personnel from the General Service and Grapevine offices made the week run seamlessly.

The Fellowship lost a big piece of history this past February when Nell Wing (nonalcoholic), Bill's secretary and A.A.'s first Archivist, died; she was 89 years old.

At the opening dinner Sunday evening, Nell was remembered by Sarah Price, former G.S.O. staff member, and Michael Alexander, trustee emeritus of the General Service Board.

The open A.A. meeting which followed the tribute to Nell was chaired by Eric Knudsen (Oregon) and led by Bobbi Padden (Western Massachusetts). Speakers were: Irene Kontje (G.S.O. staff), Tito Torres (Puerto Rico), Marianne Hawkins (California/Northern Interior), Ray Massey (general service trustee), and Jane Tolar (A.A.W.S. director).

Each morning at 7:30 the G.S.C. Serenity Group met for an open A.A. meeting, with topics taken from A.A. literature. Bruce Akin (Western New York) chaired the meeting. George Martin (Delaware) served as secretary/treasurer. A ticket was given to each attendee every day, and on Friday a drawing was held for two A.A. books, signed by members of the group.

Tuesday afternoon Conference members and their guests rode the subway uptown to visit the G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. A big attraction in the Archives was a demo of a Timeline covering the first 10 years of the Fellowship. Eventually, the Timeline will be on G.S.O.'s Web site — a decade at a time — in three languages. "It is important that A.A.'s Web site has the official history," said Amy Filiatreau (nonalcoholic), archivist.

Wednesday afternoon Conference members elected two new regional trustees and the trustee-at-large/Canada. Conley Byrd, of Redfield, Arkansas, will succeed Gary Kluksdahl as Southwest trustee, and John Kane of Collinswood, New Jersey, will follow Mike Perry as Northeast trustee. Jo-Anne Lowenberger, of Winnipeg, MB, will succeed Murray McIntosh as trustee-at-large/Canada.

The new general service trustees will be John Skilton, who will serve as director on the A.A.W.S. Board, and Dorothy Hurley, who will serve on the Grapevine Board.

France Jolicoeur of NE Quebec will be the delegate chairperson for the 2008 Conference; Ron Hubbard of Western Missouri will be alternate chair.

Beginning Wednesday evening, after the 13 standing Conference committees had met, reviewed source material, and deliberated on their agenda items, the committee reports were presented to the entire Conference body. Recommendations were then discussed, questioned and debated, and the group

conscience of the Fellowship emerged — resulting in Advisory Actions, highlights of which appear on page 3.

The Conference officially closed Friday afternoon with the Serenity Prayer, led by Dave McCallum in English, Lynda Bergeron in French, and Hernán Merea in Spanish.

At the closing brunch Saturday morning, farewell talks were given by rotating trustees: Allen Ault, Gary Kluksdahl, Murray McIntosh, Mike Perry and Arnold Ross.

Then delegates of the 57th General Service Conference returned to their areas across the United States and Canada, where the process would begin again for the 58th Conference.

### Greetings from Delegate Chairperson

I'd like to welcome everyone to the 57th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous. I'd especially like to welcome the Panel 57 delegates, who are here for the first time, along with the G.S.O. staff and the trustees.

New York City is a long way from Greensburg, Kentucky, where I started my journey in sobriety 12 + years ago—when I walked, or should I say staggered, into my very first A.A. meeting.

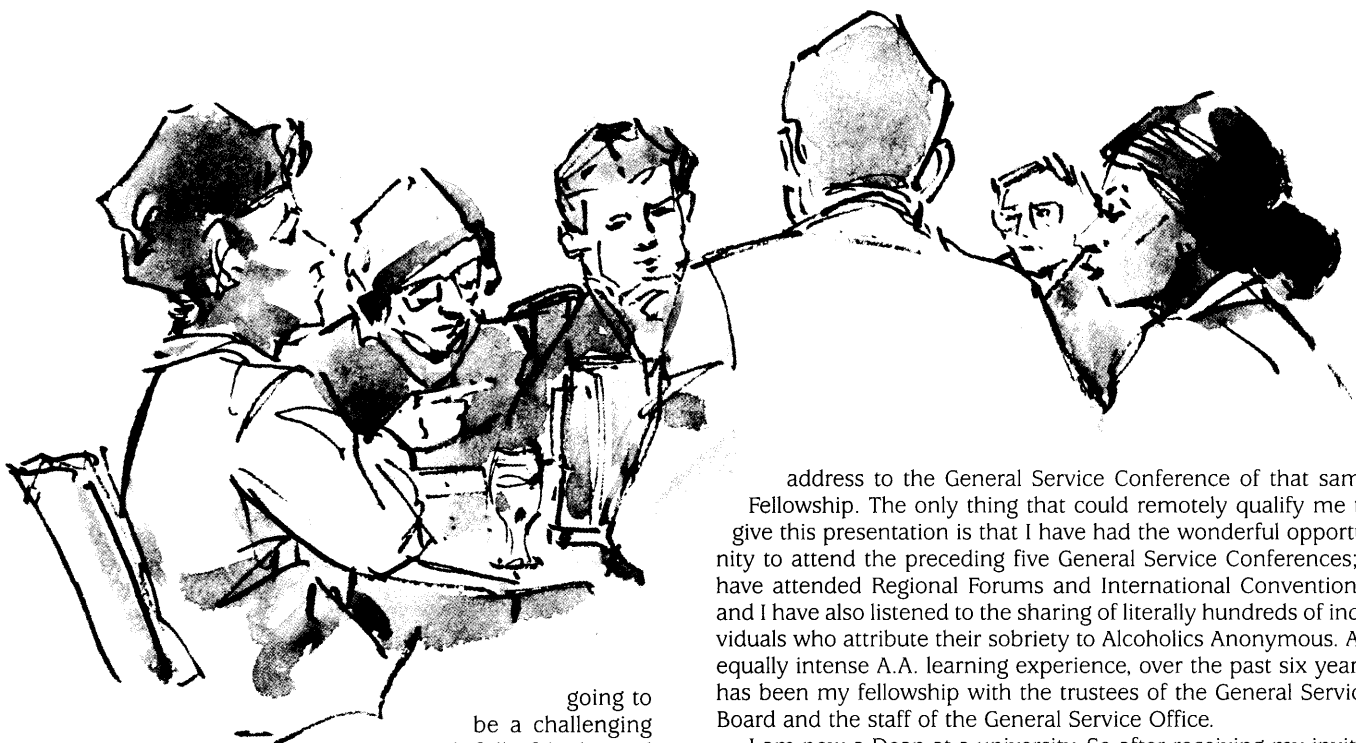
I hope no one feels as I felt last year, "like a lost ball in high weeds." Don't worry, I lived through it and you will too. Look around, because you haven't met your best friend yet. You aren't alone. But be aware that what we have to do here is bigger than any one of us. The reason I'm here today is that I owe Alcoholics Anonymous a debt for the life that I have today, that I could barely pay the interest on. For that, I'm grateful to have this opportunity to serve as your delegate chairperson.

That brings me to the theme of this year's Conference, "Our 12th Step Responsibility—Are We Going to Any Length?" Thinking about the theme caused me to ask myself some questions: Have I had a spiritual awakening as the result of these Steps? Am I truly responsible? Have I made myself available to the alcoholic who still suffers, both inside and outside of the room? What is our real purpose? Do I keep in mind that I'm to be of maximum service to God and my fellows? Let's ask ourselves those questions as we go about our duties as trusted servants this week.

So what is it going to be like this week? I can tell you that it's







going to be a challenging week full of highs and lows and long hours. Sometimes the Conference process seems confusing, and you may feel that you don't know what you're doing, but be assured we all felt the same way. I'm humbled by the fact that what happens here is really important, but the fact that we're willing to be here far outweighs the mistakes we may make.

I'd ask you to listen as though you have no opinion, to trust that the committee process is being led by something bigger than any one of us. We need to try and remember to keep our responsibilities in perspective, and that we're just part of a bigger whole. What we do here at the Conference was given to us by Bill and Bob years ago, to look out for the future of Alcoholics Anonymous, not only at our home group, but worldwide. Remember, even when we may feel uncomfortable with the process, that we're in a room with people that love us, and understand us more than we may ourselves. And that God is here to guide us as long as we have the willingness to ask.

That reminds me of the closing of last year's Conference, where we said the Serenity Prayer in four different languages and how recovery crosses all boundaries. Alcoholics Anonymous is saving the lives of people we don't even know across this big wonderful world and it's up to us to carry the message. Are we fulfilling our Twelfth Step responsibility? Are we going to any length?

I'd like to close with this thought, "No eyes can see. No ears can hear. No mind can even comprehend what God has in store for you at the 57th General Service Conference."

Darryl Miller, Kentucky

## Keynote

Good morning. I am Allen Ault, a departing Class A trustee. I was introduced to Alcoholics Anonymous in 1971 when three members of the Fellowship visited my office in a maximum security prison outside of Jackson, Georgia. As warden, they asked me to allow them to visit the institution once a week and work with inmates who had a drinking problem. It is amazing, at least to me, that 36 years later I have been invited to make the keynote

address to the General Service Conference of that same Fellowship. The only thing that could remotely qualify me to give this presentation is that I have had the wonderful opportunity to attend the preceding five General Service Conferences; I have attended Regional Forums and International Conventions; and I have also listened to the sharing of literally hundreds of individuals who attribute their sobriety to Alcoholics Anonymous. An equally intense A.A. learning experience, over the past six years, has been my fellowship with the trustees of the General Service Board and the staff of the General Service Office.

I am now a Dean at a university. So after receiving my invitation to do the keynote, I proceeded in the typical academic manner, to research great speeches. I found that, arguably, one of the very best speeches was also one of the briefest. It was given by Winston Churchill at a commencement in 1941. After a lengthy introduction, Mr. Churchill strode to the rostrum, looked at the audience and then, after a dramatic pause, said, "Never give in. Never give in—never, never, never—on nothing great or small, large or petty, never give in, except to the convictions of your own honor and good sense." He then proceeded to sit down. After a few seconds of stunned silence, the audience broke into sustained applause, which lasted for several minutes.

I believe that Prime Minister Churchill's remarks are still very pertinent today when related to the theme of this Conference—Our 12th Step Responsibility—Are We Going to Any Length?

This, of course, is not a commencement speech or even a great one. It is simply my thoughts about the theme for the 57th General Service Conference. What you have before you is an individual who has never formally worked any of the preceding Eleven Steps giving you a lecture about the Twelfth One. The audacity of some Class A trustees is beyond the pale!

The Twelfth Step reads as follows: "*Having had a spiritual awakening as the result of these steps, we tried to carry this message to alcoholics, and to practice these principles in all our affairs.*"

My speech is already longer than Winston's and I am just now getting to the point. Early in my career as a psychologist I observed that good mental health, or phrased another way, personal "well being," only began if individuals started to care about others, rather than totally concentrating on self.

The wonderful thing about Mr. Bill and Dr. Bob's "revolutionary insight" was that they articulated that it took a great deal of focused effort on "self" and a spiritual awakening before one could effectively reach out to others. Hence, the brilliance of the first Eleven Steps!

The other essential realization was that in order to maintain or sustain personal well being, one has to continue to care about and reach out to others. To put it in context for the members of the Fellowship it means that in order to sustain sobriety and health one has to consistently extend a helping hand to other

"still-suffering alcoholics." The Twelfth Step.

Are we going to any length with the Twelfth Step? Absolutely not. There are still millions of human beings in the world who are still suffering the rages of alcoholism. If that is a truism, then what strategies do we need to develop or change in order for us to optimize our efforts in leaving no hand untouched that is reaching out for help?

This is a totally different world than the one known by Mr. Bill and Dr. Bob. The methods of communications are drastically different and varied. The problems that face the human race are much more complex than in 1935. The available knowledge base has increased a trillion times since the early days of the Fellowship. Because of these dramatic changes, along with new transportation methods, the world has drastically shrunk. Or, as Mr. Freidman proclaims in his book, *The World Has Become Flat*.

With that in mind, the theme of this Conference may cause its delegates to reflect on some key issues for the betterment of the Fellowship: Have the basic needs of the human spirit changed? Answer: Probably not. Is it all right, for the sake of the continued "well being" of the Fellowship that its members only reach out to individuals who look like them? Answer: Resoundingly no. Is it all right to regress on occasion and become self-centered and self-serving? Answer: No, it is not healthy for the Fellowship or its members, but it is human.

Most importantly, in light of vast changes in the world in the past 72 years, can the methods used by the Fellowship to carry the message be greatly improved? Answer: Absolutely yes!

That leads directly to the theme of the Conference, paraphrased: How Can That Be Accomplished? Enabling members of the Fellowship to more effectively carry the message to other alcoholics has been and continues to be the only litmus test for any action taken by the General Service Conference and the General Service Board of Trustees.

Thank you for being my friend.

Allen Ault, Class A trustee

## Workshop: "Spiritual Value of Our A.A. Dollars"

Wednesday morning Conference members divided into groups for workshop discussions based on the topic selected by the 2006 Conference, "Spiritual Value of Our A.A. Dollars." Following are questions and a summary of responses from those discussions.

### 1. What practical and spiritual benefits come from contributing in the hat?

**Practical Benefits:** The most practical benefit that come from contributing in the hat is that we are able to reach out and help the person who is still suffering, and that helps in our recovery-the value of what we receive exceeds the contribution. Our con-

tributions also teach us to take care of ourselves by making sure that our expenses are covered, including rent, literature, coffee, coffee pot and supplies, and that our doors remain open. It supports our autonomy in action and sense of belonging and it gives us the feeling of having a voice. Self-centered fear is overcome and we feel good about ourselves. Contributing in the face of financial challenges provides a person with the feeling of doing the right thing. It also allows for more Twelfth Step work in the areas of H&I, C.P.C., and P.I. and allows us to care for groups that can't or are unable to pay rent, purchase literature and La Viña subscriptions.

**Spiritual Benefits:** There are many spiritual benefits that come from contributing in the hat, the most important being the sense of belonging, as the result of participating. Even minimal contributions make us feel a part of A.A.

Being a part of is a spiritual value; it is a demonstration of spiritual service and personal responsibility. Contributing is an action and a feeling that I have something of value to give. When we say to others and to ourselves that our contribution matters-we are saying what we have to give is important, no matter how much or how little. Contributing in the hat bolsters our self-esteem and self-worth; it deflates our ego. A.A. dollars are a personal sacrifice and demonstration of unselfishness; there is a sense of pride, ownership and autonomy. The contributions that we give today will come back threefold. When we contribute we feel spirituality, humility, gratitude and love.

Another spiritual aspect is that we learn about our common welfare; it provides a connection to A.A. as a whole. What we give to each other we give to God or to our Higher Power. Contributing promotes Unity and brings God's blessing. We have a group conscience as a result of contributing-a little bit of money from each makes us all one. The dollar put in the basket becomes money out of our own pocket to support our group and district. It is money that we will never miss and it never causes me any stress. Through our Twelve Concepts Bill W. would say that we may grow as individuals, but it's another thing to see other groups, districts, areas and regions and other countries being able to participate in Twelfth Step. Contributing in the hat ensures that A.A. is here for the future.

In the beginning, we may not have understood the purpose of contributing in the hat, but as we stayed sober we learned it was about "carrying the message to the person who still suffers." We also learned that we should be an example for others. In early sobriety we relied on everyone else, but somewhere in sobriety we learned to contribute what we could and it would be okay. As



times goes on, often learned that we needed to put more than \$1.00 in the basket, if we could afford it, because A.A. needed it to carry the message, and we needed to be responsible to A.A. as a whole. We came to realize what our seat cost in our home group and what each seat in A.A. costs in the world-in relation to providing A.A. needed services. Now we can compare the price of a drink versus the contribution to A.A. The monetary contributions that we make represent the spiritual benefits we receive from the program of Alcoholics Anonymous.

In the beginning, putting money in the basket made sense, but the longer we are sober, we became fearful of not having enough money. Trust came with time. There are places we might limit contributions for lack of a healthy group conscience, for example, we might bite our tongue when someone has a \$5.00 latte and doesn't participate in the hat. We make spiritual progress though dealing with problems that arise out of money issues. The money in the hat goes farther to helping others than a gift or loan to an individual. We do not donate, we contribute.

Knowledge of service entities starts with the G.S.R. In Québec, where there are low rents, each entity spends what is needed and passes the rest on to the next service entity. We should continue to encourage cooperation between the General Service Office and central or intergroup offices, especially in areas such as literature sales. Our home group and district are subsidized by raffles, the area by conventions, and G.S.O. by the sale of literature. To strengthen our communication and ensure that we fully inform our Fellowship we provide accounting and inventories of our spending, allocations of resources by priorities (either amounts or percentages), and we hold Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions study meetings. The Seventh Tradition is tied with the Twelfth Step.

We were taught by example to give in the hat. Hearing the stories of those directly helped by contributions was important. One delegate would lose a week's pay by coming to this Conference (self-employed), but what value can one put on a program that saved our life?

We need to keep emphasizing all of these growth principles and the practical benefits that allow us to carry the message. As the result of the practical action we also receive the spiritual benefit. Participation in the Seventh Tradition may appear at first to be a practical matter, but later it is seen as spiritual. The practical versus spiritual is hard to separate. Paying the bills (practical) and the sense of belonging after putting money in the basket (spiritual). The spirit of Tradition Two, the group conscience at all levels of A.A., guides the wise use of contributions to carry the message of hope.

## **2. Am I hesitant to ask other A.A. members to contribute or dig a little deeper, if they can? Why?**

There is no problem confronting those we know-but we can't ask them to do what we don't do. If a sponsee doesn't put a contribution in the basket, we may speak gently to him/her and explain why we have the Seventh Tradition. Often it is not that they don't want to contribute, but rather they don't understand. Encourage them one-on-one and remind them of the various levels of service. At some meetings and groups it may be necessary to ask directly for money to cover the meeting place or group expenses. Try not to forget that it is the spiritual aspect of participation that is important and not the amount. The spiritual always precedes the material.

The Fellowship has to see the need, then the groups will give freely. It is easier to ask for dollars when there are facts or detailed financial reports. Tell people their generous contributions make services possible. Explain Bill's story, in *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, of contributing the dime. Talk about the message of the Seventh Tradition while the basket is being passed. When the

group is in need, it is easier to ask folks to dig deeper. It helps to explain that money is the means that allows us to keep doing what we are doing.

We don't want to single anyone out or drive him/her away from recovery-therefore, this should be a sponsor-sponsee conversation. It's part of sponsorship to inform newcomers about the importance of the Seventh Tradition. At one person's first A.A. meeting, the person who became their sponsor stopped them from putting money in the basket and said "members only." It taught the newcomer the meaning of the Seventh Tradition and now this lesson is passed on to others. Sometimes we are hesitant because we know that people can't often afford contributions when they are new to A.A. But we learn that there are other ways they can contribute. Some individuals, groups, districts, and/or areas like to be asked for their help, usually if the cause is spiritual. Take the time to explain the real need. On anniversaries one group gives out G.S.O. envelopes for birthday contributions and explains that "if you give, you get something back" but "if you don't give, you get nothing back." We need to lead by example and not pressure folks to give, or to give the impression that giving, or giving a certain amount, is a requirement. Educate newcomers about the Seventh Tradition and explain where the money goes. Although many may ask members to contribute more money, another recommended approach is to read the "green card."

We use the phrase "We like to contribute meaningfully to G.S.O." and to this end one group passes the basket twice. It is one thing to not vote against a spending motion; however, one should never ask a member of A.A. to dig deeper. *The A.A. Service Manual* warns against pressuring A.A. members for money. To imply that there are dues or fees is wrong. It is not our business how much another member gives; however, don't be hesitant to talk about the importance of contributions. Asking for Seventh Tradition contributions gives those who may not be aware an opportunity to participate. We should rid ourselves of expectations regarding what we put in the basket; let others know that all that is needed is willingness and he/she will be given that ability. Do something positive and something positive will happen. It is difficult for some to encourage others to contribute, so it is helpful to remind others of the current price of a drink. One dollar in the basket is outdated because of inflation. A good Seventh Tradition "rule of thumb" is to contribute the price of just one drink.

Groups struggle with finding ways to ask A.A. members to contribute. Some areas have begun to refer to the literature as "no cost" instead of "free," because someone has to pay for it. Our literature tells us that money is a symbol of love and service. In one group they give both a medallion and a birthday envelope to members celebrating anniversaries. The easiest way to stay sober is by participation. We don't cut services, rather we ask for more contributions. Health and giving are ultimately related; often you can see people's lives change when they give.

Ask "What is your sobriety worth?" A Grapevine gave a new way of thinking about this: One member said he realized somehow that he misses meetings and contributions but expenses don't stop. So he puts \$20.00 in the basket at the beginning of each month to make sure he covers what he feels is his part. The point isn't how much; the point is stretching spiritually, to give as much as you can. Relate stories like the ones we have heard in A.A. (e.g. the street person who collected bottles so he could contribute knowing that the meeting would be there for him and others). Many members get to A.A. with higher bottoms. A G.S.R. in Québec said, "We would appreciate a silent contribution." Another says, "instead of sitting here and complaining about \$1.00 look inside of yourself and ask if I am giving all I can?"

Ask for Seventh Tradition contributions by encouraging

greater participation at all levels of service. Be an active service member who shows by example how the Seventh Tradition works for us as an organization and as individuals. The Grapevine publishes articles that remind members about being responsible. Conference reports provide opportunities to share the extensive uses of contributions. A Seventh Tradition contribution is unconditional and is given for the sake of the gift itself. The Seventh Tradition is given freely, without regard for the expected services to be received. We don't have to be timid about asking for contributions if it helps to inform others.

### **3. How does my group ensure that A.A. dollars are spent wisely in the spirit of carrying the message at:**

**The Group** — In our home group we contribute a set amount to all our service entities. We have regular group business meetings to discuss the wise use of A.A. contributions and disbursement, to explain the Seventh Tradition, the real need of contributions, and how these contributions help us with Twelfth Step work. We explain that contributions are general funds that are dedicated for a specific purpose and they are given freely with no strings attached. We use the suggested formulas (50/25/25) etc. and stick to it, and we talk to people individually about where the money goes.

**The District** — Our G.S.R. attends district meetings regularly to keep informed. One district always has about \$2,500 in its treasury to buy literature and to do things for others. If we are doing A.A. work and carrying the message the money is always there.

**The Central or Intergroup Office** — Our G.S.R. and Intergroup representatives make presentations twice a year on why we send money to our service entities, this way all of our members are informed. Central offices keep the phones operating and makes literature available. We have service representatives participate in the intergroup business meetings.

**The Area** — Our area guidelines suggest prudent uses of our A.A. funds, we are willing to adjust our prudent reserves rather than hoard the money. Our area is doing well, but we had to go into our prudent reserve to send our delegate to this Conference. We try to fully fund our delegate. Our area loved getting a letter thanking us for our contribution.

**The General Service Office** — We send contributions to G.S.O. according to our new pie chart. We encourage G.S.O. to focus on areas where participation is slow.

**The A.A. Grapevine** — The Grapevine reports on how groups and delegates carry the message. Help support the Grapevine by encouraging subscriptions, giving them as gifts and putting them in doctor's offices. Some groups give the Grapevine away at free raffles, and others subscribe to the Grapevine and La Viña and give Grapevine subscriptions to our members on their first anniversary. We also have group subscriptions to the Grapevine. Get a Grapevine subscription for yourself and if you don't read it give it to a newcomer.

One delegate is often asked why some groups don't get mail from G.S.O. I ask them when was the last time they contributed or if they had a G.S.R.? One of the most important jobs of the G.S.R. is to explain the need for unification, being a part of the whole, and the spiritual growth

of the group. Our group is fractured and our district is falling apart; our treasurer has taken off with the money. Our group took its own inventory after a treasurer absconded with the funds. We came up with a way of encouraging qualified candidates to stand for treasurer. Someone took responsibility for recruiting, preparing and supporting the best treasurers they could. It also helps to have treasurer workshops.

We need to hold our service entities accountable, and to make sure that they tell us what they are doing with the contributions. There is no such thing as an A.A. dance, fish fry, etc. Our group does not use money collected via the basket to support group anniversaries. Accumulating extra funds distracts groups from A.A.'s primary purpose. We do not support non-A.A. type events. There was much discussion about misconceptions of club participation in A.A. as a whole. Supporting clubhouses doesn't mean that contributions are going to A.A. Ask clubs to participate in ways consistent with A.A. principles. Contribute time and service to your community.

Groups must meet their financial responsibilities. Inform groups, but don't embarrass anyone; stick to the Twelve Traditions and principles and disregard personalities. Follow the group conscience and if it strays from the Twelve Traditions, start a new group. P.S.A. and videos are money well spent; C.P.C. work is very important.

It has been an exciting year reaching our young people, which to me is spending A.A. dollars wisely. We have clearly defined responsibilities for each service position.

Trust the process and trusted servants. Be wise, responsible and informed and encourage members to do their own fact-finding and research about where the money goes. We need to stay informed at all levels and contribute accordingly. We try to send something to all levels of the service structure, no matter the amount. Be connected, so A.A. will be here for our children and grandchildren.



# Conference Advisory Actions

*Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 2007 Conference.*

## AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 1 The theme for the 2008 General Service Conference be: "Communication and Participation—The Key to Unity and Self-Support."
- 2 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2008 General Service Conference:
  - a) Communication and Participation:
    - 1) Sharing the Message of Service
    - 2) Our Key to Keeping A.A. Strong
    - 3) Leadership in A.A.: Building Communication
  - b) Unity:
    - 1) Our Common Welfare Should Come First
    - 2) Principles Before Personalities
    - 3) Diversity: Reaching Out to All Alcoholics
  - c) Self Support:
    - 1) Self-Supporting Through Members' Voluntary Contributions Only
    - 2) Contempt Prior to Investigation
    - 3) Responsibility to Communicate and Participate
- 3 The following be the workshop topic for the 2008 General Service Conference: "Love and Tolerance, Now More Than Ever."

## ARCHIVES<sup>1</sup>

It was recommended that:

- 4 Any future proposed project involving widespread distribution of archival recordings be submitted to the Conference Archives Committee so that the Conference might provide guidance prior to production.

## COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

No recommendations.

## CORRECTIONS

It was recommended that:

- 5 The draft informational media presentation featuring someone highly credible in the corrections field introducing A.A. to training academies and in-service training programs for correctional personnel be approved with a suggested change to be reviewed and approved by the trustees' Committee on Corrections.

## FINANCE

It was recommended that:

- 6 The annual limit contributed to the General Service Board from individual A.A. members be increased from \$2,000 to \$3,000 and that bequests from A.A. members should be subject to the same limit and continue to be on a one-time basis and not in perpetuity.
- 7 The following text: "G.S.R. travel expenses to attend service functions" be added to the sentence "Once the basic group expenses have been taken care of (rent, refreshments, A. A. literature, local meeting lists)" on page 7, paragraph 3, first sentence of the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix" (F-3) as these expenses are suggested in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

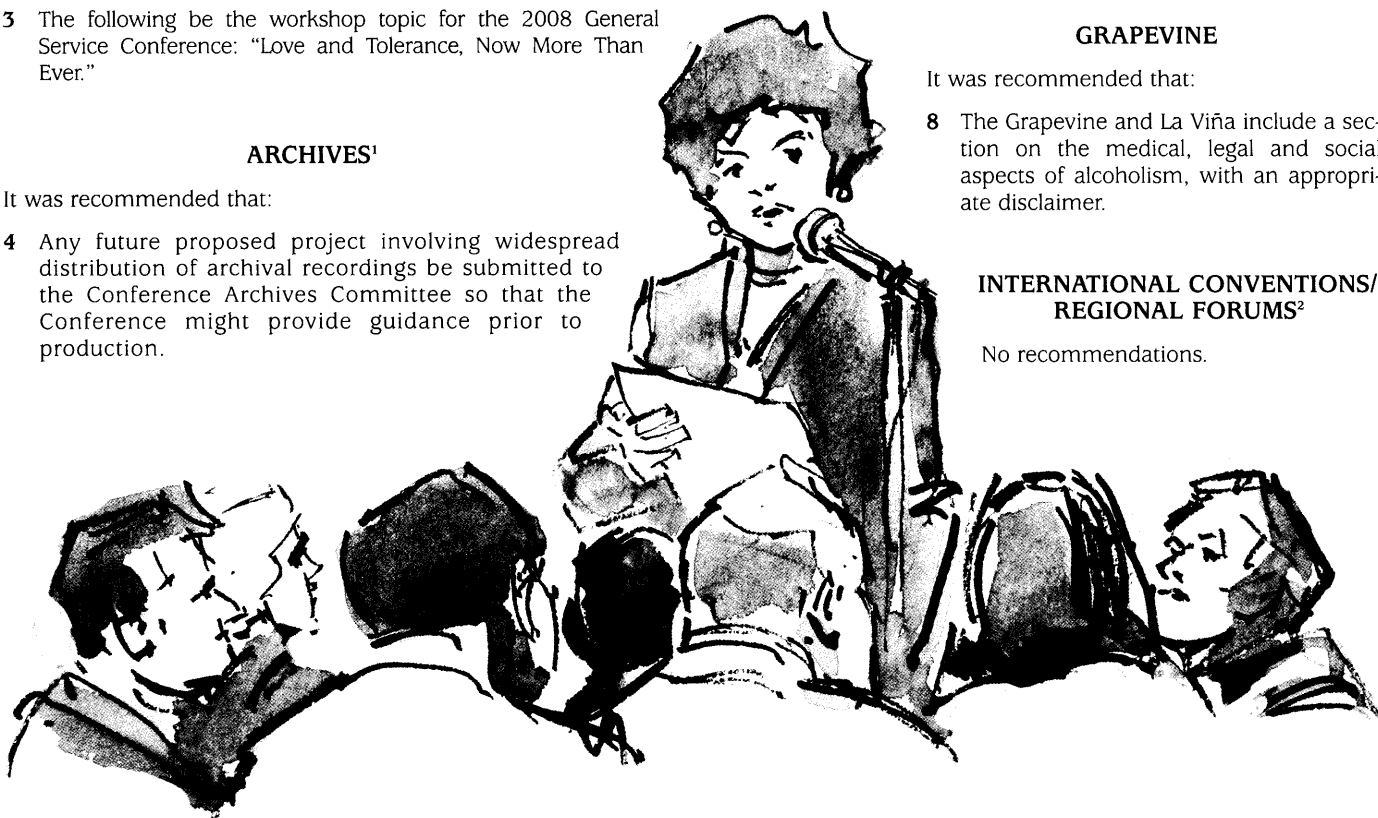
## GRAPEVINE

It was recommended that:

- 8 The Grapevine and La Viña include a section on the medical, legal and social aspects of alcoholism, with an appropriate disclaimer.

## INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS<sup>2</sup>

No recommendations.



<sup>1</sup>Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

## LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

- 9 The following text from *The A.A. Service Manual* be added to "The A.A. Group" and the "G.S.R." pamphlets:

"Financial Support: Current experience indicates that many groups provide financial support for their general service representatives to attend service functions."

- 10 The title of the pamphlet "Can A.A. Help Me Too?" subtitled "Black/African Americans Share Their Stories" be changed to "A.A. for the Black and African American Alcoholic."

- 11 The pamphlet, "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" be revised to include current experience of A.A. members and that a revised draft pamphlet or a progress report be brought back to the 2008 Conference Committee on Literature.

- 12 The Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, be produced, keeping in mind the 2004 Conference Advisory Action on contents, story selection, and process, as follows:

### I. Contents

- a) The Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book to be similar in page count to the English Fourth Edition Big Book.

- b) The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, the Preface, the Forewords, "The Doctor's Opinion," "Dr. Bob's Nightmare," and the Appendices will undergo a complete review to assure accuracy of translation and consistency of style and tone throughout the text. As in translations of all languages, the Publications Department strives to reflect the best possible translation of Bill W.'s writings and does not require Conference-approval.

#### c) Personal Stories:

- Retain selected stories from current Spanish-language Second Edition.
- Select stories from A.A.'s *La Viña* magazine.
- Select new stories from Spanish-speaking membership.
- Stories to be designated to three main sections similar to the English Fourth Edition Big Book.

### II. Story Solicitation

- a) Within the United States and Canada and internationally to Spanish-speaking countries.

### III. Story Selection Process

- a) To be under the direction of the trustees' Literature subcommittee on the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book.

#### b) Story selection subcommittee:

- All bilingual—Spanish and English:
- Spanish editors.
- Spanish-speaking staff members.
- Chair to appoint some subcommittee members from the Fellowship.

#### c) Basic Selection Criteria:

- To use the same criteria as the English Fourth Edition Big Book based on Bill W.'s recommendations.
- Each story must, as Bill W. recommended, reach out to the newcomer who is still looking for the A.A. solution.
- Each story must be a standard A.A. story that tells what it was like, what happened, and what it is like today.

and, that the Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book include:

- Updated translations of Bill's Own Story, "Dr. Bob's Nightmare," the stories "Alcoholics Anonymous #3" and "Women Suffer Too."
- The existing twelve original stories from the Second Edition Spanish-language Big Book.
- Up to 32 new selected Spanish-language stories.
- Translations of the Forewords to the English Edition and the Foreword to the existing edition.
- A new Foreword to be developed by the Publications Department explaining the process and development of the Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book.

The committee acknowledged that the Publications Department strives to reflect the best possible translation of Bill W.'s writings and recognized that translations of Bill W.'s writings do not require Conference-approval.



## POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

- 13 Hari Boggs, alternate delegate, Area 81, New Brunswick/PEI, be seated as a Conference member at the 57th General Service Conference because Adrien Gionet, the Panel 56 delegate for Area 81 is unable to attend.
- 14 The 60th General Service Conference be held April 18-24, 2010, since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays, hotel availability and Bylaws' deadlines of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.

## PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

- 15 The 2007 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis as was done in the 2004 A.A. Membership Survey.
- 16 The public service announcement "A Force of Nature," developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee, be approved.
- 17 The television public service announcement "A Force of Nature" be centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$30,000, in addition to the work of local Public Information committees.
- 18 The 2002 Conference Advisory Action that states "After the initial four years this cycle would continue with the oldest P.S.A. [public service announcement] being replaced each year" be reaffirmed and a new P.S.A. be developed for review by the 2008 Conference Committee on Public Information at a cost not to exceed \$40,000, and the oldest P.S.A. in the four year plan be replaced.
- 19 The trustees' Committee on Public Information develop their suggestion for a video project that would include video/digital submissions from the Fellowship, with selected submissions to be compiled and used in carrying the A.A. message to young people. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Public Information:
  - Develop clear guidelines for the request and submission of videos (or digital files) at their July 2007 meeting and that the guidelines be consistent with A.A. Traditions and appropriate safety/legal concerns.
  - Create a timetable at their July 2007 meeting for the request of video/digital submissions from the Fellowship.
  - Develop a draft from video/digital submissions or progress report to be brought back to the 2008 Conference Committee on Public Information for review.

Note: Estimated development cost is \$28,000
- 20 The list of early signs of alcoholism derived from A.A. Conference-approved literature forwarded by the trustees' Committee on Public Information replace the current list of early signs in the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings."
- 21 A section on posthumous anonymity be developed by the Publications Department for inclusion in the pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" and a draft be brought back to the 2008 Conference Committee on Public Information for consideration.

- 22 The words "Young, old. Rich, poor. Black, white." under the section titled ALCOHOLISM be deleted from the pamphlet "A Message to Teenagers."

## REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

- 23 The second paragraph on p. S29 of *The A.A. Service Manual*, which reads, "In the majority of areas, a district includes six to 20 groups. In metropolitan districts, the number is generally 15 to 20 groups, while in rural or suburban districts the number can be as small as five," be replaced with the following:

"The number of groups per district varies widely, from as few as five in a rural district to 90 or more in a metropolitan district. Population density and the geographic size of the district, which will affect the ability of the D.C.M. to communicate with the groups, would be key factors determining the number of groups a district will have."
- 24 The following sentence be inserted on p. S72 of the *The A.A. Service Manual* at the beginning of the second paragraph under the heading "Trademarks, Logos, and Copyrights":

"In 1993, Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc., announced that official use of all of the several circle/triangle trademarks and service marks was being discontinued."
- 25 The Publications Department insert into *The A.A. Service Manual*, where appropriate, the inverted triangle graphic that currently appears annually in the General Service Conference manual.
- 26 A paragraph titled "District Information," which includes an illustration of the District Information Change Form (F-43), be developed for inclusion in Chapter Three in *The A.A. Service Manual* and brought back to the 2008 Conference Committee on Report and Charter for review.
- 27 The last sentence in the second paragraph of "The Conference Structure—An Overview" (p. S15) in *The A.A. Service Manual*, which reads: "Today, general service includes all kinds of activities within the Conference structure, carried on by districts, area committees, delegates, trustees, the General Service Office and the Grapevine," be changed to read as follows:

"Today, general service includes all kinds of activities within the Conference structure, carried on by groups, districts, area committees, delegates, trustees, the General Service Office and the Grapevine."

## TREATMENT FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

- 28 The video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* be revised, retaining only the script, and that sample footage or a progress report be brought to the 2008 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities.

Note: The cost would be approximately \$50,000.



## TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

- 29** The following slates of trustees and officers be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., in April 2007:

### Class A

|                              |                    |
|------------------------------|--------------------|
| Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D. | Herbert I. Goodman |
| William D. Clark, M.D.       | Vincent E. Keefe   |
| Ward B. Ewing, D.D.          | Jeanne S. Woodford |
| The Hon. Rogelio Flores      |                    |

### Class B

|                          |                      |
|--------------------------|----------------------|
| Charles J. (Chuck) Barta | Howard Lowery        |
| Conley F. Byrd, Jr.      | Raymond Massey       |
| Paul Cleary              | Robert (Bob) Mayer   |
| Dorothy L. Hurley        | Madeleine J. Parmley |
| John J. Kane, Jr.        | John Skilton         |
| Tom Kraemer              | Dorothy Wilson       |
| Jo-Anne Lowenberger      |                      |

Note: The General Service Board will operate short one Class B regional trustee.

The following slate of officers be elected at the second quarterly meeting of the General Service Board in April 2007.

|                                |                              |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------|
| <i>Chairperson</i>             | Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D. |
| <i>First vice-chairperson</i>  | Herbert I. Goodman           |
| <i>Second vice-chairperson</i> | William D. Clark, M.D.       |
| <i>Treasurer</i>               | Vincent E. Keefe             |
| <i>Secretary</i>               | Charles J. (Chuck) Barta     |
| <i>Assistant Treasurer</i>     | Donald W. Meurer             |
| <i>Assistant Secretary</i>     | Eva Sanchez*                 |

\*To be replaced at G.S.O. staff rotation, July 2007.

- 30** The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of A.A. World Services, Inc. in April 2007:

|                  |                |
|------------------|----------------|
| Paul Cleary      | Eva Sanchez*   |
| Roberta Lindeman | John Skilton   |
| Howard Lowery    | Jane Tolar     |
| George G. Martin | Dorothy Wilson |
| Greg Muth        |                |

\*To be replaced at G.S.O. staff rotation, July 2007.

- 31** The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. in April 2007:

|                     |                               |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|
| Ginger Rhoades Bell | Raymond Massey                |
| James Branscome     | Robert (Bob) Mayer            |
| Robin Bromley       | Madeleine J. Parmley          |
| Herbert I. Goodman  | Andrew M. (Andy) Talbert, Jr. |
| Dorothy L. Hurley   |                               |

- 32** In accordance with the Bylaws of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., the General Service Board consider all eligible Class A (nonalcoholic) and Class B (alcoholic) trustees when selecting the chairperson of the General Service Board.

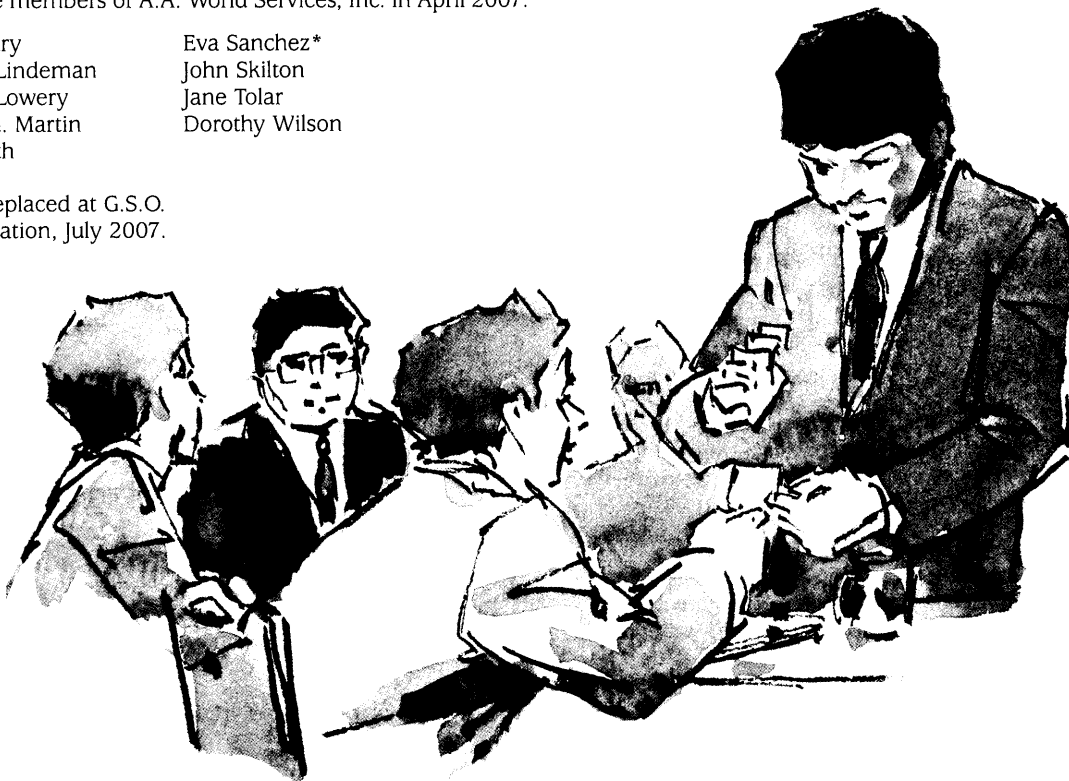
Note: The Bylaws of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., may be found in The A.A. Service Manual.

- 33** The amendment to the April 2006 Bylaws of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., as forwarded from the General Service Board, be approved. The new language would be:

"In the case of a Class B trustee, the maximum term of service of such successor member trustee shall be limited to that number of one-year terms which would result in the term of service of the successor member trustee ending at the same time as the term of the replaced member trustee would have ended, if no vacancy had occurred and the replaced member trustee had served four successive one-year terms."

Note: The language in the Bylaws, approved in April 2006, which will now be replaced, was:

"In the case of a Class B trustee, the maximum term of service of such successor member trustee shall be four years from the date of the meeting at which he or she is elected."





# Presentations and Reports

## REPORT: FINANCE

*Monday afternoon the Finance report, followed by a sharing session, was given by Vince Keefe, treasurer of the General Service Board and chairman of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. For more details please see the finance section of this Report, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary report.*

Good afternoon. My name is Vince Keefe and I am a grateful Class A trustee and treasurer of the General Service Board. I consider it a privilege to deliver the Treasurer's report today to the 57th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The complete report of our independent auditor, Owen J. Flanagan and Company, will be included in the finance section of the *Final Conference Report*. Our audit partner, Kevin Sunkel, is in attendance this afternoon and is available to answer any questions that may arise from this report. Also available are Don Meurer, chief financial officer of the General Service Office, and Eugene O'Brien, controller of the A.A. Grapevine. We are fortunate to be blessed with an extremely competent finance team.

The format for my report, as in previous years, will be a PowerPoint presentation showing the key points of the financial condition of the General Service Board, as well as that of A.A. World Services, Inc., and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. My primary goal is to help you become as familiar as possible with our financial condition, so that you can communicate clearly when you return to your area. I believe that one of the characteristics of a strong service structure is a clear understanding of our finances by everyone involved, so please do not hesitate to ask any questions that you may have now, or as the week progresses. Your area will be listening carefully to what you have to report after this Conference, and I am anxious to help you in any way I can.

This financial presentation is organized into five basic components: (1) our General Service Office, (2) A.A.W.S. Publishing activities, (3) La Viña, (4) The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and (5) the General Service Board Reserve Fund. There is also one additional section this year, a review of the recent changes in federal pension regulations and their impact on Alcoholics Anonymous. We will primarily focus on the results for the calendar year 2006; however, prior year results and the 2007 budget are also included to allow a broader perspective.

Our first chart summarizes the cost of the service functions performed at your General Service Office on behalf of the General Service Board. I am sure that we are all familiar with each function listed, with the possible exception of the last line entitled Supporting Services. Supporting Services includes the administrative, accounting, human resources, information technology, rent, and other indirect overhead costs. The individual service functions would not be able to operate without this support structure. The total cost of the General Service Office functions for 2006 is \$8,272,012, approximately \$828,000 (or 11 %) more than the \$7,443,295 spent in 2005.

This increase of \$828,000 can be further detailed as follows: The increase in pension and retirement health equals \$306,000 with \$193,000 of the amount allocated to

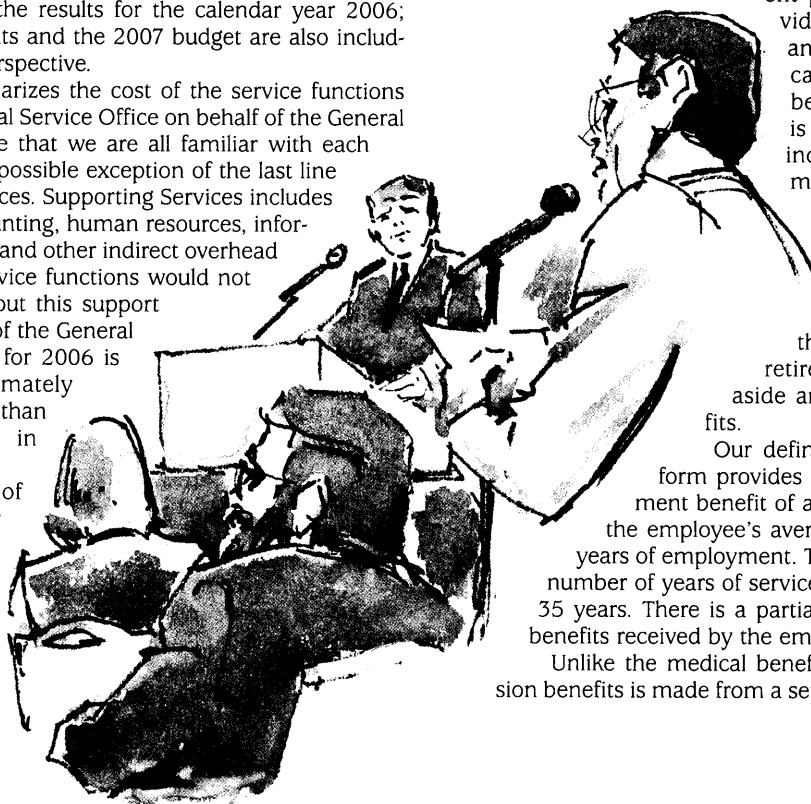
the General Service Office. Other increases include Writer Fees of \$105,000, Foreign Literature Assistance of \$109,000, the World Service Meeting of \$88,000, and then the normal inflation amounting to approximately \$223,000. This accounts for \$718,000, with the remaining \$110,000 spread over a large number of line items.

**Health Insurance Benefits for Retirees:** For many years we have included retired employees in our group health insurance coverage. For each retired employee, we currently pay between 25% and 75% of the cost of providing such insurance for the retiree, depending on their length of service with us. The retiree pays the remainder. Until last year, this practice was done on a "pay as you go" basis—no funds were set aside to pay future benefits. When the insurance bills came in, we paid them, and that was it. Our share of the annual payments under this practice currently is about \$200,000 per year. However, Generally Accepted Accounting Principles requires that our financial statements show an expense each year for a portion of the amount that will be paid to our current employees in the future. As a result, each year a liability has been recorded for a portion of the future medical insurance payments for the benefit of our current employees after their retirement, and this liability shown on our balance sheet has grown over the years to almost \$4,000,000. That liability will eventually be paid, in some cases far in the future, in connection with our annual payment of the insurance bills. Given the size of this liability, we decided last year that it would be prudent to create a fund, separate from our reserve fund, to accumulate money to help pay these future benefits. Our goal is a modest one—to reduce the balance sheet liability by half within the next 10 years. A payment of \$225,000 was made to this fund last year, and we have budgeted a \$250,000 payment for 2007. All payments are shared between A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. We plan to make comparable payments into the fund each year for the foreseeable future. Premium payments to the insurance companies will continue to be made from the operating accounts of A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine, and not from the new fund.

**Defined Benefit Pension Plan:** We established a defined benefit pension plan in 1965 to provide pension benefits to A.A.W.S. and Grapevine employees. It is called a *defined benefit* plan because the benefit to be paid is calculated by a formula that is independent of the amount of money which we have set aside to pay these benefits. The other type of pension plan that some companies have is known as a defined contribution plan, which bases the amount to be paid to the retiree on the amount actually set aside and available to pay the benefits.

Our defined benefit plan in its current form provides benefits as follows: The retirement benefit of an employee is a percentage of the employee's average compensation in the final years of employment. The percentage is 2 % times the number of years of service with us, up to a maximum of 35 years. There is a partial offset for the Social Security benefits received by the employee.

Unlike the medical benefits program, payment of pension benefits is made from a separate Pension Trust. Oversight



of the activity of the Pension Trust is the responsibility of our Retirement Committee, which has an independent fiduciary duty to monitor the proper payment of benefits and the prudent investment of the money held in the Pension Trust. The committee is composed of representatives from our corporate management, directors, retirees and current employees. The committee retains the services of professional investment advisors and actuaries to assist it in its duties.

Each year, with the assistance of our actuaries, we determine the amount of the contribution we will make that year to the Pension Trust. Federal law prescribes minimum contributions, although we typically pay more than this required minimum. Our contribution for the 2006 plan year was \$710,000. Income earned on investments in the trust fund, together with our annual contribution, is designed to cover the cost of benefit payments and to allow the fund to grow so that future benefits are adequately provided for. At the end of last year the market value of the investments in the Pension Trust was just under \$13,000,000.

Each year the actuaries calculate the present value of all future pension benefits of our current and retired employees. This calculation is made in accordance with Generally Accepted Accounting Principles, and the amount determined is disclosed in a footnote to our financial statements. At December 31, 2006, this amount was approximately \$17,850,000. You will note that this is about \$4,850,000 more than the assets in our Pension Trust. Many pension funds are similarly situated, primarily because of the steep stock market declines in 2001 and 2002. While there is no accounting requirement to actually fund this difference, our annual contributions are intended to close this gap over time. You may recall that the shortfall last year was almost \$5,800,000. A very strong stock market in 2006 caused an increase in the market value of the Pension Trust portfolio of more than \$1,400,000. Offsetting this was an increase in the present value of the pension liability of about \$400,000, and thus the net improvement of our position of about \$1,000,000.

The calculation of pension liabilities requires many assumptions to be made, including mortality rates, employee turnover, future wage rates, and a rate of discount to properly reflect the fact that much of this liability will not have to be paid until well into the future. This brings us to the new Federal pension law amendments and the effect they will have on our funding. The new law requires us to determine the difference between the Pension Trust's assets and the future value of pension benefits as of January 1, 2008, and mandates that we make contributions to the Pension Trust to completely eliminate any shortfall within seven years. The law prescribes how the calculation of the value of the future benefits is to be made; the assumptions used in making this calculation are significantly different than those used in the calculation made for purposes of our financial statements. Although we will not know the exact number until next January 1, we anticipate that the amount of the shortfall that we will be required to fund under the new law will be in the neighborhood of \$2,000,000.

We have decided to begin extra funding this year in order to get a head start on the payments that will be needed to meet this new "full funding" requirement. We have budgeted a little over a \$1,000,000 payment to the Pension Trust in 2007, and anticipate that comparable contributions will be needed for the foreseeable future.

You will note in our consolidated balance sheet a pension liability of about \$1,660,000 as of December 31, 2006. Why is this different than the shortfall described in the footnote and the shortfall which we expect to start funding for tax purposes? Alas, it is computed in yet another manner, different from both of the others, although new accounting rules effective in 2007 may

bring the footnote and the balance sheet into line at the end of this year. Although these retirement benefit matters are very complicated and difficult to understand, I think we will be fine if we just keep our eye on the ball. The situation, in summary, is this: The unfunded liabilities, regardless of how calculated, represent a commitment to future payments over a very long period of time, and do not impose an annual cash flow burden on us beyond our ability to handle them in the ordinary course of our activities. The recent pension law amendments and our decision to establish a separate fund for payment of future retiree medical benefits will impose increased funding requirements on the order of several hundred thousand dollars a year. While this is a significant amount, we should remember that it represents only a small percentage of our total operating expenses. With the continued support of our membership, we should be able to meet these requirements without affecting the level of our services to the Fellowship.

The next chart is very similar to the first except that in this slide Supporting Services has been allocated across the activities to show the fully absorbed cost of each activity. We can see that a contribution of \$6.37 per member, or \$142.42 per group, in 2007 will allow the Fellowship to be fully self-supporting from contributions. A.A.W.S. is budgeting \$8,337,958 in 2007, an increase of approximately \$66,000, or 0.8%.

Our next chart shows a detailed breakdown of the Group Services activities. In 2005, Special Needs was included in Group Services, and Nominating was included in Regional Forums. This slide is intended to help groups understand the range of services performed by the General Service Office on behalf of each group.

How do we pay for these important service functions? The General Service Board has three sources of funds: group contributions, A.A.W.S. literature profits, and transfers from the Reserve Fund.

In 2006 the General Service Board received group contributions of \$6,068,172, which is an increase of \$651,126, or 12%, over the previous year. This is clearly a record for any one year in the history of the Fellowship. Not only is the dollar amount a record, the 12% increase is also the largest increase for any one year, at least in recent memory. I am sure I speak for everyone when I say how deeply grateful we are for this outpouring of support from across the Fellowship. We are grateful for every member who has sent in a contribution to help pay the bills of your General Service Office. A special word of thanks to all the delegates, D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s who worked to help make this strong result possible. Your hard work is most evident by looking at these gratifying results.

We are also delighted to see an increase this year in both the number and percentage of participating groups. In 2006, 45.5% of groups sent contributions, which is an increase over last year of 2.3%. It is important to remember that the statistics we discuss concerning number of groups, membership and averages are only a reflection of the information we capture on our systems. We report to you what you report to us.

Our next slide summarizes the financial performance of A.A.W.S. publishing activities. Gross sales of literature in 2006 amounted to \$12,006,989, which is \$83,150 or 0.7% greater than 2005. After deducting the cost of goods sold and shipping and warehousing costs, there remains a gross profit of \$6,880,015, or 57.3% of sales. The final profit from literature sales after deducting the administrative expenses is \$2,857,740, a decrease from 2005 of \$142,088.

La Viña, our Spanish-language magazine, reported improved financial results for 2006. Gross profit from the sale of magazines and related items equaled \$41,247, an increase of \$19,598 over 2005. After deducting the costs and expenses of \$113,248, the

result is a loss for 2006 of \$72,001. This compares to a loss in 2005 of \$107,739.

The A.A. Grapevine, on the other hand, has had a very challenging year. We have just heard a very complete report describing in detail the extensive work underway to solve a myriad of issues before the Grapevine Board. Last year fell short of expectations in both magazine and related items sales and margins. Magazine gross profit was approximately \$50,000 under budget. Gross profit from related items was under budget by approximately \$65,000. Costs and expenses were kept below budget by approximately \$37,000 in spite of increases in health and pension costs similar to those incurred by A.A.W.S. This reduction in budgeted expenses was not enough to offset the shortfall in gross profit. As a result the Grapevine had an operating loss of \$48,873 for 2006.

The budget for 2007 anticipates a loss of \$81,328. This budget does include some additional costs that the Board feels necessary to help eliminate losses in the years ahead.

It is obvious to me that the Grapevine needs our support. Quite frankly it appears that we have put the Grapevine in a no-win situation. What we have done is this: first, we ask very capable individuals to take on the responsibility of being directors of the Grapevine; second, we ask them to maintain the independent voice of our Fellowship (a very precious tradition); and third, we ask them to be sure that the Grapevine remains self-supporting. After doing all of this, many of us then hesitate when it comes time to subscribe to the magazine. How can the Grapevine ever meet our expectations without the support of all of us?

Here are a few facts worth remembering about our Grapevine magazine:

- Much of Bill W.'s early writing appeared for the first time in the Grapevine magazine during the years when he was developing many of his thoughts.
- Thousands of alcoholics have told their story of recovery in a Grapevine article.
- The Grapevine does not seek contributions from A.A. members or A.A. groups, nor advertising revenues of any kind. The Grapevine has a mandate to be self-supporting entirely through the sale of magazines and the sale of related items such as books, CDs, and the audio Grapevine.
- During the 56-year period, from 1951 to 2006, the A.A. Grapevine operated in the black for 37 years and in the red for 19 of those years. Over these same 56 years the Grapevine generated an overall profit of \$725,749.
- The Grapevine is totally focused on carrying the message of recovery as well as serving the Fellowship as a Twelfth Step tool. Did you know that the pass along rate of the Grapevine is four people plus the original subscriber? What does this tell us about the Twelfth Step value of the magazine?
- The A.A. Grapevine board recently determined that it would only take about 9,300 additional subscribers to put the magazine on very a solid financial base. According to group records in the General Service Office, we have approximately 1.3 million A.A. members in the U.S. and Canada. If we can increase the current subscriptions from 103,000 to 112,300, our subscription rate would then be 8.6 % of the total. So what if each delegate encouraged their area to have a subscription rate of at least 9% of the members in their area?

We can be more responsible in supporting our "meeting in print" by subscribing now and encouraging others to do the same.

The next chart shows a combined financial overview of the General Service Board for the year ended December 31, 2006.

The General Service Office shows contributions, interest, and literature profits totaling \$8,929,898. We then subtract the cost of services provided of \$8,272,013, leaving a surplus for 2006 of \$657,885. Next we subtract the operating losses of the A.A. Grapevine (\$48,875) and La Viña (\$72,004), leaving a net combined surplus of \$537,008 for 2006.

The last part of our analysis will cover the General Service Board Reserve Fund. The Reserve Fund ended 2006 with a balance of \$10,357,069, equal to approximately 8.8 months of operating expenses. This means that we remain at the lower end of the acceptable range in terms of the number of months of expenses covered.

I would like to remind everyone of the key actions that have been taken in recent years to maintain the Reserve Fund within an acceptable range. As you know, we have:

- Reduced the price of the Big Book by \$1 coincident with the publication of the 4th Edition.
- Restored the price of the Big Book in July 2004 by raising the price by \$1.
- Announced increases in certain book prices and handling charges effective July 1, 2005.
- Accomplished a major cost reduction program at the General Service Office to lower our annual operating costs.

As a result of these actions, the Reserve Fund has fluctuated between 12 equivalent months of operating expenses in calendar 2000 to 8.8 months at the end of 2006.

What can we conclude after having reviewed all of the various financial statements? For one thing we can say surprises happen every year and 2006 is certainly no exception.

In 2006:

- We saw the Fellowship respond with a record amount of contributions to help pay the cost of our General Service Office.
- The percent of groups sending contributions increased for the first time in the last five years.
- Increases in pension and retiree health care costs have added significantly to the annual cost of the General Service Office.
- Gross sales of literature showed only a very small increase over 2005, while the related gross profit was slightly lower.
- La Viña reduced the overall loss incurred in 2005 by approximately \$36,000.
- The A.A. Grapevine posted a loss of \$48,875 instead of the budgeted profit of \$19,983.

My view is that we have strong committees, management, and staff that work hard throughout the year, reacting very well to all the surprises that come along. And even in light of all these surprises, our Prudent Reserve finished practically even with the number of months covered in 2004 and 2005.

Of course, this would not have happened without the generous and loyal support of our Fellowship. A big tip of our hat goes to the delegates, D.C.M.s, and G.S.R.s who have done the hard work of communicating our financial needs all the way up to the group level. The record contributions show that our service structure is strong and very functional.

My hope is that each of us pledges to continue to do our best to maintain momentum into 2007 and 2008. Surprises will come our way, but with the continued support of our membership we will be able to meet new surprises without affecting the level of our services to the Fellowship.

*Vincent E. Keefe, treasurer  
General Service Board*

## ARCHIVES

*Monday evening's session began with a presentation by G.S.O.'s archivist. The sharing session which followed was chaired by Herb Goodman, Class A trustee.*

When I opened the invitation to speak to you, the letter suggested that my talk focus on Archives, naturally, as well as on the Conference theme, "Our 12th Step Responsibility—Are We Going to Any Length?" As a nonalcoholic, I found this a grave challenge, as I'm sure I know very little about Our 12th Step Responsibility, compared to anyone else in this room.

What I love about our Archives is that the records we have are singing to us a siren song, beckoning us to find in them a wealth of treasures that add so much to our published literature, that help us fill in the gaps in some of our publications. The Archives contain the kind of material that makes it possible for someone like me to understand a little bit more about carrying the message to other alcoholics, and practicing these principles in all our affairs.

In the year that I have served as the Archivist for G.S.O., I have received many questions from the Fellowship about a certain passage in *Twelve Steps* and *Twelve Traditions*, specifically in the Third Tradition. This story just seems to resonate with the Fellowship. The passage, and I'm sure all of you know it well, reads as follows:

*"On the A.A. calendar it was Year Two. In the time nothing could be seen but two struggling, nameless groups of alcoholics trying to hold their faces up to the light.*

*"A newcomer appeared at one of these groups, knocked on the door and asked to be let in. He talked frankly with that group's oldest member. He soon proved that his was a desperate case, and that above all he wanted to get well. 'But,' he asked, 'will you let me join your group? Since I am the victim of another addiction even worse stigmatized than alcoholism, you may not want me among you. Or will you?'" (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions, pp. 141-142)*

Now, fast forward to 1968. Bill W. is speaking at the opening dinner of the General Service Conference, and the subject of his talk is the Traditions. The Conference theme that year is "Personal Recovery Depends on A.A. Unity."

Although A.A. has no opinion on outside issues, it doesn't exist in a vacuum either, so I'd like to set the stage with a little historical context: 1967 and 1968 were incredibly turbulent years for this country and Canada, to say the least. The Vietnam War was raging, the terrible My Lai massacre took place in March, and powerful war protests were widespread. The Cold War and the space race were heating up. Civil rights demonstrations were intensifying and violent race riots were taking place all over the country. Martin Luther King, Jr. was assassinated April 4, 1968, just days before the General Service Conference convened. Robert F. Kennedy would be assassinated that June. It must have been an extremely strenuous time for everyone involved.

The Conference body that year would reaffirm the Anonymity Tradition; discuss ways of reaching minorities and non-English speakers; describe local services provided through Intergroups and Central Offices; approve the distribution of the first membership survey; and approve the first World Service Meeting, to take place in 1969.

But before any of that happened at the Conference, Bill gave his talk at the opening dinner. He seems to speak a bit more slowly than in prior years, his voice a bit frail. Quite simply, his talk includes one of the finest examples of tolerance and love I have ever heard, as we hear his views on the common welfare

and carrying the message, with regard to that newcomer with the double "affliction."

[Recording will play] ...*The group conscience began to say to us, "The common welfare comes first. We do not have these biases [of power, prestige, or money]. Let us take thought for the general welfare, and after that, let's see where the leadership stands." So we turn up as leaders who have not power in the usual sense, not prestige in the usual sense. We turn up as genuine servants with a discretion from the group conscience to act for them. And that's our state here. The general welfare comes first.*

*Take another which may at first glance seem a little remote. At about year two, of the Akron group, a poor devil came to Dr. Bob in a grievous state. He could qualify as an alcoholic, all right. And then he said, "Dr. Bob, I've got a real problem to pose you. I don't know if I could join A.A., because I'm a sex deviate." Well, that had to go out to the group conscience, you know. Up to then it was supposed that any society could say who was going to join it.*

*And pretty soon the group conscience began to seethe and boil, and it boiled over. And, "Under no circumstances could we have such a peril, and such a disgrace, among us," said a great many.*

*And you know, right then our destiny hung on a razor edge over this single case. In other words, would there be rules that could exclude so-called undesirability? And that caused us in that time and for quite a time, respecting this single case, to ponder, what is the more important: the reputation that we shall have? What people shall think? Or is it our character? And who are we, considering our records? Alcoholism is quite as unlovely. Who are we to deny a man his opportunity? Any man, or woman?*

*And finally the day of resolution came. And a bunch were sitting in Dr. Bob's living room, arguing, "What to do?" Whereupon, dear old Bob looked around and blandly said, "Isn't it time, folks, to ask ourselves, what would the Master do in a situation like this? Would He turn this man away?"*

*And that was the beginning of the A.A. tradition that any man who has a drinking problem is a member of A.A. if he says so, not whether we say so.*

*Now, I think that the import of this on the common welfare has already been staggering. Because it takes in even more territory than the confines of our Fellowship. It takes in the whole world of alcoholics. Their charter to freedom, to join A.A., is assured. Indeed, it was an act in the general welfare. (General Service Office Archives CD GSC 68/1, part 2, first audio clip)*

This passionate speech, to me, simply typifies Bill and Bob's vast intelligence, clarity, and wisdom, as well as their unconditional acceptance of all alcoholics in need of help. Former trustee and general manager Bob P. gave a wonderful talk at his last Conference in 1986, in which he decried what he saw as A.A.'s growing rigidity. He said, "...And in this trend toward rigidity, we are drifting farther and farther away from our co-founders. Bill, in particular, must be spinning in his grave, for he was perhaps the most permissive person I ever met." [General Service Conference *Final Report*, 1986]

In that time, during that opening Conference dinner in the midst of those difficult and strange days in 1968, Bill's words must have echoed very loudly indeed.

Amy Filiatreau, G.S.O. Archivist

## INCLUSIVENESS IN A.A.

*Tuesday afternoon, before the trip to G.S.O., Conference members listened to presentations on Inclusiveness, chaired by Chuck Barta, West Central regional trustee.*

### Our 3rd Tradition

Our 12th Step Responsibility—Are We Going to Any Length? I am going to ask more questions than I answer; I hope that you will find these questions useful in your reflections on the Fellowship, as well as on your personal engagement. Please indulge me as I extract quotations from our literature, as it is more salient than I could possibly be.

Are we inclusive? If the only requirement to be a member of Alcoholics Anonymous is a desire to stop drinking, and if we maintain that requirement, then we include all who have a desire to stop drinking—regardless of any other attribute. In taking an inventory of A.A. literature, I have been unable to identify a group within our society that is not included, either directly or indirectly, in a pamphlet, PSA, or other piece of literature. Our Big Book gives me the exact words to reach across age, race, sexual preference, language, or any other possible perceived barrier, as it says “We alcoholics are men and women who have lost the ability to control our drinking,” (*Alcoholics Anonymous* p. 30) ...no more and no less. Thus, the foundation of our being able to carry the message of recovery is built on our Legacy of Unity, as found in Tradition Three and in our common malady, alcoholism.

Does Twelfth Step work mean that I need to accept anyone who has a desire to stop drinking? It is so very easy to love the lovable.... But our Third Tradition states “Our membership ought to include all who suffer from alcoholism. Hence we may refuse none who wish to recover. Nor ought A.A. membership ever depend upon money or conformity.” (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S13) Clearly, we accept all who cross our threshold—but do I stand back and let someone else greet the newcomer who smells of booze and is filthy, or do I step up and welcome this person?

Going to any length to insure inclusiveness is not only who comes or participates in A.A., but also how we make Twelfth Step work possible. In my home group, Pass It On, in Walhalla, South Carolina, a husband and wife arrived at our Tuesday night Twelve and Twelve study meeting. As is our habit, the couple was greeted. Immediately, going to any length to carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous took on a different meaning—they spoke little English and read only Polish. At that moment, I became so acutely aware of the interrelationship of our Traditions: If my home group had not been participating in the Seventh Tradition by sending money to G.S.O., then the Big Book may not have been translated into Polish, or there may not have been a service worker to package and send the needed books. When we reached out for help, the hand of A.A. was there because your groups were willing to go to any length to provide an opportunity for recovery to other alcoholics by participating in the spiritual connection of the Seventh Tradition.

“...much attention has been drawn to the extraordinary liberties which the AA traditions accord to the individual member and to his group” “There is another good reason for ‘participation,’ and this one has do to with our spiritual needs. All of us desire to belong. We want an A.A. relation of brotherly partnership. It is our shining ideal that the ‘spiritual cooperation’ of A.A. should never include any members who are regarded as ‘second class.’” (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 21)

“In Alcoholics Anonymous individual freedom is of enormous importance. For instance, any alcoholic is a member of A.A. the

moment he says so; we cannot take away his right to belong. Ours is indeed a charter of minority privileges and liberties.” (ibid, p. 22-23) Not only as an individual or group “...we expect that our Conference will always try to act in the spirit of mutual respect and love—one member for another.... our Conference will ever be prudently on guard against tyrannies, great or small, whether these be found in the majority or in the minority.... Freedom under God to grow in His likeness and image will ever be the quest of the Alcoholics Anonymous. May our General Service Conference be always seen as a chief symbol of this cherished liberty. To a man, we of A.A. believe that our freedom to serve is truly the freedom by which we live—the freedom in which we have our being.” (ibid, p.25)

With God’s grace and power, I pray that I shall always remember that, in A.A., mutual love and respect for one another is practicing inclusiveness, and unconditional love for my fellow man; a gift that knows no boundaries or conditions.

*El Nault, South Carolina*

### Growth of the Fellowship

I am going to make some blanket statements, based on my experience over the past couple of decades. The accuracy of these statements is speculative. You decide for yourself, based on your own experience. The whole purpose of this brief talk is to ponder the relationship, if any, between the idea of inclusiveness and A.A. growth.

If the measure of growth is a comparison, over time, of the numbers of groups and members within the Conference area as reported in the *Conference Final Reports*, it can be concluded that A.A. is not growing and has not been since 1990. It may prove true that these barometers are no longer accurate. Based on my travels, it appears that A.A. is probably growing somewhat, but not in the same way as before. Indeed it is difficult to measure such growth using our historic parameters. Is it possible that A.A., in many ways, including how we belong and how we relate to one another, may be “morphing” into something else? Is it becoming “everything anonymous,” as many fear it may be?

There are, in my estimation, two examples of inclusiveness in the literature. First, the Big Book in various places describes inclusiveness as it pertains to the realm of the spirit. Second, Tradition Three long-form, states, “Hence we may refuse none who wish to recover.” Let us consider these for a moment, as it appears that the juxtapositioning of these ideals may be an underlying challenge.

The Third Tradition describes who can be a member, and by inference, who cannot. As a Fellowship, we practice inclusiveness in both by trying to reach out to all who suffer from alcoholism, regardless of race, creed, color, religion, sexual orientation, or any other secondary difference that seems to occupy first-row seating from time to time in describing our individual condition. The age-old statement “I’m different” now has the support of a veritable deluge of information underpinning such notions.

We found we cannot (and should not) deny mankind the use of our principles and process to help with the myriad (200+ “fill in the blank” anonymous to date) of afflictions people suffer from. We have freely given our Steps and Traditions to many of these fellowships and continue to do so. The untold truth is that by giving these away, we are able to remove a good number of people from our A.A. groups as they are directed to a more applicable fellowship. Yet, and in spite of this, many of our A.A. groups are engaged directly in attempting to include all who suffer from “whatever.”

As long as we continue to let A.A. meetings be the forum

under which this sorting out process occurs, we will continue to have difficulties and conflicts. I contend that by properly Twelfth Stepping people prior to their getting to our meetings, we can eliminate some of the juxtapositioning that has been occurring. This speaks directly to the individual and collective responsibility of carrying our message.

How did we end up in this kind of shape? Let us reflect for a time on what has happened in the past few decades, in and out of our Fellowship. A.A., pretty much from the beginning through World War II and then through the 1950s, though not invisible (one way to be exclusive), certainly was not as wide open (one way to be all inclusive) as it later became. For the most part, people coming to the group or meetings were sponsored by somebody who knew, first of all, where the meetings were.

However, and nearly coincident with the passage of the Hughes Bill in 1968 that basically created the alcoholism treatment industry in the U.S.A., our "growth" as measured by our historic barometers began to skyrocket. Both the number of listed groups and members shot up dramatically between 1970 and 1990.

A.A.'s response to all this? Well, at this time, a curious phenomenon developed. More people began coming to A.A. "unsponsored," meaning no one had Twelfth Stepped a good share of these folks. They were coming to us from treatment centers, courts, agencies and employers, and others. Some, maybe most, were in trouble with alcohol; some were alcoholics of the kind our book references. Later on, the "drug is a drug" mentality prevailed in the culture and addictions of all types came in.

Good Twelfth Step work, which had been largely responsible for the growth of A.A. in the early years, became passé as it was discovered that all we had to do was sit back and wait for the folks to show up. We had only to put up a shingle stating "A.A. meeting tonight" and presto, the seats were full of prospects. Often, too, we were the only game in town. Coincident with all this, we sold the best public relations tool we ever had, the open meeting, down the river in favor of the open topic discussion meeting. That way, according to revisionist principles of the time, anybody could participate, and did! Also, many A.A. groups by and large began substituting the strength and essence of the pro-

gram (the taking of the Steps and working with others) for the forum of the meeting. It is almost as if meeting attendance became mandatory in order to be considered a successful A.A. member, and the taking of the spiritual program of action became an option available to the prospective member. In short, A.A. was overwhelmed, and yet considered itself remarkably successful. Perhaps our euphoria was really that of being spoiled by our successes. It became difficult for the alcoholic, who was supposed to be the recipient of the message, to find a place where the message was being carried.

That all ended, or at least changed significantly, in the early 1990s in the United States. Yet the influences of those that arrived en masse from that time is still being heard and felt throughout the Fellowship. Some of the changes that occurred during this time are with us still, and you can speculate for yourself if they have improved the "inclusiveness" of our program for all who suffer from alcoholism. The practice of closing meetings began in earnest, largely in reaction to who was coming, not what was being discussed. And in the interest of singleness of purpose, we had placed into effect additional rules and requirements for membership.

The blue Singleness of Purpose Card (Open and Closed Meeting announcements), intended to help the situation, has instead become scripture, has blurred inclusiveness, and has been subjected to widely divergent interpretation. Worst of all, I believe the Conference abrogated the A.A. group's conscience by defining the open and closed meeting. The groups took the edict from "on high" and stopped developing their own descriptions of the terms from their group conscience. The phenomenon of "underground" A.A. meetings is a direct response to concerns about *who* is coming to A.A. The unstated purpose of tunneling a group is that they believe A.A. has been too "inclusive."

Finally, the notion of segmented and targeted pamphlets (A.A. and the Native North American, Gay & Lesbian, etc.), which represent A.A.'s attempt at inclusiveness, actually separates us out and apart under the guise of inclusiveness, by emphasizing our secondary differences.

If A.A. is to have any hope of reaching out and including those who suffer from alcoholism, and thereby continue growing, it must:





- Revitalize the Twelfth Step call and Twelfth Step work, reaching out to the alcoholics where they are, rather than waiting for them to come. Find out about these people, their stories, and what they are looking for, before they hit our groups.
- Stop creating wrong dependences on our members, which we do, by inundating them with services. We have placed the work of carrying this message on a service plane in many cases, and are suffering the consequences as a result.
- Put the open meeting back on the forefront as A.A.'s showcase of what it can do for an alcoholic.
- Revive the institution of sponsorship in all three Legacies of our program.

*Gary Kluksdahl, Southwest regional trustee*

## Reaching Out to All Who Want It

Our 12th Step Responsibility—Are We Going to Any Length? The One Million Dollar Question! There is no doubt in my mind that our areas, Conference or district committees, such as C.P.C. or Public Information, are doing an incredible amount of work to reach alcoholics who still suffer.

However, when we look at the 2006 *Final Report* and realize that the membership has an increase of 8,057 new members from 2004 to 2005 (in almost 58,000 groups) we must admit that it may not be a problem, but surely it is a big concern. It takes almost two groups to create one new member. I mean your group welcomes the body, and my group half a head.

Are we going to any length? Individually, I don't think so. Some of us want to stay so anonymous that our doctors, friends, and relatives don't even know we are A.A. members. And yet we could do important Twelfth Step work or public information work ourselves.

Individually, in our home groups, do we welcome a newcomer with love and compassion? Do we listen, do we still remember where we came from? Do we understand the Third Tradition that is an inclusive one? Do we know that it is our personal responsibility to provide literature, to give our phone numbers to a newcomer? We all know that it is easier to reach out to the very young, blond girl or the flashy guy who arrives on his Harley. What about Uncle Leo who stinks and gets drunk at every New Year's Party? Or the gay guy who lives in my building and reeks of beer all the time, or the stranger with the gash on his face who owns the corner store? Do I find it in my heart to give them a meeting list?

Many people visit us and never come back. Sometimes A.A. is a real social club. We tell the newcomer "Keep coming back, it works," and as they are leaving, we are discussing our next trip.

Society changes. Because of drinking and driving, more people are drinking at home; 40% of older people, who are living in retirement homes, have problems with alcohol. Are we reaching them? As a Fellowship we have responsibility, as trusted servants we also have responsibilities. We must use our leadership to bring more and more people to get involved in service. We must use our little power to make the right decisions.

Last year, here at the Conference, we debated more than 3½ hours for a \$2,100 expense, a decision that should be the decision of G.S.O.'s general manager. We discussed for almost two hours before accepting three short video segments for the C.P.C. committee. Another two-hour debate before approving the pamphlet "Too Young." I know these discussions are important for our democracy, but these are tools to facilitate the A.A. recovery message for the suffering alcoholic. And we are still hesitating—two steps forward and one step back.

Inclusiveness? I am pensive. Last year I felt like as a newcomer, there was no one at the door to greet us at the Sunday night dinner. I went in the ballroom, and didn't know where to sit. I finally found a place at a table and no one talked to me. I thought I must stink! Friday afternoon the chair of my committee went to the front of the room and mentioned "the members of our committee met and decided blah blah...." I was totally astonished and worried and pissed off; I wasn't there when they made that decision.

I was sober six months when I learned that decisions in A.A. are made during the business meeting, not with four or five members on the corner of a table. Our Fourth Concept tells us that all who desire may belong to A.A.—no members are second class. I quit the room and wanted to resign; after all, I'm an alcoholic. But, I acted like a newcomer—I shared, I cried, I shared and cried. One trustee told me that I must come back and tell the story to avoid it ever happening again.

The funniest thing is that I received a letter this year asking me to make a presentation about Inclusiveness!

Last year I understood why we meet in a large hotel—it's because large hotels have large doors to let our large egos get through. Know what, my friends? Inclusiveness should start right here.

*Luc Rainville, Southwest Québec*

## OUR PRIMARY PURPOSE

*Wednesday afternoon's presentation/sharing session was chaired by Madeleine Parmley, Pacific regional trustee.*

## Attraction Rather Than Promotion

I came into the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous after watching my mother for three years. In the opinion of the family she was a "Hopeless Alcoholic" and as much as we loved her we could not help her. She went to an A.A. meeting one evening and met some ladies who were almost exactly like her and, to our surprise (in spite of all our efforts), she stopped drinking and stayed stopped through many very traumatic experiences in her life.

Her sister was very attracted by what she saw and asked her to help her daughter. My cousin joined A.A. and, in spite of all her family's cajoling, she too stopped drinking. I watched this with great interest and two years later made the telephone call to my cousin that saved my life. I was very attracted by the life I had seen these two women achieve in sobriety and "wanted what they had." We need to carry this idea of attraction to many levels in our Fellowship, particularly when we refer to our Primary Purpose.

Tradition Five and Tradition Eleven must be our guidelines when we speak about "Carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers, and Attraction rather than Promotion at the level of press, radio, and film"—but what about in our communities?

When I am out and about in the community in which I function and attend social gatherings, many people are very aware that I do not drink. I am a business woman who is active in my professional community and am often asked why? My response is always the same "I have found a way to live without drinking alcohol and if you would like to talk more about it—here is my number, please call me." With all the notoriety that we are receiving today from celebrities who are searching for what we have, I believe we must be compassionate, kind, and understanding, because they do not know any different and are only looking for help.



Our Public Information Committees at all levels must continue their work in sharing the proper information about our Fellowship and our Eleventh Tradition, which states the importance of our anonymity. *As Bill Sees It*, page 255, says "To reach more alcoholics, understanding of A.A. and public good will towards A.A. must go on growing everywhere."

Our Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees must be available to provide assistance to professionals who do not know who we are and who we are not. "We need to be on still better terms with medicine, religion, employers, governments, courts prisons, mental hospitals and all enterprises in the alcoholism field." (ibid.) What a wonderful resource we can be for professionals who might come in contact with someone who has a *drinking problem*. Each and every one of us must be an example of sobriety in action, and many of those who do not want to be labeled "an alcoholic" will be attracted by what they see. In our communities we should strive for the ideals that we review each and every day in our books and our literature. If we are to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers—what message are we carrying? Are we carrying a message of recovery from a seemingly hopeless state of mind and body into a place of usefulness, or are we carrying a message of selfish and self-centered egotism? "Nothing matters more to A.A.'s future welfare than the manner in which we use the colossus of modern communication. Used unselfishly and well, it can produce results surpassing our present imagination. Should we handle this great instrument badly, we shall be shattered by the ego manifestations of our own people." (ibid.) My family, friends and some business associates know that I am a member of A.A. I have stressed to them the importance of my anonymity and that I am available to them at any time, anywhere, to assist anyone who has a drinking problem. Personally, I would like those who are in recovery to be kind, considerate, nonjudgmental and open minded. Love and Tolerance are our guides. With these traits foremost in our minds who could help but be attracted to what we have. Are these extravagant expectations?—Likely Yes. Shall we strive for them—Why Not?

As you will note, *As Bill Sees It* is one of my favorite books. Below its title it simply reads The A.A. Way of Life, and I truly subscribe to that. Page 278 refers to speaking up without fear. This was a major accomplishment in my life, because of the connotation that went along with it—that of a woman who drinks too much. She was of low moral character and an embarrassment to those around her. Today I can tell anyone that I have met the most courageous women in my life around the meeting rooms of A.A., and that I am proud to be a member of Alcoholics Anonymous. We have had the courage to change our lives and the lives of those who were affected by our drinking. Who would not be attracted to us?

When I speak before semi-public gatherings I wish to convince audiences that our alcoholism is a sickness we no longer fear to discuss with anyone. Page 316 talks about the spirit of anonymity and giving up our natural desires for personal distinction as A.A. members. Our 12th Step Responsibility is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers and we should go to any length that is required. That means attending meetings and welcoming the newcomer (even when we are not having a great day), answering the telephones (even when we are busy), doing a Twelfth Step call (even when it is inconvenient), and being an example of Hope and Sobriety. We will attract those who wish recovery by watching us. Please don't stop carrying the message; you may be the only example of the Big Book that someone in despair, who is reaching out for help and stumbling in the darkness, may ever see. Thank you all for making the gift of recovery attractive to me.

Patricia Long, Alberta/NWT

## Working with Wet Drunks

I have had a number of occasions to talk with the "Wet Drunks." On those occasions I felt the only one that gained anything was myself. It gave me a sense of gratitude, reminding me where I was not that long ago. When I am asked to make these calls, I like to take a little time beforehand to read two chapters from the Big Book: Chapter 3 "More About Alcoholism" and Chapter 7 "Working with Others." This gives me an opportunity to refresh my memory of "what it was like" and how I was treated when I was in that situation. I also carry cassette tapes of those two chapters in my vehicle, in case I don't have time to read beforehand.

I hear some people say that it is a waste of time and effort to speak to a drunk in his cups, but is it? It is our purpose to go to any lengths to stay sober, and that means helping someone else, and to me that doesn't always mean "when he is dry."

I was chairing a Beginners meeting one time in the basement of a church. We were well into the meeting, when we heard this noise coming down the steps, and in walks this drunk, just totally blitzed! He sat down, almost missing the chair. We poured him a half cup of coffee. He sat there bobbing and weaving and, I guess, listening. After the meeting was over we talked to him and he left, maneuvering his way up the steps. I could just picture him in my mind, waking up the next morning, telling one of his buddies that he had this terrible nightmare about going to an A.A. meeting. I'm pretty sure he didn't remember anything else and I don't think I've ever seen him again, sad to say. But deep down inside I believe a seed was planted and it may take some more watering before it grows, but, yep, it was planted!

The 1:30 a.m. phone calls can be a "tester" for us, or at least me—when they want to do all the talking and want someone to listen. I try to be courteous and try to keep the conversation as short as possible. If the individual will give me his phone number and address, especially his address, I like to make it a point to be at his house at about 6:00 a.m. to finish our conversation. It seems that they tend to be very receptive at that particular time. The best is when a woman calls; I poke my wife and say "Honey, it's for you!"

I think it is important when Twelfth Stepping someone that you bring someone new with you. It seems they relate to someone who has very little sobriety—better than someone who has been sober longer, and I think that the new person remembers a lot more about their last drink. And it's not that any of us forget it, but the feeling is a lot fresher in the newcomer.

If the individual wants to get sober, I ask him if he is on any medications, along with the alcohol, or if he feels he can safely come off the alcohol on his own. He may want to consider detox if he feels unsure about his physical condition, whether it can withstand the trauma of detoxing. Though I have experienced DTs myself, I am not trained in that field. A drunk may have all sorts of physical limitations, such as heart problems, that may need specially trained supervision. I am not a doctor, though sometimes my ego would like to take over and say I am! Ask my wife!

If he decides on detox, I would explain that we would be there to support him until he gets out. Then we would be willing to work with him, if he so chooses. I offer to get him to meetings and introduce him to other people.

One of the last wet drunks we called on was locked up in a motel room for about a week, no one seemed to know where he was. His wife tracked him down by tracing his credit card use. This individual happened to be a retired police officer, so his wife knew some of his old friends in the department, and they helped her track him down. That is when we went and visited him and brought him to detox. He went into seizures and, for awhile, they

were thinking that they would have to put him in a nursing home, for the rest of his life, with a wet brain! For two days he sat up in bed and just smiled, and then he miraculously snapped out of it. He is OK today, and sober! It was a close call, but being he was with professionals and the detox was a unit of the hospital, he got the much needed care. We were all so grateful it turned out well.

As Bill stated on page 15 of the Big Book "...when all other measures failed, work with another alcoholic would save the day."

Regarding another experience, I had told one of my sponsee's early in his recovery that I would be gone for the weekend, and if he had trouble, to call a number of people. I gave him a list of other A.A. members. If he wasn't able to connect with anyone, I suggested that he then go to the detox center and ask if he could speak with someone there. He himself had just come out of there a week or two before. Well, he was down and out, having a really rough time. He took my suggestion and went and spoke to another drunk for a couple of hours. When he left he had forgotten about all his problems, and walked away with a grateful heart.

It works when we get out of ourselves and work with another person—imagine that!

*Jerry Saari, Northern Minnesota*

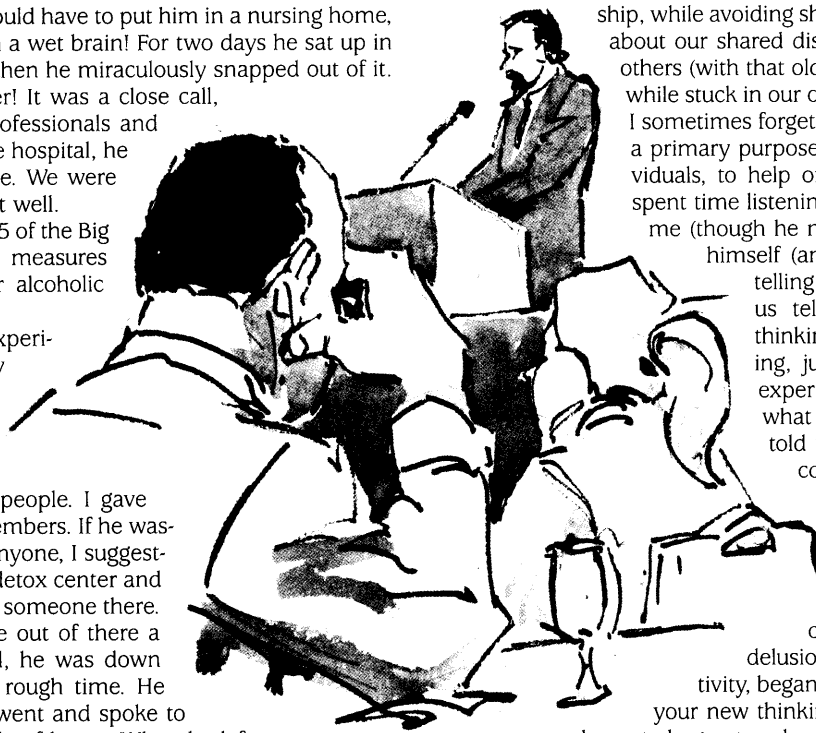
### Practicing These Principles in All Our Affairs

The Twelfth Step is the greatest promise in the A.A. program. "Having had a spiritual awakening as the result of these steps" offers the new person the hope needed to work our other 11 Steps. "We tried to carry this message" (success is not mentioned or measured by head count) gives long-timers the gratitude to appreciate their own personal miracle and the spiritual growth needed to stay recovering from our disease. Our goal is to carry this message to the next suffering alcoholic; sometimes that's a new member and sometimes that could be a long-timer. We all need the continuing grace this process provides to live happy, sober and free. It is only in so doing that we can relive, again and again, the original experience of our own recovery, each time with greater appreciation and understanding.

In "practicing these principles in all our affairs," we put to use, get better at, become more comfortable, and make a part of ourselves, these spiritual principles, all 36—the Twelve Steps, the Twelve Traditions, and the Twelve Concepts. I am coming to believe that my life mission should include efforts to incorporate all of these 36 principles into my daily living. To continue (as in Step Ten), to seek (as in Step Eleven), that spiritual awakening (guaranteed in Step Twelve).

I have sometimes found myself on a different route than the one prescribed in our literature; that spiritual path, the road of happy destiny, the journey of spiritual progress. I have felt personally, and have observed others like me, behaving a bit differently.

A.A. is not a parking garage where we get sober, find a comfortable spot in that garage to sit, relax and idle, waving some encouragement to the occasional passer by, offering a little fellow-



ship, while avoiding sharing the uncomfortable facts about our shared disease, fearing the opinions of others (with that old defect of "people pleasing"), while stuck in our own section and level. Perhaps I sometimes forget for the moment that we have a primary purpose, as a Fellowship and as individuals, to help one another. I have too often spent time listening to someone who is just like me (though he may not know it yet), lying to

himself (and anyone else who'll listen), telling us what he thinks, instead of us telling him what he is really thinking, what his disease is brewing, just as it did in all of us. My experience was that I wasn't asked what I was thinking, rather I was told what I was thinking, before I could try to formulate the lie, in order to impress those who knew me better than I knew myself. They told me if I kept coming, something would rub off. The old thinking, phoniness, self-delusion, evasion, self-pity, and negativity, began to rub off of me, and some of your new thinking, love, tolerance, peace and honesty began to rub off onto me.

During World War II, a minister made this statement during the military occupation of his area: "The only thing necessary for evil to flourish is for good men to do nothing." He paid the ultimate price for his stand. Am I forgetting my responsibility, passing it off onto others, those in service positions, or even outside professionals, while I sit in the garage waving, patting those I can reach on the head, instead of honestly sharing with them about my alcoholism and how it played me? "Who will speak our word to them" if we don't?

The A.A. Grapevine did a survey of readers recently and found that many of their past subscribers didn't renew because the magazine wasn't as necessary to them as when they were newly sober, or else they didn't have time to read as much. Are we getting complacent as we get along in sobriety? (Like, maybe I'm making too much work of such a simple thing like this recovery?)

Am I working for the "good" of A.A. when I should be working for the "best" of A.A.? Am I spending too much time in my parking spot instead of trudging the road of happy destiny, out on the spiritual highway with my own kind?

It's a fine line to walk. "When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. to be there...." Not the A.A. hook, lasso, shackles, or the net. On one of his trips to Vermont, Bill inquired about "the kid," a young man whom he had met on previous visits (who later became our delegate). Bill was told that he had returned to drinking, was doing "a little more research." Bill is said to have replied, "Don't chase him, you'll kill him." Where is that fine line of being there, without dragging them in, of being of help without chasing them away to their demise? Have we spread ourselves too far chasing after potentials instead of tending to those nearby who are willing, or almost willing, in our own midst? Are we losing our important legacy, settling for less?

I need to practice what I was shown, share my experience, not what I think they want or what they need to hear. It's so simple, just share my experience, yet I have to complicate it due to my self-will, getting in the middle again, character defects blazing.

Everyone has to come to their own surrender; no one else can surrender for you. We all need repeated surrenders, when the ego

recovers once we start to feel better. You can lead a horse to water, but you can't make him drink, and you can lead a drunk to A.A. but you can't make him not drink. His surrender has to come from within, has to be his own. Once arrived in the rooms with whatever means it takes, PI, CPC, pamphlets directed at certain factions of our society, professionals, other members, it becomes critical that we do our job of helping them identify, get hope, get in the program and stay instead of backpedaling out because "I'm different."

Practicing these principles in all our affairs—anonymity should keep us safe; after all, we let our friends do our talking for us. But do our non-A.A. friends have as much good to say about us as they used too? Have we allowed other issues to cloud our simple message? Have we let up on our firm commitment to be who we say we are and then slipped back due to nonaction? Have we made ourselves something our friends can be proud to sing the praises of? Have we let too much go? Have we held on to what is ours?

All our affairs—The shameful way we sometimes treat one another, the mistrust and negativity, which is all too prevalent at our service gatherings, is not what and who we are. What happened to putting trust in trusted servants? If someone takes advantage of their service opportunity, the shame is theirs not ours. I have seen many well intentioned people, who are trying to do the best for A.A., treated badly just because there is disagreement. I was told very early that I should not agree just to be agreeable, (and liked), nor to disagree just to be disagreeable (for the attention). We all want this thing NOW. We can't wait to wade in at meetings sharing our knowledge and experience. We all know the story of the Prodigal Son. We might identify with him, lost and destitute and then received back into the family. But what about his brother? I identify with him too. I hated anyone richer than me, better looking, more popular, smarter (a lot of people). (Jealousy, another character defect that can rear its ugly head.) Now, when someone gets a little attention, being new and received into our family, or getting to speak, or getting some other attention, am I a little reluctant to participate in the celebration of the miracle because I won't get recognized? Do I take my program and my experience and go sit in the garage, becoming selfish and hoarding because I feel I am not appreciated? I was guided to learn to listen, that in order to hear the message I had to listen to hear.

I see a lot of speaker meetings going by the wayside, or changing formats, because no one wants to listen to somebody else anymore. Yet there is a boom of discussion meetings, because everyone wants to get in on the sharing, spending the whole meeting preparing their inspiring words for their turn, while hearing only a little. I know, that's often been my personal experience. I need to get out of the garage, get back on the spiritual path, rubbing fenders with a lot of people, getting some old stuff and thinking rubbed off, and some new stuff and thinking rubbed on. I need to listen and hear my fellow travelers, and use the 36 spiritual principles I have been given to make my journey better for myself and others. I can practice them with every human being I meet, and take inventory, and practice some more. Continuous spiritual growth will insure my continued recovery from the disease that I still have and that can still kill me. We may be doing good, but let's not forget that "sometimes the good is the enemy of the best." If we renew, revive, reconnect, and get back to the spiritual path, it's not just to make newcomers better, not just to make A.A. as a whole better, but because it will make me a better person. (Striving to be the best we can be.) After all, "What's in it for me?" has always been my fight song, but growing spiritually was never my goal. You have taught me different. Help me to help myself. This thing works, it really does.

*Mike Perry, Northeast regional trustee*

## HUMILITY AND RESPONSIBILITY

*Thursday morning presentation/discussions was chaired by Bill Clark, Class A trustee.*

### Expressed by Anonymity

I would like to start with a couple of excerpts from Bill W. The first one, from the Grapevine, January 1955, may be found in *The Language of the Heart*, pp. 210-11.

"Our new book the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, states that 'Anonymity is the greatest protection our Society can ever have.' It says also that 'The spiritual substance of anonymity is sacrifice'... 'At the beginning we sacrificed alcohol. We had to, or it would have killed us. But we couldn't get rid of alcohol unless we made other sacrifices. Big-shot-ism and phony thinking had to go. We had to toss self-justification, self-pity and anger right out the window. We had to quit the crazy contest for personal prestige and big bank balances. We had to take personal responsibility for our sorry state and quit blaming others for it... When the first A.A. group took form, we soon learned a lot more of this. We found that each of us had to make willing sacrifices for the group itself, sacrifices for the common welfare. The group, in turn, found that it had to give up many of its own rights for the protection and welfare of each member, and for A.A. as a whole. These sacrifices had to be made or A.A. couldn't continue to exist.'"

Also from *The Language of the Heart*, p. 240, Bill asks "How can we continue to progress throughout our A.A. lives?" "Step Eleven can keep us growing," Bill said, "if we try hard and work at it continually. If we neglect those who are still sick, there is unrelenting danger to our own lives and sanity." He reminded us that "Our Society... has but one high mission—to carry the A.A. message." The A.A. "key to sobriety" is our "gift from God," Bill said. And "It is the great paradox of A.A. that we know we can seldom keep the precious gift of sobriety... unless we give it away."

When I think about Humility and Responsibility Expressed by Anonymity, I can't help but think about the last couple of months in my home. It started with the death of my sister-in-law, Joyce on January 22, 2007. Joyce and her husband, Pete, lived in Dallas, Texas. Both were members of Alcoholics Anonymous. I was some seven or eight hours away and felt helpless, I did not want Pete to be alone during a difficult and dangerous time like this. Here is where I think true humility and responsibility came in to play expressed by anonymity. I live in Topeka, Kansas. Five or six years ago I met a man at an A.A. conference in Ruston, Louisiana named Jim W. Jim is in a wheelchair and I thought he lived in Dallas, Texas, but I did not know for sure. I also had no idea how to get a hold of him. I called a fellow A.A. member in Joplin, Missouri, to see if he knew exactly where Jim lived and how to get in contact with him. Dave made a few phone calls and found out that Jim did live in Dallas and he was able to come up with a phone number for me. I called Jim to see if he would call my brother in law Pete. Jim said he did not know what he could say or do, but that he would call Pete. Here is where I think that God does take care of us. As Pete and Jim talked they realized that they in fact did know each other and that they even went to the same meeting on Sunday night. Amazingly, they only lived about a mile apart. They had that anonymity thing going on and did not know that they even knew each other. Jim made this difficult phone call, not for glory or fame but rather just to be of service to a fellow member of A.A. in his time of need, even though he did not know at the time that he even knew Pete. I believe Jim must have felt a responsibility to a Fellowship that gave him his life back. Thank you, Jim, for not staying at home on Sunday

nights, or looking at your caller ID when the phone rang. Thank you for your service to Alcoholics Anonymous, my family, and to me, you make what I do seem small.

Sometimes my God has to show me what true humility and responsibility is and so it was with men like Jim and countless others who carried my family through this difficult time when we were incapable of walking on our own. The true meaning of humility and responsibility was shown through self-sacrifice, through the willingness to do what we don't like, or even want to do, with no thank you, no glory, and no fame. To simply be of service to Alcoholics Anonymous and their fellow man with true humility and responsibility expressed by anonymity.

In closing I would like to read Bill's own thoughts on anonymity.

"For a long time now, both Dr. Bob and I have done everything possible to maintain the Tradition of anonymity. Just before he died, some of Dr. Bob's friends suggested that there should be a suitable monument or mausoleum erected in honor of him and his wife, Anne, something befitting a founder. Dr. Bob declined, with thanks. Telling me about this a little later, he grinned and said, "For Heaven's sake, Bill, why don't you and I get buried like other folks?" Last summer I visited the Akron cemetery where Bob and Anne lie. Their simple stone says never a word about Alcoholics Anonymous. This made me so glad I cried. Did this wonderful couple carry personal anonymity too far when they so firmly refused to use the word 'Alcoholics Anonymous,' even on their own burial stone? For one, I don't think so. I think that this great and final example of self-effacement will prove of more permanent worth to AA than could any spectacular public notoriety or fine mausoleum. We don't have to go to Akron, Ohio, to see Dr. Bob's memorial. Dr. Bob's real monument is visible throughout the length and breadth of AA. Let us look again at its true inscription—one word only, which we AAs have written. That word is sacrifice." (*The Language of the Heart*, pp. 217-218)

Mike Sumpter, Kansas

### Are We Resting On Our Laurels?

Bill W. wrote, "All A.A. progress can be reckoned in terms of just two words: humility and responsibility. Our whole spiritual development can be accurately measured by our degree of adherence to these magnificent standards." (*As Bill Sees It*, p. 271) Humility can be defined as "freedom from pride and arrogance" and responsibility as "the ability to respond or answer for one's con-

duct and obligations." (*Webster's Collegiate Dictionary*, 5th Ed.) After a "few" drinks before driving home, I was often asked "Are you ok?" and replied, "I'm fine." How arrogant, how devoid of any responsibility for the possible results of my actions! When I came to A.A., I had no clue what these two principles really meant, but was unable to admit it! After all, I am a pretty smart cookie.

At my first meeting, you asked if there were any newcomers present. I stood and shared the *entire* tale of the night before. This was the start of learning about these two principles: for the first time taking real action and responsibility for where drinking had taken me and exhibiting a modicum of humility by admitting I needed help. You had the answer—I am an alcoholic. You gave me clear cut directions and guided me through our Twelve Steps. If we have learned responsibility and humility through the practice of the Twelve Steps, what will happen? To me, it is learning "...to be one in a family, to be a friend among friends, to be a worker among workers, to be a useful member of society." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 53)

Are we resting on our laurels? What are laurels? The ancient Greeks crowned victors with a laurel crown; it was a symbol of honor. What did I do to deserve honor?

The question, "Are we resting on our laurels?" suggests taking an inventory of how we practice our Twelfth Step, in our own lives, in our home groups, and throughout our service structure. The Big Book (p. 97) says, "Helping others is the foundation stone of your recovery." What do I do when the phone rings at 2:00 a.m. with a "live" one on the other end? When my home group needs a coffee maker, a greeter, a chairperson? I have been in meetings when no one raises their hand. In some meetings, we recite the Responsibility Declaration. Yet, we ask for persons willing to be sponsors and few raise their hands. The basket is passed; what do I contribute? In my home group, we consider it our responsibility to send contributions to our district, area, and General Service Office on a regular basis, just like paying the rent. When I first heard that the Big Book was translated into Swahili, I was excited to be part of this. Just think, the gal who didn't want to call anyone on the last night of her drinking, is connected to something so incredible.

What is our responsibility? Our Conference theme is "Our 12th Step Responsibility—Are We Going to Any Length?" What is any length? It is easy to measure it in terms of actions we take—sponsoring, answering the phone, traveling in all kinds of weather to service events. The bigger challenge for me is to stay true to my



experience. Do I change the clear-cut directions that were given me in an effort to make it "easier" for the next alcoholic to stay sober? How has this worked for me, and for the other alcoholic?

Can we find members willing to be responsible and fill jobs in every level of our service structure? You taught me it was my responsibility to be available when needed. A family member once asked, "Why do you have to do these jobs?" "Because I can." Is service the biggest secret in A.A.? Is it because we do not share our service experience as we do our other A.A. experiences? Is this true humility? As I was working on this presentation, it was almost time for us to leave and take a meeting into the local jail. I was tired, this presentation was due, and I was tempted to let the other A.A. go alone. What was I thinking? On the way home after the meeting, we were full of energy and gratitude.

To finish the quote from *As Bill Sees It* (p. 271), "Ever deepening humility, accompanied by an ever greater willingness to accept and act upon clear-cut obligations—these are truly our touchstones for all growth in the life of the spirit. They hold up to us the very essence of right being and right doing. It is by them that we are enabled to find and to do God's will." I challenge all members of Alcoholics Anonymous to accept and act upon these clear-cut obligations. How will potential members learn about our wonderful program if we do not accept our obligation in carrying and remaining true to the message of recovery that has saved our lives? Are we doing enough?

*Becky Collette, Vermont*

### Raising Literature Prices or Footing the Bill?

Our Fellowship has some challenges ahead. Presently, Seventh Tradition contributions to the General Service Board amount to about 70% of expenditures, with the balance, or 30%, made up by literature sales. The board then distributes the money based on the instructions we gave them through the Conference, and the authority we have placed on them through our Concepts.

The cost of our literature and books is directly proportionate to the amount of Seventh Tradition contributions received. So our question is, will our groups take responsibility and participate in their own recovery and the recovery of alcoholics to come?

μgrowth, with fewer groups carrying more of the load of financial accountability.

Our groups have many choices today. They can choose to participate in Twelfth Step work or not. They may choose to be an isolated group. By that, I mean they could coast along, not growing. Every once in a while welcoming a newcomer who sees them in a group schedule, or perhaps one or two members doing corrections or institutions work, as long as it is close to home. Their Seventh Tradition funds being spent mostly on rent and refreshments. They do not contribute to entities outside their home group, intergroup or central office. They hold with disdain the services done on behalf of their district, area or the General Service Board as wasteful and not mindful of the importance of the Seventh Tradition. They want their money spent at home. They are a group that is virtually blind, deaf, and mute. There is no G.S.R. to see or hear information from the General Service Office or the area, and no voice to communicate their group conscience.

These choices are made by some because of the belief that Tradition Four is the authority to not be part of A.A. as a whole. In a sense, they are correct. Tradition Four gives them the right to be autonomous, operating independently, with no one over them. However, that is only part of a much larger responsibility.

We are responsible to communicate the many paths that lead to recovery and Spiritual Awakening locally, nationally and worldwide. Our General Service Office began a program in 2006 that produced wonderful results. By bringing in the D.C.M.s, and including them in mailings detailing the work done nationally and internationally, our percentage of participation has increased. My own area has benefited by this inclusion. But what of the groups that are not registered, or the groups that are registered, but have made the choice not to participate?

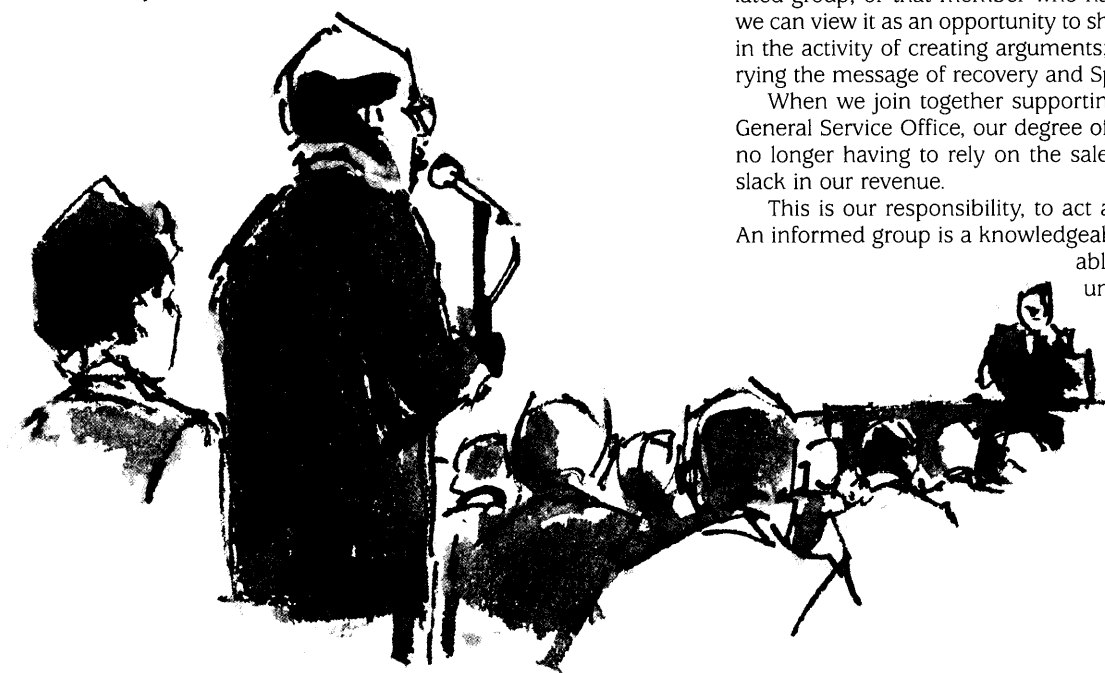
Our choice as members of the Fellowship is clear. It is to discuss in unambiguous non-judgmental terms the work of A.A. inside our area, state or province, and country. We can clearly share the instructions given us in the Twelfth Step: To carry the message to alcoholics who still suffer. By this sharing, we can bring these groups into the realm of participation.

We can share that our Fellowship instructed the board to carry our work around the world. That is why the Big Book is printed in 52 languages, and Alcoholics Anonymous is in over 180 countries. We members are part of a society based on communication; one member talking to another. When we encounter an island or isolated group, or that member who has a provincial point of view, we can view it as an opportunity to share our structure. We are not in the activity of creating arguments; we are in the action of carrying the message of recovery and Spiritual Awakening.

When we join together supporting our district, area, and the General Service Office, our degree of self-support increases, thus no longer having to rely on the sale of literature to take up the slack in our revenue.

This is our responsibility, to act as a conduit of information. An informed group is a knowledgeable group, and a knowledgeable group will recognize and understand our principle of self-support as written in Tradition Seven.

*Jerry Clarkson, California/  
San Diego-Imperial*



## INTERNATIONAL: A.A. AROUND THE WORLD

*Thursday afternoon the International presentation/Sharing session was chaired by Dorothy Wilson, trustee-at-large/U.S.A.*

### A.A. Around the World

Good afternoon, my name is Doug, I am an alcoholic and currently have the privilege of serving as the General Service Office staff member on the International assignment and I am grateful for this opportunity to share with you.

Murray McIntosh, trustee-at-large/Canada, has included in his presentation a report on the 19th World Service Meeting, which took place last October in Malahide, Ireland, so I will not comment except to say it was an exciting and loving sharing of international A.A. experience.

The years between World Service Meetings is when Zonal Meetings are held. The first zonal meeting on the horizon is the Sub Saharan Africa Service Meeting that will meet this May in Windhoek, Namibia. As of this time, delegates from the following English-speaking African nations will be attending: Botswana, Kenya, Lesotho, Malawi, Namibia, South Africa, Tanzania, Uganda and Zimbabwe. This meeting is organized by South Africa and financially supported equally by the General Service Boards of Great Britain and the United States. In July, Japan will host the Asia Oceania Service Meeting (AOSM) in a town outside of Tokyo, and the European Service Meeting (ESM) will take place in Frankfurt, Germany in October. Also in October, our trustees-at-large U.S. and Canada will be delegates to The Meeting of the Americas (South America, Central America and North America), or the REDELA as it is more commonly referred to, that will meet in Sao Paulo, Brazil. Rounding out the year will be the first West Central Africa Service Meeting for French-speaking African nations, which will take place in December in Paris. This meeting is financially supported by the General Service Boards of France and the U.S. The reason for this meeting taking place in France is twofold—first, the trustees of the French General Service Board felt that it would be helpful for the delegates from Africa to see an established A.A. structure and its service entities—which was one of the reasons Bill gave for holding the first World Service Meeting in New York in 1969; a group conscience of the participating countries agreed. Secondly, it is actually less expensive to fly delegates from Africa to France than it is for the delegates to travel within Africa. We expect future meetings will take place in a country within the zone.

As you all know, G.S.O. receives a number of invitations from international A.A. service structures to visit other countries. Historically, the G.S.O. staff person on the International desk has participated in overseas travel, and I have been no exception. Over the last 18 months or so, I have traveled to countries I never dreamed I would visit. In Mongolia, I slept in a "yurt" with the general manager—a yurt is a round tent-like structure. On a 27-hour bus ride in Russian Siberia, I added running hot water and flushing toilets to my gratitude list, since there was a notable lack of both on this journey. Everywhere, I met dedicated A.A. members like you, seeking better ways to carry the A.A. message. I encountered medical professionals, media people, government administrators, police and military personnel—all looking to help the alcoholic. In a part of Russia called the Federation of Tuva, near Mongolia, the Minister of Health told us that 85% of all the crime in his region was alcohol related—sound familiar?

I don't have the time to report in detail about each trip so I am going to share a few highlights of one trip that I took last May with our chairman, Leonard Blumenthal, to Turkey, Croatia and Bosnia-Herzegovina. Leonard already has included in his report some of

the P.I. and Cooperation With the Professional Community activities that took place during our visit to Ankara, where we visited the G.S.O. We then drove to Urgup, in the Cappadocia region, to attend the A.A. National Convention of Turkey, which was attended by about 150 members. This convention is used as an opportunity for the Turkish service structure to have one of its three annual business meetings: of its board, the G.S.O. officers, and approximately 19 group representatives that make up the group conscience of Turkey. This meeting lasted six, smoky, hours without a break; it was a powerful example of how vital our Traditions and our Twelve Concepts for World Service really are.

In the Turkish structure, all the board, the G.S.O. officers and the group representatives have a voice, but only the group representatives have a vote. However, their method of reaching a group conscience does not correspond to how we reach a consensus. Agenda items that are to be brought to the business meeting are discussed by the individual groups, a group conscience is taken, the result of the group conscience is sent in writing to the secretary of the G.S.O., and the groups "instruct" their reps to confirm the group conscience at the business meetings. There is no debate of the agenda items, other than to perhaps express support for what each group decided. Once the group conscience has been sent in, a representative is not free to change his or her vote. And since the votes are generally predetermined, there is no right of appeal. A simple majority determines the outcome.

Also interesting, the groups have consistently refused to allow the board to register A.A. or the G.S.O. with the Turkish government as a legal entity, because they believe it is in violation of the Traditions to do so—that A.A. ought never to be organized. Many of the representatives had not considered the implications of Tradition Eight, nor were they aware of the experience of A.A. in other countries regarding this issue.

In terms of rotation, the entire board, approximately four members, rotates every two years, alternating the composition of its members between the larger Turkish cities where A.A. is established. Board members have so far come from Izmir and Ankara. Each rotation also requires that the G.S.O. move to the city of the sitting board and there is also a complete change of the four or five G.S.O. officers who must come from the city where the trustees live. After the business meeting, many hours were spent talking about the Concepts and Traditions. When I returned, one of my requests was to have the pamphlet, "The Twelve Concepts Illustrated," translated into Turkish as a resource for their membership's use.

Leonard and I next went to Croatia and visited members in Zagreb and Split. Croatian A.A. appears to be in good shape. There is a Central Information Office in Zagreb and the members seemed enthusiastic about supporting this office. On our first full day, we spent several hours at their tiny office sharing service experience. The office had no water and no bathroom. Fortunately, the office manager lived across the street. In Split, I gave a translations workshop, and then we met with treatment and municipal administrators at the town hall.

Our last stop together was in Bosnia-Herzegovina. A Croatian member drove us seven hours over mountainous roads to Sarajevo. Bosnia was a bloody battleground twelve years ago and the evidence of the war was everywhere, with bombed out and bullet-ridden buildings.

In Sarajevo, we met with two American A.A. members living in Bosnia, a Bosnian, who is a member of N.A., and a local psychiatrist who spent decades treating alcoholics. Again, time does not allow me to tell the story of this extraordinary psychiatrist and her efforts to help her alcoholic patients during the fiercest fighting of the war. A tall woman, about 70, she was bursting with enthusiasm, energy and love of humanity—especially of





### 19th World Service Meeting

The theme for this Conference is: "Our 12th Step Responsibility—Are We Going to Any Length?" I intend to address this topic from the point of view of what we as a structure and a Fellowship, are doing internationally in Twelfth Step work.

One of the assignments that Dorothy, trustee-at-large/U.S., and I had this past year was to represent the Fellowship of the United States and Canada at the biennial World Service Meeting. In October 2006, 54 delegates, representing 34 countries and zones, gathered in Malahide, Ireland, for the 19th World Service Meeting. It was the largest gathering of delegates to attend a World Service Meeting since this event's beginnings, 37 years ago, in 1969. At the first World Service Meeting, 13 countries and zones were represented. This meeting has since grown as the hand of A.A. has been extended into the far corners of the world. India, Malta, the Ukraine and Venezuela participated in this event for the first time.

The delegates who met together represented countries with some form of general service structure and all had a G.S.O. Their workshops, presentations and discussions touched on Twelfth Step work, reaching out to young people and professionals, how to encourage members to do service beyond the group, the nuts and bolts of service organization and, for a number of countries, meeting the challenge of helping women who seek help in A.A. when, frequently, the male dominated A.A. meetings and the society at large seem unreceptive and/or intolerant of the alcoholic woman.

In terms of translations and printing A.A. literature into other languages, one important result of the World Service Meetings in recent years has been the development and enhancement of the International Literature Fund. This fund was set up in order that other countries might help provide some financial assistance to A.A. World Services, Inc. and participate in its efforts to see that A.A. literature was translated and made available to more suffering alcoholics around the globe. These contributions represent a sacrifice on the part of the world's Fellowships. Some countries are in a position to share from their abundance in the thousands, and even in the tens of thousands of dollars, while other countries share more modestly but with no less of a desire to participate and to go to any lengths to help the suffering alcoholic. On the morning after the 19th World Service Meeting, when many delegates were to check out of their hotel rooms in Ireland, Doug Richardson, coordinator of the 19th WSM, found an envelope slipped under his door—it contained two crisp ten dollar bills and represented a contribution to the International Literature Fund from the members of A.A. in the Ukraine.

There are some shining examples of how country-to-country

alcoholics. We attended a meeting of recovering alcoholics at a "club" she supervised—these clubs were facilities set up under communism to help drunks and their families and, today, still offer the primary recovery program in Bosnia and Croatia. After the two-hour meeting, I commented that just like in an A.A. meeting, I had heard the language of the heart spoken. She replied, "Here, we speak no other."

One additional observation was how eager the A.A. members in each country were to tell us what they were doing and accomplishing. They look to the U.S. and Canada service structure as a resource of shared experience. There were many questions about service, Traditions and Concepts and how other groups and our G.S.O. function, and always lots of questions related to translations and literature. Everywhere, we saw very strong fellowshiping and great affection among the members (in Turkey, just about every male A.A. member bear hugged me and kissed my cheeks—I had bristle burn by the time I left). There seemed always a warm welcome for the newcomer, and I noted that in Croatia, women were right in the center of every service activity.

In all three countries, sponsorship seemed to be a major challenge. Not a lot of members had long-term sobriety—double-digit sobriety seemed a rarity. I don't think there was a lack of emphasis on sponsorship—it wasn't something that was being deliberately downplayed or ignored, but I think it was a lack of experience and mostly a lack of examples. Hopefully, this is an area where future travels and our literature can have some impact.

I wish to express my gratitude to Alcoholics Anonymous, G.S.O., the boards and this Conference, for the opportunity and privilege to have served on this assignment—it has been, literally, an incredible journey. It is staff rotation time at G.S.O. and, as much as I have loved working on this assignment, and most particularly of meeting A.A. members all over the world, my jet lag has jet lag, and I look forward to the experience of A.A. in my own backyard. I have been blessed over the last two years with observing A.A.'s spiritual growth and the Twelfth Step enthusiasm exhibited wherever I have traveled. My prayer is that A.A. United States/Canada continues to stay closely connected to our A.A. brothers and sisters around the globe as our universal message of recovery and hope is carried across borders, cultures and languages, from one alcoholic to another.

*Doug Richardson, G.S.O. staff*



sponsorship has been increasingly effective, with Mexico acting as sponsor to the service structures of Cuba, Colombia, the Dominican Republic, and Poland which was informally sponsored by Germany in the days when producing or carrying A.A. literature was considered illegal. Poland is now acting as sponsor to many of the emerging Eastern European Fellowships, such as Belarus and the Ukraine. Switzerland continues its active sponsorship of Croatia. France is deeply involved in helping members in the French-speaking countries of Africa. At the 19th World Service Meeting, several countries provided financial sponsorship so that delegates from some less well-off countries might attend—Norway sponsored Uruguay; Great Britain sponsored the Ukraine and Trinidad and Tobago; we sponsored the Dominican Republic; and Mexico sponsored Cuba.

In the four international forums I have had the honor of attending—two REDELAs and two World Service Meetings—I have heard and shared experience in committee deliberations, workshops and presentations. More meaningful for me, however, were the spontaneous questions and comments, some on a personal level and others on a system-wide level. Some concerns that came up during the sessions: what use can we make of the new media?; how can we reach the groups and strengthen unity?; how do we get and keep Class As on the general service board?; how do we get the groups to contribute to their service structure?; what can be done to attract women and youth to A.A. and keep them once they come to us?; and (for those of us in service, the perennial question) how do we get more A.A. members involved in service? On all of these topics and more, there was widespread sharing of experience.

We have a place at the international table of A.A.—and a responsibility to share our experience with others at this table. In order to do so, we need first to take care of business here at home by serving our US/Canada Fellowship throughout the year; to review our efforts to ensure the A.A. message is carried through our literature and other media, and to monitor our service structure to ensure that it can best assist the groups to do their Twelfth Step work. These actions, over time, are what have created our “senior” service model to which other “younger” service structures look for answers and collected experience.

In March, I spent eight days in South America visiting the G.S.O.s of Peru, Uruguay and Chile. Both Uruguay and Chile voiced some dissatisfaction with their service structure, and a desire to more closely follow the model of service outlined in our *A.A. Service Manual*. In both these situations, I carefully responded so as to not seem to be touting our own service structure, and instead referred them to our next-door-neighbor Mexico for their experience in the matter. At both the 2005 REDELA and the WSM last year, some of the most enthusiastic proponents of adopting our US/Canada service structure model were the Mexican delegates. They had had the experience of forging their own structure and writing their own service manual, and had had increasing difficulties in coping with the problems inherent in their structure. They had finally come to the conclusion that the answer they sought was to adapt our *A.A. Service Manual* to their needs and to replace theirs.

The reason they saw the value in the US/Canada Service Manual as the answer to their service dilemma was that it outlines the best model available for their needs so far. We have expended great sums of money and effort to ensure our A.A. service structure is effective, efficient, self-monitoring and self-correcting. Can we do better? The answer is always “yes.” We cannot ever rest on our laurels.

To our credit, our US/Canada structure has been consistently engaged in assisting newly-emerging A.A. entities globally through our General Service Office. In conjunction with other

A.A. structures, we continue to be actively involved in the World Service Meeting and each of the four, soon to be five, zonal meetings presently in operation. Each level—national, zonal and world—fosters communication among alcoholics, which is essential to enabling the message of Alcoholics Anonymous to be carried to the newcomer, wherever in the world he or she may be.

We here, in our two-nation Conference, have been the underwriters, financially and spiritually, of many of these far-flung efforts to carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous. We have now been joined in this task by other A.A. service structures with the same goal. Our collective responsibility remains the same as it was in the beginning—to be there when the hand of A.A. is called for. We must continue to provide this strength and hope for the generations to come, both here and abroad, and in so doing, we help to create new partner structures with whom we can carry the message of A.A. to still more alcoholics in still more places yet not reached on this earth.

I thank you for this opportunity to serve our Fellowship.

*Murray McIntosh, trustee-at-large/Canada*

## THE A.A. GRAPEVINE TAKES STOCK

*Friday morning's session began with two presentations on the Grapevine, chaired by Dorothy Hurley, Grapevine director.*

### The A.A. Grapevine Takes Stock: How the A.A. Grapevine Serves the Fellowship Today

Exactly 50 years ago, Bill W. in writing *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age* (p. 31) described the A.A. Grapevine as “...our biggest and best means of communicating current A.A. thought and experience in staying sober, in hanging together, and in serving. ...a lively and convincing means of introducing A.A. to the new or potential member....[It is] the monthly mirror of A.A. in action, always the same principle yet ever growing and ever finding better ways of doing and thinking on new fronts of our exciting adventure in living and working together.” A mere two years later, on the occasion of the A.A. Grapevine’s 15th anniversary, Bill W. reminisced about the very early days when “...the enthusiastic founders did everything. Not only did they do the art work, write the bulk of the stories, they kept the books, they paid the printing bill, they typed the addresses on each copy, and finally licked all the stamps.” (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 396) He then observed that the A.A. Grapevine “...is our great means of inter-communication; a magic carpet on which each of you can ride to the more distant reaches and watch new brothers and sisters emerge from darkness into light.” (ibid, p. 396)

These quotations illustrate for me two essential characteristics of the A.A. Grapevine that we must never lose sight of: from its earliest days, it has been viewed as a vital Twelfth Step tool, a means of introducing the experiences of recovery to the newcomer; and in order to accomplish this mission it must be constantly evolving and changing in the way it reaches the members of the Fellowship. We rarely lick stamps at the A.A. Grapevine anymore, but we are still carrying the same message of hope and recovery contained in the very first issues of the magazine.

The theme of this year’s Conference, “Our 12th Step Responsibility—Are We Going to Any Length?” invites each of us to take an inventory of our efforts to reach the newcomer. We at the A.A. Grapevine in recent years have been busily engaged as a corporation in doing just such a stock taking. We have conducted surveys of our readers and past subscribers and have learned many interesting things and gained some valuable insights into

how effective we are in our responsibility for carrying the message of recovery. From our current subscribers we have learned that an overwhelming majority view the A.A. Grapevine as a very valuable aid to sobriety and source of information about A.A. They tell us that they are hungry for more information about A.A. around the world and deeply treasure the personal stories of recovery contained in its pages. But we have also learned from them that we could be doing a much better job of reaching minorities and younger members of our Fellowship.

From our former readers we have learned that they still have a high opinion of the magazine, but no longer subscribe because they do not have the time to read it. In this we are not alone. Newspapers and the major news magazines have all seen staggering declines in their subscription bases during the last decade. A.A. Grapevine circulation peaked in 1990 at 135,000. Today circulation hovers around 104,000. Such trends have led some publishing pundits to fear that we in the U.S. and Canada are becoming two nations of nonreaders. But a closer examination of the data does not bear this out. Some specialty or niche magazines have experienced strong growth during the last decade. However, these tend to be celebrity or entertainment journalism that depends on newsstand or checkout counter sales, rather than a subscription base. The young professional is much more likely to read the news from the New York Times or Washington Post online at work, rather than at the breakfast table over coffee. In fact, when online readership is factored in, newspaper readership has actually increased during the last decade, while print subscriptions were declining. So perhaps it is more accurate to say that we are not becoming nonreaders, but readers seeking changing content served up to us in different formats or on different platforms.

We at the A.A. Grapevine see our Twelfth Step responsibility as requiring us to reach out not only to our loyal readers with a continued strong message of recovery in print, but at the same time to reach out to the member who does not have time to read by supplying him or her with high quality CDs of Grapevine material, with our online presence, and through the medium of our newest effort, the audio A.A. Grapevine. We see it as our responsibility to reach younger readers with improved graphics and visual content of our magazines and to reach Spanish-speaking members through the pages of *La Viña*.

Each of us, however, can well ask, "Am I going to any length?" When I ask myself this question, I realize that it has been a long time since I gave a gift subscription for the A.A. Grapevine to a sponsee. I recently gave a subscription to my home group, but I could have done it years earlier. When asked to lead a meeting, I sometimes bring a recent issue of the A.A. Grapevine, read a short article to the group, and throw out the theme of the article as a discussion topic. When I do so, after the meeting fellow members often ask me for a subscription form. I could do a much better job of raising awareness of the downloadable Grapevine. I am determined that, going forward, any time I see younger members of our Fellowship sporting iPods or MP3 players to ask them if they have sampled the audio Grapevine from our Web site. I hope each of us will engage in such personal inventory taking.

If we do, then I am sure we will continue to see fulfilled the mission of the A.A. Grapevine articulated by one of our first staff members who said, "We think that the Grapevine ought to become the 'voice of Alcoholics Anonymous,' bringing us news of each other across great distances, and always describing what can be freshly seen in that vast and life-giving pool we call 'A.A. experience'...always mindful of our sole aim to carry the A.A. message to those who suffer alcoholism—such is our idea for the Grapevine." (ibid, p. 389)

*John Skilton, Grapevine director*

## A Reflection on Our First Ten Years

First, let me review a bit of history. In 1991, a General Service Conference Advisory Action recommended that the Grapevine begin publishing at least one article in Spanish in the magazine every month.

In 1995, the Spanish-speaking Fellowship brought to the General Service Conference a request for a Spanish edition of the Grapevine. The General Service Conference approved the idea, and three months later a special edition of the Grapevine was produced in Spanish.

In 1996, the Conference recommended that the Grapevine begin publication of a Spanish magazine, on a trial basis, for five years. Therefore, the first issue of *La Viña* came off the press in 1996. Copies were distributed to subscribers in the United States, Canada, Mexico, Central and South America, the Caribbean and Europe. The trial period expired in 2001. The response to *La Viña* had been so positive, that the General Service Conference that year recommended that *La Viña* continue to be published by the A.A. Grapevine, with the support of the General Service Board, as a service to the Fellowship.

In the last two years, *La Viña* has grown dramatically. We have seen circulation increase from about 9,000 to 11,000 issues a year. As we all know, the Spanish-speaking population in A.A. is growing very rapidly. We really need our magazine, which is an important tool to reach out to newcomers and prospective A.A. members.

Our 12th Step Responsibility: Are We Going to Any Length? For me, this question is asking whether I am doing enough in my efforts to reach the alcoholic who still suffers. Alcoholics Anonymous found me and gave me my life back. Among the gifts that A.A. has given me is the responsibility to go to work every day and pay my bills. Everything I have now is because of my loving brothers and sisters in A.A., and I am very grateful for that.

In these first ten years, *La Viña* has been read by thousands of Spanish-speaking members and friends of Alcoholics Anonymous around the world. In *La Viña* we have the opportunity to read about many different kinds of meetings, the experiences of our brothers and sisters in Latin America, the joy of living sober and of doing service in A.A. This wonderful tool has carried and continues to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic and allows us to share experience, strength and hope with others in our language. But this goes beyond the Spanish language. I am talking about the language of the heart, something we all share and understand.

Going to any length is our decision. How far do we want to go to attract newcomers? In my experience, this is not an easy job. *La Viña* is one of the resources we have to carry our message. I, for one, leave magazines at my doctor's office and in a cab, pretending that I have forgotten them. There are many other ways to use this resource. Action is the key. Giving back a little of what Alcoholics Anonymous has given me is more than a choice, it is my responsibility. I make it part of my job to try to reach my brothers and sisters who are still suffering from alcoholism. I bring *La Viña* to correctional facilities, hospitals, schools and other institutions. This is just one way in which I fulfill my responsibility.

There are so many people who need us. If we keep giving back to Alcoholics Anonymous and keep an eye out for our friends and the people around us, we will be able to continue our Twelfth Step work and reach yet another alcoholic, the person who is extending his or her hand, asking for help. Both the hand of Alcoholics Anonymous and my own hand have to be there. And for that, I am responsible.

*Jorge Flores, Rhode Island*

# Reports from the General Service Board and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Corporate Boards

## GENERAL SERVICE BOARD REPORT

**Trustees' report:** As we once more gather to conduct our annual Conference, our 57th, we should take the time to thank the God of our understanding for the wonderful gift of this program. Our theme for this Conference—Our 12th Step Responsibility—Are We Going to Any Length?—is a particularly poignant question for all of us to consider. In my travels amongst you and in foreign lands, I have witnessed many striking examples of members carrying our message. Almost universally, however, there is a feeling that more can and should be done.

Following the 56th General Service Conference, we welcomed three new Class B trustees to the board: Madeleine Parmley, Pacific regional trustee; general service trustee Jane Sheppard; and Denis Vezina, Eastern Canada regional trustee. Sadly, this past year Jane Sheppard and Denis Vezina passed away, a great loss to the Fellowship. Jane and Denis are remembered for their sterling dedication and service to A.A. They are greatly missed by all whose lives they touched.

After a review of the Bylaws of the General Service Board and the options for the selection or election of a regional trustee due to Denis Vezina's sudden passing, the delegates of the Eastern Canada region caucused and recommended that the position remain vacant for the balance of the four-year term that expires in 2010, and that the chairman of the General Service Board appoint a trustee to fill the position. After careful consideration, I appointed Murray McIntosh to serve as acting regional trustee concurrent with his duties as trustee-at-large/Canada, until he rotates at the close of this Conference. I will then reappoint a trustee to serve as acting Eastern Canada regional trustee. In October, the General Service Board's recommendation that John Skilton serve as general service trustee replacing Jane Sheppard was forwarded to the 2007 Conference Committee on Trustees.

In November, the board reviewed the final report from the Ad Hoc Committee on Regional Structure Inventory. The board approved and forwarded recommendations, which pertain to amendments in the Bylaws of the General Service Board and *The A.A. Service Manual*, to the Conference Committees on Trustees and Report and Charter. The board continued its review of the Bylaws and in January forwarded an amendment to the Bylaws to the General Service Conference Committee on Trustees. Changes to General Service Board Bylaws must be approved by the General Service Conference.

In March 2005, the board began the inventory process of the three boards. Following the General Service Board meeting in March 2006, an ad hoc committee was appointed to review the three board inventories (A.A. Grapevine, A.A. World Services and General Service Board) taken in 2005 through 2006. The scope of the committee included a review of inventory reports to sort out trends, issues, and indicators reflected in the discussions that point to the future; review suggestions in the final report from GSB Regional Composition and Structure Inventory Ad Hoc Committee and final report from GSB Native North American Ad Hoc Committee; and to prioritize all suggestions.

March 17-18, 2007, the General Service Board held a special meeting on Board Inventories. The purpose was to review priority lists of suggestions of the three board inventories, final reports from the GSB Regional Composition and Structure Inventory Ad Hoc Committee and GSB Native North American Ad Hoc Committee, and to strategize and discuss plans of action. We look forward to further implementation on several of the suggested items.

Since the 56th Conference, the board has hosted Regional Forums in Seattle, Washington; Sudbury, Ontario; and Atlanta,

Georgia. Special Forums were held in Banning, California; Philadelphia, Pennsylvania; and Kenosha, Wisconsin. All were well attended by enthusiastic members with continued interest in A.A.'s Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service. One of the most memorable was the Special Native North American Indian Forum, held on a reservation of the Morongo Band of Mission Indians, where over 120 Native North Americans attended. It was an extraordinary experience in that a local group conscience committee of Native North American members was formed to work with G.S.O. staff, Grapevine and the board to create an agenda that included workshops and presentations moderated by Native North Americans, less G.S.O. presentations, and a special social powwow.

In October 2006, Dorothy Wilson and Murray McIntosh, trustees-at-large, U.S. and Canada, traveled to Malahide, Ireland, as World Service Meeting delegates to participate in the 19th World Service Meeting. It was one of the largest gatherings of WSM delegates since it began in 1969.

In order to assist others in carrying the A.A. message, some trustees, G.S.O.'s general manager and staff traveled overseas to Bosnia-Herzegovina, Croatia, France, Greece, Ireland, Kuwait, Mexico, Russian Siberia, South Korea, Sweden, Trinidad and Tobago, and Turkey. Equally as important to sharing our experience, we ask other countries to share their experience with us.

From May 22 through June 3, 2006, I traveled with staff member Doug Richardson to Turkey, Croatia and Bosnia-Herzegovina. In each country, we were able to participate in P.I. and C.P.C. service. In Turkey, I had the opportunity to share about A.A. on two television programs in Ankara, the capitol city. It was reported to us that the phone at the local service office rang steadily after the programs. We also visited a renowned psychiatric unit of the University Teaching Hospital, which offers the most extensive alcohol treatment program in Turkey. The entire goal of the program was geared to funnel patients into Alcoholics Anonymous and to get families tied into Al-Anon. It was quite a model system with a long waiting list.

In Croatia and Bosnia-Herzegovina, we met with a number of psychiatrists and municipal administrators. Both these countries were part of the former Yugoslavia and inherited a system that was set up by a then well-known psychiatrist at a time when the political realities would not allow for anonymous meetings or the public acknowledgement of God. They formed "clubs," which were however, not at all like the clubs with which we are familiar. At their height, over 500 clubs were set up in localities throughout the countries where professional therapists would conduct weekly discussions of the Twelve Steps with groups of former hospital patients and their families. Only about 180 of these clubs still exist and the physicians and local government folks we spoke with are searching for ways to move ahead without entirely abandoning past practices. They agreed that A.A. could be part of the answer.

One of the ways that A.A.'s message of hope and recovery from alcoholism is carried beyond our borders is through translations of A.A. Conference-approved literature. Since last April, the pamphlets "Is A.A. for You?," "A Newcomer Asks," and "A Brief Guide to A.A.," in Bosnian and Kazakh were completed, in addition to "44 Questions" and "This is A.A." in Kazakh. The service piece "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous" was translated into Bosnian, Croatian, Kazakh and Turkish. The pamphlets, "If You Are a Professional" and "Twelve Traditions Illustrated" in Croatian, and the books *Living Sober* in Armenian and the Fourth Edition Big Book in Sinhala were completed. The "Twelve Steps" and "Twelve Traditions" (short form) were also translated into Bosnian.

In January, we had the pleasure of welcoming the Conference delegate chair and the chairpersons of Conference committees at the quarterly General Service Board meeting. Delegate chairpersons attended an orientation meeting at G.S.O., met with their committee staff secretaries, and attended sessions of corresponding trustees' committees as guest observers. The practice of inviting Conference committee chairpersons to the January board weekend began in 1991 and continues to benefit the Conference process in helping delegates fulfill their trusted servant responsibilities to the Conference and A.A. as a whole.

At the close of this Conference, five trustees will rotate: Allen Ault, Gary Kluksdahl, Murray McIntosh, Mike Perry and Arnold Ross. We are grateful for their dedication, self-sacrifice and tireless service on behalf of the Fellowship.

The General Service Board is looking forward to hosting A.A.'s 75th Anniversary Celebration at the International Convention in San Antonio, Texas, in July 2010. The theme for this wonderful event will be "A Vision for You."

This week we will hear and see many reports and presentations regarding our theme and what has been done to enhance our Twelfth Step responsibility. I am sure that if Bill W. were here with us he would be very proud, but would then prod us to move further and faster. He, no doubt, would exhort us to embrace the future more aggressively in carrying out our Twelfth Step efforts.

We are less than 30 years away from our centennial. Now is the time to start discussing and planning for our 100th anniversary and strategies to extend our Twelfth Step responsibility into A.A.'s second century.

*Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D., chairman*

## ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.

**Directors' report:** Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) is a not-for-profit corporation, composed of nine directors. Members of A.A.W.S., Inc. are the 21 trustees of the General Service Board, who elect directors responsible for oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.), group services, printing and distribution of Conference-approved literature and service material. A.A.W.S. owns copyrights on A.A. literature, and is responsible for translations of A.A. literature, including titles licensed to A.A. boards or committees in other countries.

There are nine A.A.W.S. directors: two general service trustees and two regional trustees; three nontrustee directors; G.S.O.'s general manager and staff coordinator. Essential nonvoting support personnel attend each board meeting: senior advisor to the general manager, G.S.O. staff, controller, publications director, human resources manager, archivist, board secretary, and one or more representatives of the A.A. Grapevine.

Directors serving on Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. report annually to the General Service Conference on A.A. publications, group services provided by the General Service Office, and other activities linked directly to A.A.'s primary purpose. A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. employees agree that our purpose, expressed through requested services and publication of A.A. literature, is to enable members and groups to enlarge their Twelfth Step work, and share A.A.'s solution with each suffering alcoholic. The structure, composition and responsibilities of Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. are described in Chapter 10 of *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*.

The A.A.W.S. Board met seven times since the 56th Conference to receive reports from G.S.O. management and staff; review updates on group services activity and track progress on implementation of Conference and board recommendations; review financial reports; price new and revised publications; consider publishing operations and G.S.O. administration matters; discuss requests from A.A. members and non-A.A.s seeking permission to reprint A.A.-copyrighted literature; and address other pertinent matters.

Committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Services (considers the needs of all service assignments); Publishing (reviews reprints, foreign literature and publications matters); Finance (oversees budgeting and financial results); and Nominating (suggests candidates for nontrustee director and general service trustee vacancies). Long-range planning is conducted within each committee and by the board as a whole.

**Visitors and Special Guests** — G.S.O. welcomed 1,762 visitors during 2006, and several groups of 15-50 members, some traveling great distances to spend a day in their office. The office also welcomed 315 enthusiastic A.A.s who visited the office while attending the Hispanic Convention in Rye, New York. Twenty-two tours were held that day in order to accommodate these members.

**New Groups** — A net total of 986 new A.A. groups listed with G.S.O. last year. Each new group's general service representative (G.S.R.) or contact received A.A. literature and basic information to encourage the group to link with their local structure and support Twelfth Step services.

**Regional and Special Forums** — Since the 56th Conference, A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff participated in three Regional Forums: Pacific in Seattle, Washington, June 23-25; Eastern Canada, in Sudbury, Ontario, September 15-17; and Southeast in Atlanta, Georgia, December 1-3. In addition, three Special Forums were held: Native North American Indian Special Forum in Banning, California, May 20-21; Special Inner City Forum, in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania, October 14-15; and the Hispanic Special Forum, in Kenosha, Wisconsin, November 10-12.

**Annual Intergroup Seminar** — Chris Cavanaugh, Warren Stafford and Andrea Brennan attended the 21th Annual Intergroup/Central Office Seminar in Akron, Ohio, September 28-October 1. Other attendees included A.A.W.S. chairperson Paul Cleary; nontrustee director George Martin; as well as participating G.S.O. and Grapevine staff.



*Annual Native American Convention* — Valerie O'Neill attended the 16th Annual Native American Convention, in Green Bay, Wisconsin, September 29-October 1.

*International Conference of Young People in A.A. (I.C.Y.P.A.A.) Convention* — Eva Sanchez attended the 48th Convention, New Orleans, Louisiana, June 28-July 2.

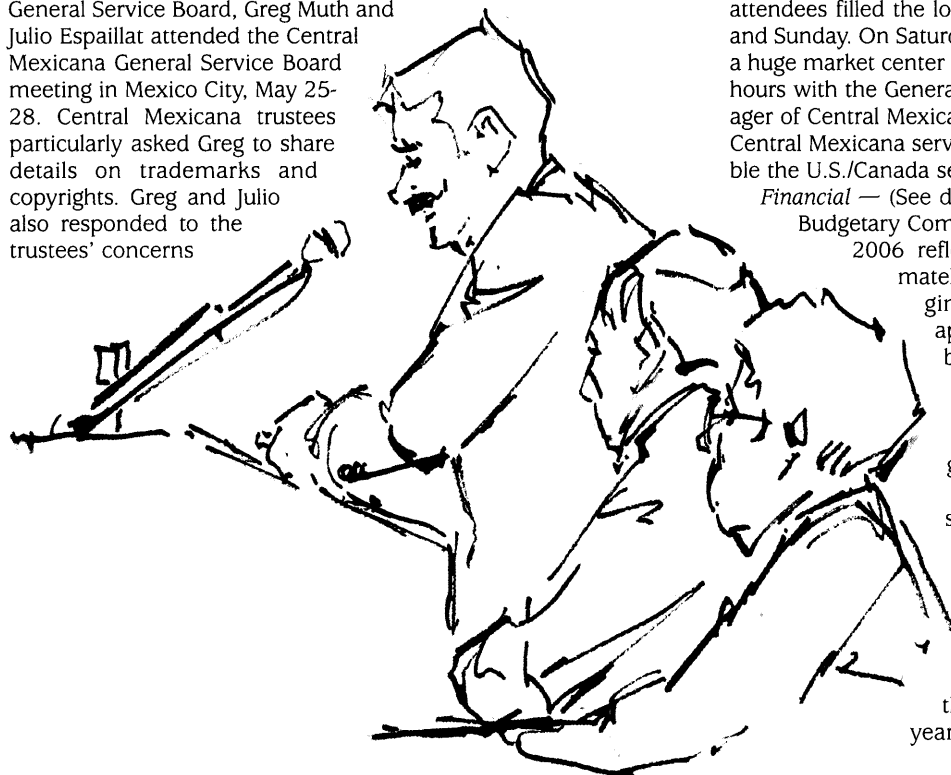
*Other Activities* — April 29, 2006, Doug Richardson attended an Open House celebrating the 55th Anniversary of Al-Anon/Alateen Family Groups in Virginia Beach, Virginia. June 8 and September 21 Irene Kontje attended two Advisory Council meetings of the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse & Alcoholism (N.I.A.A.A.) in Bethesda, Maryland, as an observer.

*G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site* — The board approved the 2006 quarterly and the 2006 Annual Web Site Activity Reports, and forwarded them to the trustees' Committee on Public Information. The board also approved electronic distribution of the newsletters *Markings* and *About A.A.*; and when practical, authorized posting on G.S.O.'s Web site a list of A.A.W.S., Inc. literature, including graphics of some titles, without price details.

The board approved the Services Committee's recommendation to accept the Policy on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site presented in January 2007, as well as the committee's recommendation that the Intra-Office Web site Committee be authorized to add to G.S.O.'s Web site any Conference-approved pamphlet designated as "recovery" literature without the need for further approval by the Services Committee or the A.A.W.S. Board.

*International* — Trustees and G.S.O. staff accepted invitations from A.A. in other lands to share experience with A.A. groups and trusted servants in local service structures, Leonard Blumenthal, chair of the General Service Board, and Doug Richardson traveled to Turkey, Croatia and Bosnia-Herzegovina May 14—June 6. Doug also visited Greece and Paris, France; and, while in Paris he worked with G.S.O. and trustees on plans for the 1st West Central Africa Service Meeting (French-speaking Africa) to be held in Paris, December 2007.

At the request of the Central Mexicana General Service Board, Greg Muth and Julio Espallat attended the Central Mexicana General Service Board meeting in Mexico City, May 25-28. Central Mexicana trustees particularly asked Greg to share details on trademarks and copyrights. Greg and Julio also responded to the trustees' concerns



about periodic disunity within the Fellowship in Mexico.

August 10-27, Doug Richardson and Greg Muth traveled to South Korea, Mongolia and Russian Siberia to meet with A.A. members on the forefront of A.A.'s growth, and with professionals in medicine and government. In Seoul, they met with the South Korean G.S.O. staff and board members. Doug and Greg attended the 2nd National A.A. Convention of Mongolia, and also met with an A.A. group in Ulaanbaatar, capital of that vast land. In Russian Siberia, Doug and Greg were invited to meet with the Minister of Health in Kyzyl (Federation of Tuva), to visit the Narcological Institute, and attend the first ever A.A. meeting in Tuva, before traveling on to visit A.A. groups in Ulan Ude, Irkutsk and Kharabarovsk.

October 15-19, A.A. in Ireland hosted the 19th World Service Meeting (WSM) in Malahide. Fifty-four WSM delegates representing A.A. in 34 countries came together for presentations, workshops and sharing sessions centered on the theme "Anonymous—But Not Invisible." The 20th WSM will be hosted by our General Service Board, October 25-29, 2008 in New York City.

Dorothy Wilson and Greg Muth fulfilled an invitation to attend the 6th Gulf Coast Convention in Kuwait City, Kuwait, November 8-11. Present were over 40 A.A. members and guests from Abu Dhabi (United Arab Emirates) Bahrain, India, Iran, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, as well as Kuwait. Dorothy and Greg took advantage of an opportunity to meet with five Iranian A.A. members present for the convention. The Iranians sought guidance on forming a translations committee that would begin to translate A.A. pamphlets and books in Farsi.

March 16-19, Doug Richardson attended the Gratitude Celebration for Media in Mexico City, where the theme was Celebration of the 65th Anniversary publication of the Jack Alexander article on A.A.

March 23-25, Leonard Blumenthal, Greg Muth and Doug Richardson attended the 9th National Convention of Mexico as guests of the Central Mexicana General Service Board. The celebration was held in Guadalajara, where more than 45,000 joyful attendees filled the local soccer stadium for meetings on Friday and Sunday. On Saturday, dozens of A.A. workshops were held at a huge market center nearby. Leonard, Greg and Doug also spent hours with the General Service Board and the new general manager of Central Mexicana's G.S.O. discussing the transition of the Central Mexicana service structure to one that will closely resemble the U.S./Canada service structure.

*Financial* — (See details in Report of the Trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee.) A summary of financial results for 2006 reflected net sales of \$11,681,000, approximately \$621,700 (5%) under budget. Gross margin on literature sales was \$8,347,200, approximately \$180,500 (2%) under budget, but \$350,000 greater at year end 2005. Contributions received in 2006 totaled \$6,068,200, exceeding budget by \$548,200 (9.9%), and \$651,100 (12%) greater than the 2005 total.

Total revenue (gross profit on literature sales, contributions, and interest earned on cash flow) was \$12,952,200. Total revenue was about \$193,800 more than budgeted and \$849,100 greater than in 2005. Net profit for the year 2006 came to \$657,900, compared with \$474,981 budgeted, and \$318,300 less than \$976,000 net profit reported for the year 2005.

*Mid-Year Budget Considerations (2006)* — A.A.W.S. approved and forwarded to the Trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee (TFBC) these projects that resulted from Conference Advisory Actions:

| Item                        | Line Item           | Amount           |
|-----------------------------|---------------------|------------------|
| C.P.C. video segments       | Writers' Fees       | \$ 60,000        |
| Track & distribute          |                     |                  |
| P.S.A. Testimonials         | Contracted Services | 31,000           |
| Start next P.S.A. in series | Writers' Fees       | 40,000           |
| Corrections Video           |                     |                  |
| (Training Academies)        | Writers' Fees       | 50,000           |
| <b>Total</b>                |                     | <b>\$181,000</b> |

Costs of these projects resulted in an adjusted budgeted net income for 2006 of \$475,000, compared with \$656,000 originally approved.

A.A.W.S. approved and forwarded to TFBC a request for approval of approximately \$274,500 to replace carpeting throughout G.S.O. and to refurbish the 11th floor lobby. Most of carpet slated for replacement was installed when G.S.O. moved into the current location (1992). In keeping with policies adopted by TFBC and the General Service Board in January 2005, the carpet and refurbishment expenditures will be accounted for as "Major Projects," and be capitalized and depreciated in the Capital Projects Fund of the General Service Board.

A.A.W.S. approved and forwarded to TFBC details on negotiations to extend the office lease. The A.A.W.S. board reviewed new information obtained during the negotiations indicating that we will be required to be responsible for specific upgrades to our office space in 2009. The projected cost of \$435,000 would be for energy efficient light fixtures and 36,000 square feet of Class A Building Standard ceiling tiles, in addition to the carpet replacement previously noted. After reviewing the new information, the A.A.W.S. Board concluded that, taking into account the \$435,000 unanticipated costs, the original reasoning and decision to renew/extend the lease presented in the 2005 Relocation Study remained valid, and requested that TFBC ratify the original decision. In keeping with policies adopted by the TFBC and the General Service Board in January 2005, those expenditures will be accounted for as "Major Projects" and, as such, capitalized and depreciated in the Capital Projects Fund of the General Service Board, when incurred in 2009.

A.A.W.S. approved and forwarded to the TFBC information on a proposal to expend approximately \$130,000 to rewrite/expand the capabilities and functions of G.S.O.'s Fellowship/Delarea data base programs. A.A.W.S. directors received updates and reports on this project for about a year, including Request for Proposal (RFP), solicitation of several vendors, and bid reviews. The A.A.W.S. Board approved the project named Fellowship New Vision (FNV) and requested authorization from TFBC. In keeping with policies adopted by TFBC and the General Service Board in January of 2005, these expenditures will be accounted for as "Major Projects," and capitalized and depreciated in the

Capital Projects Fund of the General Service Board.

*2007 Budget* — The board approved G.S.O.'s budget for 2007 as prepared by A.A.W.S.'s Finance Committee, and forwarded to TFBC for review.

*Transfer of Funds to Reserve Fund* — The board approved the A.A.W.S. Finance Committee's recommendation that \$350,000 be transferred to the General Service Board's Reserve Fund.

*Transfer of Retained Earnings to General Fund* — The A.A.W.S. Finance Committee recommended, and the board approved, a transfer of retained earnings to the General Service Board's General Fund in the amount of \$2,420,827.43. The transfer will cover the General Service Board's loss of \$2,199,854.17, the La Viña loss of \$72,004.11, the net \$398,969.15 Capital Projects Fund expenditure; and, together with the \$250,000 already received from the Reserve Fund, will restore the General Fund balance to \$57,012.90.

*Requests for Possible 2007 Conference Agenda Items* — The A.A.W.S. Finance Committee also forwarded to the board two requests from an area that a review of literature volume pricing and literature shipping charges be considered by the 2007 General Service Conference. The board discussed and reaffirmed the committee's recommendation that these policies are within the scope of the A.A.W.S. Board's responsibilities; and, expressed unanimous support for the current literature pricing structure, including the schedule of shipping charges on small orders and quantity discounts on large orders as a prudent operating policy. The board agreed to forward the requests to TFBC for wider guidance, noting that similar requests were discussed by the 2006 Conference Committee on Finance.

*Publications: Unit Distribution of Books* — In 2006, G.S.O. distributed a total of 1,951,938 book units, 7% less than 2,102,014 distributed in 2005. In 2006, A.A. purchases totaled 1,607,760 units; and non-A.A. purchases accounted for 344,178 units, or 16% of the total.

*Big Book Sales* (all editions) — For the year 2006, we distributed 1,067,191 units, compared to 973,764 in 2005.

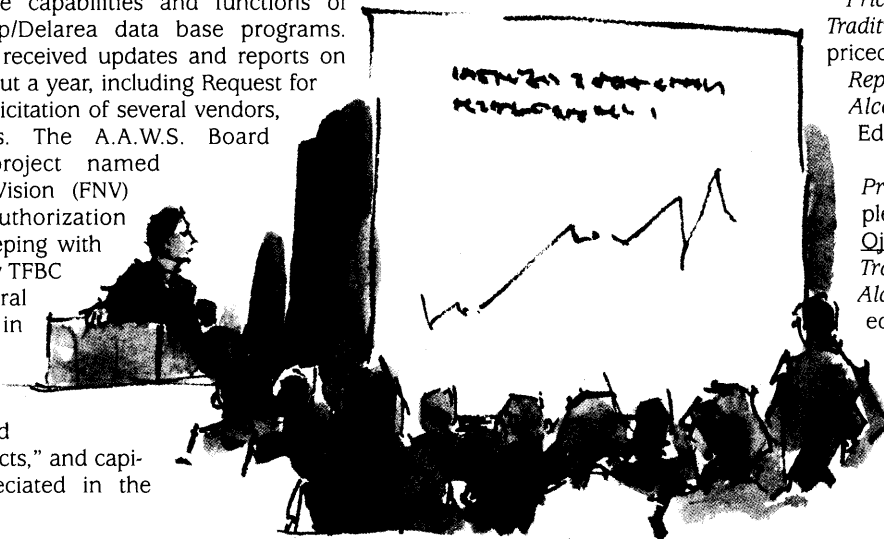
*Suspension of Publication, 2006-2007 A.A. Directories* — Due to extensive delays in the production of A.A. Directories, the A.A.W.S. Board determined that it was best to suspend publication of the 2006-2007 A.A. Directories, including three Regional Directories, the International Directory, and the lists of domestic and overseas Central/Intergroup Offices and Answering Services.

*Inventory Reduction Proposal* — The board approved as presented an Inventory Reduction proposal and Inventory Reduction application that included a list of items to either be discontinued, archived or kept on hand in a minimum quantity.

*Pricing — Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* audio-book on CD was priced at \$18.

*Repricing* — The audio CD of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, 4th Edition, was priced at \$55.

*Translations and Licensing Projects* — Translations completed: Armenian Living Sober; Qijibwe Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions audiotapes and *Alcoholics Anonymous* (pocket edition) audiotapes; Croatian Alcoholics Anonymous, 4th Edition, "Information on A.A.," A.A. Guidelines on Central/Intergroup Offices, A.A. Guidelines on Conferences, Conventions,





and Roundups, "Twelve Traditions Illustrated," "Concepts Checklist" and "Traditions Checklist—A.A. Grapevine"; Turkish "Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated," "Information on A.A.," "If You Are a Professional," and Public Information Workbook; Sinhala *Alcoholics Anonymous*, 4th Edition; Bosnian *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*; "A Newcomer Asks," "Is A.A. for You?," "Information on A.A." and "A Brief Guide to A.A."; Kazakh "Information on A.A.," "44 Questions," "Is A.A. for You?," "This Is A.A.," "A Newcomer Asks" and "A Brief Guide to A.A."; Farsi "Information on A.A.," "A Brief Guide to A.A." and "This is A.A."; Greek Public Information Workbook; Indonesian *Alcoholics Anonymous*, 4th Edition; Thai *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* and "What Happened to Joe?"

*Approved Licenses* (granted to boards or committees serving A.A. in their countries to translate and/or print and distribute) — "Do You Think You're Different?" and "A.A. for the Older Alcoholic" in English (Australia); *Came to Believe*, "Letter to a Woman Alcoholic," and "A.A. at a Glance" in Flemish (Belgium); *Came to Believe* in Hungarian (Hungary); *Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers*, "Problems Other than Alcohol" and "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" in Polish (Poland); *Alcoholics Anonymous*, 4th Edition, in Slovenian (Slovenia); "How It Works" and "Pass it On" in Spanish (Mexico).

*Loss of Copyright on Twelve Concepts for World Service* — Early this year, we learned that copyright protection on the original 1962 version of the *Twelve Concepts for World Service* expired on December 31, 1990, because the copyright was not renewed prior to that date. *Twelve Concepts for World Service* was first registered with the U.S. Copyright Office on September 19, 1985, by Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. as owner and claimant. *Twelve Concepts for World Service* was written by Bill W. and first published in 1962. Bill W. copyrighted works he authored, but did not register *Twelve Concepts for World Service*.

We greatly regret the loss of this copyright. The A.A.W.S. Board accepts responsibility for preserving and protecting copyrights and trademarks. With the guidance of intellectual property attorneys, we continue to review the copyright status of all titles owned by A.A.W.S. and utilize a solid system to prevent future copyright losses. The board prepared a simple Fact Sheet on the loss of Concepts' copyright that will be distributed to all Conference members. We encourage you to share the facts with members in your area and region.

*Online Ordering System* — The A.A.W.S. Publishing Committee discussed customer qualifications for online ordering accounts and recommended the following clarification of qualified customers, approved by the board: Any recognized central or intergroup office; any district or area or any committee thereof; and any other entity that has spent

\$25,000 or more on A.A. literature in any one of the past three years. Customers must be from either the United States or Canada.

*Revision* — The revised "Young People and A.A." pamphlet was published, and includes new stories for younger people.

*Publications Personnel* — The sudden passing of production manager Carole Harley was a shock to everyone in G.S.O. Carole's outstanding work in our Publications Department continues to benefit A.A. literature.

The Publications Department announced two promotions within the Department: Ed Nyland, former production coordinator, was named production manager; and, Daniel Brown's title was upgraded to digital media manager.

*G.S.O. Archives* — The archival collection compiled by the International Conference of Young People in A.A. (I.C.Y.P.A.A.) was presented to G.S.O.'s Archives by Tom H., I.C.Y.P.A.A. archivist. This generous and memorable gift adds vital history to A.A.'s historic collection.

*Archives' Audio and Film Preservation Projects* — These projects are proceeding with 4,085 records describing audio recording added to the InMagic database, and completion of 144 detailed entries on archival films. Archives' staff is transferring master copies to off-site storage, matching originals with the (new) CDs, and performing quality control on InMagic records. We continue to preserve Bill's handwritten correspondence, as well as the minutes of The Alcoholic Foundation.

*Archives Disaster Plan* — The Plan was approved by the trustees' Archives Committee, and archivist Amy Filiatreau plans on implementation in 2007. Amy and staff are working to have emergency supplies ready and ensure that each member of the response team has a copy of the plan. The Facilities Assessment Report and Environmental Report will be completed and placed on file.

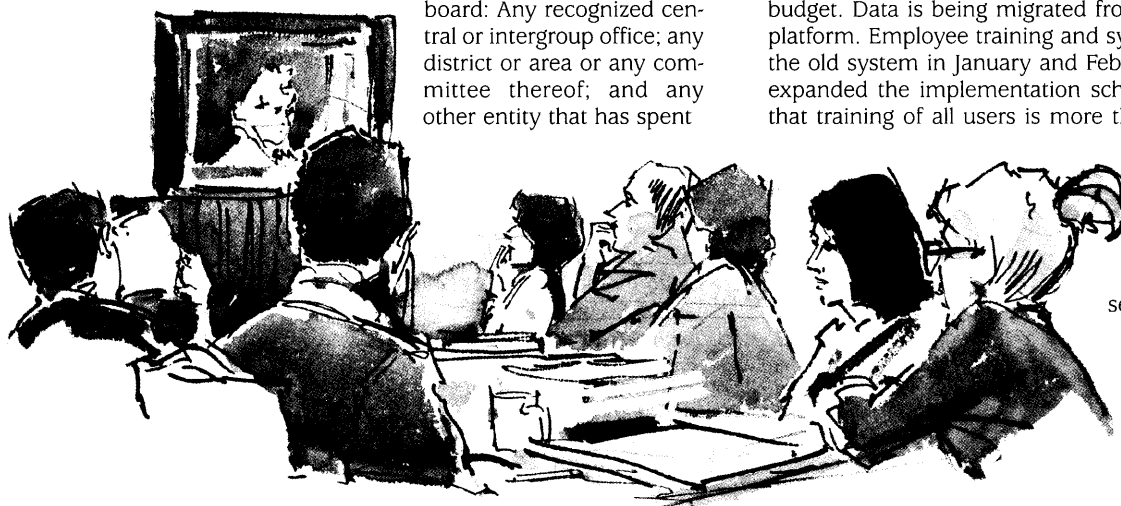
*New officers and directors on A.A.W.S. Board* — In June 2006, the board elected a slate of officers to serve through the 57th General Service Conference. The board also welcomed Southeast regional trustee Howard Lowery and Roberta Lindeman as new directors. Past A.A.W.S. director Jane Sheppard began service as a general service trustee; however, several months later, Jane became ill and passed away on October 25, 2006. The board adopted a "Conflict of Interest Policy for A.A.W.S. Directors and Officers," modeled on the one adopted by the General Service Board for its trustees and officers.

*G.S.O. & Staff Operations* — At year-end 2006, G.S.O. had 80 full-time employees, plus 4 part-time/ students.

*Fellowship New Vision (FNV) System* — The development and deployment of Fellowship New Vision is on schedule and within budget. Data is being migrated from the old system to the FNV platform. Employee training and system testing ran parallel with the old system in January and February 2007. The Project team expanded the implementation schedule to May 2007 to assure that training of all users is more than adequate. The FNV team

also developed a training video to familiarize participating Area Record keepers with the new program. The training video will be distributed to those trusted servants when all aspects of development are completed.

Paul Cleary, chairperson





# Literature Distributed — 2006

## ENGLISH

### Books

|                                                  |                  |
|--------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Alcoholics Anonymous                             | 498,735          |
| Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover)                | 396,443          |
| Alcoholics Anonymous (large print)               | 40,483           |
| Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)           | 131,368          |
| Daily Reflections                                | 150,956          |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. ed.)    | 160,186          |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift ed.)    | 10,407           |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)  | 157,619          |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print) | 19,695           |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (pocket ed.)  | 52,535           |
| A.A. Comes of Age                                | 10,697           |
| As Bill Sees It                                  | 35,809           |
| As Bill Sees It (soft cover)                     | 29,754           |
| Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers                   | 9,999            |
| "Pass It On"                                     | 9,794            |
| Experience, Strength & Hope                      | 10,683           |
| <b>Total</b>                                     | <b>1,725,163</b> |

### Booklets

|                                                               |                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| The A.A. Service Manual/<br>Twelve Concepts for World Service | 28,574         |
| Living Sober                                                  | 132,468        |
| Came to Believe                                               | 54,703         |
| A.A. in Prisons: Inmate to Inmate                             | 15,768         |
| <b>Total</b>                                                  | <b>231,513</b> |

### Pamphlets

|                                                     |         |
|-----------------------------------------------------|---------|
| A.A. and the Armed Services                         | 9,401   |
| A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic                  | 25,729  |
| A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional | 32,985  |
| A.A. for the Native North American                  | 16,182  |
| A.A. for the Woman                                  | 111,110 |
| The A.A. Group                                      | 93,880  |
| A.A. in Your Community                              | 42,514  |
| A.A. in Correctional Facilities                     | 18,396  |
| A.A. in Treatment Facilities                        | 21,700  |
| The A.A. Membership Survey                          | 32,079  |
| The A.A. Member – Medications and Other Drugs       | 112,268 |
| A.A. Tradition – How It Developed                   | 30,392  |
| A.A.'s Legacy of Service                            | 11,093  |
| A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous               | 113,270 |
| Circles of Love and Service                         | 48,582  |
| Bridging the Gap                                    | 23,116  |
| Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.                | 21,287  |
| The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous             | 14,849  |
| Do You Think You're Different?                      | 124,810 |
| 44 Questions                                        | 229,954 |
| G.S.R.                                              | 46,313  |
| Grapevine — Our Meeting in Print                    | 16,887  |
| How A.A. Members Cooperate                          | 12,143  |
| How It Works                                        | 58,376  |
| If You Are a Professional                           | 29,332  |
| Inside A.A.                                         | 45,324  |
| Can A.A. Help Me Too?                               | 27,140  |
| Is A.A. for You?                                    | 358,762 |
| Is A.A. for Me?                                     | 93,029  |

|                                                      |                  |
|------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?              | 21,143           |
| Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?                  | 82,528           |
| It Happened to Alice                                 | 43,779           |
| It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell                      | 43,469           |
| The Jack Alexander Article                           | 24,500           |
| Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends                   | 10,652           |
| Letter to a Woman Alcoholic                          | 66,925           |
| A Member's-Eye View of A.A.                          | 48,899           |
| Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic            | 36,006           |
| A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators  | 10,462           |
| A Newcomer Asks                                      | 316,275          |
| Problems Other Than Alcohol                          | 113,950          |
| Questions and Answers on Sponsorship                 | 279,484          |
| Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings                        | 16,215           |
| The Twelve Concepts for<br>World Service Illustrated | 34,122           |
| The Twelve Steps Illustrated                         | 71,578           |
| Twelve Tradition Flyer                               | 6,325            |
| The Twelve Traditions Illustrated                    | 49,246           |
| This Is A.A.                                         | 272,121          |
| Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.          | 18,570           |
| AA for the Older Alcoholic (Lrg Print)               | 56,487           |
| Too Young?                                           | 69,054           |
| Understanding Anonymity                              | 55,406           |
| What Happened to Joe                                 | 46,669           |
| Young People and A.A.                                | 115,413          |
| <b>Total</b>                                         | <b>3,730,181</b> |

### Miscellaneous

|                                                     |                  |
|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Wallet cards-two-fold                               | 309,864          |
| Wallet cards-I Am Responsible                       | 52,281           |
| Wallet cards-Anonymity                              | 30,452           |
| Anonymity Display Card                              | 2,505            |
| Parchment-scrolls                                   | 2,603            |
| Placards                                            | 579              |
| C.P.C. Workbook                                     | 1,242            |
| Archives Workbook                                   | 571              |
| Correctional Facilities Workbook                    | 810              |
| P.I. Workbook                                       | 1,782            |
| Treatment Facilities Workbook                       | 1,111            |
| Treatment Facility Kit                              | 409              |
| Big Book on computer disk                           | 93               |
| Twelve and Twelve on Computer Disk                  | 93               |
| A.A. Guidelines                                     | 75,044           |
| Group Handbook                                      | 2,365            |
| Wire Racks                                          | 1,777            |
| Cassettes (tape cassettes)                          | 745              |
| Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)               | 1,793            |
| Alcoholics Anonymous (4th Ed cassette album)        | 122              |
| A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)                  | 113              |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album) | 924              |
| TV Public Service Announcement                      | 182              |
| Radio Public Service Announcements                  | 202              |
| Twelve Steps Shade displays                         | 1,960            |
| Twelve Traditions Shade displays                    | 1,874            |
| Fact File                                           | 1,432            |
| Table Top Display 12 & 12                           | 455              |
| Pioneers of AA (Cassette Album)                     | 43               |
| Living Sober (Cassette Album)                       | 133              |
| <b>Total</b>                                        | <b>493,559</b>   |
| <b>Grand Total</b>                                  | <b>6,180,416</b> |

## SPANISH

### Libros y Librillos (Books & Booklets)

|                                                                                                                    |                |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Alcohólicos Anónimos<br>(Alcoholics Anonymous soft cover)                                                          | 21,912         |
| Alcohólicos Anónimos<br>(Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)                                                           | 8,264          |
| Alcohólicos Anónimos<br>(Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)                                                | 6,824          |
| Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)                                                                                  | 5,686          |
| A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)                                                                | 3,896          |
| El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos<br>(Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)                                              | 2,895          |
| Transmitelo (Pass it On)                                                                                           | 3,128          |
| Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)                                                                            | 9,300          |
| Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)                                                                                     | 12,253         |
| El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos<br>para el Servicio Mundial<br>(A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts) | 3,345          |
| Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones<br>(Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)                                              | 23,566         |
| Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)                                                                                 | 4,863          |
| A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)                                                              | 5,366          |
| Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (pocket ed.)                                                                         | 6,174          |
| <b>Total</b>                                                                                                       | <b>117,472</b> |

### Folletos (Pamphlets)

|                                                                                                         |        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)                                                           | 4,459  |
| 44 Preguntas (44 Questions)                                                                             | 25,395 |
| Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)                                                                             | 28,138 |
| Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)                                                                  | 75,953 |
| Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica<br>(Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)                                           | 7,576  |
| Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida?<br>(Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)                                  | 10,706 |
| Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico<br>(Memo to an Inmate)                                     | 4,796  |
| El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A.<br>(A Member's-Eye View)                                        | 2,318  |
| Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander<br>(Jack Alexander Article)                                     | 2,873  |
| Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W.<br>(Three Talks to Medical Societies)                     | 4,481  |
| Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)                                                              | 14,497 |
| Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)                                                                 | 6,121  |
| Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)                                                         | 7,834  |
| Comprendiendo el Anonimato<br>(Understanding Anonymity)                                                 | 3,666  |
| El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)                                                                       | 7,903  |
| Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento<br>(Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)                | 12,885 |
| El Miembro de A.A. - Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas<br>(The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs) | 5,400  |
| Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas<br>(The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)                                  | 4,001  |
| A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento<br>(A.A. in Treatment Centers)                                           | 1,729  |
| Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)                                                              | 11,979 |
| La Tradición de A.A. - ¿Cómo se Desarrolló?<br>(A.A. Tradition - How It Developed)                      | 2,382  |
| Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)                                                           | 10,399 |
| A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales<br>(A.A. in Correctional Facilities)                           | 1,528  |

|                                                                                                               |                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol<br>(Problems Other Than Alcohol)                                             | 8,384          |
| Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda<br>(It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)                                  | 4,998          |
| ¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.?<br>(How A.A. Members Cooperate)                                          | 1,788          |
| Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)                                                                                  | 3,679          |
| A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud<br>(A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional) | 2,028          |
| Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A.<br>(The Clergy Asks)                                            | 989            |
| R.S.G. (G.S.R.)                                                                                               | 3,407          |
| ¿Se Cree Usted Diferente?<br>(Do You Think Your Different?)                                                   | 8,531          |
| Le Sucedió a Alicia<br>(It Happened to Alice)                                                                 | 5,916          |
| Hablando en Reuniones no-A.A.<br>Speaking at non-A.A. Meetings                                                | 2,262          |
| A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)                                                                       | 8,877          |
| Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A.<br>(A.A. Membership Survey)                                               | 1,329          |
| ¿Hay un alcohólico en el lugar de trabajo?<br>(Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)                       | 2,431          |
| Es A.A. Para Mi? (Is A.A. for Me?)                                                                            | 11,757         |
| A.A. para el alcohólico de edad avanzada<br>(A.A. for the older alcoholic)                                    | 3,481          |
| Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados<br>(The Twelve Steps Illustrated)                                                   | 6,180          |
| Círculos de Amor y Servicio<br>(Circles of Love & Service)                                                    | 4,815          |
| Uniendo las Orillas (Bridging the Gap)                                                                        | 2,087          |
| Los Doce Conceptos Ilustrados<br>(Twelve Concepts Illustrated)                                                | 2,332          |
| A.A. para los alcohólicos gays/lesbianas<br>(A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)                          | 2,441          |
| <b>Total</b>                                                                                                  | <b>344,731</b> |

### Diversos (Miscellaneous)

|                                                                 |                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Guías (Guidelines)                                              | 7,643          |
| Parchments, Spanish                                             | 439            |
| Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)                        | 12,463         |
| Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album)<br>(Big Book on cassette) | 492            |
| Los Doce Pasos (cassette album)<br>(Twelve Steps on cassette)   | 512            |
| <b>Total</b>                                                    | <b>21,549</b>  |
| <b>Grand Total</b>                                              | <b>483,752</b> |

## FRENCH

### Livres (Books)

|                                                                               |       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| Les Alcooliques Anonymes<br>(Alcoholics Anonymous - format relie)             | 5,241 |
| Les Alcooliques Anonymes<br>(Alcoholics Anonymous - format souple)            | 1,503 |
| Les Alcooliques Anonymes<br>(Alcoholics Anonymous - format poche)             | 617   |
| Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions<br>(Twelve & Twelve - format relie)  | 1,857 |
| Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions<br>(Twelve & Twelve - format souple) | 1,237 |
| Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions                                      |       |

|                                                             |               |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| (Twelve & Twelve – format poche)                            | 526           |
| Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte<br>(A.A. Comes of Age) | 445           |
| Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)                        | 2,628         |
| Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)                 | 5,637         |
| Dr Bob et les pionniers<br>(Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers) | 562           |
| <b>Total</b>                                                | <b>20,253</b> |

### Plaquettes (Booklets)

|                                                 |              |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Nous en sommes venus a croire (Came to Believe) | 1,750        |
| Vivre ... sans alcool! (Living Sober)           | 3,094        |
| Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts      | 1,264        |
| <b>Total</b>                                    | <b>6,108</b> |

### Brochures (Pamphlets)

|                                                                                                         |        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)                                                                           | 10,186 |
| Les A.A.: 44 Questions (44 Questions)                                                                   | 2,720  |
| Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)                                                        | 15,046 |
| Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)                                                             | 2,406  |
| Collaboration des membres des A.A.<br>(How A.A. Members Cooperate)                                      | 245    |
| Y a-t-il un Alcoolique dans Votre Milieu de travail?<br>(Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)       | 1046   |
| Le membre des A.A. face aux medicaments et a la drogue<br>(The A.A. Member – Medications & Other Drugs) | 2,102  |
| Les A.A. – Article du Saturday Evening Post<br>(The Jack Alexander Article)                             | 266    |
| Collaborons avec nos amis<br>(Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)                                       | 748    |
| Questions et reponses sur le parrainage<br>(Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)                       | 3,171  |
| Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les medecins<br>(A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)      | 1,662  |
| Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement<br>(A.A. in Treatment Facilities)                               | 238    |
| La Tradition des A.A. et son developpement<br>(A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)                         | 414    |
| Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme?<br>(If You Are a Professional)                                    | 1,185  |
| L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)                                                             | 1,277  |
| Jean face a son probleme d'alcool<br>(What Happened to Joe)                                             | 847    |
| Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)                                                     | 1,053  |
| Problemes autres que l'alcoolisme<br>(Problems Other Than Alcohol)                                      | 1,951  |
| Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A.<br>(A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)                                  | 540    |
| Les Douze Traditions illustrees<br>(The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)                                  | 1,233  |
| Les A.A. dans les etablissements correctionnels<br>(A.A. in Correctional Facilities)                    | 452    |
| Ca vaut mieux que de languir en prison<br>(It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)                             | 731    |
| Petit guide pratique sur les A.A.<br>(A Brief Guide to A.A.)                                            | 1,011  |
| Les membres du clerge se renseignent<br>(Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)                          | 376    |
| Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)                                                    | 995    |
| Message a l'intention d'un detenu<br>(Memo to an Inmate)                                                | 1,202  |
| Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels<br>(Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)         | 284    |
| Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)                                                                     | 2,829  |

|                                                                                            |               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Les Douze Concepts illustres<br>(Twelve Concepts Illustrated)                              | 1,599         |
| Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)                                            | 3,364         |
| Trois causeries a des societes medicales<br>(Three Talks to Medical Societies)             | 918           |
| Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie?<br>(Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)            | 2,040         |
| Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)                                                                     | 1,176         |
| Causeries a l'exterieur des A.A.<br>(Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)                        | 931           |
| Trop jeune? (Too Young?)                                                                   | 2,581         |
| La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)                                       | 944           |
| L'Heritage des Services des A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)                                | 155           |
| Cercles d'amour et de service (Circles of Love & Service)                                  | 1,475         |
| Vous croyez-vous different?<br>(Do You Think You're Different?)                            | 1,933         |
| Lettre a une femme alcoolique<br>(Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)                             | 1,240         |
| Sondage sur les membres des A.A.<br>(The A.A. Membership Survey)                           | 3,368         |
| Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)                                               | 1,784         |
| Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)                                                                 | 1,315         |
| AA pour l'alcoolique plus age (AA for the older alcoholic)                                 | 1,438         |
| Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)                                                   | 5,340         |
| Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)                                              | 1,998         |
| Favoriser de rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)                                              | 822           |
| Les Douze Etapes Illustrees (Twelve Steps Illustrated)                                     | 2,775         |
| Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques<br>(A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic) | 504           |
| Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amerique du Nord<br>(A.A. and the Native North American)     | 356           |
| Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)                                                       | 2,963         |
| <b>Total</b>                                                                               | <b>97,235</b> |

### Divers (Miscellaneous)

|                                                                         |                |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| 12 & 12 (cassette album)                                                | 47             |
| Le Gros Livre (cassettes album)                                         | 88             |
| Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions<br>(Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions) | 1,946          |
| Carte anonymat (Francais/anglais)<br>(Anonymity wallet card)            | 300            |
| Video Cassettes                                                         | 30             |
| Notre Methode (How It Works)                                            | 12,791         |
| Manuel de Groupe                                                        | 52             |
| Pochette de l'Information Publique                                      | 31             |
| Pochette des Centres de Detention                                       | 14             |
| Pochette de la CMP                                                      | 17             |
| Prière de la Sérénité (12x16) (Parchment Serenity Prayer)               | 33             |
| Pochette des Centres de Traitement                                      | 6              |
| Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (Fact File)                          | 280            |
| <b>Total</b>                                                            | <b>15,635</b>  |
| <b>Grand Total</b>                                                      | <b>139,231</b> |



## A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

**Directors' report:** One of the operating arms of the General Service Board, the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., publishes the A.A. Grapevine magazine, our monthly meeting in print. Beginning in July 2006, the magazine also became available as an audio download from our Web site, [www.aagrapevine.org](http://www.aagrapevine.org). Collections of Grapevine articles also appear in books, audio CDs, and online in the Digital Archive. In addition, A.A. Grapevine, Inc., publishes La Viña, the Spanish-language journal of Alcoholics Anonymous, and CDs and anthologies of La Viña stories, all of which are financed by the General Service Board as a service to the Fellowship.

The directors of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., have convened four times as a board since the 56th General Service Conference—three times during quarterly General Service Board weekends, and once to take formal action during a Planning Committee meeting in June. Two more board meetings will be held this week during the Conference. The Grapevine directors also met four times as a Planning Committee and held a joint dinner meeting with the Editorial Advisory Board, a group of A.A. members who are professionals from the publishing industry and who share their experience, insight, and perspective concerning the editorial content, graphics, and readership of the magazine and related items. The directors of A.A. Grapevine, Inc. review the corporation's finances and operations and take formal actions during quarterly board meetings; they discuss matters of broad policy and develop plans for the corporation's future at Planning Committee meetings.

**Board Structure** — There are nine directors on the Grapevine Corporate Board: two general service trustees, two regional trustees, one Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee; three nontrustee directors; and the executive editor. This year, the board forwarded the name of Dorothy Hurley as a general service trustee on the Grapevine Board to succeed Arnold Ross, who rotates after this Conference. Dorothy has served on the board as a nontrustee director since May 2004. Pacific regional trustee Madeleine Parmley has been nominated to replace Tom Kraemer, regional trustee from Western Canada, who rotates from the Grapevine Board after this Conference. The board also nominated two new nontrustee directors—Ginger Rhoades-Bell and Andrew Talbert—to replace nontrustee directors Dorothy Hurley and John Skilton, who has been nominated to serve as general service trustee on the A.A.W.S. Board. All nominations are subject to General Service Conference disapproval, if any.

It has been a productive year for the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and much has been accomplished thanks to the leadership of the seven committees that the chair appointed this year. The nominating committee was chaired by regional trustee Tom Kraemer. It facilitated the nomination of the board's incoming regional and general service trustees and agreed to support the board development committee's recommendation to change the rotation schedule of the AAGV Board chair. The finance and budget committee, chaired by the board's treasurer, nontrustee director John Skilton, reviewed and reported on the corporation's financial standing each quarter and worked with staff to draft the corporation's 2007 budgets. The La Viña committee, chaired by general service trustee Ray Massey, reviewed the history of La Viña funding; looked at various business models that might improve the

cost structure of La Viña; and recommended that La Viña's editorial advisory board be revived, which the board approved. The risk management committee, chaired by Class A trustee Herb Goodman, initiated the development of a plan for reacting to disasters and a senior staff succession plan, now in progress, and recommended that A.A. Grapevine's Corporate Board develop and adopt a compensation philosophy, which the board agreed to do. The committee also reviewed Grapevine copyright policies and procedures and recommended an annual review of the copyright status of Grapevine material, which the board approved. Chaired by nontrustee director Dorothy Hurley, the board development committee recommended a scope and responsibilities statement for the board's ad hoc committees, which the board approved; updated the directors' manual; and developed a one-day strategic planning session for the board, which was held on March 16. The circulation committee, chaired by nontrustee director James Branscome, oversaw formal surveys of current Grapevine subscribers and online surveys of AudioGrapevine subscribers and of visitors to the Grapevine Web site. The Internet committee, chaired by regional trustee Bob Mayer, discussed the launch of the AudioGrapevine and the security of online surveys. It also reviewed plans to develop the Web site in 2007, which include increasing its interactivity and updating the look of the home page to encourage greater use of such features as the story and jokes of the day, discussion topics, free audio, and the bulletin board.

**Grapevine Financial Report** — The Grapevine realized a loss of \$48,873 in the year ending December 31, 2006, versus a budgeted profit of \$19,879. Total Grapevine income, including cash flow and interest from the Reserve Fund, was \$1,587,176 or \$106,039 lower than budget and \$20,386 higher than last year.

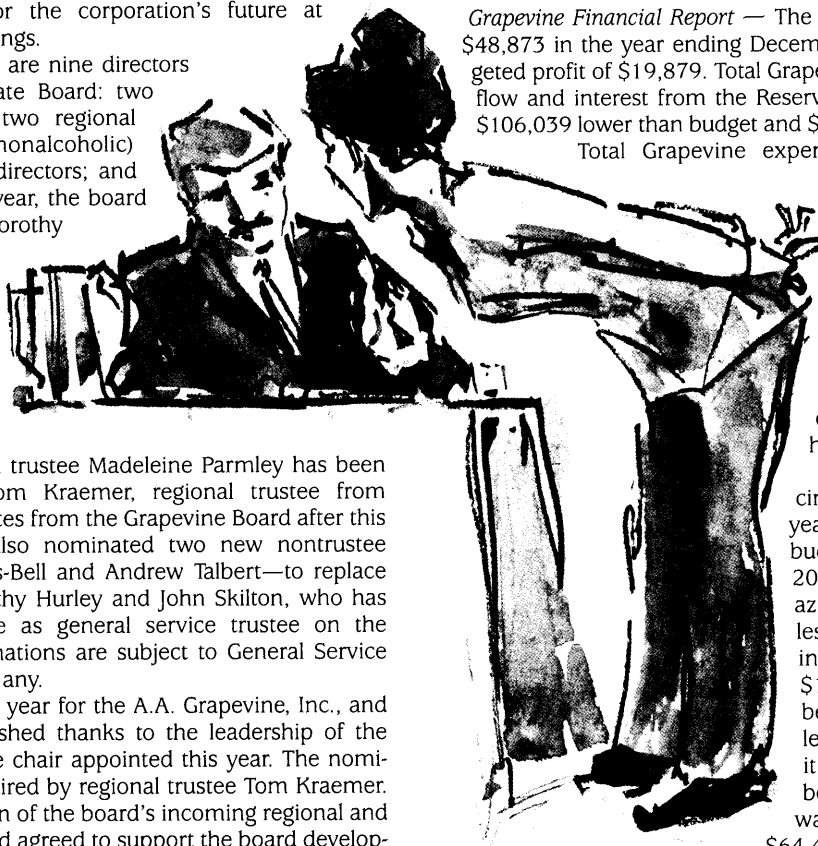
Total Grapevine expenses were \$1,636,049, or \$37,287 lower than budget.

These expenses included editorial costs, which were lower than budget by \$23,224; circulation and business expenses, which were \$43,329 lower than budget; and general and administrative expenses, which were \$29,267 higher than budget.

Average monthly magazine circulation was 103,878 for the year. This was 1,622 lower than budget and 478 lower than 2005. Gross profit on the magazine, which is total income less direct costs such as printing and postage, was \$1,151,365. This was \$52,306 behind budget and \$11,633 less than last year. Gross profit on related items, which are books, CDs, and other items, was \$367,639. This was \$64,405 lower than budget and

\$24,129 ahead of last year.

**La Viña Financial Report** — Bimonthly circulation averaged 10,223 for the year ending December 31, 2006. Magazine income was \$89,080, which was ahead of budget by \$7,782. Direct costs such as printing and mailing were \$68,620, which was \$2,857 over budget. Gross profit on the magazine, income less direct costs, was \$20,460. This is \$2,552 ahead of budget and \$16,549 ahead of the same period in 2005. Other publishing





income of \$27,739 was \$9,739 ahead of budget. Gross profit on LV items was \$20,787. This is \$6,635 ahead of budget. Total gross profit from the magazine and other items was \$41,247. Editorial, circulation and business, and general and administrative expenses were \$113,251. This was \$492 over budget. The net loss for La Viña for 2006 was \$72,004. This was lower than the budgeted loss of \$80,699 by \$8,695.

**Financial Management** — Management has taken steps designed to get the Grapevine back in the black by 2008. It has reduced office space by more than 20%, it is tightening control over warehousing and publishing schedules, and it continues to accomplish a great deal with a lean staff. In addition, with the board's help, the executive editor has developed a long-range business plan.

Developed to help the corporation fulfill its mission of "carrying the A.A. message to as many people as possible," the overarching goals of the business plan are two-fold: to expand circulation of the magazine in print and online, and to keep the corporation financially self-supporting. To achieve this, the corporation will explore the feasibility of publishing the magazine in new media, beginning with the AudioGrapevine; continue to keep operations and production cost-effective; maintain a systematic circulation program; and increase communication with the general service structure to expand awareness of the Grapevine's effectiveness.

Central to these efforts will be adopting a pricing policy that is in line with the Grapevine's mandate to be self-supporting, as described in its charter and Concept XI. The policy calls for timely increases in the prices of GV publications to cover increasing expenses, which in 2006 alone included a \$56,000 increase in pension-related expenses. In 2007, there will be a \$25,000 increase in the cost of mailing the magazine. In July, the Grapevine's subscription price will go up \$2 (an increase of 17 cents an issue). The last Grapevine price increase was five years ago. Fifty-packs will go up to \$40 (to 80 cents a copy). In the past, price increases have not always kept up with escalating expenses and because of that, the Grapevine has operated at a loss. Price increases are necessary because the Grapevine has no other source of revenue. Unlike most other magazines, it does not take advertising or membership fees. Nor does it accept contributions for operations. The Grapevine supports itself solely through the sales of subscriptions and Grapevine items. In instances where production costs decrease, the Grapevine will be able to decrease

prices. For example, in February 2007, the corporation was able to lower the annual subscription price for the AudioGrapevine to \$20, because production costs are lower than originally estimated.

As noted above, there has been extraordinary growth in La Viña this year—circulation climbed 11% and the momentum seems to be building. The increase in subscriptions helped lower the net loss by over 10% in 2006, and the 2007 price increase is expected to cover increased expenses totaling more than \$15,000. This is expected to keep the loss for 2007 level with that of 2006.

**Publishing Operations** — As the chief executive of the corporation, the executive editor defines the operational and editorial goals of the corporation and oversees their administration. The controller supervises accounting, customer service, and fulfillment and plays a key role in the financial management of the Grapevine. Publishing operations are carried out by the editorial, circulation, and Internet operations departments. Each has undertaken several important projects since the last Conference:

**Editorial and Internet Departments** — The Grapevine and La Viña editorial staff is responsible for producing our meetings in print, which are composed primarily of stories written by A.A. members. Our Spanish-language meeting in print is a lifeline to alcoholics, especially in areas and institutions where there are no or only a handful of Spanish-speaking meetings. La Viña also fosters unity: it assures recovering alcoholics that they are not alone; they are part of a worldwide community of Spanish-speaking A.A.s. In addition, La Viña offers readers a window on the rich history of A.A., and often acts as a gateway to service. With stories from Spanish-speaking A.A.s around the world, it assures readers that they have a voice in our Fellowship and makes it clear that in A.A., every voice matters.

The editorial staff also works on anthologies, like *Emotional Sobriety*, and supports the work of the Director of Internet Operations, who is responsible for updating the Web site and Digital Archive, overseeing production of CDs, and developing special projects, such as the AudioGrapevine, audiobooks, and the E-newsletter.

Highlights of this year's Grapevine magazine included: Interviews with A.A.s celebrating fifty or more years of sobriety; reports on ICYPAA and A.A. after Katrina; special sections on Working with Wet Drunks, Classic Cartoons and Jokes, and Letting Go of Resentments; the "New Name for Ham on Wry" contest; and the debut of the new department, "What's On Your Mind?"

Highlights for La Viña included special issues on: Women in A.A.; Young People; Newcomers; La Viña's 10th Anniversary, and Special reports on A.A. in Cuba and Peru.

New Publications: *Pasos 7-12*, La Viña's third CD; Two AudioCDs, remastered from tapes of Grapevine stories on the Traditions; *Emotional Sobriety* (which has sold 10,000 copies in its first 6 months); *The Home Group*, revised Spanish-language edition; *Best of Bill* audiobook, in English and Spanish; *The Language of the Heart*, large-print edition; *In Our Own Words: Stories of Young A.A.s in Recovery from the Grapevine*.

Web site Highlights: Launch of the AudioGrapevine — the MP3 version of the magazine; Redesign of "Heard It Through the Grapevine," the e-newsletter which goes to 19,300 members; switch from biweekly to daily postings of i-Say, where members discuss such topics as Twelfth Step work, sponsorship, and on occasion, Regional Forums; development of the GvR section of the Web.

*Circulation Department* — The executive editor hired a circulation manager in May, the first that the Grapevine has had in almost five years. Since then, the circulation manager has developed a thorough circulation program, which includes the tracking and analysis of circulation initiatives, a successful gift subscription program, carefully monitored renewals, and systematic announcements of new publications. The circulation and the office managers also are looking at ways to improve communication with, and support of, Grapevine and La Viña representatives. Moreover, the circulation manager has helped the Grapevine develop a fuller understanding of the current position of its circulation and readership, and the impact that rapidly changing information technology is having on the Grapevine and the publishing industry at large.

A formal survey of magazine subscribers and online surveys of AudioGrapevine subscribers and visitors to Grapevine Web site have been particularly illuminating, yielding important insights into the interests and concerns of readers and the demographics of the Grapevine's current audience.

*Sample findings of GV subscriber survey* — Grapevine subscribers are passionate about our meeting in print; 88 % said they were very satisfied with their subscriptions; 85 % called it an essential or valuable tool of their sobriety; the pass-along rate is four. So the GV reaches over half a million people a month; 43 % consider it a bargain; 74 % said that the availability of the DA and AudioGV would not affect their decision to renew; only 37.8 % said their home groups subscribed; 23.9 % said their groups had a GvR; 73 % are over 50 years old; 44 % have been sober for 18 years or more; 95 % are white.

*Sample findings of web visitor survey* — 83 % read the print magazine and 49 % subscribe; 3 % are under age 29; 49 % are over age 50.

*Sample findings of AudioGV subscriber survey* — 94 % said it was easy to use; while 6 % did not; 32 % listen to stories from their desktop; 41 % listen on an MP3 player like the iPod; 77 % also read the print edition.

One of the important things learned from these surveys is that for those who know about it, the Grapevine is an essential tool of recovery and long-term sobriety. However, it does not seem to be reaching newcomers or young A.A.s in print or online in sufficient numbers. So this year, the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., is making

reaching young people in A.A. and newcomers a priority. But we cannot do it alone. We need your help. We challenge you to make sure that A.A.'s magazines are an integral part of your area's service structure and readily available for the A.A. members doing Twelfth Step work in your area. Encourage committees to work together to bring our magazines and other items into hospitals, schools, and institutions. Challenge your GV/RLV Area Chairs or D.C.M.s to make sure every group has a Grapevine and La Viña subscription and, better yet, also a La Viña or Grapevine representative. Why? Because the international journal of Alcoholics Anonymous has a vital role to play in the Fellowship, offering hope to countless alcoholics and demonstrating to anyone, anywhere reaching out for help what an effective means of recovery A.A. is in the 21st century.

#### **AA Grapevine, Inc. Mission Statement**

The purpose of the Grapevine is to carry the AA message to as many people as possible, both inside and outside the Fellowship, through publication of its magazines and related items, which reflect the experience, strength, and hope of its members and friends on topics related to recovery, unity, and service. Further, our purpose is to provide such service in a manner consistent with the Twelve Traditions, and without soliciting monetary contributions from AA members or groups to fund operating expenses.

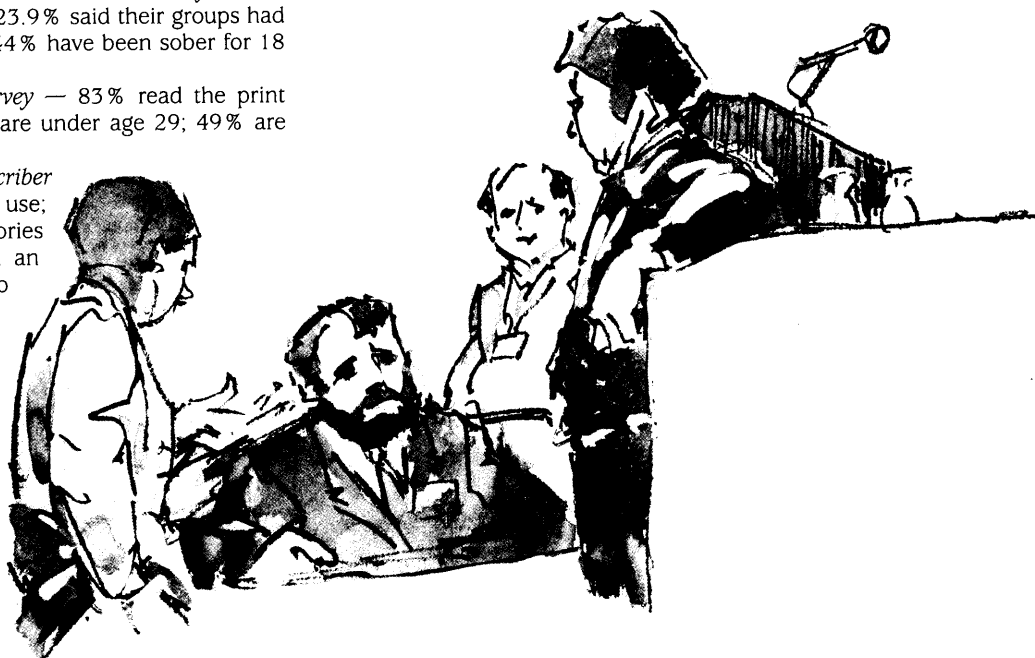
#### **The AA Grapevine, Inc. Corporate Board Mission Statement**

The purpose of the Grapevine Corporate Board, an affiliate service corporation of the General Service Board, is to serve the A.A. Fellowship in the following ways:

- To oversee the publishing operations of the AA Grapevine, Inc.
- To provide sound financial management of the Corporation
- To establish corporate policies and set corporate priorities
- To engage in the ongoing process of strategic planning
- To operate in accordance with the principles of AA as expressed in the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions and Twelve Concepts

*Adopted by the AAGV Corporate Board  
October 27, 2000, amended January 26, 2001*

*Arnold Ross, chairperson*



# AA Grapevine Literature Distributed — 2006

## ENGLISH

### Book Units

|                                              |               |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Best of Bill (hardcover)                     | 4,399         |
| Best of Bill (softcover)                     | 9,198         |
| Best of Bill/large print (softcover)         | 1,945         |
| Best of the Grapevine I (softcover)          | 1,636         |
| Best of the Grapevine II (softcover)         | 1,119         |
| The Language of the Heart (hardcover)        | 6,582         |
| The Home Group                               | 436           |
| Best of the Grapevine III (softcover)        | 1,164         |
| A.A. Around The World                        | 1,279         |
| The Language of the Heart (softcover)        | 3,150         |
| Thank You for Sharing                        | 1,683         |
| Spiritual Awakening                          | 6,566         |
| The Home Group (revised/softcover)           | 4,287         |
| I am Responsible: The hand of AA (softcover) | 3,467         |
| Emotional Sobriety (softcover)               | 9,974         |
| Loh/Big Book Pkg.                            | 1             |
| <b>Total:</b>                                | <b>59,752</b> |

### Cassette Tapes

|                                |              |
|--------------------------------|--------------|
| Classic Tapes #1               | 96           |
| Classic Tapes #2               | 63           |
| Classic Tapes #3               | 54           |
| Youth Enjoying Sobriety        | 89           |
| Old-Timers Corner              | 135          |
| Back to Basics, Vol. 1         | 124          |
| Back to Basics, Vol. 2         | 106          |
| Sponsorship, Vol. 1            | 92           |
| Sponsorship, Vol. 2            | 91           |
| History Lights the Way         | 103          |
| What We Were Like              | 93           |
| Not for Newcomers Only, Vol. 1 | 55           |
| Not for Newcomers Only, Vol. 2 | 46           |
| Attitudes                      | 173          |
| Character Defects              | 178          |
| Pathways to Spirituality       | 151          |
| Maintaining Spirituality       | 185          |
| Our Experience Has Taught Us   | 68           |
| Practice These Principles      | 119          |
| <b>Total:</b>                  | <b>2,021</b> |

### CDs

|                           |              |
|---------------------------|--------------|
| Pathways to Spirituality  | 1,035        |
| Classic Grapevine, Vol. 1 | 476          |
| Classic Grapevine, Vol. 2 | 371          |
| Classic Grapevine, Vol. 3 | 325          |
| Not for Newcomers Only    | 666          |
| Partners on the Journey   | 628          |
| Story of A.A.             | 1,377        |
| What It Was Like          | 1,271        |
| The Twelve Traditions     | 120          |
| It Works if We Work It    | 149          |
| <b>Total:</b>             | <b>6,418</b> |

### Miscellaneous

|                              |               |
|------------------------------|---------------|
| Facsimile of first Grapevine | 481           |
| AA Preamble                  | 1,722         |
| Grapevine Binder             | 508           |
| Man on the Bed               | 1,818         |
| Slogans                      | 1,596         |
| Serenity Prayer              | 4,208         |
| Victor E. Poster             | 236           |
| Wall Calendar                | 9,300         |
| Pocket Planner               | 12,690        |
| Grapevine Workbook           | 287           |
| Co-Founder's Memorial Issue  | 2,731         |
| Traditions Checklist         | 619           |
| AA Grapevine Index           | -             |
| <b>Total:</b>                | <b>36,196</b> |

## SPANISH

|                                                 |               |
|-------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| El Lenguaje del Corazón (Language of the Heart) | 3,277         |
| Lo Mejor de Bill (The Best of Bill)             | 4,901         |
| Sonidos de Sobriedad                            | 7             |
| Historia de La Viña/CD                          | 746           |
| Historia de La Viña Vol. II/CD                  | 974           |
| Historia de La Viña Vol. III/CD                 | 1,004         |
| Victor E. Poster - Spanish                      | 124           |
| Preámbulo (Preamble)                            | 335           |
| Lemas (Slogans)                                 | 295           |
| La Oración de la Serenidad (Serenity Prayer)    | 1,550         |
| Tradiciones (Traditions Checklist)              | 1,494         |
| <b>Total:</b>                                   | <b>14,707</b> |

## FRENCH

|                                                  |              |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Best of Bill - French (Softcover)                | 2,109        |
| Le langage du cœur                               | 704          |
| The Home Group - French                          | 221          |
| Les Sons de la Sobriété (Sounds of Sobriety) 100 |              |
| Slogans - French                                 | 235          |
| Victor E. Poster - (French)                      | 7            |
| <b>Total:</b>                                    | <b>2,476</b> |

**Grand Total:** 121,570

## GRAPEVINE SUBSCRIPTIONS\* — GEOGRAPHICAL BREAKDOWN

|                                        | APRIL 2007    | APRIL 2006    | INCREASE/<br>DECREASE |
|----------------------------------------|---------------|---------------|-----------------------|
| <b>UNITED STATES*</b>                  |               |               |                       |
| Alabama                                | 992           | 935           | 57                    |
| Alaska                                 | 545           | 538           | 7                     |
| Arizona                                | 1,837         | 1,778         | 59                    |
| Arkansas                               | 616           | 552           | 64                    |
| California                             | 9,066         | 8,958         | 108                   |
| Colorado                               | 1,703         | 1,718         | -15                   |
| Connecticut                            | 1,526         | 1,557         | -31                   |
| Delaware                               | 428           | 449           | -21                   |
| District of Columbia                   | 186           | 201           | -15                   |
| Florida                                | 5,420         | 5,132         | 288                   |
| Georgia                                | 2,422         | 2,242         | 180                   |
| Hawaii                                 | 503           | 494           | 9                     |
| Idaho                                  | 609           | 593           | 16                    |
| Illinois                               | 3,747         | 3,650         | 97                    |
| Indiana                                | 1,439         | 1,440         | -1                    |
| Iowa                                   | 1,117         | 1,217         | -100                  |
| Kansas                                 | 1,113         | 1,122         | -9                    |
| Kentucky                               | 880           | 884           | -4                    |
| Louisiana                              | 737           | 709           | 28                    |
| Maine                                  | 664           | 666           | -2                    |
| Maryland                               | 1,450         | 1,473         | -23                   |
| Massachusetts                          | 2,625         | 2,711         | -86                   |
| Michigan                               | 3,380         | 3,257         | 123                   |
| Minnesota                              | 2,611         | 2,565         | 46                    |
| Mississippi                            | 510           | 491           | 19                    |
| Missouri                               | 1,573         | 1,549         | 24                    |
| Montana                                | 595           | 591           | 4                     |
| Nebraska                               | 915           | 904           | 11                    |
| Nevada                                 | 694           | 730           | -36                   |
| New Hampshire                          | 802           | 785           | 17                    |
| New Jersey                             | 2,740         | 2,727         | 13                    |
| New Mexico                             | 679           | 656           | 23                    |
| New York                               | 5,798         | 5,987         | -189                  |
| North Carolina                         | 2,245         | 2,177         | 68                    |
| North Dakota                           | 364           | 340           | 24                    |
| Ohio                                   | 2,766         | 2,684         | 82                    |
| Oklahoma                               | 892           | 826           | 66                    |
| Oregon                                 | 1,499         | 1,431         | 68                    |
| Pennsylvania                           | 4,959         | 4,766         | 193                   |
| Rhode Island                           | 378           | 351           | 27                    |
| South Carolina                         | 1,013         | 966           | 47                    |
| South Dakota                           | 387           | 366           | 21                    |
| Tennessee                              | 1,282         | 1,150         | 132                   |
| Texas                                  | 4,250         | 4,128         | 122                   |
| Utah                                   | 577           | 523           | 54                    |
| Vermont                                | 374           | 389           | -15                   |
| Virginia                               | 2,170         | 2,100         | 70                    |
| Washington                             | 2,866         | 2,902         | -36                   |
| West Virginia                          | 526           | 491           | 35                    |
| Wisconsin                              | 2,529         | 2,406         | 123                   |
| Wyoming                                | 329           | 312           | 17                    |
| Puerto Rico                            | 31            | 30            | 1                     |
| U.S. Possessions/APO                   | 119           | 122           | -3                    |
| Virgin Islands                         | 52            | 46            | 6                     |
| <b>Subtotal U.S.</b>                   | <b>89,530</b> | <b>87,767</b> | <b>1,763</b>          |
| <b>CANADA</b>                          |               |               |                       |
| Alberta/NWT                            | 851           | 754           | 97                    |
| British Columbia/Ykn                   | 984           | 1,019         | -35                   |
| Manitoba                               | 414           | 405           | 9                     |
| New Brunswick/<br>Prince Edward Island | 248           | 249           | -1                    |
| Nova Scotia/<br>New Foundland/Labrador | 378           | 384           | -6                    |
| Ontario                                | 2,976         | 2,844         | 132                   |
| Quebec                                 | 256           | 266           | -10                   |
| Saskatchewan                           | 367           | 370           | -3                    |
| <b>Subtotal Canada</b>                 | <b>6,474</b>  | <b>6,291</b>  | <b>183</b>            |
| <b>FOREIGN</b>                         |               |               |                       |
|                                        | 1,223         | 1,287         | -64                   |
| <b>Grand Total*</b>                    | <b>97,227</b> | <b>95,345</b> | <b>1,882</b>          |

### LA VIÑA SUBSCRIPTIONS\*

| Mar./Apr. 07 | Mar./Apr. 06 |
|--------------|--------------|
| 7,791        | 6,669        |

(\*does not include monthly orders)



# Trustees' Committees and G.S.O. Reports and Grapevine Reports

## ARCHIVES

**Trustees' report:** It has been a busy and productive year, as the committee continued its mission of supporting the work of the G.S.O. Archives to both preserve and provide access to archival material. We initiated a variety of significant endeavors, addressing important policy issues and the preservation of archives through several distinct projects.

The committee reviewed the continuing project to digitize and catalog the audio and film recordings in the archives. More than 4,000 recordings have now been digitized, preserving them for the future. Having these wonderful recordings digitized has raised the obvious question of making them accessible to the Fellowship. The G.S.O. Archives had never before had a policy for the distribution of its audio and film recordings, but now that so much of this material is available digitally, it was clear that a policy was badly needed. The subcommittee on Archives Recordings attempted to reconcile two diametrically opposed concepts: the deep philosophical view that A.A. members should have access to the newly digitized audio and film recordings in the archives, versus the legal reality that providing unfettered access to all this material would constitute a grave infringement of copyright law.

The subcommittee studied pages and pages of legal opinions and other background, and developed recommendations and policies that were approved by the full committee. Hopefully these will provide a solid initial step—permitting archival recordings to be accessible to the Fellowship, as appropriate, without violating copyright laws. The 2007 Conference Committee on Archives will be providing its views and guidance with regard to these new policies. The committee also approved the installation of a new digital listening station, so that visitors to the General Service Office can listen to excerpts of the audio recordings and experience the wonder of hearing the words of our early pioneers in crisp, clear digital audio.

We adopted a new "Collection Policy" for the G.S.O. Archives, specifying in detail the kinds of material the Archives collects for its permanent archives, what it does not collect, and why. It is hoped that these policies will help to clarify and strengthen the cooperative relationship between the General Service Office Archives and the area, district, and intergroup/central office archives that do so much of the fine work of collecting A.A.'s history and archives throughout the U.S. and Canada. Archival collections from areas, with any kind of local focus, should ideally be collected by these area archives rather than G.S.O., to enhance their collections and spread the wealth of archival material beyond the walls of the General Service Office, and keep this material closer to home, where it will be most relevant.

The committee also approved several changes and updates to

the Archives Workbook, the Statements of Policy, and the Mission and Purpose Statement, and approved a new service piece, the "Oral Histories Kit," which offers detailed instructions for interviewing long-timers. We also continued gathering information regarding security procedures in the Archives, and approved a disaster response plan, to safeguard the treasures of A.A.'s history.

*Herb Goodman, chairperson*

**Archivist's report:** The G.S.O. Archives has a twofold responsibility: to *preserve* the official record permanently so that there can be no distortion of A.A.'s history; and to *provide* service to those who are interested in learning more about A.A.'s historical legacy, as well as to archivists within the Fellowship. Each of these is equally important.

In 2006 we responded to more than 1,500 individual requests for research and information, an average of about six per day. These requests come from all over the world, and we answer questions using our primary sources. Depending on the complexity of the question, a request may take 15 minutes or more than 20 hours to research. We feel strongly that these requests are an essential means of carrying the message of Alcoholics Anonymous through its founding vision and principles.

We corresponded with many archivists in the Fellowship and offered assistance and support whenever possible. These dynamic and active archives, at the level of the area, district, group, and central intergroup offices, represent an extraordinary movement-within-a-movement. The work they are doing is exciting and creative, and it's a pleasure to work with them and learn from them.

The new service piece, the "Oral Histories Kit," is intended to offer guidance for A.A.s wishing to record interviews with significant and long-time members. These oral histories sometimes offer the only way to capture A.A.'s history and memories. Bill wrote about his desire to capture oral histories in a letter in 1954: *"If this isn't done I fear the very earliest days will be pretty much lost from view. While, of course, it is possible to make a time table or a fact sheet of events, it would be impossible to recapture the spirit and color of old times unless we complete this job."*

We have many oral histories in the Archives that have been collected over the years, and we have just reinstated the project to try to record more interviews with figures significant to the history of A.A. at the national and international level.

We published three issues of *Markings*, the Archives newsletter, in 2006. Articles in the newsletter included historical topics like A.A.'s very early history and the "rocky road" to the General Service Conference, as well as a two-part piece on preserving photographic media. We published several pieces submitted by members, and hope to increase this in the future so that *Markings*





### COMPENSATION COMMITTEE

can truly become an “archives interchange” for the Fellowship, as it was envisioned to be.

We looked at ways to increase security and preservation in the Archives, both through facilities improvements and added security measures. A disaster plan was developed and adopted, providing instructions for responding to a water leak, fire, mold outbreak, or other emergency in the Archives.

Several new rotating exhibits were mounted in the Archives in 2006, including highlights of our women leaders: Henrietta Seiberling, Lois W., and Sister Ignatia. We also created an exhibit showcasing the long history of the International Convention of Young People in A.A. (ICYPAA). We plan to rotate the displays on a regular basis so the material will stay fresh and exciting.

A new traveling exhibit was created, which can be requested by areas hosting conventions or other events. The large, full-color exhibit offers an attractive introduction to A.A. history.

We wish to express our grateful appreciation to those who have donated material to the Archives this year. We received many wonderfully rich collections, including the archives of ICYPAA; tremendous and unique sound recordings; early pamphlets, correspondence, and books relating to the Alcoholic Foundation in its first decades; and more.

*Amy Filiatreau, archivist*

### AUDIT COMMITTEE

**Trustees’ report:** The trustees’ Audit Committee, formed in 2003 by the General Service Board, consists of four trustees in addition to the board treasurer, who chairs the committee. The committee was created to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance.

The committee meets with the outside auditor and G.S.O. and Grapevine management; separately with the auditor; and in executive session without the auditor.

The Audit Committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews such items as audit process, audit results, internal controls, best accounting practices, and management integrity.

*Vince Keefe, treasurer*

**Trustees’ report:** The trustees’ Compensation Committee, formed in 2006 by the General Service Board, consists of five trustees. The committee was created to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance.

The committee meets with the outside compensation consultants and G.S.O. and Grapevine management. The committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews and advises A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. on such items as overall compensation philosophies and policies, annual salary increase process, best compensation practices, and executive compensation.

*Herb Goodman, chairperson*

### CONFERENCE

**Trustees’ report:** The committee met three times since the 2006 General Service Conference, and we reviewed the Advisory Actions pertaining to the Conference, including the theme chosen for the 57th General Service Conference, “Our 12th Step Responsibility—Are We Going to Any Length?” We also discussed summaries of the Evaluation Questionnaires and of a Post-Conference Sharing Session.

The committee approved the updated 2007 Conference week schedule, including presentation topics approved by the 2006 Conference. Noting the impact of the Archives presentation at last year’s Conference, the committee included an Archives presentation/discussion on the Monday of Conference week. We also approved the workshop questions for distribution in the Communications Kit that was mailed in December. In addition, we reviewed the list of suggestions for the theme, presentations and workshop topics for the 2008 Conference.

The committee reviewed a list of topics submitted to the Conference assignment for consideration as agenda items in 2007. Forty-one items were forwarded to trustees’ and Conference committees, or to the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Corporate Boards.

We considered the request from the trustees’ Committee on Public Information to consider including a presentation on the A.A. Membership Survey during Conference week and took no action. The committee noted that having a presentation on the rel-

evance and process of the survey in the years in which the survey is scheduled would be in conflict with the long-standing custom of not having a presentation at the Conference on a topic that is on the agenda of a Conference committee. They agreed that having survey information for area delegates at the Conference would be helpful, if conducting the survey is approved. They also suggested that the trustees' Committee on P.I. find a way to communicate this information to delegates on site, should conduction of the survey be sanctioned by the Conference.

The committee discussed a proposal regarding the process for review and approval of Conference literature. The proposal deals with the dissemination of background material, the editing and production procedure, and the voting process for approval of a Conference committee's recommendation. After extensive discussion, the committee requested that sharing be gathered from other trustees' committees about the practicality and usefulness of the proposal, and its potential impact upon their work.

We reviewed information on the Conference Evaluation Questionnaire, and considered removing the question about participation in the Conference by classification, and agreed to gather sharing from the 2007 Conference Agenda Committee.

The idea of a secure electronic dashboard for Conference members was examined, and the committee acknowledged that this communication method will probably be useful in the future and requested further development.

We reviewed a revised version of a service piece directed to Conference members on "trust" and the Conference Committee process. It was agreed that this service piece should be distributed in the Conference Communications Kit and in the Conference Manual.

*Tom Kraemer, chairperson*

**Staff report:** The Conference coordinator is the G.S.O. contact for General Service Conference members. The Conference process continues throughout the year and the coordinator corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates, who cooperate to make the annual Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. The coordinator is also the contact for area and district committee members, as well as past delegates, in the 93 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

The annual meeting of the General Service Conference, which first met in July 1955, is the closest thing A.A. has to a group conscience in the U.S. and Canada. A.A. members are encouraged to submit topics through their area structures for consideration by the Conference. Suggested topics may be forwarded to a trustees' committee for consideration and, where appropriate, referred directly to a Conference committee. Occasionally, topics are submitted that are more appropriately under the purview of either the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Boards. These items are accordingly forwarded to those boards for their attention. The Conference coordinator is responsible for:

- Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are reviewed by the Conference Agenda Committee, which makes selections that are recommended to the Conference for approval.
- Working with the G.S.O. staff and general manager on planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and other information for the Conference Manual; and, with the guidance of the Publications Department, the Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.

*Rick Walker*

## COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY/TREATMENT FACILITIES

**Trustees' reports:** The trustees' Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community and Treatment Facilities were combined by action of the General Service Board in April 1998. Since the 2006 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities has met three times.

*Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.)* — A primary committee focus is assisting local C.P.C. committees to provide A.A. information to professionals who, through their work, may come in contact with the still-suffering alcoholic.

The committee reviewed four sample C.P.C. presentations for possible inclusion in the C.P.C. Kit and a subcommittee continues to review and edit presentations. The full committee will review any presentations to be included in the C.P.C. Kit.

We agreed to forward to the 2006 Conference C.P.C. Committee the agenda item "Discuss the need for three short video segments that could be accessed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and directed to professionals in the employment/human relations, legal/criminal justice, and medical fields, with a total cost not to exceed \$60,000."

We began discussion on how A.A. may be able to reach professionals in newly emerging professional settings, such as at Drug, Mental Health, Family, Re-entry and Other Specialty Courts. Committee members noted that there might also be C.P.C. opportunities at law enforcement professional schools and academies. Collected shared experience will be kept on file to be distributed to committees, upon request, and may provide topics for potential *Box 4-5-9* articles. We also discussed how A.A. might better reach professionals who come in contact with alcoholics. Suggestions included utilizing PowerPoint presentations and demonstrating G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

We reviewed the 2006 list of 62 exhibits at national professional conferences, as well as the exhibit evaluations. Offers to exhibit at professional conferences are considered based on expanding the range of professions and on new geographical locations. The committee noted the need to exhibit at more events attended by African-American clergy.

Staff shared experience that the current C.P.C. display used at exhibits did not clearly indicate that the information available was geared toward helping professionals in their work with alcoholics, and recommended to the General Service Board that new tabletop exhibit artwork be purchased to clearly indicate that the information available at the A.A. exhibit booth is geared toward helping professionals in their work with alcoholics.

*Treatment Facilities* — The committee's interest in treatment facilities, rehabilitation centers and similar centers is reflected through local A.A. committees on Treatment Facilities, Hospitals & Institutions (H&I) and Bridging the Gap (BTG). Shared experience about this facet of Twelfth Step work is conveyed in literature, by written communications, and by articles in *Box 4-5-9*. The committee considers the need for changes in related literature and service material, such as the Treatment Facilities Workbook and Kit.

In response to a request from the 2006 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities, the committee gathered sharing from the Fellowship regarding use of the video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* by those A.A. members carrying the message into treatment facilities and other noncorrectional environments. The report of collected shared experience has been forwarded to the 2007 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities.

The committee reviewed a request for sharing from the A.A.W.S. Board regarding a 2006 Conference Committee on

Treatment Facilities additional consideration to develop a pilot electronic bulletin board on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site for those bringing the A.A. message to treatment facilities and other non-correctional environments, and agreed to encourage A.A.W.S. to pursue development of such a pilot project. The A.A.W.S. Board subsequently decided not to consider this project at this time.

A proposal for an e-mail delivered newsletter for Treatment Facilities Committee Area chairs will be discussed by the committee at their July 29, 2007 meeting, at which time the committee secretary will provide additional background.

Allen Ault, chairperson



#### Staff reports:

*Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.)* — Experience indicates that many professionals are aware of A.A., yet few know what A.A. is or what we do, and fewer have been to an "open" A.A. meeting. The staff member on the C.P.C. assignment, along with a capable assistant, provides information about A.A. and facilitates communication with those outside A.A. who may have direct contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their professional work.

The C.P.C. desk responds daily to inquiries from professionals. In 2006, 622 professional requests for information on A.A. were associated with visits to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. Other requests arrived by letter, e-mail, fax and phone. Many of these professionals were put in touch with local C.P.C. committees who responded with offers for direct contact, information about how to send clients to meetings, offers of literature, or other means to assure that A.A. is a resource for professionals.

Another way that we endeavor to see that professionals are aware of the long-range help offered by A.A. include the newsletter for professionals, *About A.A.* Two issues of *About A.A.* were published in 2006. The spring issue reported on a national Employee Assistance Program (EAP) Professionals Day of Sharing at G.S.O. The fall issue focused on making A.A. accessible to alcoholics with special needs. More than 16,000 professionals receive *About A.A.*

Professional exhibits continue to result in requests for additional A.A. information, as well as personal contacts with local committee members. The C.P.C. assignment arranged for displays at 62 national or international conferences of professionals in 2006. At these exhibits, G.S.O. provides the booth space and literature; local C.P.C. committees coordinate A.A. volunteers who staff the booth to answer questions and provide literature and contacts. In addition, 52 local exhibits were referred to area C.P.C. committees.

The C.P.C. desk is a resource for C.P.C. chairs throughout the U.S. and Canada. New chairpersons at the area and district levels are sent welcome letters and applicable C.P.C. background material. Upon request, we assist C.P.C. committees by sharing C.P.C. experience. And they are encouraged to send minutes and to share their experiences for possible inclusion in *Box 4-5-9* articles. Articles were published in *Box 4-5-9* about local C.P.C. activities throughout the year. This created interest in C.P.C. service work with courts, clergy, doctors, medical students, educators and other professionals.

The C.P.C. staff member greets students from Cornell

University Medical Center who visit G.S.O. throughout the year. These future physicians are helped to see that A.A. can be a valuable resource when they encounter the still-suffering alcoholic. The students are provided with literature, given a brief introduction to the A.A. program, a tour of G.S.O. and encouraged to attend open A.A. meetings.

The staff member on C.P.C. also serves informally as a liaison representative to several national meetings, such as the National Institute for Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (N.I.A.A.A.) and Recovery Month planning meetings.

Irene Kontje

*Treatment Facilities* — The primary purpose of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to share experience and information with committees that carry the A.A. message into a variety of treatment settings. The General Service Office lists 87 Area Treatment Facilities (T.F.) committee chairpersons, plus 396 district and other T.F. chairpersons, as well as 26 Area Bridging the Gap (BTG) and 19 Area Hospitals and Institutions (H&I) committee chairpersons; 137 BTG and H&I district and other chairpersons are also listed. The total list comprises 665 T.F.-related trusted servants. Each is involved in one or more facets of providing A.A. meetings and/or information in treatment settings.

Highlights of quarterly meetings of the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities are sent to members of the Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community, Corrections, Public Information and Treatment Facilities Committees. Periodically, we share highlights from the trustees' meetings and activities from the T.F. staff assignment with area, district and other T.F. chairs, for the benefit of the committees they chair. In addition, we are always grateful for local T.F. experience that may be included in an activity report or in a *Box 4-5-9* article.

Each committee chair is sent a welcome letter along with the Treatment Facilities Kit and/or Workbook, A.A. Guidelines and related material. These trusted servants receive *Box 4-5-9* and *About A.A.* to share with their committee. Area T.F. chairs also receive an up-to-date, confidential list of all Area T.F. committee chairs so that they can share experiences and activities. Correspondence, including requests for sharing and for G.S.O.'s collected experience, is always welcomed from local committees. Some committees are invigorated through cooperation with professional staff in local facilities, often learning better ways to



approach clients within the regulations established by the facility.

The T.F. staff member also receives correspondence from clients or patients in treatment centers. Each request receives a response from the staff member along with A.A. literature. Some of these patients submit a request for help and are referred to local committees so that local committee members have the opportunity to extend the hand of A.A. Requests from professionals in treatment centers are given careful attention. Each professional is sent literature, and in most cases a contact with members of the local Treatment Facilities or C.P.C. Committee is arranged.

The staff member on this assignment also serves as secretary to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities, and as co-secretary to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities.

Mary Clare Lynch

## CORRECTIONS

**Trustees' report:** The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Corrections is to recommend to the General Service Board actions that support carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Since the 2006 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Corrections has met three times.

At the recommendation of the 2006 Conference: a subcommittee was appointed to work with the Publications director and staff to develop an "informational media presentation featuring someone highly credible in the corrections field introducing A.A. to training academies and in-service training programs for corrections personnel." The committee reviewed a draft media presentation and recommended that it be forwarded *only* to the members of the 2007 Conference Committee on Corrections prior to the 2007 General Service Conference for review and consideration.

The committee reviewed the content in the service pieces "The A.A. Prerelease Contact Program" (for the outsider) and "The A.A. Prerelease Contact Program" (for the inmate), and then reviewed revised drafts of these service pieces prepared by the Publications department and suggested that the revised service pieces replace the existing ones.

We discussed changing the word "prerelease" to "reentry" in all A.A. service material. The committee agreed that, as an alternative, the staff add appropriate reference to "reentry" *only* in the

letters to corrections professionals sent in the biennial mailing.

A possible "Day of Sharing" was discussed and we took no action. We discussed a trustee suggestion to present information about A.A. at national level corrections conferences and other relevant venues and took no action. The need for a possible "Letter of Credential" was discussed and no action was taken.

We also reviewed the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure on July 29, 2006 and made no changes.

Chuck Barta, chairperson

**Staff report:** The Corrections assignment is responsible for helping A.A. members and local committees carry the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Nearly 600 letters a month arrive from inmates, most requesting free literature, many asking to participate in our Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.) or for help in making contact with A.A. upon their release. We try to facilitate these requests, primarily through our network of area, district and local Corrections committees. The newsletter, *Sharing From Behind the Walls*, containing excerpts of sharing from inmate letters sent to G.S.O., is also a responsibility of this assignment.

The Corrections Correspondence Service, coordinated by this desk, continues to be one of our most valuable efforts. Many inmates are looking to turn their lives around and crave outside support from A.A.s with whom they can share experience, strength and hope. There is an ongoing need for "outside" A.A. members, particularly men, to participate in this service. Yet whenever a G.S.O. staff member attending an assembly, convention, conference or other Fellowship function mentions the tremendous need for C.C.S. volunteers and provides a supply of the service piece *Corrections Correspondence — a Special Kind of A.A. Service* (F-26), there is a substantial increase in the number of A.A.s wishing to correspond with those on the inside. Additionally, a letter explaining the Corrections Correspondence Service is sent twice a year to delegates and corrections chairpersons asking for A.A. volunteers to write to inmates on an individual basis. The Grapevine printed a service opportunity alert telling A.A.s of the need for letter writers three times this year. The C.C.S. serves both Canada and the United States.

The staff member sends an alternate year informational letter to wardens and corrections professionals throughout the U.S. and Canada, enclosing a return postcard for those professionals requesting additional information or contact with a local A.A. Corrections committee. The mailing contains: information that A.A. pamphlets and books are available in languages other than English, a copy of the current special A.A. Grapevine issue that is bound specifically for correctional settings, and language about A.A. that is particularly pertinent to selective correctional settings. The same issue of the A.A. Grapevine is also sent to all inmates who contact the office requesting prerelease assistance.

One of the most important duties of the assignment is communicating with area and district Corrections, Hospitals and Institutions and Bridging the Gap Committees. Three or four times a year, an activity report goes to each of these committee chairs. This year, these chairs helped the trustees by offering local sharing regarding distribution of literature in correctional settings and suggestions about the prerelease service pieces.

Following the three trustees' Corrections Committee meeting, a report of the meeting highlights is mailed to delegates on the Corrections, Treatment Facilities, Cooperation With the Professional Community and Public Information committees.

New Corrections chairs are welcomed with a Corrections Kit and Workbook to help them in their service.

A frequent question asked by A.A. members involved in corrections service is how to get their fellow members on the "outside" to commit to speaking or sponsoring a meeting in a correctional facility. The fear of not having the inmate identify with an A.A. member who has not been to prison, and the amount of time institutions require for orientation seminars to qualify to go into correctional facilities, are commonly pointed out as impediments to Fellowship participation. *Carrying the Message Behind These Walls*, a video created to encourage A.A. members to participate in corrections service, addresses many of the concerns that may hold members back from this rewarding Twelfth Step work.

Mary Dargan

## FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

**Trustees' report:** At last year's Conference we reviewed the proposed budget for 2006 and reported that the G.S.O. expected a profit from operations of approximately \$656,000, which after Conference actions resulting in midyear budget adjustments, was reduced to \$475,000. Actual results for 2006 were actually close to the original budget, in fact a net profit of \$657,900. While expenses for the year were within \$11,000 (one-tenth of one percent) of budget, total revenue was approximately \$194,000 better than expected thanks to contributions. At the end of 2006, the Reserve Fund balance represented approximately 8.5 months of operating expenses.

**General Service Office** — As you know, our revenue essentially comes from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions. We should all be encouraged that contributions in 2006 were again higher than the previous year, in this case by about \$650,000 (12%). This represents the ninth year in a row that contributions have increased over the previous year and continues to reflect a positive trend. Contributions of \$5,922,000 received from groups and members were \$517,000, or 10%, greater than budgeted, and \$640,000 (12%) more than in 2005. The \$5,922,000 in contributions came from 26,622 groups, individuals, and service entities. That, for comparison, represents 45.5% of the 58,539 groups registered with G.S.O., an increase of 2.3 percentage points from the 43.2% last year.

Beginning in 2002, we were obliged to record funds received on behalf of the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund as Contributions to G.S.O. Total contributions of \$6,068,000, reflected in our 2006 financial statements, include approximately \$145,000 received to help carry the message around the world from those participating countries. The comparable comparisons for prior years were: 2005, \$135,000; 2004, \$128,357; 2003, \$102,900; and 2002, \$108,000. While total contribution dollars were higher again this year, and the number of groups listed at G.S.O. was also slightly higher, the good news was that the percent of groups contributing has increased slightly as well. It is important to remember that the statistics we discuss concerning number of groups, membership and averages are only a reflection of the information we capture on "our systems." We report to you what you report to us.

Turning to the other major component of our income, net sales of literature were \$11,681,000, which was \$622,000 (5%) less than budgeted, and just about \$80,000 higher than 2005. During 2006, with the exception of the Big Book, units of books sold generally declined from 2005. (During 2006, the total number of Big Books sold was approximately 92,000 (3.7%) more than in 2005.) We believe that this

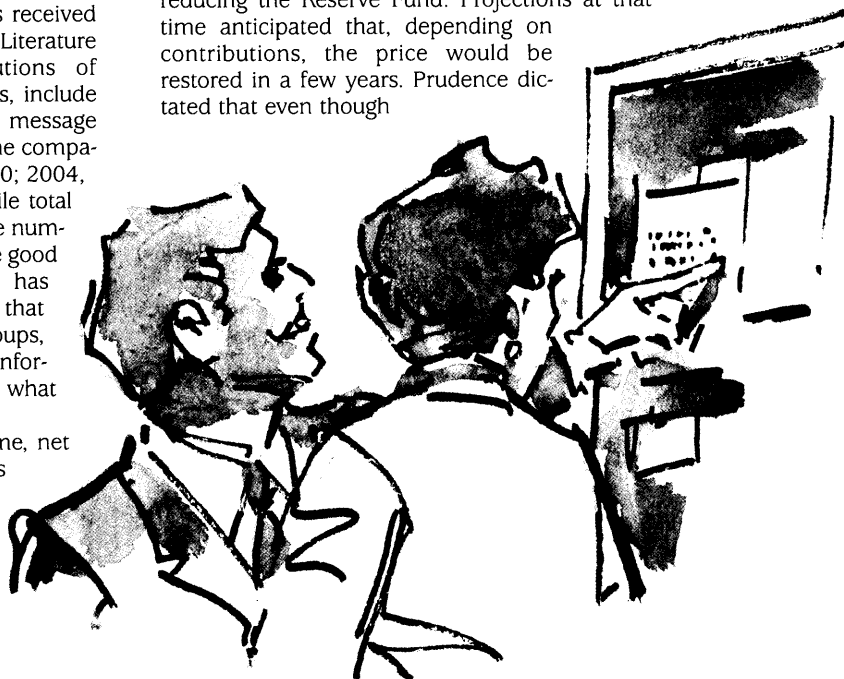
reflects the combined effect of buying and leveling off resulting from the midyear price adjustments of different titles two years in a row. In total, printing and other manufacturing costs, shipping expenses and royalty payments were less than budgeted by a considerable margin. This is a result of lower than expected sales as well as a residual effect of efforts to reduce print costs. Gross profit of \$6,875,200 was \$360,000 less than budgeted.

The combination of contributions and net literature sales resulted in total G.S.O. revenue of \$12,952,200, some \$194,000 greater than originally budgeted. Total operating expenses for G.S.O. during 2006 were \$12,294,300, approximately \$11,000 more than budget.

When compared to budget, the increased revenues offset by the slight increase in expenses resulted in a 2006 operating profit of \$657,900. The profit was about even with the original budget and \$183,000 more than the adjusted budget.

**Historical Reference for Price Adjustments** — In 1994, G.S.O. lowered prices and increased discounts on literature. These changes were undertaken to lower the Reserve Fund, which was at that time approaching the upper limit established by the General Service Conference of 12 months of combined operating expenses. In subsequent years, it became necessary to restore the revenue stream by pricing adjustments. At December 2006, the calculation produces about 8.5 months of operating expenses. The adjusted balance used for the calculation, \$10,007,000, amounts to about \$171 per listed A.A. group. Dividing total contributions received (\$6,068,172) by the 58,539 groups registered gives us an average of about \$104, while expenses to support services to those groups amounted to approximately \$141. The adjusted balance used for the Reserve Fund calculation has increased approximately \$750,000 from last year.

Turning to 2007, the G.S.O. budget, anticipates a return to more "normal levels" of unit sales following the price adjustments of the past few years. In 2005, your responsible trusted servants, after reviewing financial matters, recommended an increase in prices of books and booklets (except the Big Book), as well as an imposition of a small shipping charge effective July 1, 2005. This followed by one year the restoration of the price of the Big Book on July 1, 2004. You may remember that the price of the Fourth Edition was set at \$5.00 (a \$1.00 per book reduction from \$6.00), specifically reducing the expected Gross Profit with a goal of reducing the Reserve Fund. Projections at that time anticipated that, depending on contributions, the price would be restored in a few years. Prudence dictated that even though





Contribution revenue has seen favorable upward movement during the last several years, restoration of the overall revenue stream was appropriate. Trusted servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations, as well as assess the services supplied. You should also be aware that as we continue to strive to have literature available—for our Service Conference, in the Spanish and French languages as well as English—lower print runs in those languages result in higher production costs. Because we strive to have similar selling prices regardless of our manufacturing cost, lower overall gross profits are an expected result, making price increases required from time to time.

In keeping with our Seventh Tradition of self-support, this year's budget anticipates about a 2% increase in contributions. The budget envisions approximately a 2% increase in costs when compared with 2006 actual results, and a 2% increase when compared with the 2006 budget. Based on these primary assumptions—approximately even dollar sales; a 2% increase in contributions; and a slight increase in total operating expenses—the projection for 2007 is for an excess of revenue over expenses of \$237,450, somewhat less than the 2006 budgeted profit..

As mentioned in prior reports, following three years of planned losses (1995-1997), the Reserve Fund was at a point where it was prudent to anticipate slightly better than break-even years, and we did! Then, following a very good year in 2000, both from operations and the Convention, the Reserve Fund was approaching the 12-month level. We were grateful when the Conference moved forward the "Floating Cap plan" allowing for the orderly "managing down" of the Reserve Fund. We saw the results of those actions and now are focusing on future levels.

Just to expand a bit on the use of the Fellowship's money in providing services back to the Fellowship — in 2006, we spent \$8,272,000 on services to the Fellowship, approximately \$830,000 more than spent in 2005. This compares with \$7,443,300 in 2005, \$7,622,288 in 2004, \$7,088,055 in 2003, \$7,182,000 in 2002, \$6,685,600 spent in 2001, \$6,143,300 spent in 2000, \$5,876,500 in 1999, \$5,867,700 in 1998, and \$5,944,000 in 1997. Contributions provided 73% and 27% came from the profit from literature sales. (This compares with 73% and 27% in 2005; 68% and 32% in 2004; 72% and 28% in 2004; 71% and 29% in 2002; 70% and 30% in 2001; and 73% and 27% for 2000.) Services spending amounted to \$141 per listed A.A. group, up about \$13 from the previous year, while total contributions were about \$104

per group, up \$13. The 2006 service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services 31.8% (which includes the Group Services assignment; Box 4-5-9; A.A. Directories; records and files; contributions processing; and French services); the General Service Conference, 12.1%; Loners, Internationalists, and Overseas Services, 11.6%; trustees' and directors' activities, 6.7%; Regional Forums, 6.9%; Archives, 9.7%; C.P.C., 5.5%; Public Information, 5%; Correctional Facilities, 5.2%; and Treatment Facilities, 1.6%; World Service Meeting, 1.6%; Special Needs; 1.%, Nominating 1%; other various 0.3%.

*The Grapevine* — At the Grapevine, magazine income was approximately even with the prior year and average circulation was approximately even as well. Average circulation during 2006 was 103,878. This compared with 104,356 for 2005, 108,426 for 2004, 112,614 for 2003, 115,753 for 2002, 115,000 in 2001, 115,700 in 2000, 115,900 for 1999, 117,300 for 1998, 120,679 for 1997, and 128,360 during 1996. Gross profit on the magazine was \$1,151,000, which was \$12,000 less than last year and \$52,000 less than budgeted as well. Revenue of Other Items was \$27,000, less than budgeted but \$51,000 higher than the prior. Gross profit on Other Items was approximately \$64,400 less than budgeted but \$24,000 greater than 2005 therefore, total income, including interest income, was \$1,587,200, \$20,200 more than last year but about \$106,000 less than budgeted.

Costs and expenses for editorial, circulation and business, and administration were \$1,636,049. This is \$113,500 more than last year, but \$37,200 less than budget. As a result, the Grapevine (excluding La Viña) reported a loss from operations of \$48,875, compared with the \$44,190 profit last year.

The Grapevine's 2007 budget, excluding La Viña, anticipates magazine income of \$1,964,197, approximately \$69,000 greater than the \$1,895,450 realized in 2006, an increase in magazine direct costs of \$19,500, and a gross profit of \$1,200,575. Gross profit on Other Publishing Income is anticipated to increase \$71,000, while interest income should be about even. A loss for 2007 of \$81,328 is anticipated, approximately \$32,500 greater than the \$48,875 loss for 2006. These two losses follow four successive positive years of Grapevine operations. A price increase of \$2.00 effective July 1, 2007 is included in this budget.

*La Viña* — La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a





2006 average circulation of 10,223. This compared with a 2005 average of 9,453, a 2004 average of 9,316, a 2003 average circulation of 9,222, and 2002 circulation of 9,000, 8,600 in 2001, 8,500 in 2000, 8,000 in 1999, and 8,400 in 1997.

La Viña appears to be a first-rate product. Our hope is that it will increasingly fulfill the needs of our Spanish-speaking members and we will see a growth in circulation. To date, the project has incurred losses each of the past ten and one-half years. During 2006, subscription income was \$89,080 and direct costs of publishing were \$68,620, resulting in a \$20,460 gross profit. During 2006, La Viña realized approximately \$20,787 from the sales of CDs, net of costs. Operating expenses directly associated with the publication were \$113,251. These include the editorial, circulation and administrative costs attributable to La Viña. Therefore, the overall loss on La Viña for the year was \$72,001 compared with a loss for 2005 of \$107,740.

The Grapevine Board and management have worked hard to put out a quality product that is responsive to the needs of the Spanish-speaking members of the Fellowship on a cost-effective basis. For 2007, the loss on the La Viña project is budgeted to be approximately \$72,333, essentially the same as 2006, with circulation being projected to decrease slightly to 10,100 copies. The Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee continue to monitor progress and report results to the Conference. Since the inception of the project, \$1,071,000 has been invested in La Viña. In 2001, the General Service Board recommended that La Viña continue to be published and agreed to provide the necessary funding.

During the year, the trustees finance and Budgetary Committee received reports from the subcommittee formed to attempt to define a concise message about self-support. The work product of the subcommittee is as follows.

#### Self-Support of the World Services of Alcoholics Anonymous

The A.A. spiritual Principle of self-support enables us to pursue our primary purpose of carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic with a shared sense of responsibility for our lifesaving work and without interference or financial dependence on outsiders. From our Fellowship's earliest days, the expenses of the General Service Office, and the world services provided by it, have exceeded the amount derived from contributions of A.A. groups and members. As a result, providing these needed services has necessarily been supported in part by income from the sale of A.A. literature. It is the policy of the General Service Board that income from literature sales should only be in amounts required to allow continued provision of vitally needed services and maintenance of a Prudent Reserve Fund. We hope that the day will come when A.A. groups and members, through their contributions, will be able to fund fully the services provided by the General Service Office. If that is achieved, revenues from literature sales will only be needed in amounts necessary to cover the actual costs associated with literature production and to maintain a Prudent Reserve Fund.

The A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine Corporate Boards, as well as the trustees finance and Budgetary Committee, continue to receive information and recommendations from the Retirement plan's Actuaries concerning requirements placed on A.A. as a result of recent pension legislation enacted by the U.S.

Congress. This legislation calls for accelerated funding of pensions, which is a departure from the previously accepted method of long-term funding of pensions over the employees working life. The legislation provides that accrued obligations are fully funded over a specified period of time and current unfunded position over a period of 7 years, commencing

in 2008. While there may be advantages to having more funds in the plan earlier, to earn revenue, basically the long-term funding requirements are the same.

In addition, while funding requirements may change annually

based on fund earnings and retiree payments, the financial impact on the A.A.W.S. 2007 budget is an increase of approximately \$300,000 from the 2006 contribution of \$678,000. While nowhere near this dollar amount, the Grapevine also is required to increase its funding substantially. It is anticipated that this increased funding level will continue for several years.

In summary, while your trusted servants continue to monitor financial affairs, steps taken over the past several years to enhance the revenue side of the equation, reductions in the expense side, and consideration of long-term obligations, help insure that the Fellowship's finances remain in good condition. The outlook for this year appears to be favorable, and we continue to have the financial wherewithal to carry our message.

*Vincent Keefe, treasurer*

#### GENERAL SHARING SESSION

**Trustees' report:** Since the 56th General Service Conference, the board has held three General Sharing Sessions. Following is a summary of each session.

*July 2006 — "Are We Growing — Let's Talk About It" —* Greg Muth, general manager, gave the presentation on "Are We Growing — Let's Talk About It." Greg shared that on August 19, 1940, Bill W. wrote to trustee Frank Amos the following: "The great news here, of course, concerns the phenomenal and successful spread of A.A. There must be well over one thousand active members now. The most important happening is this; it has been shown beyond doubt that A.A. will successfully blanket the country with no more centralized assistance than can be rendered by the book, our central office 'propaganda,' and the relation of casually traveling members to beginners in new localities."

Greg also quoted from the February 1961 Grapevine, where Bill wrote in an article titled The Shape of Things to Come, "A.A.'s first quarter century is now history. Our next twenty-five years lie in prospect before us. How, then, can we make the most of this new grant of time? Perhaps our very first realization should be that we can't stand still, now that our basic principles seem established, now that our functioning is fairly effective and widespread, it



would be temptingly easy to settle down as merely one more useful agency on the world scene. We could conclude that 'A.A. is just fine the way it is.' Yet how many of us, for example, would presume to declare, 'Well, I'm sober and I'm happy. What more can I want, or do? I'm fine the way I am.' We know that the price of such self-satisfaction is an inevitable backslide, punctuated at some point by a very rude awakening. We have to grow or else deteriorate. For us, the 'status quo' can only be for today, never for tomorrow. Change we must; we cannot stand still."

Greg said that a few years ago the A.A.W.S. Board held a sharing session to discuss, "Is There a Genuine Plateau in the Growth of A.A. Membership, and is There Anything We Can Do About It?" A chart of membership indicated that in 1939 A.A. counted 100 members, and by 1999—60 years later—A.A. recorded 1,258,940 members. Although the numbers showed growth in membership, the number of new members had declined each year since 1990. New members in 1990 totaled approximately 68,000, yet by 1996 we recorded an estimated 16,000 new members. Groups should remember that they are responsible for providing accurate, current information to G.S.O., the area assembly and the local intergroup.

Greg said that he is fond of reminding Regional Forum attendees that "Numbers in A.A. are suspect, except for those on financial statements prepared by our team of professional accounting employees; and, that financial reports are reviewed and audited by outside auditors. We're an anonymous Fellowship, constantly changing and numbers are not always relevant." Here are some highlights of subsequent sharing:

- The question was posed, "What would have to happen today to spark the kind of growth that early A.A. experienced?"
- The general public's perception of the A.A. program has changed since 1990, and fewer individuals are being referred to A.A. Also, we seem to not be doing enough to reach the black or Hispanic communities.
- Pre-1990, there were many works published that promoted the value of the A.A. program of recovery, and early on members were able to attend a meeting a day. However, the longer one stays in A.A. and the fuller one's life becomes, in general, the fewer meetings one attends.
- The flat growth of A.A. is directly attributed to the amount of Twelfth Step work being done today. A.A. can continue to grow if we do more. Not just taking the Steps, but taking A.A.'s Twelve Steps to the still-suffering alcoholic.
- Sometimes we are not as welcoming as we might be. We need to be more tolerant of newcomer behavior.
- Things have changed dramatically since the early days of A.A. Today, there are more alternatives for the still-suffering alcoholic seeking recovery.
- Some 35 years ago A.A. was known to be one of the most effective treatments for alcoholism. Thus, there was lots of interest and funding available for treatment centers who in turn promoted A.A.
- Other fellowships have come of age and there are now more



viable alternatives than were available in the past.

- We as A.A. members have nothing to be ashamed of. "Let's not forget about what we're doing that's working."

October 2006 —  
*"Leadership: Our Collective Vision — Our Future Depends On It"* — Bill Clark, Class A trustee, presented on "Our Recent Experience — Examples of Leadership," and began with a poem by Vaclav

Havel entitled, "It is I Who Must Begin," which provided a backdrop for his message.

Bill pointed out that A.A.'s founders realized that leadership could not forever rest with them, so the Conference assumed leadership in 1955. Of course, the second generation of leadership needed guidance. In a 1959 Grapevine article about leadership, Bill listed essential attributes of good leadership: responsibility, tolerance, flexibility, and vision. The article's key concepts are that leaders must envision strategies for a future that can never look like the past; that leaders will fail if they cannot tolerate criticism and listen for the creative notions that are easily lost during controversy; and that leaders must be alert to ideas that might emerge from our harshest critics—even those who personally attack us. Finally, a leader must be ready to restate his thinking, or be more transparent about it, or reframe the ideas.

Bill noted that in the second generation of the Fellowship, there were still people who knew the first-generation founders, but now almost none remain. We worry that we have to have new rules for leaders in order to carry on the founders' vision. But the comprehensiveness of the Twelve Concepts ensures that the Fellowship will enable, rather than disable, leaders so they can responsibly execute leadership.

In conclusion, Bill said that so long as A.A.'s leaders keep values at the forefront, adjust policies and procedures to serve the mission, and accept the support of the Fellowship, each of us can be a faithful and effective trustee for the work of ensuring A.A.'s future.

Howard Lowery, Southeast regional trustee, presented on "Current Challenges Where Leadership is Vital." Howard began by pointing out that our tendency is to sometimes forget who, what, and where A.A. really is. "Alcoholics Anonymous is not found here in this room, or at 475 Riverside Drive, or in the central office of whatever city you want to mention, and it is not in any of the local treatment centers. When looking for A.A., I suggest we look in places like Ocean Springs, Mississippi, where a local group met in a parking lot for weeks because a hurricane had blown away their meeting place, or maybe the little group in the plains of Montana where the members slog through the snow to their meeting."

Howard shared that sometimes we launch into mental gymnastics, pursuing some lofty goal that has nothing to do with serving A.A. We forget that our primary purpose is not to further research, to provide solutions to people who do not want them, or to take on business decisions that do not directly benefit A.A. groups and members. Often we make our decisions based on

what is the best business decision, or what satisfies our customers, rather than making our decisions based on what is going to provide the most help for our members. What am I prepared to do to be of maximum service to God and the people about me? Am I willing to expend the time and effort to fulfill my commitment to Alcoholics Anonymous? Am I willing to put what is good for A.A. ahead of my personal wants and opinions? These are not easy questions, and the answers are tougher. I believe the solution to our challenges lies in our answers to these questions.

Following are highlights of subsequent sharing:

- In regard to leadership, one person shared that the men in A.A. who mentored him, such as trustee emeritus, Jim Estelle, come to mind. He remembered Jim's words, which still inspire him today—"If you are willing, God will provide the time."
- Those of us here today have a responsibility to prepare our leaders of tomorrow. We might ask ourselves, "What am I doing to encourage others to serve?" It is A.A.'s Three Legacies: Recovery, Unity and Service, that are important, as they are a part of a greater whole.
- Also reflecting on A.A.'s Three Legacies it was suggested that an example of a true leader in A.A. is one who has high standards for carrying A.A.'s message through Twelfth Step work.

January 2007 — "Right of Participation — Concept IV" — Herb Goodman, Class A trustee, spoke on the topic "Concept IV and the 'Right of Participation' — Who Participates?" Herb asked: "In A.A., who has the right to participate?" His answer was everyone involved in whatever issue is at hand, or is under review, or is being discussed. Bill W. wrote that at the Conference, everyone is equal, and that principal is meant to be observed at every level of the Fellowship, from the groups, through the districts and the regions, in the various committees and task forces, and on the boards of A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine.

Herb shared that Concept IV provides that all groups in A.A. should be given a right to participate in the affairs of A.A. It provides not only that groups of alcoholics be permitted to participate, but also staff that include nonalcoholics should be permitted the right to vote in proportion to the responsibility which they discharge. This ensures that every skilled and experienced element of the Fellowship's structure, which is needed to make an informed and appropriate decision, has the right to participate.

Herb continued that Concept IV, together with the other Concepts of World Service, spells out the foundation of the wonderful, democratic nature of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous, which illuminates all our activities. This Fellowship provides a shining example of the way a democracy is supposed to work, with democratic participation leading to an informed group conscience.

Murray McIntosh, trustee-at-large/Canada, presented on the topic "Concept IV: Right of Participation—Representation in Proportion to Responsibility." The General Service Conference, Murray pointed out, has three groupings of voting participants, totaling 136 votes. The delegates—representing the A.A. groups—make up the largest contingent at the Conference. In the upcoming Conference there are 93 delegates, making up 69% of the voting body.

Just as the groups cannot be practically convened, Murray said, neither can the area delegates be collectively consulted beyond the few days at each year's General Service Conference. To solve this, administrative authority is delegated to the General Service Board. However, the General Service Board meets only quarterly and cannot possibly manage the day-to-day operation of these various services. The board therefore delegates to each of the corporate boards the responsibility for the daily operations of A.A. World Services, Inc., and its General Service Office, and The A.A.

## Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 2007<sup>1</sup>

|                                      | Groups  | Members   |
|--------------------------------------|---------|-----------|
| United States                        | 53,665  | 1,213,269 |
| Canada                               | 4,874   | 95,443    |
| Sub-Total                            | 58,539  | 1,308,712 |
| Correctional facilities <sup>2</sup> | 2,432   | 63,357    |
| Internationalists                    |         | 65        |
| Lone members                         |         | 227       |
| Total                                | 60,971  | 1,372,361 |
| Outside U.S. & Canada <sup>3</sup>   | 53,590  | 616,899   |
| Grand Total                          | 114,561 | 1,989,260 |

1. The General Service Office does not keep membership records. The information shown here is based on reports given by groups listed with G.S.O., and does not represent an actual count of those who consider themselves A.A. members.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

3. We are aware of A.A. activity in more than 180 countries, including 57 autonomous general service offices in other lands. Annually we attempt to contact those G.S.O.s and groups that request to be listed in our records. Where current data is lacking we use an earlier year's figures.

Grapevine, Inc. and the Grapevine office.

The General Service Board, Murray continued, has "the chief initiative and active responsibility in most world service matters" (Concept VI); and its trustees are "the principal planners and administrators of overall policy and finance" (Concept VIII). The smaller groups of trustees and the nontrustee directors of the corporate boards exercise similar responsibility. Their numbers—21 trustees and 6 nontrustee directors, totaling 27—make up the second largest grouping of Conference members. This year, they represent 19% of the Conference participants.

Murray concluded by saying that the Conference's third group of voting participants is composed of paid employees of A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine. They number 16 and represent approximately 12% of Conference voting participants. In summary, the proportion of voting representation in the General Service Conference is 69:19:12 or, roughly, 7:2:1, which is in keeping with the amount of responsibility flowing to each voting group from the source of all responsibility for Alcoholics Anonymous—the A.A. groups themselves.

Tom Vida, Panel 56 delegate, Area 86, Western Ontario, spoke on the topic "Concept IV: Right of Participation—Equal Partnership." Tom shared that he is only one member in his group, equal with the others, and that he has one voice and one vote at their business meetings. At an area assembly, we are equal participants and equal partners with each G.S.R. We each have our own experience and perspective to share; as a world servant, I have a different level of experience and a different perspective, no more, no less, just different.

Tom noted that at the level of the General Service Conference, we especially need this right of equal partnership. No class is set in absolute authority over another. When the time comes for balloting, there are no superiors, no inferiors, and no advisors.

Through participation at the Conference, corporate board, and staff meetings, staff members and assistants are able to make known their personal questions, experiences and examples on the job—and even their fears—to the trustees, delegates, and A.A. as a whole. “They must be made to feel that they are on the team.” (Concept XI)

Tom concluded his presentation by sharing the following: “My service sponsor tells me that the highest office anyone can obtain in Alcoholics Anonymous is ‘sober.’ That makes me and all of us here, and in the whole world of A.A., ‘equal partners’ with the ‘right of participation’ in the service structure of Alcoholics Anonymous. I pray that we shall forever cherish and protect this equal partnership, as Dr. Bob and Bill W. cherished their equal partnership in the days when A.A. was first coming of age.”

The following sharing ensued:

- A.A.’s Right of Participation has both a practical and a spiritual application. It had allowed one to open up to others in the Fellowship. The Right of Participation is absolutely essential in order to achieve a true “group conscience”; we need not be fearful that anyone will abuse the principle described in Concept IV.
- Staff members face challenges when sharing opportunities arise at the General Service Conference. Given the lessons presented in Concept IV, is it appropriate to ask which voting groups at the Conference share “too much” or “too little,” and is this in keeping with the spirit of Concept IV?
- Participating is a responsibility of each individual. We are members of A.A. and our A.A. groups when we say we are. Our job as A.A. members is to comfort the afflicted and to afflict the comfortable.
- Having a balance of authority versus responsibility is important. The smaller voting groups (trustees, directors, and staff) at the Conference have larger areas of responsibility and therefore should have comparable authority to discharge their duties as the Concept advises.

Jeanne Woodford, chairperson

### A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

**Office report:** The Grapevine had a challenging and productive year in 2006. Chaired by the executive editor, the Editorial Advisory Board (EAB) met five times last year to help develop the audio edition of the international journal of Alcoholics Anonymous, the AudioGrapevine, which was launched in July 2006. The EAB also endorsed a request to reinstate the section “About Alcoholism,” to provide information on the physical aspect of the illness to readers, and helped Grapevine staff develop a classic cartoon and joke issue in November and two new departments: *What’s on Your Mind?* and *50-Year Wonders*, a series of interviews with A.A.s who have celebrated 50+ years of sobriety. Concerned with the declining circulation of our English meeting in print, the EAB reviewed the results of three surveys to current subscribers, former subscribers, and online users. They discussed the high approval ratings the magazine got from subscribers (88% said they were “very satisfied with their subscription”), the Grapevine’s high pass-along rate (four readers per copy), and the fact that 73% of our subscribers are over 50 years old. The EAB also noted the importance of doing all we can to make young A.A.s and newcomers aware of the magazine.

In May, staff welcomed Jadine Zemsky, our new circulation manager, the first the Grapevine has had in four years. In addition to developing a program to increase awareness of our meetings in print and in other media, Jadine has been gathering information about where and how people learn about the Grapevine and La Viña and is enabling us to offer more support to our network of GvRs and RLVs, which now total 3,370. She pointed out that,

with a pass-along rate of four, the Grapevine reaches about half a million people a month; La Viña reaches at least 41,000.

During the year we released two books: *Emotional Sobriety* and *El Grupo Base: Corazón de AA* (the Spanish edition of *The Home Group: Heartbeat of AA*); *Historias de La Viña III: Pasos 7 a 12* (a CD on Steps 7-12); and four updated and remastered Grapevine tapes on CD: *The Story of AA*, *What It Was Like*, *The Twelve Traditions* and *It Works If We Work It*. The Grapevine also reprinted the facsimiles of the memorial issues marking the passing of our co-founders, Bill W. and Dr. Bob. All told the Grapevine distributed 113,000 books, CDs, and other items this year, compared to 107,000 in 2005. Visitors to the Web site have grown 22.5% this year, to 38,000.

To cut costs, Grapevine reduced its office space more than 20% this year and reconfigured the remaining space to make it more efficient. To improve the quality of printing and delivery, we completed our move to a new printer, beginning with the April issue of the Grapevine—May/June in the case of La Viña. Still, the rising cost of postage (up 40% since 2000) and other fixed expenses made it necessary to increase the subscription and cover price of La Viña in 2007 for the first time in ten years, and to plan a subscription price increase for the Grapevine, the first in five years. Customer service continues to be coordinated by Jeff Monasch at the Grapevine office. The finance and fulfillment departments remain unchanged and are overseen by the controller.

Our international magazine in Spanish, La Viña, had a stellar year, with an increase in average circulation of about 9%, to 10,223. La Viña’s three CDs in Spanish have also been selling well. La Viña and the Grapevine staff continue to receive many invitations to participate in state, area, district, and intergroup events, as well as at International Conventions and Regional Forums. Highlights for 2006 were presentations and workshops at NERAASA and PRAASA, the Old Granddad State Convention in Arkansas, Central America A.A. Convention in Nicaragua, the Intergroup Seminar in Ohio, the California Hispanic State Convention, the Pacific Regional Forum in Washington, the Eastern Canada Regional Forum in Ontario, the Special Inner City Forum in Pennsylvania, the National Hispanic Convention in New York, the Special Hispanic Forum and a Grapevine workshop in Wisconsin, and the Southeast Regional Forum in Georgia.

Robin Bromley, executive editor

### GROUP SERVICES

**Staff report:** Responsibilities of the Group Services coordinator include supervising the production of service material. To assist groups, the General Service Office provides service material based on an indicated need in order to provide information and share experience not found in Conference-approved literature. Examples of service material include: Group Handbooks; G.S.R. and D.C.M. Kits; A.A. Guidelines; Referral List of Fellowships Similar to A.A.; a catalog of A.A. Literature and Audiovisual Material for Special Needs.

In addition, the Group Services coordinator serves as G.S.O.’s liaison for Intergroups and Central Offices and has a primary role in coordinating A.A.W.S.’s participation in the annual Intergroup/Central Office Seminar. The staff member also responds to the inquiries and concerns of A.A. members and other individuals regarding G.S.O.’s A.A. Web site. Ongoing projects:

- The Group Services coordinator is working closely with the Special Projects manager regarding directories and central/intergroup office records and lists.
- Currently supervising the updating of service material such as A.A. Guidelines, Group Handbooks, G.S.R., and D.C.M. Kits.
- On an ongoing basis, the Group Services coordinator works

closely with G.S.O.'s Intra-Office Web site committee to update and improve G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

The staff member on Group Services also serves as secretary of the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, secretary of the A.A.W.S. Board's Services Committee and as the regional correspondent for the southeast region of the United States.

Warren Stafford

## INTERNATIONAL

**Trustees' report:** This committee is responsible for suggesting policies and actions to assure that the A.A. message is available around the world, especially in areas where there is no established service structure. We provide shared experience, support translations of A.A. literature in other languages, and encourage the expansion of regional or zonal meetings. The committee is the primary link between the international A.A. community and the U.S./Canada General Service Board of Trustees.

*World Service Meeting* — The 19th World Service Meeting (WSM) was held October 15-19 in Malahide, Ireland, with the theme "Anonymously, But Not Invisible." There were 54 delegates representing 34 countries or zones in attendance. Dorothy Wilson, trustee-at-large/U.S., was the first-term delegate, and Murray McIntosh, trustee-at-large/Canada, was the second-term delegate representing the General Service Board. G.S.O. general manager, Greg Muth, presided at the event and staff member Doug Richardson served as WSM coordinator. Other staff members who served as secretaries to WSM committees were Julio Espallat, Irene Kontje and Warren Stafford. John Kirwin was the logistical coordinator, in charge of the workroom and hotel facilities. The next WSM will take place in New York City, October 25-29, 2008, and the theme will be "Service—Gratitude in Action."

*Literature Assistance* — The 2007 Literature Assistance budget of \$117,700 will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish a variety of foreign language books, pamphlets and reprints. A portion of this expense will be drawn from the International Literature Fund, representing contributions from A.A. groups and structures around the world. A.A.W.S. holds the copyrights on all foreign-language versions of our Conference-approved material and issues licensing agreements for publication and distribution to those countries which have an established general service office, board, conference or structure. When necessary, we translate and publish the material, subject to scheduling by the Publications Department and approval of the A.A.W.S. Board. Since the last Conference, 80 translations have been completed.

*Interim Zonal Meetings* — The United States and Canada will be represented at four zonal service meetings in 2007, which are held in the year when the World Service Meeting does not meet. In May 2007, Doug Richardson will attend, as an observer, the 3rd Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting (SSASM) in Windhoek, Namibia. The new G.S.O. staff member on the International Desk will attend, as an observer, the 7th Asia-Oceania Service Meeting in Tokyo, Japan in July and the 14th European Service Meeting in Frankfurt, Germany in October. Dorothy Wilson and the new trustee-at-large Canada will be delegates to the 15th Meeting of the Americas (REDELA) in Sao Paulo, Brazil in October.

*International Trips* — The General Service Board and General Service Office responded to many invitations from other countries to attend events ranging from conventions, anniversary celebrations, conferences, board meetings, office visits, regional assemblies, and other events. Trustees and staff members visited many countries, including Bosnia-Herzegovina, Croatia, Federation of Tuva, France, Great Britain, Greece, Ireland, Kuwait, Mexico, Mongolia, Russia, South Korea, Sweden, Trinidad & Tobago and Turkey.

We continue to be encouraged and inspired by the international A.A. community and General Service Boards and offices in other countries, who carry the A.A. message to countless thousands in new regions and across difficult linguistic, cultural and economic barriers.

Murray McIntosh, chairperson

**Staff report:** The International desk receives correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s and professionals interested in obtaining information about A.A. in countries outside of the U.S. and Canada. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 59 international general service offices and literature distribution centers. The International desk is also responsible for communication with structures, groups and members outside the United States/Canada. Correspondence arrives at the International desk in many languages and it is answered in the appropriate language, often accompanied by A.A. literature. In order to accomplish this, the staff member on the assignment is assisted by a bilingual (English-Spanish) assistant and the services of both our G.S.O. translators and outside professional services. In addition, G.S.O. staff members who are fluent in other languages aid in telephone or in person communications. Where there is a nearby office, we provide the location, telephone number and e-mail or Web site address. We emphasize our faith in the fact that these members can maintain sobriety, help others and become independent in their own countries. Other responsibilities on the assignment are:

- Serving as coordinator for the biennial World Service Meeting (WSM) and maintaining contact with WSM delegates and their offices throughout the year.
- Maintaining close communications with our Publications Department on requests for new translations of literature (most touching are the unanticipated translations of the Big Book lovingly prepared by an A.A. member), and the beginnings of new general service or information offices that may be able to distribute literature to local members and groups.
- Translation of A.A. literature: Each year, the A.A. World Services Board receives offers to translate our literature into foreign languages. A primary in consideration of each request is the need to ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message. To that end, the Publications Department has the responsibility of having each translation checked against the English original. In countries where there is a general service board licensed to publish or distribute A.A. literature, an approved translation is often financed and published there. Where a stable A.A. structure is not yet present, the A.A.W.S. Board undertakes the new publication when funds are available. The Big Book has been translated into about 52 languages, and additional translations are pending approval and/or funding.

Doug Richardson

## INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

### Trustees' report:

*International Conventions* — Much of the activity for the 2010 International Convention lies in the next few years. This year, the committee reviewed a list of suggested 2010 International Convention themes and recommended to the General Service Board that the theme of "A Vision for You." The committee also reviewed the updated Site-Selection Procedures for the 2020 International Convention in anticipation of the start of that process this summer.

*Regional Forums* — Since the 2006 Conference, Regional

Forums have been held in the Pacific, Eastern Canada and Southeast Regions. All were well attended by enthusiastic A.A. members interested in learning more about A.A.'s general service structure. In addition, there was a Special Native American Forum held in Banning, California, a Special Inner City Forum held in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania, and a Special Hispanic Forum in Kenosha, Wisconsin. Many in attendance were experiencing their first A.A. service event as well as their first Forum. Each Forum was viewed as an opportunity to present information about the three corporate Boards, G.S.O. and the Grapevine. Equally important was the opportunity to hear sharing of experience, strength and hope, as well as challenges and successes of A.A. members on the front lines of service.

Following is a list of the committee's activities relative to Regional/Special Forums since the 2006 General Service Conference:

- Reviewed and accepted the proposed 2007 Regional Forums budget and forwarded it to the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee.
- Reviewed and accepted the 2007 Regional Forums schedule, which includes four Regional Forums: Northeast, West Central, Southwest and East Central.
- Accepted the withdrawal of the request for a Special "Remote" Forum, which was to be held in 2009 in Northeast Ontario.
- Reviewed summaries of the Evaluation Questionnaires from the Western Canada, Pacific, Eastern Canada and Southeast Forums, as well as the Native American, Inner City and Hispanic Special Forums. These summaries include attendees' comments on Forum agendas, suggestions for improvements and suggestions for future Forum presentation and workshop topics.

In July, the chairperson appointed a Special Forums subcommittee to clarify the definition, purpose, and format and request process for Special Forums. The subcommittee reviewed the findings of the 2002, 2003 and 2005 Special Forums subcommittees. As the fourth subcommittee to address the subject of Special Forums, the subcommittee agreed that, rather than proposing temporary or minor adjustments to the schedule or definition of Special Forums, it would present a more sweeping change in Forums scheduling. The General Service Board and the committee accepted the subcommittee's recommendations:

- (a) that future Special Forums be discontinued effective January 1, 2008, with the exception of one Special Forum commitment to Area 84, to be held in 2009 in Northeast Ontario; (b) that the General Service Board coordinate an Additional Regional Forum every eight years in each region; (c) that the General Service Board encourage regions to support Local Forums, structured to provide Forums Information and to meet cultural, accessibility and population considerations within their own A.A. communities; (d) that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums annually approve at its July meeting travel of one member of the General Service Board (the Local Forum regional trustee if available) and one member of the G.S.O. or Grapevine staff at up to three Local Forums annually; (e) that these recommendations be implemented on a trial basis with an annual review/inventory of the status of these recommendations for five years by the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums; and (f) that the concept of Local Forums be forwarded to the 2007 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums for discussion.

Recommendation (b) would guarantee that each region would have the opportunity to host an Additional Regional Forum (ARF) once every eight years. The date and location of each Additional Regional Forum would be chosen by a regional group conscience

at the Conference Regional Lunch two years in advance of the anticipated date for the Forum. The following eight year schedule for ARF host regions was drawn from the hat, taking into consideration Special Forums scheduled for 2006-2007: 2008 Southwest, 2009 Eastern Canada, 2010 West Central, 2011 Pacific, 2012 East Central, 2013 Southeast, 2014 Northeast, 2015 Western Canada.

While not limited to this purpose, it is hoped that regions would use this Additional Forum to accomplish the current stated purpose of Special Forums.

As the purpose of these recommendations is not to limit access to Regional Forum information, the committee would encourage regions to coordinate additional Local Forums to meet cultural, accessibility and population considerations within their own A.A. communities and to eventually increase the number of Local Forums to address special circumstances in each region.

These Local Forums would not be coordinated or funded by the General Service Board. The board would provide additional support to these Local Forums through the availability of the G.S.O.'s Forums coordinator to provide experience, samples of successful local agendas, flyer formats, etc. G.S.O. could also help with the limited distribution of flyers. A local secretary would prepare and distribute a Final Report, which would be reviewed by the G.S.O. Forums coordinator for accuracy.

#### *Explanation, Purpose, and Intent of the Subcommittee's Recommendations:*

- The recommendations are an attempt to respond with a new structure to expressed needs of geographic isolation, language, culture and underserved populations addressed previously by Special Forums.
- Local Forums would eliminate the perceived inequity of the current Special Forums scheduling process, while continuing to serve populations previously served by Special Forums.
- Local Forums would address the problems of limited regional access and availability of the current General Service Board-sponsored Special Forums.
- The intent and expectation for Additional Regional Forums is that, in most cases, regions would use Additional Forums to address the needs that are now addressed by Special Forums.

Thus, while the committee recommended that Special Forums, as such, be discontinued, it fully intends that their current stated purposes can and will be achieved within the new Forum structure. The Additional Regional Forums will increase the number of Regional Forums available to a region by 25 percent.

The General Service Board approved the committee's recommendation to restore participation and attendance by one Grapevine director and one A.A.W.S. director (nontrustee director, general service trustee or regional trustee) at Regional Forums on a rotation basis effective January 1, 2007.

The General Service Board approved the committee's recommendation that effective January 1, 2008 the revised Regional/Special Forums schedule accepted by the 2005 trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums that incorporated three Special Forums in 2006 and 2007 be discontinued as experience indicates that it is not feasible to continue three Special Forums a year at the current G.S.O. staffing and resource level. The committee also discussed a request to consider a consistent policy for G.S.O. staff members' attendance at the Regional Forum for their correspondence region. G.S.O. management participated in this discussion and it was agreed that, when practical, G.S.O. staff members would attend the Forum for which they are the regional correspondent.

The committee also discussed the June 14, 2006 request for a Special Forum to be held in Golden, B.C. (Area 79) on May 9 and 10, 2009 and took no action. The committee encouraged Area 79



to apply for a Local Forum. The committee discussed an area's request to make a Special Forum for Native Americans an annual event until no longer needed and took no action. The committee noted that a process has begun with the Native American A.A. community coordinating Native American A.A. Gatherings with support and assistance by the General Service Board and General Service Office. The committee noted that the concept of an annual Forum coordinated by G.S.O. is outside the current Forum structure.

The following Regional Forums are scheduled prior to the 2008 General Service Conference:

| 2007          |                |                                                                         |
|---------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| May 5-6       | Special Remote | Holiday Inn<br>St. Thomas,<br>U.S. Virgin Islands                       |
| June 1-3      | Northeast      | Lancaster Host Resort<br>& Conference Center<br>Lancaster, Pennsylvania |
| July 14-15    | Special Remote | Yellowknife,<br>NW Territories                                          |
| August 11-12  | Special Remote | Hotel Rimouski<br>Rimouski, Quebec                                      |
| September 7-9 | West Central   | Doubletree Hotel—Omaha<br>Downtown<br>Omaha, Nebraska                   |
| October 12-14 | Southwest      | Red Lion Hotel—<br>Denver Central<br>Denver, Colorado                   |
| November 9-11 | East Central   | Sheraton Chicago<br>Northwest Arlington<br>Heights, Illinois            |

Ray Massey, chairperson

#### Staff reports:

**International Convention** — The International Convention assignment entails coordinating the myriad details involved in producing the A.A. International Convention, held every five years. Working with four committees—Trustees, Conference, G.S.O. Planning and Host—the International Convention coordinator is responsible for bringing the Convention to life and ensuring that thousands of A.A.s can share and celebrate A.A.'s Anniversary.

While still on the back burner, initial plans are under way for the next International Convention in San Antonio, Texas, July 1-4, 2010. Big meetings will be held in the Alamodome, and other meetings will take place in the San Antonio Convention Center and local hotels. Notifications about the Convention, including housing and registration information, will be made available as we get closer to the dates. Information will be available on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and articles will be published in *Box 4-5-9*, which is mailed throughout the Fellowship.

Rick Walker

**Regional Forums** — The staff member on the Regional Forums assignment is responsible for coordinating arrangements for holding Regional Forums and Special Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. members and service workers in a region, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., the Grapevine Corporate Board, and the Grapevine and General Service Office staffs. Regional Forums are organized by

the General Service Board and held at the invitation of a particular region every two years; currently there are four Regional Forums annually. Prior planning and on site work gets done with the help of a very able staff assistant.

The location and agenda for a Regional Forum are decided jointly by the regional trustee, area delegates and G.S.O. The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes invitations to participants and registration forms to groups and service workers throughout the region and, working with the host contact and regional trustee, coordinates Forum details: hotel arrangements, program, hospitality and displays. The Regional Forums coordinator is also responsible for preparing and distributing an "Early Bird" Newsletter at each Forum and forwarding a Forum Final Report to all who attend. This year we have begun to distribute the Final Report electronically upon request. The Final Report includes answers to all questions asked in Sharing Sessions and Ask-It Basket Sessions as well as unanswered Ask-It Basket questions. Sometimes the sharing is so enthusiastic that there is not enough time to answer all questions from the Ask-It Basket at the Forum. The Final Report from the December 2006 Southeast Regional Forum includes answers to 115 questions.

**Special Forums** — A region may request a Special Forum, which has fewer participants from the boards and staff over shorter time periods. Special Forums require the approval of the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums based on a detailed description of the purpose and goals to be accomplished by the Special Forum. Special Forums may be requested for remote, sparsely populated or urban areas. The Regional Forums coordinator works closely with the regional trustee, host delegate and host contact to tailor each agenda to local needs. Special Forums will not be held after 2007, but will be replaced by up to three Local Forums a year. Local Forums will still bring Forum information to remote, sparsely populated or urban A.A. communities; however, the Local Forum process will include a local organizing group conscience committee so that the Final Program will be responsive to local needs and challenges.

This year the staff member was busy preparing background, minutes and reports for two subcommittees. The results of these subcommittees' recommendations will be found in the trustees' report. The staff member on the A.A. Regional Forums assignment also serves as secretary of the trustees' and Conference International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Valerie O'Neill

## LITERATURE

**Trustees' report:** This report offers a summary of the literature projects of the trustees' Literature Committee since the 2006 General Service Conference.

- *"A.A. for the Native North American" pamphlet* — A memorandum was mailed to Conference members, literature committee chairs, and intergroup/central offices listed in the U.S./Canada to solicit Native North American stories for the "A.A. for the Native North American" pamphlet that is being revised. Attendees at a Native American Forum, held May 20-21, 2006 in Banning, California, who requested information were contacted. Story solicitation information was in the October-November 2006 and Holiday issues of *Box 4-5-9* and in the A.A. Grapevine. The original deadline for story submissions was December 15, 2006.

Prior to the October 28, 2006 meeting, six stories were submitted for consideration. The committee agreed that the selection process should not be rushed and requested that the story submission deadline be extended until June 30, 2007. The extension will provide a greater opportunity for Native North American A.A.



members to share their stories, offering a wider pool of stories that would be considered for the pamphlet. To date, 34 stories have been submitted. The committee agreed to forward a progress report on the "A.A. for the Native North American" revision to the 2007 Conference Committee on Literature for their review.

- *Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, Alcohólicos Anónimos* — The committee discussed the 2006 Advisory Action that "the Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, continue to be developed and that a report be brought back to the 2007 Conference Committee on Literature, in keeping with a 2004 Conference Advisory Action regarding content, story solicitation, and process.

The chair appointed subcommittee on the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*. The deadline for submissions was June 30, 2006. A total of 173 stories were submitted. The subcommittee on the story selection reviewed the first 164 pages, the Preface, the Forewords, "The Doctor's Opinion," "Dr. Bob's Nightmare," and the Appendices to assure accuracy of translation and consistency of style and tone throughout the text.

The proposed Third Edition of *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, will consist of the updated translation of the basic text, including "Bill's Own Story," "Dr. Bob's Nightmare," the translations of two English stories ("Alcoholics Anonymous #3" and "Women Suffer Too") already in the current edition, the existing twelve original stories in the current edition, up to 32 new selected stories, translations of the Forewords to the English Edition and the Foreword to the existing edition. A new Foreword will be developed by the Publications Department explaining the process and development of the new edition of the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book.

The committee accepted the final report of the subcommittee on the Spanish-language Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, and is mindful of the 2004 Conference Advisory Action that "as in translation of all languages, the Publication Department strives to reflect the best possible translation of Bill W.'s writings and does not require Conference approval" and agreed to forward the "Final Report on the Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*," to the 2007 Conference Committee on Literature.

- *Distribution Process for Conference Approval of Literature* — The committee discussed a letter regarding the Conference approval process for literature. The committee discussed at length the implications of widely distributing drafts of proposed literature items for Conference approval, and it was the sense of the committee that literature projects are "works in progress." Each trustees' committee is autonomous with a "Right of Decision." The committee agreed that the topic needs broader discussion.

#### *Projects Ongoing:*

- Literature that is up for reprint will continue to be reviewed for any reference that the standard text of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* has "remained unchanged" or "untouched," and when appropriate will insert the word "largely" so that the text reads "remains largely unchanged" or "largely untouched."

#### *Projects Completed:*

- "Too Young?," "It Happened to Alice!," and "Young People and A.A." pamphlets — The revised pamphlets were produced.

"Letter to a Woman Alcoholic" pamphlet—Local offices, districts, areas, and all appropriate service workers were informed that all languages of the pamphlet, "Letter to a Woman Alcoholic," was discontinued on February 1, 2007, as recommended by the 2006 General Service Conference. Copies were available to service committees for 90 days after February 1, 2007 and an appropriate number of copies will be kept by Publications and Archives, as well as the digital file.

*Projects forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee for consideration:*

- Final Report on the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*.
- Progress report on the pamphlet "A.A. for the Native North American."

Bill Clark, chairperson

**Staff report:** As secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees, the Literature coordinator works closely with the editor, writers and illustrators on reviewing all new recovery pamphlets, books and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. Along with the Publications Department, the coordinator follows the progress on the updating and revising of all existing recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications Department. This year there was close collaboration and cooperation with the Publications Department on the production of the revised pamphlets "Young People and A.A.," "It Happened to Alice!" and "Too Young?"

This was a year of extensive subcommittee activity, meetings, conference calls, deadlines and detailed reports as progress continued on the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*. The literature assistant is invaluable in supporting and helping facilitate all Literature assignment committee and subcommittee responsibilities.

The Literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups asking many literature-related questions: How can I order literature? Who does translations? Who can help me with my literature order problems? Where can I send my suggestion for a new literature format? And who can give me specific text and/or historical information from our literature? Many of these inquiries are passed along to our Order Entry Department, our Customer Service representatives, our Publications staff and our Archives staff. Contact is also maintained with all current area, district, intergroup/central offices and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and guidelines to assist the chairperson in this vital responsibility. There are currently 75 area literature chairpersons, 368 district literature chairpersons and 298 literature persons serving intergroups and individual A.A. groups.

The Literature staff member also gathers sharing for *Box 4-5-9*, published in English, French and Spanish with the following bimonthly distribution: 70,000 copies in English, 3,000 copies in French and 7,000 copies in Spanish. The staff member works closely with the Publications Department editor and the G.S.O. editorial committee to continue to bring the Fellowship news and notes from G.S.O. in *Box 4-5-9*. The editorial committee welcomes ideas, suggestions and sharing on service from the Fellowship so that *Box 4-5-9* can be an accurate reflection of both Fellowship and G.S.O. activities. As literature is essential in helping to carry our message of recovery, this remains a challenging and rewarding assignment.

Adrienne Brown

## LONERS, INTERNATIONALISTS, HOMERS

**Staff report:** The Loners/Internationalists Correspondence Service is a valuable method of sharing for about 227 Loners in 58 countries, plus 65 Internationalists, and 209 Homers. Loners are members who are unable to attend A.A. meetings because there are no A.A. groups within a reasonable distance. Internationalists are members working or serving on a seagoing vessel for lengthy periods, and Homers are A.A.s who are house-

bound due to illness or physical incapacity. Each is a valuable part of a service coordinated by the General Service Office that enables the member to stay sober by sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters, tapes and/or e-mail, in addition to reading A.A. literature.

The correspondence service also includes 500 Loner Sponsors, who are not "Sponsors" or "Loners" in the traditional sense. Instead, these members share their A.A. group experience and activities with Loners, Homers and Internationalists through correspondence. We also list 52 Port Contacts who are valuable resources when Internationalists are briefly onshore. These members also share experience and hope via correspondence.

Complimentary literature is sent to each new member, including the *Loners, Internationalists, & Homers Directory* and a subscription to *Box 4-5-9*. Each LIM member receives the *Loners/Internationalist Meeting-by-Mail (LIM)*, a bimonthly publication containing excerpts of letters from LIM members to the General Service Office. As with any directory or list distributed by G.S.O., LIM is confidential to insure the anonymity of LIM members.

In 2006, correspondence from around the world demonstrated that the A.A. program continued to be the basis of sobriety and our way of life. A single issue of LIM may include sharing from Australia, Belgium, Germany, England, India, Ireland, New Zealand, Peoples Republic of China, Slovenia, Taiwan, Vietnam, one or more countries in Africa, as well as Canada and the U.S. The letters are inspiring in their simplicity and straightforward sharing. It is a joy to be on the LIM assignment, to benefit by the sharing of members who encounter unique challenges to their sobriety and courageously share their A.A. experience, strength and hope with one another.

Mary Clare Lynch

## NOMINATING

**Trustees' report:** The trustees' Committee on Nominating of the General Service Board was first appointed by the chairman of the board on January 18, 1944. At that time its principal responsibilities were to "establish criteria for and to review resumes of trustee candidates and directors and to make recommendations regarding electoral procedures and matters which may affect the composition of the board and election to it." (History and Actions of the trustees' Committee on Nominating)

Since that time the trustees' Committee on Nominating generally has met three times each year and, with the forming of the General Service Conference in 1951, the committee began to meet annually with the Conference Committee on Trustees. The responsibilities of the committee grew over time to encompass criteria for all vacancies—whether in the ranks of trustees, or among key service directors and staff members.

At each meeting for over 60 years, the committee has worked to fulfill the task outlined for it. In *Twelve Concepts for World Service*, developed in 1962, that task included: "The recommendations of this committee to a large extent will determine the continuous success of our services. Its members will have the primary voice in choosing our future Trustees and non-Trustee workers. Careful deliberation, painstaking investigation and interviewing, refusal to accept casual recommendations, preparation well in advance of lists of suitable candidates—these will need to be the principal attitudes and activities of this committee. All temptation to haste or snap judgment will need to be faithfully and constantly resisted." (Page 49)

Activities of this committee in the past year have included:

- The committee reviewed the resumes, curriculum vitae, and other material of more than two dozen applicants for the Class A

(nonalcoholic) trustee vacancy to replace Allen L. Ault following the April 2007 General Service Conference, taking into consideration any preferences expressed by General Service Board members for occupation or area of expertise. The committee chose four applicants to interview for the position, and invited three of the four for interviews in January of 2007 (one applicant had taken another position). Following the interviews, the committee unanimously recommended to the General Service Board that Judge Rogelio Flores be invited to serve as a Class A trustee, filling the slot in April 2007.

- The committee recommended to the General Service Board, as eligible for election in April 2007, all candidates submitted for Northeast and Southwest regional trustees, and for trustee-at-large/Canada.

- Following the sudden death of Denis Vezina, newly-elected Eastern Canada regional trustee, in September 2006, the committee reviewed the options under the Bylaws for the selection/election of an Eastern Canada regional trustee, taking into consideration the results of an October 5, 2006, caucus of all Eastern Canada regional delegates, in which they expressed a preference to keep the position vacant for the balance of the four-year term and to have the chairperson of the General Service Board appoint an acting regional trustee during that time.

- In response to the request from the 2006 Conference Committee on Trustees that additional relevant background be gathered and reported to the 2007 Conference Committee on Trustees regarding the option of having a Class B (alcoholic) trustee serving as chairperson of the General Service Board, the committee spent several sessions defining, requesting and collating additional background information and sharing. After lengthy discussion, the committee agreed to forward the additional background to the 2007 Conference Committee on Trustees.

- The committee reviewed samples of vacancy announcement letters with the "Diversity Statement" positioned closer to the beginning in order to improve the impact of the statement, as had been suggested by the 2006 Conference Committee on Trustees. Suggested changes will be reflected in the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the trustees' Committee on Nominating. The committee also agreed to add the REDELA (Meeting of the Americas) zonal meetings into the section on time commitments in the letter regarding trustee-at-large vacancies.

- Recommended to the General Service Board that John Skilton serve as a general service trustee on the A.A.W.S. Corporate Board, following the April 2007 General Service Conference, replacing Jane Sheppard, who passed away in October 2007.

- Recommended to the General Service Board that Dorothy Hurley serve as a general service trustee on the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, following the April 2007 General Service Conference, replacing Arnold L. Ross.

Gary Kluksdahl, chairperson

**Staff report:** This staff assignment—now in its second year—is responsible to the trustees' Nominating Committee, as well as to the Conference Committee on Trustees, serving as secretary to both committees when they meet, as well as preparing background, minutes and reports for the committees and reporting projects and activities to the Fellowship as a whole. In addition to all of the assignment activity generated by several trustee vacancies taking place in April 2007, the staff member was able to collect and collate responses from delegate areas regarding the request from the 2006 Conference Committee on Trustees for sharing about the possibility of a Class B (alcoholic) serving as chairperson of the General Service Board. Based on remarks from delegates, this request for sharing generated great unity within some areas as they embarked on a common project, and provid-

ed wonderful opportunities for members to learn more about the Fellowship.

The staff member on this assignment also serves as a resource point for Special Needs/Accessibilities committees within the Fellowship, sending out welcome letters, material, and shared experience to district and area committee chairs, as well as serving as a Special Needs correspondent. In the fall of 2006 the staff member worked collaboratively with the staff member on the C.P.C. desk and the Publications department to gather background for the Fall *About A.A.* issue that lets professionals know what resources are available through A.A. for those clients who are alcoholics with special needs. The feature article was able to include several personal anecdotes from alcoholics who are blind, deaf or quadriplegic, as well as sharing from Special Needs Committees, along with information on literature and other material available from A.A.W.S. An early copy of this *About A.A.* issue was included in a winter mailing to Special Needs/Accessibilities chairs, which also carried the news about a new low price for the Braille version of *Alcoholics Anonymous*.

Additionally, this assignment provides a central point for shared experience about Remote Communities work in A.A., and the staff member serves as the G.S.O. liaison to A.A. members involved in this service, and works with the elected chairs of the pre-Conference Remote Communities Meeting. Remote Communities resource material housed at G.S.O. include pieces of A.A. literature (Serenity Prayer, Steps, and Traditions) that have been translated locally in a variety of Native North American/Aboriginal languages. Some of these translations—such as Mohawk, Navajo and Oji-Cree—were recently checked for accuracy and reformatted as service pieces for those who request them. The staff member on this assignment has also been working with Archives on assembling a history of Native North American A.A. meetings.

Gayle Solheim Riese

## PUBLIC INFORMATION

**Trustees' report:** The trustees' Committee on Public Information is charged with the responsibility of helping the membership to carry the A.A. message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers. We do this by recommending and coordinating activities which include: creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing television and radio public service announcements (P.S.A.s); producing films about A.A.; preparing press releases and reports to the public; coordinating health fairs and other community and school exhibits with local P.I. committees; conducting the triennial A.A. Membership Survey; and carrying A.A.'s message through electronic as well as print media. Projects over the past year have included:

**Television P.S.A.s** — In response to a 2006 Conference Advisory Action that reaffirmed the 2002 Advisory Action regarding the production of one new television public service announcement (P.S.A.) every year, and the request that a new P.S.A. be developed for review by the 2007 Conference, the committee reviewed several concepts that had been submitted by different candidates for consideration. A subcommittee on Television Public Service Announcements was formed to coor-

dinate the selection of one concept for development of this P.S.A.

In October 2006 the trustee's Committee on Public Information recommended that the concept "A Force of Nature," submitted by TV Access, Inc., be developed as the 2007 TV P.S.A. After viewing a rough cut of the P.S.A. the committee made several suggestions for changes, and agreed to forward to the 2007 General Service Conference a revised version of the P.S.A. after review by the trustees' subcommittee on the 2007 P.S.A.

**Communications with the Media** — We reviewed the text and format of the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media and suggested that this year's letter be sent by e-mail *only*, and that requests for further information and feed back be evaluated and compared to previous years.

**Membership Survey** — The committee reviewed several suggestions for modifications to the A.A. 2007 Membership Survey Questionnaire, which has been forwarded as additional considerations of the 2006 Conference Committee on Public Information. After several discussions regarding the trustee's Committee on the General Service Conference's decision not to include a presentation on the "A.A. Membership Survey Process," as it would be in conflict with the Conference's long-standing practice of not discussing or making presentations on items that are on the agendas of Conference committees, the trustee's Committee on Public Information asked the staff secretary to work closely with the Conference coordinator to find a suitable way to share information about the survey process with Area Conference delegates, provided the Conference approves to conduct the 2007 A.A. Membership Survey.

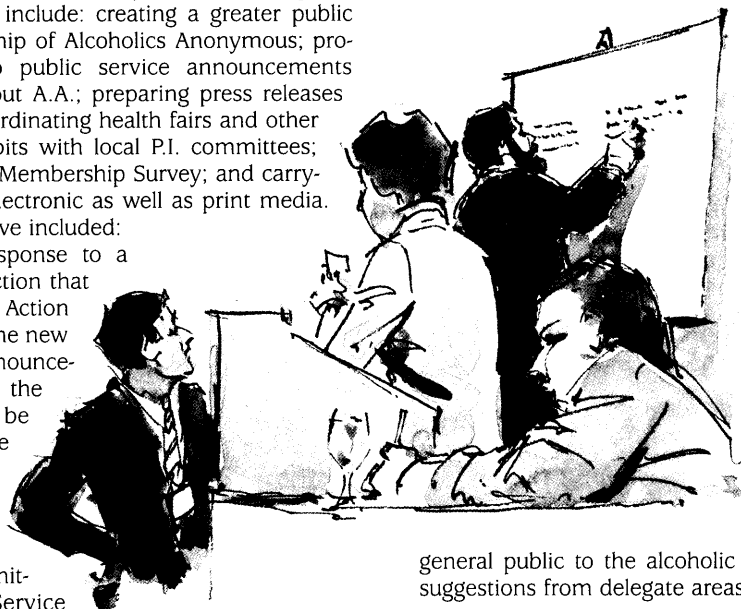
**Young People's Videos** — The committee reviewed the recommendation for the development of an idea to replace the current videos for young people ("Young People and A.A." and "A.A.: Rap With Us") and formed a subcommittee to develop new options and report back to the committee. We accepted a report from the subcommittee on Videos for Young People and, after careful research and consideration, agreed with the suggestion to request video/digital submissions from the Fellowship, with selected videos to be compiled and used in carrying the A.A. message to young people, and forwarded the suggestion to the Conference Committee on Public Information for consideration.

**Oversight of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site** — The committee reviewed quarterly reports from the A.A.W.S. Board regarding changes to the Web site, updates on Web site activity, and a summary of requests or correspondence from the Fellowship regarding the Web site and a summary of actions taken by the A.A.W.S. Board in response to those requests or correspondence. An annual report by the A.A.W.S. Board on the above areas, along with any additional comments from the trustees' Committee on Public Information, was forwarded to the 2007 Conference Public Information Committee.

The committee remains committed to do all they can to assist the membership in their service of carrying the message of recovery through the

general public to the alcoholic who still suffers, and welcomes suggestions from delegate areas as to what more can be done.

Ward Ewing, chairperson



**Staff report:** This assignment is charged with assisting the A.A. members who carry our message to the suffering alcoholic through the public—schools, health fairs, libraries, and all forms of the media. Below are some of the ways that this task is carried out:

- Communicate with over 700 P.I. committee chairpersons at the area, district and intergroup/central office or group level to provide them with Workbooks, Guidelines, and current shared information on Public Information activity.
- Provide literature to supplement the efforts of local Public Information committees which are serving as a resource about Alcoholics Anonymous at local health and community fairs.
- Provide P.I. committees with information regarding the production and distribution of television Public Service Announcements (P.S.A.s), and radio P.S.A.s, in order to enhance their efforts on the local level, and refer all media requests for P.S.A.s to local committees.
- Respond to all inquiries that come to the office from the media, providing them with accurate information about Alcoholics Anonymous.
- Read and process a number of newspaper, magazine and Internet feature stories that mention Alcoholics Anonymous, and receive information from members regarding anonymity breaks at the level of press, radio and films.
- Pass along instances of anonymity breaks in the media to the delegate in the area in which the break occurred, and provide them with an opportunity to contact the member and share experience regarding our Eleventh Tradition.
- Send out the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media. In March 2007 it was e-mailed to over 9,000 media outlets in the U.S. and Canada. This included daily and weekly newspapers, wire services, radio stations, and TV networks, stations and cable services.
- Coordinate the triennial A.A. Membership Survey. In 2004 the Survey was sent to over 700 groups in the United States and Canada, with instructions to delegates and to group representatives regarding timelines and instructions for responding. The results of triennial surveys are then published in pamphlet form and as a large format table display for visual information about Alcoholics Anonymous at public events.

The goal of Public Information work at G.S.O. is to see that the A.A. message of recovery reaches the still-suffering alcoholic by informing the general public about the A.A. program.

*Julio Espallat*

### STAFF COORDINATOR

**Staff report:** Services to A.A. groups are the heartbeat of the General Service Office. Eleven A.A. members make up the "G.S.O. Staff," with each person responsible for a functional assignment in addition to responding to requests from a specific region in Canada and the U.S., or from other countries. In 2006, the staff received 31,982 such requests by mail, e-mail or fax,

plus many phone calls daily. The staff coordinator helps to ensure that letters are answered when staff members are involved in large projects or away from the office to attend A.A. events, or at times of illness or vacation. All mail, e-mail, faxes, etc. are responded to within ten business days.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff trips to area assemblies, conventions, Regional Forums, and other large A.A. events, making sure that the office is adequately covered at all times. To further ensure that the work flow is smooth and adequately covered, assignments are divided into two units. Unit A consists of Cooperation With the Professional Community, Corrections, International Convention, Literature, Nominating, Public Information and Treatment Facilities. Unit B includes Conference, Regional Forums, Group Services, International, and staff coordinator.

G.S.O. staff has the benefit of the experience of A.A. groups gathered over many years. These resources are passed on to members who seek guidance for their group, central office, district or area assembly. Requests for guidance received from the Fellowship are often brought to weekly staff meetings, so that all responses reflect either research from A.A. literature or service material or the collective experience of G.S.O. staff and archives. Our weekly staff meetings provide a forum for sharing ideas on how to improve services to A.A. groups and members or how to provide the most complete answers to Fellowship inquiries. The staff coordinator chairs these weekly meetings and prepares a report on this sharing session which is distributed to heads of various G.S.O. departments for their information. G.S.O. staff members serve as secretaries to trustees' and Conference Committees and also are voting members of the General Service Conference. The staff coordinator is secretary to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

In 2006, G.S.O. welcomed a total of 1,762 individual and about 19 English and Spanish-speaking groups ranging in size from 10 to 50. Each visitor had an opportunity to see and hear how G.S.O. works during a tour of both G.S.O. and the Grapevine offices. Often visiting members and guests attend the open A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays. This is an opportunity for the G.S.O. staff to welcome A.A. members from all over the world or from around the corner.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance material, preparing the minutes of board meetings and gathering information on board activities that appears in the *Quarterly Report*. The staff coordinator has the privilege of serving as a director on A.A. World Services, Inc. in accordance with Concept IV, and also serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments. None of these activities would be possible without the dedication and skills of a very capable support staff.

*Eva Sanchez*



# Area Service Highlights — Panel 57 Delegates

(Only first-term delegates give Area Highlights)

**Alabama/Northwest Florida:** Area 1 has about 417 groups, 23 geographic districts and 11 Spanish groups within our linguistic district. It is not unusual to have all 24 districts represented at our quarterly assemblies in Montgomery, Alabama. Usual attendance is 350-400 with 125-135 G.S.R.s. We began implementing the committee system and our April 2007 assembly was a weekend pre-Conference Agenda. The Southeast Regional Forum in Atlanta in December had at least 66 attendees from Area 1. Our A.A. experience includes the Rainbow City Group in the Northeast Alabama mountains; in the Northwest are the quad cities groups of Florence, Sheffield, Tuscumbia and Muscle Shoals; headed south is Haleyville in the Free State of Winston County; Birmingham includes "5 points," the oldest A.A. meeting south of the Ohio River (1939), and the first Southeastern Conference in 1945. Montgomery is the home of Muir Jennings "Easy" E-sobriety Date November 15, 1942! The In-depth Big Book Study group of Pensacola, Florida, is one of many along the beautiful beaches of Gulf Shores Alabama, Fort Walton and Panama City, Florida. Ya'll come see us if you get a chance. — *Tim Donaldson*

**Arkansas:** Area 4 serves 12 districts with 281 active registered groups, including 17 active prison groups. We hold quarterly two-day assemblies at a central location. Our state convention, Old Grandad, celebrating 67 years of A.A. in Arkansas, is moving back to Hot Springs, July 27-29, 2007 at the historic Arlington Resort Hotel and Spa. This is the oldest convention west of the Mississippi and we are excited to return to a central location. Our Archives is one of the finest and is currently chaired by a past delegate who is our candidate for regional trustee. Our corrections committee is active in coordinating meetings behind the walls. Our treatment facilities committee is active and has an established Bridging the Gap program. C.P.C. and P.I. work closely, including workshops for districts. P.I. continues to distribute meeting schedules and display booths at health fairs. Our Grapevine committee has an extensive display at our assemblies and conventions. We have a group relations committee that comprises all our D.C.M.s. Our past delegates are active. It is humbling to serve an area that actively cares about our Twelfth Step responsibility. — *Nora Bromley*

**British Columbia/Yukon:** Area 79 includes the Yukon Territory, most of the province of British Columbia and two small sections of Washington State. It is the second largest delegate area in the North American service structure. Our area includes districts that are as big as California. We have over 700 groups in 46 districts. A trip from Vancouver to the north-west coastal community of Prince Rupert is just under one-quarter the length of Area 79 geographically (roughly 780 km/500 mi.). Actual road travel comes in at twice this length due to navigating around vast mountain ranges, rivers and lakes. So many of our members face the barriers of distance, terrain and sparse population that Area 79 created a standing committee on Remote Communities last term. Many districts and groups are only serviceable by ferry, small plane, boat or snowmobile. In spite of these challenges—or perhaps because of them—district participation at our annual area committee gatherings (two quarterlies, a Pre-Conference assembly and a voting assembly) averages about 90%. I am grateful and humbled to serve Area 79. — *Trish LaNauze*

**California (Central):** Area 93 has approximately 990 groups and 28 districts. We are beginning our seventh year as Area 93 and we just completed our second area inventory and will be implementing some changes as a result. We have five assemblies, a

Pre-Conference Workshop and five area committee meetings each year. Districts bid for the location of the assemblies. Our assemblies consist of new G.S.R. orientation, given by the alternate delegate, and the G.S.R. and D.C.M. sharing sessions. When we began Area 93, we started with some combined committees, such as PI/Website/Accessibility and Literature/Audio Virtual/Newsletter. So far, when asked if they wish to break off into stand alone committees and meet separately, the members have declined. Our C.P.C. committee has a project, called "Police and Corrections Teams," and has representation in every district. The next generation of trusted servants is in place, and we seek to carry the message and have a great time doing it! — *Debbie Johnson*

**California (Northern Coastal):** Area 6 has over 1,800 registered groups from the Oregon border, down through the Bay Area and all the way to Monterey. Of our 22 districts, four serve our Spanish-speaking groups. We host four assemblies per year, rotating throughout the area and our area committee meets monthly at a central location. Spanish interpretation is provided at both. At each area committee meeting, we have a D.C.M. and D.C.M.C. Sharing Session and our six standing committees meet, as well. Our four linguistic districts host a quarterly inter-district meeting. Most districts also host agenda topic workshops before our Pre-Conference assembly. We continue to strive toward providing all written communications in both English and Spanish. Participation in our sub-district structure is always a challenge. Consequently, many of our districts are re-evaluating the number and geographic boundaries of their sub-districts. We are also discussing the work load of our eight area officers, with emphasis on our area treasurer position. We look forward to hosting PRAASA 2009 in Oakland, California. — *Sharon Buckley*

**California (Southern):** Area 5 is one of the smallest geographic areas in the U.S. and Canada Conference, and is one of the more populated, with approximately 1,141 groups and 40,000 members. We have a very diverse membership—culturally and linguistically. We have four assemblies, four area committee meetings and a two-day Pre-Conference Workshop each year. Our combined and stand-alone districts have, as an immediate objective, to motivate the election of G.S.R.s at groups without one and to sponsor new G.S.R.s. To achieve that goal our districts have various events: Workshops, Unity Day, Third Legacy Meeting, Love and Service Seminar, What a Concept Lunch, the Spanish-Speaking General Service Foro, Appreciation Breakfast and more. Last year group contributions went up. This allowed the area to increase the contribution to G.S.O. in regard to delegate expenses at the Conference, and to buy four new computers for our area officers. — *Gustavo Trujillo*

**Colorado:** Area 10 has 600+ active registered groups in 34 districts. We also have one linguistic district. We hold three assemblies per year, from Friday through Sunday. Our districts bid to host assemblies and we encourage outlying districts to host assemblies. Hosting an assembly energizes and unifies a district as well as getting it more involved in service. Attendance at an assembly is usually about 125 G.S.R.s, most of our 44 D.C.M.s, all of our 17 elected officers and appointed standing committee chairs, and four or five past delegates. We have an annual state convention, held on or near Labor Day. We have just made our Web site committee a permanent part of our service structure. The Tradition of self-support is being heard loud and clear in Area 10. An ad-hoc committee appointed to look into assembly

financing has made some excellent recommendations. Our group contributions to G.S.O. are on the increase and our communication in all areas of our service structure has opened up. Thank you Alcoholic Anonymous for showing me how to live and giving me such an awesome life. — *Bill Fifield*

**Connecticut:** Area 11 has 9 geographic districts and one Spanish-speaking non-geographic district, with approximately 1,500 registered groups. The area holds 10 monthly area service meetings and two D.C.M./area chairperson meetings a year. We hold a pre-Conference assembly in March, with strong participation. We host a Spring Assembly to report back to the Fellowship the activities of the General Service Conference. We have 16 special service committees, four of which host area events including a Round Up in April, Soberfest (a summer get-together), area convention in September and CSCYPAA (Connecticut State Conference of Young People in A.A.), which hosts a convention in November. Two of our committees are liaisons with the Al-Anon Workshop and Convention. Our Answering Service Committee has continued to work on the coordination of a state-wide telephone number. We continue to expand communications with our Spanish-speaking district with the support of our Special Needs Committee, which also provides signers and literature in Braille. Area 11 is alive, well and sober! — *Pat McDonald*

**District of Columbia:** Area 13 is located in the metropolitan area of Washington, D.C., two counties in Maryland and Latino groups in Virginia. As a diverse area with many visitors we celebrate our deep roots in A.A. history. Washington D.C. is home to the first African-American group in A.A. The group's history is told in "Jim's Story" in the Big Book. This past year our Intergroup Archives Committee located the final resting place of Florence R. the very first woman in A.A. Florence's story, "Feminine Victory," is in the first edition of the Big Book. The second gay group in A.A. was in Washington D.C., and some of its members helped with the A.A. pamphlet for the gay alcoholic. The service structure of our three large Hispanic districts is about 30 years old and there are 43 active Latino groups. We have four assemblies and 11 committee meetings a year. A pre-Conference event informs the area of Conference agenda items and informs the delegate of groups' input on these topics. Over the years Area 13 general services and Washington Area Intergroup have forged a close working relationship. Visit us at our new web site, area 13aa.org. — *Kiki Roddy*

**Florida (North):** Area 14 has approximately 600 groups in 30 districts. Five of the districts have multiple D.C.M.s and we also have one Hispanic-At-Large District. We hold four area assemblies a year, and during each two-year period we invite our Southeast Regional Trustee for a visit the first year and a representative from G.S.O. the second year. Our Web site ([www.aanorthflorida.org](http://www.aanorthflorida.org)) has been averaging 2,000 hits per month. We recently elected a permanent archivist to assist in the preservation of the historic documents. Our area committee also meets with Area 15 several times a year to exchange information. We have active and well-established service committees. Workshops are held on a regular basis. Our past delegates participate in our quarterly assemblies by conducting Service Manual and Traditions Workshops. I am privileged to serve Area 14. — *Fred Heyne*

**Florida (South Florida/Virgin Islands/Antigua):** Area 15 is located between the Atlantic Ocean and the Gulf of Mexico. Our northern border runs from Vero Beach on the East to Hudson on the West, down through the Keys, and also includes some beau-

tiful islands out in the Caribbean. Our area has 17 districts, two of which are Hispanic; we have 1,697 registered groups. We hold quarterly weekend business meetings consisting of a speaker meeting; a night owl meeting; 12 committee meetings and workshops; an early bird meeting at 7:00 am, for both English- and Spanish-speaking attendees. We also have a Concept workshop in English and Spanish, usually presented by one or more of our past delegates. Attendance at these weekend meetings is usually 500-600, and over 700 at assemblies. Our 15 nonlinguistic districts are separated by county lines with some of our districts having more than one county within the district. We also have the second largest fresh water lake in the Continental U.S. — *Lake Okeechobee. — Bill Ouchie*

**Hawaii:** Area 17 has of 14 districts serving over 280 groups spread across the state of Hawaii on Oahu, Kauai, Maui, Molokai, Lanai and the Big Island of Hawaii. We are a diverse population that has drawn people from many ethnic backgrounds and countries and it is truly where east meets west. We are a remote community, with many of our districts located on different islands, but we as an area are separated by thousands of miles of ocean from the other areas of the U.S. and Canada. A substantial part of our budget is spent on travel to our assemblies and committee meetings rotating on various districts throughout the state. Our past Special Forum, PRAASA, the Pacific Regional Forum are a vital part of keeping our area service healthy. "Cooperation with the Elder Community" is a standing committee, the first in the U.S. and Canada. Our first "Seniors in Sobriety" Convention was held in Kona last year. The second will be held in May in Sedona Arizona. Our past delegates remain active and participate whenever asked. The message of hope is alive and well in Area 17. Mahalo Nui Loa. — *Vernon Gosney*

**Illinois (Chicago):** In 1948 the Chicago Group, with assistance from Bill Wilson, developed their service structure to Bill's idea of the proposed General Service Conference—thereby making Area 19 the first central office in A.A. history. Our booklet, "Chicago A.A. and How it Works for You" outlines our service structure and provides information on all roles and responsibilities of the committees and positions in the area. It presents the geographical boundaries of our 22 districts, which includes two Spanish-speaking districts, and the first Polish-speaking district in the United States. The area's "All Chicago Open" is an A.A. speaker meeting which has been celebrated every September for the past 68 years in remembrance of Chicago's first A.A. group. With attendance at the "All Chicago Open" ranging from 7,000 to 10,000 A.A.s., it is Chicago's largest A.A. meeting. The Chicago Area Service Assembly meets on the odd months of the year. We have nearly 3,500 weekly meetings, a 24-hour answering service, an area newsletter and an Area 19 Web site. Thank you, Chicago Area 19, and the Fellowship of A.A. as a whole, for this opportunity to be of service. — *Maurice Holman*

**Illinois (Southern):** Area 21 has more than 430 groups in 17 districts located in the bottom two-thirds of the state. We have four assemblies each year in varying locations; attendance at the quarterly assemblies average between 60 and 80 people. Two-thirds of the prisons in Illinois are located in Area 21, and we struggle to find and keep volunteers to carry the message inside the walls. We are going to have an area corrections conference in Springfield this October. Some of our districts have trouble filling all the committee chairs. These districts are large in area with very few meetings. We have two districts that have gone dark. We are working to correct this situation. In the past two years we have held several mini-forums/service workshops to interest more people in service. Our latest undertaking is to



implement an area inventory to determine if we are carrying the message of recovery to the districts and the groups as well as we should be. I am looking forward to visiting the 17 districts in our area in the next few months. In fellowship and service.  
— *Hugh Neavill*

**Indiana (Northern):** Area 22 consists of Northern Indiana, with boundaries just north of Indianapolis, to the Michigan line, and the Illinois border to the Ohio border. It is composed of 516 registered groups and 48 service districts; there are 10 standing committees. Area 22 has been a functioning area since 1986 when it split from Southern Indiana to better serve the growing number of groups. There are quarterly assemblies. The May assembly is dedicated to the delegates report. Two D.C.M. conferences are held in March and October, with the March Conference dedicated to getting feedback and a sense of the area's voice on Conference agenda items; the fall conference consists of topics and presentations to help D.C.M.s. The C.P.C. and Treatment committees were combined and there was a reorganization of the finance committee. We have started to do "Informational Forums," with presentation in areas of Northern Indiana with minimal or no activity in the assembly or committee. The coming year promises to be an adventure, with continued dedication in carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Leonard Smith*

**Iowa:** Area 24 is made up of 21 districts, 652 groups and 13,667 members. Over the past 18 months a committee has been working to develop an action plan for our Correctional Facilities Committee. This plan is a set of guidelines that will help address the challenges of rotation by creating a more permanent mailing address for the BTG program and the Pink Can Literature Fund. It also outlines a plan to keep our corrections committee work moving forward by holding workshops designated around specific state correctional facilities. In November we held our first area corrections workshop, behind the walls at the Mt. Pleasant Correctional Facility. We had 62 outside members and at least that many inside members at this day-long event. In March we have a service day to discuss the Conference agenda items and background information. In addition to these events, Area 24 holds three committee meetings and two assemblies per year. I am honored to serve this great area as their delegate to the 57th General Service Conference. — *Mike Maynard*

**Louisiana:** Recovery was a word used a lot by people in Louisiana last year. The dust and debris of Hurricanes Katrina and Rita have settled enough for us to understand that the transition period to the "new normal" will be a long one. Many of the affected areas are either back to normal or getting there. Meetings are being held in places where the population has returned. Some meetings folded because their members relocated, others because they lost their meeting place, but most have adapted to the changing situation and are up and running once again. Seventeen conferences and conventions take place each year around the state. Although those scheduled for the end of 2005 had to be cancelled, in 2006 all of our annual events took place. Our area assembly decided the experiment of two assemblies a year was not a success and voted to return to quarterly meetings. Since our primary purpose takes place at a local level, we are working on strengthening our districts, with our first delegate/D.C.M. retreat held this year. While the rest of the state is changing its most frequently used word to "rebuilding," we in Area 27 are still focusing on recovery, which begins with one alcoholic talking to another. — *Linda Seamon*

**Massachusetts (Eastern):** In his July 1965 Grapevine article, Bill W. could well have been writing about the spirit of unity in Eastern Massachusetts, when he said: "We see that the sun never sets upon A.A.'s Fellowship... we have everywhere begun to transcend the formidable barriers of race, creed, and nationality." In Area 30, newcomers, oldtimers, and everyone in-between is welcome at over 2,000 groups and meetings. With our neighbors from "The Golden West," we annually celebrate our spiritual heritage at the Massachusetts State Convention. We have 26 districts, with five intergroups and central offices from Worcester to Cape Cod, plus two Spanish districts and one Spanish Intergroup. From telephone volunteers at a central office anchored nearby Boston's historic harbor, to a young people Step meeting within walking distance of The Freedom Trail, from a men's meeting within a stone's throw of Plymouth Rock, to a women's meeting within earshot of Concord's Old North Bridge, from the magnificent Berkshires, to the teeming shores of Provincetown; the spirit of unity is alive and well in the Commonwealth of Eastern Massachusetts. — *Francis Gilroy*

**Michigan (Central):** Area 32 consists of the eastern half of Michigan's lower peninsula, except for the greater Detroit area, plus Monroe County. Area 32 has 14 districts and approximately 578 registered groups; 513 groups are active. We hold 12 area meetings a year, hosted by alternating districts, usually on the first Sunday of each month. We have an area inventory in November of each odd year. Michigan holds a statewide meeting every quarter, which includes all three areas. On the same day we have a statewide Corrections and a Grapevine/La Viña Meeting. Every three years Area 32 hosts the Michigan State Convention; we also hold a mock Conference in March to help prepare the three area delegates for the Conference. We are fortunate to have several past delegates and a past trustee that stay active in our area meetings, they bring a wealth of knowledge and information to the meetings. Our structure is solid and so is our commitment to carrying the message to the next suffering alcoholic that comes through our doors. — *Larry Sanford*

**Michigan (Southeast):** Area 33, which encompasses five counties, has 823 registered groups, divided into 25 districts, and an estimated membership of nearly 20,000. We meet the third Sunday of every month with eleven business assemblies and committee meetings annually. September is dedicated to a Service Fair workshop that is quite popular. We have seven past delegates active in area activities. Attendance has increased and we may soon outgrow our meeting space. We hold an annual week-end convention—the March Roundup—and every third year we host the Michigan State Convention. Proceeds from "jail pails" at the groups, and "jail sales" at the March Round-Up and State Convention, enabled our Corrections committee to distribute nearly \$10,000 worth of Conference-approved literature and "lots of Grapevines" to those incarcerated. We held a second annual "professional luncheon" attended by 95 professionals, including judges, lawyers, probation officers, therapists, psychologists, and police chiefs. It is both an honor and a privilege to serve as the Area 33 delegate. — *Bob Conley*

**Minnesota (Southern):** Area 36 has 27 districts serving approximately 1,150 groups. Every January we hold the Recovery, Unity and Service Conference, using the theme and presentation topics from the General Service Conference. We also hold three full-day area assemblies, four area committee meetings, and a delegate's workshop. During the delegate's workshop, the standing committees meet to discuss the Conference agenda items, and we share on each of these items. In alternate years we hold an area inventory. Our Remote Communities and Special Needs



Committee have been active. In 2005 we voted in a new linguistic district for Spanish-speaking groups, and we have purchased translation equipment for use at area or district events. We are also looking at making area meetings accessible to deaf A.A. members. In the last two years the Southern and Northern Minnesota areas have held joint workshops to foster communication and cooperation between the areas. My participation in A.A.'s service structure has provided many opportunities for growth and learning, and I am grateful to Area 36 A.A. members for their trust and support. — *Samira Anderson*

**Missouri (Eastern):** Area 38 covers about 32,000 square miles and has 520 registered groups and about 8,900 alcoholics in A.A. We have 23 districts, with 12 being considered rural. Our G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, standing committee chairs and area officers meet four times a year for one-day assemblies, except for our two-day election assembly. Our assembly includes sessions for G.S.R.s, D.C.M. w/delegate, D.C.M. Only, general service structure, plus our normal business and committee meetings, which helps prepare our delegate to attend the Conference. Our committee chairs are active. We are blessed to have many of our past delegates present at our assemblies. We are reviewing the function and procedures of our Archives, to find better ways to secure the history. We will be hosting the Southwest Region A.A. Service Assembly, October 10–12, 2008, which represents 11 areas from 7 states and usually has 600 to 800 attendees. In all, we are an enthusiastic and well-prepared group of trusted servants who are proud of Area 38. — *Patricia Basinger*

**Missouri (Western):** Area 39 consists of 59 counties, 16 districts and approximately 215 groups that meet together four times a year for our area assembly in Sedalia, Missouri, where we have held our assemblies since April 1983. At the two-day assembly, we have eleven standing committees and two subcommittees. Along with the committee conducting their business, we have G.S.R. and D.C.M. two-hour sharing sessions. Saturday evening the area officers and committee chairs give their reports and Sunday we have our area business meeting. We have two central offices, one in Kansas City, Missouri, and the other in Springfield, Missouri. I am very humbled and fearful at the same time to be able to represent Area 39 Western Missouri as delegate to the 57th General Service Conference. I am grateful that 18 years ago I was introduced to service at the group, district, and area levels. Thank God for Bill, Bob, and Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Ron Hubbard*

**Montana:** Area 40 covers most of the beautiful state of Montana. We have 14 districts and 280 registered groups, from the Host Springs Book Study to the Plentywood Group, over 800 highway miles apart. Every year we have two area assemblies, one in April, before the General Service Conference, and one in September. Our assemblies last a day and a half. At the spring assembly we discuss the Conference agenda items. Last fall we voted to try something new: Area Service Workshops, which are based on the concept of a Regional Forum. Our area advisor (the immediate past delegate) is responsible for organizing the workshops in collaboration with the local D.C.M.s from the districts where the workshops will be held. These services workshops will be held in smaller communities that do not already host one of the two annual Roundups. The first Workshops are scheduled for later this spring and early in the summer. I want to thank Area 40 for allowing me this opportunity to be of service. — *Andrew Ware*

**Nevada:** Area 42 covers 110,500 square miles of Nevada, as well as over 31,500 square miles of the central and northeastern

sides of the California Sierras. Crossing the Sierras in the winter can be “interesting,” and those communities are closer to Nevada “metropolitan” areas. The only parts of Nevada not in Area 42 are West Wendover and Jackpot—remote communities in the eastern and northern portion of the state, which are best served by Idaho and Utah. We have 12 active districts in the north, and one dark district. There are 10 active districts in the south, and one dark district. There are two broad-ranged Hispanic districts. Our area is divided into two sub-areas. We hold four SAGSC meetings (Southern Area General Service Committee) and six NAGSC (Northern Area General Service Committee) meetings a year. All area assemblies are held in Tonopah, halfway between the North and South. We rotate positions. In this rotation, the delegate, alternate chair, treasurer, alternate secretary and archivist were elected from the South. The alternate delegate, chair, alternate treasurer, secretary, and alternate archivist were elected from the North. We are a diverse lot, bound together to do the best we can for A.A. by being involved in group and area service. — *Michael Doheny*

**New Jersey (Northern):** Area 44 has 42 districts serving approximately 1,220 groups. These groups are represented by 38 D.C.M.s with four of our districts being clustered. The districts are grouped into six sections each with a leader. We have two very active Spanish-speaking districts and a permanent committees on Translations. Our seven standing committees are jointly chaired and operating in cooperation with Northern New Jersey Intergroup. We hold six area committee meetings a year, three area assemblies and one mini-Conference per year hosted by varying districts or sections. We conduct a year-end inventory at our annual Work Weekend held for three days at a Retreat House in Northern New Jersey. Area highlights include our mid-winter luncheon in February, our annual Convention in September, and committee workshops held throughout the year. Area 44 has an excellent Web site and you are invited to visit us at [www.nnjaa.org](http://www.nnjaa.org). I am humbled to be an active participant and trusted servant of the area and A.A. as a whole. — *John Mastrull*

**New York (Central):** Area 47 had its beginning in the 1940s, with A.A. groups in Binghamton, Syracuse, Rochester, Fulton, Newark, Cortland, Watertown, Ithaca, Elmira, Sayre, Corning and Geneva. There are 718 groups registered in our area today. Our area assembly meets in different cities every month and in June we have our Area 47 Convention to hear the delegate's report. There are usually from 65–70 voting members at each area assembly. We concentrate on the Conference agenda items in March and April. We collaborate with the other three New York Areas—48, 49, and 50—on the New York State Convention, and with the Northeast Region, 13 states from Maine to Maryland and including the District of Columbia, on NERAASA, NERD, NERF, and NYSIW Conventions. I was in St. Louis when Bill W. and Dr. Bob handed A.A. over to the Conference ...but I was in 6th grade. I am honored to be here. — *Liz Olmstead*

**New York (Southeast):** Area 49 is a diverse community with more than 1,700 registered groups in 137 districts. Our area covers urban, suburban and rural sections. With this diversity, we found that adding another level to our service structure, the counties, has worked for us. We have twelve counties and a non-geographical Spanish county represented by D.C.M. chairs. We have 13 intergroups and/or answering services, and hold five rotating area assemblies and seven area committee meetings a year, as well as a Delegate's Day of Sharing. Our area newsletter, *The Link*, is translated into Spanish, as are the minutes of area committee meetings and assemblies. We provide simultaneous translation at assemblies committee meetings and conventions.

We have a bulleting board on the Internet linked off our area Web site, which is devoted to sharing on a variety of subjects. We hold an area convention every year, except every fifth year when we host the New York State Convention. I thank my home group, my district, my county, my area and the Fellowship of A.A. for preparing me to be a part of this Conference. God bless and thank you all. — *John Wighton*

**North Carolina:** Area 51 is home to more than 15,000 alcoholics who belong to more than 900 regular and 64 corrections groups. After redistricting last year, those groups make up 37 geographical and two Spanish linguistic districts. We hold quarterly meetings, two in conjunction with our spring and fall area assemblies. We conducted our annual Area 51 Corrections Conference, Freedom From Bondage XIX, in Southern Pines in March, and our 60th annual North Carolina State Convention in Charlotte in July. Several years ago on the recommendation of an Ad Hoc Subcommittee on Subcommittees (only in A.A.!), we reduced the number of area standing subcommittees, thus freeing more D.C.M.s to participate on ad hoc subcommittees as needed. We have moved the Archives repository from Raleigh to Greensboro. We have developed and implemented on a trial basis an area Web site at [www.aanorthcarolina.org](http://www.aanorthcarolina.org). These are the sometimes unspectacular but important tasks that make good Twelfth Step work possible and ensure that the hand of A.A. always will be there when anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help. And for that we are all responsible. — *Newton Pritchett*

**North Dakota:** Area 52 has 3,137 members in 138 groups within 12 districts. Our area encompasses all of North Dakota and some groups from Northern Minnesota's western border. We hold three assemblies per year with our March assembly sharing its time with a service conference to better inform our Fellowship. In June, our assemblies are held in smaller towns, which cannot host a state roundup. In 2006 we held our first G.S.R. schools, one east and one west, to better inform our G.S.R.s. Our most recent past delegate, current delegate and alternate are involved in putting on the workshop. We have used the committee system at assemblies for many years with excellent results. Our members are active in prison/jails and treatment centers where we meet some of our future members. Our Web site, [aanorthdakota.org](http://aanorthdakota.org), is used regularly by members and nonmembers. I am humbled and honored to serve A.A. and Area 52. — *Phil Momerak*

**Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador:** Area 82 has 16 districts, ten in Nova Scotia, five in Newfoundland, and one district covering all of Labrador. There are approximately 235 groups with 3,300 active members. This covers a large and extensive geographic area in Eastern Canada with a total population of approximately two million. Travel involves long distances, covered by air, boat, and auto. We hold summer services weekends in each geographic province and a general assembly once a year. All districts are represented and travel expenses for the groups are a major topic of discussion. We average 30%-35% group attendance at these assemblies. We have intergroup offices in the major cities of Halifax and St. John's, with active committees. We have active committees at district and area levels and a special committee at the area level for Remote Communities. A few members carry the message into these places, providing literature, starting meetings, translating our literature into languages that are different from our own and building trust with the Inuit and aboriginal population. It is an honor for me to be here and to share the highlights from Area 82. — *Murdo MacKay*

**Ohio (Central Southeast):** Area 53 consists of 42 districts serving 38 counties, with over 600 groups. We hold quarterly assemblies and quarterly DCM/Area Committee meetings. There are ten standing committees that meet on a regular basis. The Corrections Committee hosts a weekend conference in October. The intergroups and the area sponsor a Unity Day in January. Prior to the Conference we hold a mini-conference, which provides the delegate with an informed group conscience. The Group Service Committee, along with the districts and D.C.M.s, host various service workshops throughout the year. The area provides a Web site, which is being updated, and a 24-hour voice mail. We participate in the planning of the Ohio State Convention, along with the other three areas in Ohio. Seven past delegates remain active and always willing to assist. I feel honored and grateful to be able to serve Area 53 and Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Sharon Farnsworth*

**Ohio (Northeast):** Area 54 embraces 20,000 members in 1,500 groups and 64 districts. Eight intergroup offices serve the area. We have a Web site. Each of our six area officers serves as a liaison to two or more of our eleven standing committees. Six area assemblies and three workshops per year keep our G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s informed and involved. A summer Open House Picnic and an autumn Gratitude Dinner are hosted by our districts. Inactive districts remain a challenge. Groups still receive the same level of service from the area whether or not they shoulder the shared responsibility of our Seventh Tradition. We held our 32nd Annual Mini-Conference in March modeled after the Conference. An informed area conscience prepares the delegate for the Conference. Our area hosted the East-Central Regional Conference of Delegates, past and present in February. We will also host the 2008 East-Central Regional Convention in conjunction with the 52nd Ohio State Convention. I am honored to serve, and humbled by the trust of my area. — *Jeff Your*

**Oklahoma:** Area 57 has 6,727 members, with 400 registered groups and eight districts. We have four area state committee meetings a year and one state assembly annually. We hold our State Conference in May, which alternates between Oklahoma City and Tulsa. Our service committees are active at the area and district level. We have been getting a large influx of folks coming to A.A. by way of our Drugs Court System in Oklahoma. For the past five or six years we have been going through the process on how and what to do with the potential A.A. members coming to the groups in our area A.A. meetings. C.P.C. and P.I. have played a big role in working with the drug court coordinators. Area 57 has been blessed with many trusted servants whose dedication to our Third Legacy helps to carry the message to that still-suffering alcoholic. I am grateful to be of service to Area 57 Oklahoma and the General Service Conference. — *Paul Alexander*

**Ontario (Eastern):** Area 83 encompasses an extensive land mass extending from Oakville on the west to the Quebec border on the east, north to Algoquin Park, and south to Syracuse, New York. We have 579 groups, which includes 20 correctional groups. The area consists of 28 districts and 5 intergroups—four English-speaking and one Spanish-speaking. In keeping with being an international area, one district is sponsoring an A.A. group at a Medical School on Saba Island, in the Caribbean. We hold three area meetings annually and two assemblies, with about 38% of our groups attending the assemblies. We have elected an area Archives chairperson and appointed an Area Archivist to assist district and group archivists. We are in the process of investigating the creation of an area Web site. We have implemented some changes at our Service Information Days to create more communication between groups, districts,

area and G.S.O. Area 83 is healthy and it is indeed an honour, as well as a truly humbling experience, to be able to represent this area as their delegate. — *Dot Dykstra*

**Ontario (Northeast):** Area 84 is composed of eight districts and approximately 162 groups. Our geographical area is from the North Pole to the southern tip of Manitoulin Island, to the west to Sault St. Marie on Lake Superior, and east and north another large area covering approximately 800 miles. In the past two years we have established a Remote Community Committee to carry the message to the far north. Our area hosted the Eastern Canada Regional Forum in the fall of 2006. It was a great success with over 400 in attendance. We are privileged to have a new medical school in our area and my goal is to have a link to A.A. with the new doctors in training. I would like to thank my area for their confidence and support to serve as their delegate. — *Moe Bradley*

**Ontario (Northwest):** Area 85 consists of 8 districts, 80 groups and approximately 1,600 members. There are about 10 unregistered groups, functioning on a casual basis, in remoter communities. Our area encompasses 260,000 square miles. In many areas there is over 100 miles between groups with only wilderness separating the communities. Travel is difficult in winter, but ice roads, and logging roads keep transportation affordable. Of the eight districts, there are only four D.C.M.s. Isolation tends to separate the unification of our service body, although there are very solid and active groups in districts without an active D.C.M. We have more aboriginal communities than all of Ontario. Many of these settlements are in communities accessible only by air or ice roads in winter. We expend time in corrections and district jails. Often, our membership is from economically depressed areas with unemployed or entry level workers. In spite of these impediments we continue to be self-supporting and each year our contributions increase. I am blessed to be the "messenger" for an area that is "black belt" A.A. — *Perry Marquis*

**Pennsylvania (Eastern):** Area 59 is home to over 1,400 A.A. groups and 31,000 members. The area committee, comprising 47 D.C.M.s and six area officers, conducts quarterly meetings. We have nine past delegates, six of whom are the committee members for our annual Convention/Assembly in the Pocono Mountains. In early April, we hold a Pre-Conference Sharing Session to discuss selected Conference agenda items and to enlighten the delegate. Other events include a D.C.M. orientation, an area inventory, a D.C.M. Sharing Session, and three mini-assemblies to hear the delegate's Conference report. We conduct Share-a-Day workshops, with some of the eleven Intergroups that serve 40 of our 47 districts, and hold a bilingual Share-A-Day with our Hispanic Intergroup. Area 59 hosted a broadcast of the 2005 International Convention Opening Flag Ceremony and cooperated with G.S.O. at a Special Forum for the City of Philadelphia. This summer Area 59 will hold an Area Day in the Park, a new outdoor event open to the Fellowship and their families. Area 59 is confident that the Fellowship of A.A. will continue to serve the needs of alcoholics worldwide. — *Sheila Dunne*

**Pennsylvania (Western):** Area 60 serves 28 counties in rural and metropolitan Western Pennsylvania. Over 800 groups are located in 44 districts. Area 60 incorporated in 2000 and achieved 501C-3 nonprofit status in 2002. Area 60 meets at a central location for four quarterly meetings and three assemblies, including a combined fall/election assembly in even years. Days of Sharing, hosted by one or several districts working together, offer opportunities for our members to share and

learn. Area officers carrying travel displays as needed visit districts and groups when invited. The "Conference format" of our Get-A-Way Service Weekend has increased awareness of how the Conference works. Those attending work in Conference committees, review the committee agenda items, and report their discussion and recommendations to our Pre-Conference Assembly. Area 60 wants to create excitement about service and participation and strong unity in recovery so that our doors remain open wide to provide a safe home for those still-suffering alcoholics. — *Janet Hollabaugh*

**Québec (Northeast):** Area 89, one of four areas in La belle province, has 23 districts, and 6,253 members. Most of the groups are French-speaking, but some are English-speaking. Several Native communities are part of Area 89. Our representative of the remote communities is available to help them. Even if the creation of groups is sometimes difficult, the natives are more and more open to the A.A. message. Our financial health is excellent. The area committees are very active. We have a journal, *Le Nordet* (which means a north-east wind), published every two months and giving news of the area, of the G.S.O. and information that can be interest to our members. We try to put emphasis on our Third Legacy. A few years ago, the four areas of Québec created the A.A. Québec's Web site. Three times a year, a provincial committee meets to discuss the orientation of our Web site. It is a privilege for me to be here today and I thank my Higher Power each day for the Grace that I have received. *Merci d'être dans ma vie! Thanks you to be in my life! Gracias por estar en mi vida!* — *France Jolicoeur*

**Québec (Southeast):** Area 88 covers a large geographic area, including the Eastern Townships, the Gaspésie peninsula (Gaspésie) and Magdalen Island's (Îles-de-la-Madeleine) in the St. Lawrence Gulf. We have 18 districts, approximately 190 groups and 3,000 members, mostly francophones. We hold four regional reunions yearly and one general assembly to elect our servants. In order to inform all our elected servants, we also have scheduled two extra days to forward information on services and duties for their home group, district, area and the G.S.O. We participate in three regional reunions along with Quebec—Areas 90, 89, 87. Two Gratitude lunches are held yearly: one east and one west of our area for the delegate to present the Conference report. Approximately one month prior to the Conference, each district holds a Sharing Day on the Conference agenda. The P.I. committee is responsible for our active Web site. A few decades have gone by since I joined A.A. "At first I was sleeping, dreaming life was Joy only. Suddenly I woke up to reality and understood that life was Service, that mean Joy and Enthusiasm." That I wish to everyone. — *Claude Matteau*

**Saskatchewan:** With approximately 50% of our groups being rural, most of the 21 D.C.M.s in Area 91 do a lot of traveling. The delegate travels about 9,000 kilometers annually to give the Conference report. We recognize the importance of our D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s to increase participation of our 300 groups. At our area committee meeting in January, we concentrated on giving our D.C.M.s the tools to communicate a positive message of general service. We are also centering efforts this year on a shortfall in our prudent reserve and on making our assemblies fun and attractive. We continue to move along carefully towards a Web site. Table officers remain prepared to travel to the northern regions or anywhere requested to carry the message of service, unity and recovery. On January 13 in Prince Albert, Cec C's 55th A.A. Anniversary celebration was a sellout. Cec was a Panel 7 delegate and past trustees came from all over the U.S. and Canada to express their love and gratitude to Cec, who, with

the other early delegates from Saskatchewan, set high ideals for those of us following to try to emulate. What an amazing legacy they left us! Now it's up to us. — *John Fraser*

**Texas (Northeast):** Area 65 has 29 districts, including five Spanish-speaking ones and approximately 512 groups. Our area covers over 70,000 square miles, with the Dallas/Ft. Worth metropolitan area in the center. We provide translation equipment and translators for participation at four assemblies, four area committee meetings, and one convention, in conjunction with our Fall Assembly each year. Our eleven standing Conference committee and chairpersons work to provide information and support to the groups and members. Our alternate chairperson coordinates workshops for districts and groups based on the Conference theme and any other requested A.A. topics. D.C.M.s chair our mock committees on final Conference agenda items so that our delegate will be well informed. Our continued goal is to locate A.A. groups that seem to want to be invisible. It is a privilege to be allowed to represent Area 65. When we keep our Traditions in the forefront, success will follow. — *Bill Neal*

**Texas (Southeast):** Area 67 covers about 3,000 square miles and has approximately 600 groups divided into 17 districts, four of which are Spanish speaking. We have three quarterly assemblies in Houston and the fourth during our annual Area Convention in January, which rotates between Houston, Beaumont, Galveston and College Station. We also have an annual Gratitude Dinner in November, and our Corrections committee holds an annual multilingual convention in September. All of our standing committee are active. Our Multilingual committee stays busy providing Spanish translation of all area functions. Our Web site provides events and service information. P.I. and C.P.C. continue to make presentations to schools, police training academies, medical professionals, and others. Like the other areas in Texas, Area 67 is eagerly looking forward to helping with the International in San Antonio in 2010. — *Gus Henry*

**Utah:** Area 69 has 12 districts, including our new nongeographical linguistic district. We have approximately 265 groups and 5,300 members. We meet at three assemblies and four committee meetings annually. Our D.C.M. attendance at meetings is reasonably good, but we need to figure out how to get more G.S.R.s participating. In 2006 we held our first annual Area Bridge the Gap workshop. We held the meeting in a dark district, doing a Twelfth Step call, so to speak, hoping to reactivate that district into area service. We also hosted the National Bridge the Gap workshop last year. One of the great successes of our P.I. committee was the development of a PowerPoint presentation that is being shown to all female, state inmates upon their release from prison. A similar presentation is being developed for the male inmates. In 2006 we had our first ever workshop held at the state prison in Draper, Utah. A speaker was brought in, our area chairs gave presentations, some of the inmates were able to share, and there was also sharing by facility administration on the value of our program behind the walls. It's great to work with so many people so dedicated to carrying the message of recovery in Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Julie Simiskey*

**Virginia:** Greetings from the Commonwealth of Virginia where we are celebrating the 400th anniversary of the founding of Jamestown, the first permanent English settlement in North America. I can safely say that this is also the 400th anniversary of the arrival of the first permanent alcoholics to our continent. Spring forward 333 years to 1940 when the first meetings of Alcoholics Anonymous were held in Virginia. A.A. in Virginia grew into the patch-quilt known as Area 71, which now has near-

ly 1,200 groups spread over 44 districts. While many Spanish-speaking meetings exist, we have not succeeded in attracting them to participate in area service as yet. Our groups give us strong financial support, but we could use more G.S.R.s at our assemblies. This year we are conducting an area inventory. The hot discussion at our recent assemblies has been whether to expand the use of our Web site beyond Public Information. The 65th Southeastern Conference will be held in Virginia, August 2008. Above all, we have fun and share great joy to be sober alcoholics in the A.A. Fellowship. — *Ted Kroll*

**Washington (Western):** Area 72 reaches from the Canadian border in the north to the Oregon border to the south and from the Cascade Mountains in the east to the Pacific Ocean to the west. We are almost 1,200 groups serving in 41 districts. Two districts are linguistic. We also have two deaf populations, as well as more groups forming in languages other than English. Western Washington is home to many Native North American tribes, but few of the groups on their reservations have ever been represented at our assembly. We have established an area Web site and continue to work toward using technology to help us carry the message and communicate with our members. We have strong standing committees. One of our groups that meets behind the walls of a correction center will be hosting our Area Corrections Committee's Quarterly meeting in June. This is a day-long meeting and workshop about service in corrections. Since our area split in 1995, we have grown dramatically and continue to expand our efforts to serve the alcoholic who still suffers. — *Gail Harris*

**West Virginia:** Area 73 has over 300 groups in 16 districts, arranged into seven geographical regions. We hold spring and fall business assemblies, in addition to a summer area convention. The locations of the assemblies and the area convention are rotated among the regions. Usually, each district is represented, in spite of the fact that, because of the rural, mountainous nature of the state, some have to travel a long distance. The sole purpose of Area 73 is to carry the A.A. message to the still-suffering alcoholic. The area committee does this by providing literature, working with professionals and the public, and by taking the message into prisons, hospitals and treatment facilities. Our answering service through an 800 number and a Web site is receiving over 300 calls per month. Our Web site [www.aawv.org](http://www.aawv.org), posts and updates state-wide meeting schedules and includes information on area events, and more. It is an honor to be allowed to serve Area 73 as delegate. — *Jim Withrow*

**Wisconsin (Southern):** Area 75 consists of over 900 registered groups and 32 districts. We hold two agenda planning meetings and two pre-Conference assemblies a year, in addition to the two assemblies held in conjunction with our spring and fall conferences. Our Corrections committee continues to carrying the A.A. message into a wide variety of correctional institutions. We fund A.A. literature for these facilities through our Rainbow Can project, and provide many Grapevine and La Vña subscriptions to inmates through our Count on Us program. Corrections and Treatment cooperate well with our Bridging the Gap committee. Our Special Needs committee has distributed an accessibility survey for use by our groups, and our P.I. committee is improving our Web site. Our Archives committee has found a permanent location and it is open to members of the Fellowship every other Sunday. We have added the position of area registrar to facilitate collecting and maintaining accurate group records and we eagerly await implementation of the "Fellowship New Vision." This year we are looking forward to hosting the East Central Regional Conference. I am blessed to be a member of Alcoholics Anonymous. — *George Possley*

<sup>1</sup>Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

## ***Additional Committee Considerations***

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the *Final Report*." All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

### **AGENDA**

- The committee reviewed the General Service Conference Evaluation Form. In response to a request for sharing from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference on the question of participation by service category, the committee agreed that the question remain on the Evaluation Questionnaire. While the responses from the question may not affect the planning of future Conferences, it was felt that the publication of the responses in the Evaluation Summary provides an opportunity for Conference members to check their own participation, and may open communication with others on how they viewed this topic.

### **ARCHIVES<sup>1</sup>**

- The committee accepted the "Sound and Video Access Policies" and expressed gratitude for the hard work in developing this General Service Board policy clarifying procedures and limitations for accessing the archival recordings of the General Service Office Archives.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Archives Workbook and accepted the revisions.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Archives Committee consider developing new format(s) for the Archives Workbook. Suggestions included a 3-ring binder and/or a CD format, from which pages and forms could easily be updated, copied, downloaded, and/or printed.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Archives Committee consider developing language for the Archives Workbook and/or a service piece that would help foster awareness of copyright issues in local, district, and area archives projects.
- The committee forwarded to the 2008 Policy/Admissions Committee a request to consider that the Conference Archives Committee be established as a permanent Conference committee.

### **COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY**

- The committee reviewed the "Progress Report on Video Segments Directed to Professionals" from the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, and viewed a preliminary clip of the C.P.C. video directed to medical professionals. The committee offered several suggestions to the Publications Director and video production vendor regarding script pacing, content, content security, and the general direction of the video.

The video segments directed to professionals in the employment/human relations, legal/criminal justice, and medical fields will be brought back to the 2008 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community.

<sup>1</sup>Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

- The committee reviewed the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook, and suggested two minor changes to the C.P.C. Workbook, which will be forwarded to the Publications Department.

- The committee recognized that local C.P.C. committees could benefit from easier access to the C.P.C. Workbook, and suggested that placement of the C.P.C. Workbook on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site be considered by A.A. World Services, Inc.

- The committee agreed that sending letters introducing A.A. and supplying A.A. literature to professionals are valuable C.P.C. service projects. The committee stressed the importance of one-on-one contact with professionals, noting that personal contact with professionals is essential to effective C.P.C. service.

- The committee recognized the value of utilizing professionals who are friends of A.A. at local A.A. events with the goal of stimulating interest in C.P.C. service. This approach can generate enthusiasm in the Fellowship for C.P.C. service, and enthusiasm is a critical component of effectively reaching professionals.

### **CORRECTIONS**

- The committee reviewed the Corrections Workbook and suggested one change and one correction to the service piece "A.A. Corrections Prerelease Contact Information" (F-162), which will be forwarded to the Publications Department.

- The committee discussed various ways to stimulate corrections Twelfth Step work; these included:

- Utilizing the video *Carrying The Message Behind these Walls* more effectively.
- Creating Power Point presentations about A.A. corrections service including photos and discussion topics.
- Hosting A.A. round-ups inside correctional facilities similar to those previously shared about in *Box 4-5-9*.
- Mentioning in G.S.O.'s welcome letter to Corrections chairs that G.S.O. staff collects sharing on local corrections workshops and events.
- Sending sharing on local corrections workshops and events to G.S.O.
- Discussing ideas in areas and districts regarding ways to collect money to purchase literature for local correctional facilities.
- Including local corrections events on area Web sites.
- Introducing someone to corrections service by bringing them to corrections events and/or A.A. meetings on the inside.
- Listing Corrections chairs with G.S.O. so they receive useful corrections-related material and communications.
- Sharing about corrections service experience with excitement and enthusiasm.
- Encouraging ex-inmate A.A. members to participate in corrections service.
- Creating calendar of corrections events around U.S. and Canada.

### **FINANCE**

- The committee suggests that the phrase "G.S.R. travel expenses to attend service functions" be added to A.A. service material

where appropriate when describing expenses in need of support.

- The committee discussed a request to "Develop a communication plan for the purpose of increasing the level of group participation and self-support within the Conference structure" and after considerable discussion took no action.
- The committee discussed a request to eliminate volume discounts on literature orders and agreed with the A.A.W.S. practice of allowing volume discounts on literature orders.
- The committee discussed a request to incorporate shipping costs into literature pricing, and agreed that the A.A.W.S. practice of shipping charges is appropriate.

### GRAPEVINE

- The committee agreed to forward to the A.A. Grapevine Board the suggestion that the A.A. Grapevine produce in the year 2008 or later:
  - a collection of Grapevine stories by people with 40 or more years of sobriety, and;
  - a book of classic cartoons and jokes from the A.A. Grapevine.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook and suggested that the sample presentation in Appendix IV be updated.
- The committee encouraged the Grapevine to explore less expensive formats for production of the workbook.
- The committee again urged the A.A. Grapevine Board to produce a Spanish translation of the A.A. Grapevine workbook as soon as financially possible.

### INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS'

- The committee discussed the site-selection procedures for the 2020 International Convention. The committee noted that selecting an International Convention site twelve years out prevents us from having to compete for sites and yet allows us to have enough information about the site city to make a good decision.
- The committee discussed the concept and details of Local Forums as approved by the General Service Board. It was noted that the new Local Forums format specifies that some expense, such as site rental, will be the responsibility of the Local Forum organizing committee. The diversity of the purpose of Local Forums was emphasized. In addition to large gatherings, there can be smaller gatherings to present Forum and local service information to selected A.A. communities and to respond to specific needs of these communities.

There were questions about Local Forums attendance by a General Service Board trustee and a member from either the General Service or the Grapevine Office. Starting July 2008 there will be an annual inventory of the new Forum schedule by the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums to review Forum experience with the new Forum schedule and to respond to any questions about implementation of the Forum schedule.

- The committee discussed the following ways to encourage interest in Forums:

- Emphasize the importance of A.A. members talking to A.A. members about Forums.
- Use translators to communicate Forum information.
- Emphasize that it is more effective if local delegates, districts, groups and A.A. members take responsibility for providing information about Forums rather than relying on the General Service Office's mailing of registration forms.
- Encourage use of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site to find Forum registration forms, Forum information and hotel information.
- Encourage A.A. members to use G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site as a source for Forum Final Reports to find out what happened at past Forums and what Forums are like.
- Be an example of an enthusiastic Forum attendee.
- Emphasize interesting things you can learn at a Forum such as "Where does A.A.'s money go?"; "Do you want to get to know your literature?"
- Include Forum registration forms with catalogs in literature orders sent to central offices and intergroups.

### LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed the trustees' Literature Committee progress report on revisions to the "A.A. for the Native North American" pamphlet and expressed appreciation that the story submission deadline was extended until June 30, 2007 to provide a greater opportunity for Native North American A.A. members to share their stories. The committee looks forward to reviewing a draft of the revised pamphlet at the 2008 General Service Conference.
- The committee discussed at length requests to develop an intergroup/central office pamphlet and took no action. As the structure and function of intergroup/central offices vary greatly throughout the United States and Canada, it was the consensus of the committee that, where a need may exist for an intergroup/central office pamphlet, it can be addressed locally.

The committee also felt that sufficient information is available about intergroup/central offices in existing A.A. Conference-approved literature and service material, including "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, *The A.A. Service Manual*, and A.A. Guidelines on Central and Intergroup Offices.

- The committee considered a request to produce a pamphlet to replace the discontinued "Letter to a Woman Alcoholic" and took no action.

### POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee accepted the final report from the General Service Board Ad Hoc Regional Composition and Structure Inventory Committee and expressed appreciation regarding the complexity of the issues that were discussed at length by the Board's Ad Hoc Committee.

The committee requested that the General Service Board provide a summary of the board's discussions on the inventory questions for board consideration that were listed in the final report, which pertain to regional composition and structure and, if completed, forward the summary to the 2008 Conference Committee on Policy Admissions.



## PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the 2006 Annual Report from the trustees' Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and noted the detailed information provided and the thoughtful consideration given to all items involving the G.S.O. A.A. Web site.
- The committee reviewed information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the Public Service Announcement "Testimonials."
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and suggested that the language in the Workbook be revised to reflect current Conference Advisory Actions and experience regarding how to handle anonymity breaks by A.A. members at the public level.

## REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee reviewed a list of duties of a district committee member chairperson (D.C.M.C.) and requested that a "service piece" be developed for inclusion in the D.C.M. Kit.
- The committee considered a recommendation from the General Service Board that the following text be added to Chapter Nine in *The A.A. Service Manual* where appropriate:

"The intent of forming regions was to create a vehicle by which regional trustees could be added to the General Service Board and a way to provide a cross section of people who would serve A.A. as a whole—not in a representative capacity. To allow for a balanced rotation, elections of regional trustees are staggered in order that there may be a relatively even flow of new trustees coming onto the board. It was not until 1962 that the formal naming of regions occurred and a redistribution; and, soon afterwards the formation of new regions."

and took no action.

- The committee considered a recommendation from the General Service Board that the sentence, "Regional trustees bring to the board's discussions a regional point of view and experience that is invaluable," in Chapter Nine: The General Service Board, p. S62 in *The A.A. Service Manual*, 2006-2007 Edition, be replaced so that the section reads:

"While no trustee can be said to "represent" a geographical section—all trustees represent only the Fellowship as a whole—regional trustees bring to the board's discussions a diversity of A.A. experience that is invaluable."

and took no action.

- The committee considered a suggestion to include the committee scope from each Conference Committee Composition Scope and Procedure document in the Standing Committee section in the Chapter on Conference Committees and took no action.
- The committee considered and accepted a suggestion that the first sentence in the last paragraph of the preface to *Twelve Concepts of World Service*, which reads: "A 'short form' of the Concepts was prepared by the 1974 General Service Conference for inclusion in *The A.A. Service Manual*," be corrected to read as follows:

"A 'short form' of the Concepts was recommended by the 1974 General Service Conference for inclusion in *The A.A. Service Manual*."

- The committee considered a suggestion that the section on "Past Delegates," in *The A.A. Service Manual*, be moved from pages S43-44 and inserted, as amended, in Chapter Six, p. S47, after the discussion on "The Alternate" and took no action.
- The committee considered a suggestion that the terms L.C.M. (Local Committee Member) and D.C.M.C. (District Committee Member Chairperson) be added to the glossary on pages S18-19, and took no action. The committee requested that the Publications Department place a reference to D.C.M.C. in the Index.
- The committee considered a request to have A.A.W.S. discontinue publishing regional directories (Canada, Western U.S., and Eastern U.S.) and took no action.
- The committee considered a suggestion that the second to the last full sentence under Qualifications (page S29) in *The A.A. Service Manual* be amended to read: "A D.C.M. should have enough sobriety, generally four or five years" and took no action.
- The committee considered a suggestion to add to the A.A. Directories (Canada, Western U.S., and Eastern U.S.) a separate subsection within the section "INTERNATIONAL CORRESPONDENCE MEETINGS" for listing "Online Intergroups" that request to be listed, and that online Intergroups thus listed provide an e-mail and/or Web site address to be included in the directories and took no action.
- The committee reviewed the *Final Conference Report* and suggested that the publications department consider increasing the font size for future publications. The committee also wished to convey its thanks and appreciation for the artist's continued excellence in providing high quality illustrations to be included in the *Final Conference Report*.

## TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee suggested that the DVD *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* be inserted in the complimentary Treatment Facilities Kit sent to each new Treatment Facilities area committee chair.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities gather sharing from the Fellowship on how to stimulate interest in Treatment Facilities Twelfth Step work. This sharing is to include information such as:
  - Service material that has been locally produced.
  - Reports on events that have been held.
  - Examples of how sponsorship has proven to be an effective tool.

The committee is particularly interested in having samples of existing local service information available as background material to assist the 2008 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities' discussion on the possible development of Conference-approved literature and/or service material to stimulate A.A. members' interest in Treatment Facilities Twelfth Step work.

- The committee forwarded to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board a suggestion that it consider producing a special section in the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña once a year on Treatment Facilities Twelfth Step work.
- The committee discussed the need for more input from the Fellowship in the area of carrying out our Twelfth Step responsi-

bility regarding Treatment Facilities service. Based on a lack of agenda items, the committee discussed the possibility of merging with another Conference committee, and concluded that the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities is still viable.

## TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the résumés and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for Northeast and Southwest regional trustees and for trustee-at-large/Canada.
- The committee reviewed with approval the résumé of Terrance M. Bedient to serve as a consultant on the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee commencing with the July 2007 committee meeting.
- The committee accepted with appreciation the "Appeal to the General Service Conference" dated April 11, 2007 concerning the decision made in the January 2007 executive session of the General Service Board not to begin a search for a new general manager of the General Service Office.

In keeping with the importance of the principle of assuring us that the minority opinion will be heard, as outlined in Concept V, the Conference Committee on Trustees requests that this "Appeal to the General Service Conference" be given a full hearing at the next scheduled executive session of the General Service Board.

In addition, the committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Nominating review Procedure No. 9 of their Composition, Scope and Procedures—"Guidelines for Hiring the General Manager, G.S.O."—and clarify the language which refers to the length of service for that position. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Nominating forward a final report to the 2008 Conference Committee on Trustees.

## RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN A CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

### REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee recommended that the first sentence of the first paragraph in the "The Area Assembly" section of Chapter Four in *The A.A. Service Manual* which reads: "Any meeting of area G.S.R.s, and the area committee (see Chapter Five) is an assembly," be changed to read as follows:

"Any meeting of area G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s and the area committee (see Chapter Five) is an assembly."

## TRUSTEES

- The committee recommended that the existing sentence pertaining to regional trustees in the Bylaws of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., be amended to read.

"Class B regional trustees are expected to contribute their time basically during the four periods of the year, viz., each three-day period ending on the day of each quarterly meeting of the trustees of the General Service Board, and, in addition, *to provide the Board their views and opinions regarding policy matters based on Fellowship-wide experience.*"

Note: As it exists in *The A.A. Service Manual, 2006-2007 Edition*, p. S110, that sentence reads:

"Class B regional trustees are expected to contribute their time basically during the four periods of the years, viz., each three-day period ending on the day of each quarterly meeting of the trustees of the General Service Board, and, in addition, *to advise the Board with respect to regional views and opinions regarding policy matters.*"

## FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- The background material on the "Appeal to the General Service Conference" dated April 11, 2007 and reviewed by the Conference Committee on Trustees, be provided to all members of the 57th General Service Conference. (**Conference voted not to consider**)
- That the hospital scene appearing in the corrections video, previously approved, be deleted. (**Not Approved**)
- That the information media presentation introducing A.A. to training academies and in-service training for corrections personnel be edited to include at least one mention and display of our magazines, *The A.A. Grapevine* and *La Viña*, together with French and Spanish A.A. books and pamphlets. (**Not Approved**)
- That a pamphlet on intergroup/central offices be developed and that a draft copy or a progress report be brought back to the 2008 Conference Committee on Literature. (**Conference voted not to consider**)



The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.  
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.  
**CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION**

December 31, 2006 (with comparative totals for 2005)

|                                                                                                                                                         | General Service Board of A.A. |                   |                          |                                | A.A. World<br>Services, Inc. | A.A.<br>Grapevine, Inc. | Consolidated<br>2006 | Consolidated<br>2005 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
|                                                                                                                                                         | General<br>Fund               | Reserve<br>Fund   | Capital Projects<br>Fund | Postretirement<br>Medical Fund |                              |                         |                      |                      |
| <b>ASSETS</b>                                                                                                                                           |                               |                   |                          |                                |                              |                         |                      |                      |
| Cash                                                                                                                                                    | \$ 1,140,040                  | \$ 2,069,090      |                          |                                | \$ 740,191                   | \$ 314,787              | \$ 4,264,108         | \$ 3,071,272         |
| Accounts and interest receivable                                                                                                                        |                               | 113,915           |                          |                                | 267,357                      | 90,527                  | 471,799              | 629,234              |
| Intercompany balances                                                                                                                                   | (1,292,962)                   | (1,629,400)       |                          | \$ 228,092                     | 1,105,755                    | 1,588,515               | -                    | -                    |
| Inventories                                                                                                                                             |                               |                   |                          |                                |                              |                         |                      |                      |
| Books, pamphlets, etc.                                                                                                                                  |                               |                   |                          |                                | 1,904,321                    | 224,879                 | 2,129,200            | 2,259,179            |
| Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.                                                                                                                      |                               |                   |                          |                                | 358,611                      | 2,780                   | 361,391              | 109,044              |
| Investments - at fair value                                                                                                                             |                               |                   |                          |                                |                              |                         |                      |                      |
| U.S. Treasury Notes and Bills due<br>2007/2014 (Cost: 2006 - \$9,383,726<br>2005 - \$9,886,504)                                                         |                               | 9,453,464         |                          |                                |                              |                         | 9,453,464            | 9,982,857            |
| Property and Equipment                                                                                                                                  |                               |                   |                          |                                |                              |                         |                      |                      |
| Leasehold improvements,<br>computer hardware and software,<br>(net of accumulated depreciation -<br>2006 - \$3,537,039;<br>2005 - \$3,304,400) (Note 2) |                               |                   | \$ 682,961               |                                | 230,096                      | 11,896                  | 924,953              | 650,165              |
| Deferred charges and deposits                                                                                                                           | 35,841                        |                   |                          |                                | 74,332                       | 56,220                  | 166,393              | 163,431              |
| Prepaid conventions - 2010/2015/2020                                                                                                                    | 174,094                       |                   |                          |                                |                              |                         | 174,094              | 117,801              |
| <b>Total Assets</b>                                                                                                                                     | <u>57,013</u>                 | <u>10,007,069</u> | <u>682,961</u>           | <u>228,092</u>                 | <u>4,680,663</u>             | <u>2,289,604</u>        | <u>17,945,402</u>    | <u>16,982,983</u>    |
| <b>LIABILITIES</b>                                                                                                                                      |                               |                   |                          |                                |                              |                         |                      |                      |
| Accounts payable                                                                                                                                        |                               |                   |                          |                                | \$ 781,595                   | \$ 98,229               | \$ 879,824           | \$ 1,107,285         |
| Accrued royalties                                                                                                                                       |                               |                   |                          |                                | 43,210                       |                         | 43,210               | 37,786               |
| Deferred income                                                                                                                                         |                               |                   |                          |                                |                              |                         |                      |                      |
| - Orders and subscriptions                                                                                                                              |                               |                   |                          |                                | 39,467                       | 1,734,380               | 1,773,847            | 1,612,628            |
| Accrued postretirement health benefits                                                                                                                  |                               |                   |                          | \$ 4,028,210                   |                              |                         | 4,028,210            | 3,892,640            |
| Accrued pension benefits                                                                                                                                |                               | \$ 1,661,941      |                          |                                | 28,287                       | 2,174                   | 1,692,402            | 2,419,228            |
| <b>Total Liabilities</b>                                                                                                                                | <u>-</u>                      | <u>1,661,941</u>  | <u>\$ -</u>              | <u>4,028,210</u>               | <u>892,559</u>               | <u>1,834,783</u>        | <u>8,417,493</u>     | <u>9,069,567</u>     |
| Net Assets (Exhibit B)                                                                                                                                  | 57,013                        | 8,345,128         | 682,961                  | (3,800,118)                    | 3,788,104                    | 454,821                 | 9,527,909            | 7,913,416            |
| <b>Total Liabilities and<br/>Net Assets</b>                                                                                                             | <u>57,013</u>                 | <u>10,007,069</u> | <u>682,961</u>           | <u>\$ 228,092</u>              | <u>4,680,663</u>             | <u>2,289,604</u>        | <u>17,945,402</u>    | <u>16,982,983</u>    |

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.  
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

**Exhibit B**

**CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF ACTIVITY**

Year Ended December 31, 2006 (with comparative totals for 2005)

|                                                                       | General Service Board of A.A. |                 |                          |                                | A.A. Grapevine, Inc.         |              |                     | Consolidated<br>2006 | Consolidated<br>2005 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------|--------------|---------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
|                                                                       | General<br>Fund               | Reserve<br>Fund | Capital Projects<br>Fund | Postretirement<br>Medical Fund | A.A. World<br>Services, Inc. | English      | Spanish<br>Magazine |                      |                      |
| <b>INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE</b>                                  |                               |                 |                          |                                |                              |              |                     |                      |                      |
| Gross Sales                                                           |                               |                 |                          |                                | \$ 12,006,989                | \$ 2,580,900 | \$ 116,820          | \$ 14,704,709        | \$ 14,559,677        |
| Less: Discounts                                                       |                               |                 |                          |                                | 325,971                      | 68,468       | -                   | 394,439              | 377,432              |
| <b>Net Sales</b>                                                      |                               |                 |                          |                                | 11,681,018                   | 2,512,432    | 116,820             | 14,310,270           | 14,182,245           |
| Cost of Literature Distributed                                        |                               |                 |                          |                                |                              |              |                     |                      |                      |
| Printing                                                              |                               |                 |                          |                                | (3,164,182)                  | (415,490)    | (42,090)            | (3,621,762)          | (3,925,559)          |
| Royalties on books                                                    |                               |                 |                          |                                | (169,591)                    | -            | -                   | (169,591)            | (164,798)            |
| Direct shipping and warehousing                                       |                               |                 |                          |                                | (1,472,008)                  | (577,938)    | (33,483)            | (2,083,429)          | (1,887,109)          |
| <b>Gross Profit from Literature</b>                                   |                               |                 |                          |                                | 6,875,237                    | 1,519,004    | 41,247              | 8,435,488            | 8,204,779            |
| <b>CONTRIBUTIONS</b>                                                  | \$ 6,068,162                  |                 |                          |                                |                              |              |                     | 6,068,172            | 5,417,046            |
| 2005 International Convention (Net of direct expenses of \$3,958,372) | -                             |                 |                          |                                |                              |              |                     | -                    | (39,040)             |
| <b>INVESTMENT INCOME</b>                                              | 3,986                         | \$ 377,133      |                          | \$ 2,100                       | 4,778                        | 68,172       | -                   | 456,169              | 248,108              |
| <b>Total Income</b>                                                   | 6,072,158                     | 377,133         |                          | 2,100                          | 6,880,015                    | 1,587,176    | 41,247              | 14,959,829           | 13,830,893           |
| <b>FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES (Exhibit C)</b>                                |                               |                 |                          |                                |                              |              |                     |                      |                      |
| Program                                                               | 5,224,259                     |                 |                          | -                              | 2,305,877                    | 1,006,710    | 113,251             | 8,650,097            | 7,878,237            |
| Supporting services                                                   | 3,047,753                     | (757,287)       | \$ 149,456               | (90,422)                       | 1,716,400                    | 629,339      | -                   | 4,695,239            | 5,062,350            |
| <b>Total Expenses</b>                                                 | 8,272,012                     | (757,287)       | 149,456                  | (90,422)                       | 4,022,277                    | 1,636,049    | 113,251             | 13,345,336           | 12,940,587           |
| <b>EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR</b>                            | (2,199,854)                   | 1,134,420       | (149,456)                | 92,522                         | 2,857,738                    | (48,873)     | (72,004)            | 1,614,493            | 890,306              |
| <b>INTERCOMPANY AND INTERFUND TRANSFERS</b>                           |                               |                 |                          |                                |                              |              |                     |                      |                      |
| GSB La Viña support                                                   | (72,004)                      | -               | -                        | -                              | -                            | -            | 72,004              | -                    | -                    |
| Other Transfer                                                        | 2,271,858                     | 4,268,640       | 398,969                  | (3,892,640)                    | (3,020,827)                  | (26,000)     | -                   | -                    | -                    |
| <b>CHANGE IN NET ASSETS FOR YEAR</b>                                  | -                             | 5,403,060       | 249,513                  | (3,800,118)                    | (163,089)                    | (74,873)     | -                   | 1,614,493            | 890,306              |
| <b>NET ASSETS</b>                                                     |                               |                 |                          |                                |                              |              |                     |                      |                      |
| Beginning of year                                                     | 57,013                        | 2,942,068       | 433,448                  | -                              | 3,951,193                    | 529,694      | -                   | 7,913,416            | 7,023,110            |
| <b>NET ASSETS</b>                                                     |                               |                 |                          |                                |                              |              |                     |                      |                      |
| End of year (Exhibit A)                                               | 57,013                        | 8,345,128       | 682,961                  | (3,800,118)                    | 3,788,104                    | 454,821      | -                   | 9,527,909            | 7,913,416            |

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.  
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.**

**CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES**

**Exhibit C**

Year Ended December 31, 2006 (with comparative totals for 2005)

| <b>OPERATING EXPENSES</b>                       | <b>Group<br/>Services</b> | <b>Fellowship<br/>Services</b> | <b>General<br/>Service<br/>Conference</b> | <b>World<br/>Service<br/>Meeting</b> | <b>International<br/>Convention</b> | <b>Regional<br/>Forums</b> | <b>Publishing</b>  | <b>Grapevine</b>   | <b>La Viña</b>   | <b>Supporting<br/>Services</b> | <b>2006<br/>Total</b> | <b>2005<br/>Total</b> |
|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------|--------------------|------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| Salaries                                        | \$ 723,910                | \$ 829,260                     | \$ 138,664                                |                                      |                                     | \$ 157,230                 | \$ 1,140,558       | \$ 411,234         | \$ 91,542        | \$ 2,226,790                   | \$ 5,719,188          | \$ 5,510,847          |
| Payroll taxes                                   | 56,427                    | 59,448                         | 9,645                                     |                                      |                                     | 10,674                     | 84,674             | 37,158             | 2,643            | 166,213                        | 426,882               | 411,013               |
| Health and group insurance                      | 113,463                   | 103,441                        | 13,812                                    |                                      |                                     | 13,812                     | 176,960            | 65,314             | 159              | 418,192                        | 905,153               | 890,157               |
| Retirement expense - funding                    | 143,755                   | 153,025                        | 24,917                                    |                                      |                                     | 27,592                     | 223,019            | 36,622             |                  | 375,627                        | 984,557               | 645,000               |
| Other program printing                          | 245,513                   | 68,320                         | 55,802                                    | 10,950                               |                                     | 28,059                     | 2,099              |                    |                  | 1,109                          | 411,852               | 364,090               |
| Mailing labor                                   | 113,302                   | 10,100                         |                                           | 1,631                                |                                     | 1,432                      | 6,690              |                    |                  | 60                             | 133,215               | 146,157               |
| Postage and express                             | 184,849                   | 111,231                        | 49,961                                    | 1,178                                |                                     | 33,274                     | 36,616             | 10,325             | 426              | 45,185                         | 473,045               | 498,931               |
| Writers fees                                    | 10,640                    | 125,230                        | 11,058                                    | 3,080                                |                                     | 40                         | 56,495             |                    |                  | 1,917                          | 208,460               | 104,758               |
| Foreign literature assistance                   |                           | 271,594                        |                                           |                                      |                                     |                            |                    |                    |                  |                                | 271,594               | 163,072               |
| Selling expenses                                |                           |                                |                                           |                                      |                                     |                            | 213,258            | 106,380            | 4,500            | 6,376                          | 330,514               | 318,215               |
| Professional fees                               |                           |                                |                                           |                                      |                                     |                            | 7,500              |                    |                  | 337,363                        | 344,863               | 188,832               |
| Contracted services                             | 34,426                    | 232,968                        | 9,349                                     | 15,212                               |                                     | 18,913                     | 116,583            | 165,816            | 8,563            | 457,202                        | 1,059,032             | 1,014,446             |
| Occupancy                                       | 93,037                    | 122,181                        | 9,477                                     |                                      |                                     | 10,356                     | 166,104            | 83,007             |                  | 347,512                        | 831,674               | 792,289               |
| Telephone                                       | 20,609                    | 19,045                         | 2,876                                     | 428                                  |                                     | 2,953                      | 13,830             | 15,859             |                  | 36,778                         | 112,378               | 113,264               |
| Equipment maintenance                           | 185                       | 2,000                          |                                           |                                      |                                     |                            | 6,397              |                    |                  | 104,631                        | 113,213               | 55,056                |
| Furniture and equipment depreciation            | 14,152                    | 14,152                         | 1,769                                     |                                      |                                     | 1,769                      | 21,488             |                    | 530              | 42,423                         | 96,283                | 46,023                |
| Stationery and office                           | 97,803                    | 5,607                          | 5,789                                     | 3,530                                |                                     | 1,711                      | 5,275              | 37,497             |                  | 78,046                         | 235,258               | 206,621               |
| Office service and expense                      | 10,828                    | 16,845                         | 17,078                                    | 8,269                                |                                     | 11,455                     | 11,615             | 37,498             | 735              | 219,033                        | 333,356               | 346,927               |
| Travel, meals and accommodations                | 3,912                     | 43,131                         | 526,285                                   | 162,738                              |                                     | 73,746                     | 16,716             |                    | 3,793            | 498,261                        | 1,328,582             | 1,067,172             |
| Bad debts                                       |                           |                                |                                           |                                      |                                     |                            |                    |                    | 360              | 30,774                         | 31,134                | 21,010                |
| Delegate fees                                   |                           |                                | (187,542)                                 | (119,102)                            |                                     |                            |                    |                    |                  |                                | (306,644)             | (138,796)             |
| <b>Total Operating Expenses</b>                 | <b>1,866,811</b>          | <b>2,187,578</b>               | <b>688,940</b>                            | <b>87,914</b>                        |                                     | <b>393,016</b>             | <b>2,305,877</b>   | <b>1,006,710</b>   | <b>113,251</b>   | <b>5,393,492</b>               | <b>14,043,589</b>     | <b>12,765,084</b>     |
| Postretirement health benefits                  |                           |                                |                                           |                                      |                                     |                            |                    |                    |                  | (90,422)                       | (90,422)              | (442,170)             |
| Retirement expense adjustment                   |                           |                                |                                           |                                      |                                     |                            |                    |                    |                  | (757,287)                      | (757,287)             | 454,424               |
| Severance benefits                              |                           |                                |                                           |                                      |                                     |                            |                    |                    |                  |                                |                       | 13,793                |
| Capital projects depreciation                   |                           |                                |                                           |                                      |                                     |                            |                    |                    |                  | 149,456                        | 149,456               | 149,456               |
| <b>Total Expenses</b>                           | <b>1,866,811</b>          | <b>2,187,578</b>               | <b>688,940</b>                            | <b>87,914</b>                        |                                     | <b>393,016</b>             | <b>2,305,877</b>   | <b>1,006,710</b>   | <b>113,251</b>   | <b>4,695,239</b>               | <b>13,345,336</b>     | <b>12,940,587</b>     |
| Allocation of supporting services to activities | 839,559                   | 983,817                        | 309,836                                   | 39,537                               |                                     | 176,751                    | 1,716,400          | 629,339            | -                | (4,695,239)                    | -                     | -                     |
| <b>Total Allocated Expenses</b>                 | <b>2,706,370</b>          | <b>3,171,395</b>               | <b>998,776</b>                            | <b>127,451</b>                       |                                     | <b>569,767</b>             | <b>4,022,277</b>   | <b>1,636,049</b>   | <b>113,251</b>   | <b>-</b>                       | <b>13,345,336</b>     | <b>12,940,587</b>     |
| Services                                        | \$ 2,706,370              | \$ 3,171,395                   | \$ 998,776                                | \$ 127,451                           |                                     | \$ 569,767                 |                    |                    |                  |                                | \$7,573,759           | \$7,605,005           |
| Publishing                                      | -                         | -                              | -                                         | -                                    | -                                   | -                          | \$ 4,022,277       |                    |                  |                                | 4,022,277             | 3,683,610             |
| Grapevine                                       | -                         | -                              | -                                         | -                                    | -                                   | -                          | -                  | \$ 1,636,049       | \$ 113,251       |                                | 1,759,300             | 1,651,972             |
|                                                 |                           |                                |                                           |                                      |                                     |                            |                    |                    |                  |                                | 13,345,336            | 12,940,587            |
| <b>COMPARATIVE TOTALS - 2005</b>                | <b>\$2,705,628</b>        | <b>\$2,959,168</b>             | <b>\$ 1,096,529</b>                       | <b>-</b>                             | <b>\$ 255,578</b>                   | <b>\$ 618,102</b>          | <b>\$3,683,610</b> | <b>\$1,522,584</b> | <b>\$129,388</b> | <b>\$ -</b>                    | <b>\$12,940,587</b>   |                       |

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.**  
**Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.**  
**Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.**  
**Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows**  
**Year Ended December 31, 2006**  
**(with comparative totals for 2005)**

**CASH FLOWS PROVIDED (USED)**

|                                                                                           | <u>2006</u>          | <u>2005</u>          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| <b>FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:</b>                                                         |                      |                      |
| Change in net assets for year (Exhibit B)                                                 | \$ 1,614,493         | \$ 890,306           |
| Realized and change in unrealized gains on investments                                    | 9,174                | 159,510              |
| Amortization of bond premiums                                                             | 1,310                | 2,792                |
| Depreciation                                                                              | 245,739              | 195,479              |
| Changes in assets and liabilities:                                                        |                      |                      |
| Accounts receivable                                                                       | 157,435              | (233,334)            |
| Inventories                                                                               | (122,368)            | 356,538              |
| Deferred charges and other assets                                                         | (59,255)             | 871,316              |
| Accounts and accruals payable                                                             | (222,037)            | 475,873              |
| Deferred income                                                                           | 161,219              | (2,255,222)          |
| Accrued pension benefits                                                                  | (726,826)            | 454,424              |
| Postretirement health benefits obligation                                                 | 135,570              | (442,170)            |
| <br><b><u>Net Cash Flows Provided</u></b><br><b><u>By Operating Activities</u></b>        | <br><u>1,194,454</u> | <br><u>475,512</u>   |
| <br><b>FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:</b>                                                     |                      |                      |
| Purchases of property and equipment                                                       | (520,527)            | (262,740)            |
| Proceeds from sales of investments                                                        | 4,957,811            | 6,957,051            |
| Purchases of investments                                                                  | (4,438,902)          | (7,399,826)          |
| <br><b><u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used)</u></b><br><b><u>By Investing Activities</u></b> | <br><u>(1,618)</u>   | <br><u>(705,515)</u> |
| <br>Net Increase (Decrease) in Cash                                                       | <br>1,192,836        | <br>(230,003)        |
| <br>Cash, beginning of year                                                               | <br><u>3,071,272</u> | <br><u>3,301,275</u> |
| <br>Cash, end of year                                                                     | <br><u>4,264,108</u> | <br><u>3,071,272</u> |

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.



# Report of the Independent Auditor

determined **AUDITORS' OPINION**

April 5, 2007

The Board of Trustees  
The General Service Board of  
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.  
475 Riverside Drive  
New York, New York 10015  
Members of the Board:

We have audited the accompanying consolidated statement of financial position of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC., ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC., and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. as of December 31, 2006 and the related consolidated statements of activities, functional expenses and cash flows for the year then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the Organizations' management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit.

We conducted our audit in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audit provides a reasonable basis for our opinion. The prior year summarized comparative information has been derived from the Organization's December 31, 2005 consolidated financial statements, and in our report dated March 13, 2006, we expressed an unqualified opinion on those financial statements.

In our opinion, the consolidated financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the three Corporations named above as of December 31, 2006 and the changes in their net assets and their cash flows for the year then ended in conformity with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America.

Respectfully submitted,  
Owen J. Flanagan and Company  
Certified Public Accountants  
New York, N.Y.

## **THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. NOTES TO CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS DECEMBER 31, 2006**

**Note 1 Organization:** The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., and its subsidiaries A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. are not-for-profit corporations organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. Groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world, and publishing books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to that purpose.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in four separate funds, as follows:

**The RESERVE FUND** - This fund was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was re-defined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held for unfulfilled subscriptions reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees upon recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

**The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND** - This fund accounts for the cost of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects, and records annual depreciation on such assets.

**The CONVENTION FUND** - A separate fund established to record the direct income and expenses of international A.A. conventions held every five years. These events are separate from the regular operations of the General Service Office, but the General Fund receives any excess of income, or pays any excess of expense, resulting from the activity.

From a historical perspective, the net direct result of all conventions held to date is approximately an excess of income of \$716,000, and presently resides with all other income not required for working capital in the Reserve Fund.

**The POSTRETIREMENT MEDICAL FUND** - A fund established in 2006 with the goal of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the liability for postretirement health benefits by the end of ten years.

The Postretirement health benefits plan is described in more detail in Note 5.

**The GENERAL FUND** - This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the Corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

All net assets of the Corporations are free of donor restrictions.

**Note 2 Accounting Policies:** The Corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. The Organizations do not receive or solicit pledges, so contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Contributions received from A.A. groups and members are for the general activities of the General Service Office, and are recorded as unrestricted. Donations received from foreign A.A. entities for the international literature fund are also treated as unrestricted, as A.A.'s ongoing foreign literature assistance program satisfies the donor's condition on a current basis.

Intercompany balances and transfers are eliminated in the consolidated totals in the accompanying financial statements.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World

Services. Expenses related to service activities are charged to the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been allocated based on its proportionate square footage; substantially all other expenses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

**Cash:** For purposes of the consolidated statement of cash flows, cash is defined as cash on hand, checking and money market accounts and short term cash investments.

Cash in excess of federally insured limits are potentially exposed to concentrations of credit risk. However, the Organization only maintains accounts with quality financial institutions with high credit standings, so as a consequence, such risks are limited.

**Inventories:** Inventories held are recorded at lower of cost or market under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

**Property and Equipment:** The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated on a straight line basis over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are capitalized and depreciated over estimated useful lives of three to eight years by the operating entities.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 2006 and the accumulated depreciation at that date:

|                        | <b>Life</b>  | <b>Cost</b>      | <b>Current Year</b> | <b>Accumulated Depreciation</b> |
|------------------------|--------------|------------------|---------------------|---------------------------------|
| Leasehold improvements | Terms of     |                  |                     |                                 |
| 475 Riverside Drive    | Leases       | \$2,504,839      | \$ 48,041           | \$2,009,788                     |
| Furniture              | 8 Years      | 717,772          | 2,027               | 691,687                         |
| Computers - hardware   | 3 to 5 Years | 658,642          | 94,256              | 516,398                         |
| Software               | 5 Years      | 580,739          | 101,415             | 319,166                         |
|                        |              | <u>4,461,992</u> | <u>245,739</u>      | <u>3,537,039</u>                |

**Investments:** As described above, all of the investing activity of the operating entities is consolidated in the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. In accordance with established policy, the Fund invests in short or medium term U.S. Treasury Notes or Bills normally held to maturity. The investments are recorded at fair value. Gains and losses on sales or redemptions are recorded by comparison of proceeds to amortized cost on a specific identification basis.

Investment income for 2006 and 2005 is comprised of the following:

|                                   | <b>2006</b>    | <b>2005</b>    |
|-----------------------------------|----------------|----------------|
| Interest                          | \$474,814      | \$414,089      |
| Realized gains on redemptions     | 17,441         | 4,678          |
| Change in unrealized appreciation | (26,615)       | (164,188)      |
| Investment expenses               | (9,471)        | (6,471)        |
|                                   | <u>456,169</u> | <u>248,108</u> |

**Functional Expenses:** The consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C) provides detail as to program costs by major activity and supporting services. In addition to

the program costs reflected on that Exhibit, amounts shown on the consolidated statement of activities (Exhibit B) as cost of literature distributed also relate to the publishing and magazine programs.

Two of the major program activities described on Exhibit C are for "Group Services" and "Fellowship Services". Group Services includes those activities most closely associated with serving A.A. groups, including the group services staff assignment, the Box 459 newsletter, directories, group records and files, the contributions department and services to French and Spanish speaking groups in North America. Fellowship Services include activities outside of the group, such as public information, co-operation with the professional community, treatment and correctional facilities, archives and loners and overseas services.

Supporting services include costs of the General Service Office which can not be attributed to any specific program activity. These include administrative management, data processing and information systems, editorial and clerical support, trustee and director activities, copy center, accounting, human resources and miscellaneous administrative functions.

The allocation of supporting services to program activities on Exhibit C is done on a pro rata basis to program expenses by entity, and is provided for informational purposes only.

Fundraising costs are immaterial.

**Operating Expenses:** For purposes of the Statement of Functional Expenses, operating expenses are defined as recurring items requiring the current outlay of cash.

**Management Estimates:** The management of the Corporations uses estimates and assumptions in preparing financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America. These estimates and assumptions affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses. Actual results could vary from the estimates that management uses.

As described in Note 5 of this report, management made certain significant estimates in the calculation of liabilities for postretirement health benefits. These estimates include employee retention, health care cost trends and the actuarial lives of present and projected retirees eligible for benefits. It is reasonably possible that a change in these estimates will occur in the near term. The effect of changes in these estimates can not be determined.

**Note 3 Retirement Plan:** The Organizations adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible U.S. employees who have completed one year of service.

The plan provides an annual benefit equal to 2% of final average compensation multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 35 years), less 0.65% of average social security earnings multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 30 years). The social security offset can not reduce the gross benefit by more than 50%.

Pension expense is recorded in accordance with SFAS 87, in which costs are accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon factors which are not necessarily the same as those used to calculate the annual funding requirements. In addition, SFAS 87 requires, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the Organization's balance sheet depending upon a comparison of the Plan's assets to its benefit obligations.

The contributions made to fund pension benefits are recorded by the operating companies as an expense. The difference between the amounts actually paid and the net periodic pension cost under SFAS 87 is recorded by the Reserve Fund as an

adjustment to retirement expense since it is a non-cash item that does not affect current operations.

The following tables set forth the Plan's funded status, assumptions, benefit cost and payments and employer contributions for 2006:

|                                            |                    |
|--------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Fair value of plan assets (at December 31) | \$ 12,992,085      |
| Benefit obligation (at December 31)        | <u>17,841,898</u>  |
| Funded status                              | <u>(4,849,813)</u> |

|                                                                                 |              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Accrued pension cost recognized in consolidated statement of financial position | \$ 1,692,402 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|

The difference between the Plan's funded status and recognized pension benefit liability is attributable to deferral and amortization of Plan assets and obligations as prescribed under SFAS 87, as well as unrecognized actuarial losses.

|                                               |             |
|-----------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Weighted-average assumptions (at December 31) |             |
| Discount rate                                 | 6.0%        |
| Expected return on plan assets                | 9.0%        |
| Rate of compensation increase                 | 5.0%        |
| Benefit cost                                  | \$ (46,679) |
| Employers' contributions                      | \$ 710,608  |
| Benefits paid                                 | \$ 906,002  |

|                                                             |                  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Classification of benefit costs:                            |                  |
| Operating expense (cash funding)                            | \$ 710,608       |
| Non-operating expense (non-cash adjustment to pension cost) | <u>(757,287)</u> |
|                                                             | <u>(46,679)</u>  |

The expected benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

|             |             |
|-------------|-------------|
| 2007        | \$1,007,000 |
| 2008        | 971,000     |
| 2009        | 973,000     |
| 2010        | 980,000     |
| 2011        | 994,000     |
| 2012 - 2016 | 6,013,000   |

The employers' contributions for 2007 are expected to be about \$321,000 more than in 2006.

Plan assets at December 31, 2006 were composed as follows:

|                                   |               |
|-----------------------------------|---------------|
| Domestic Equity Mutual Funds      | 52.1%         |
| International Equity Mutual Funds | 12.3%         |
| Bond Mutual Funds                 | 34.2%         |
| Cash and equivalents              | 1.4%          |
|                                   | <u>100.0%</u> |

The Mutual funds in the plan are primarily index funds designed to achieve diversification between fixed income and equity investments among asset classes including S&P 500, small capitalization companies and international stocks.

The Financial Accounting Standards Board issued Statement #158 in September 2006. This statement revised financial reporting by requiring an employer to recognize the overfunded or underfunded status of a defined benefit plan as an asset or liability in its statement of financial position. The statement will be effective for 2007. If the statement had been applied as of December 31, 2006, the liability recognized in consolidated statement of financial position would have been increased by \$3,157,411 to \$4,849,813, and Net Assets would have been correspondingly decreased by \$3,157,411 to \$6,370,498.

**Note 4 Lease Commitments:** At December 31, 2006, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$471,128 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008 and extended on August 10, 2006 through December 31, 2018.

\$97,915 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008 and extended on August 10, 2006 through December 31, 2018.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 2006 is \$6,829,000 as follows:

|              |                    |
|--------------|--------------------|
| 2007         | \$ 569,000         |
| 2008         | 569,000            |
| 2009         | 569,000            |
| 2010         | 569,000            |
| 2011         | 569,000            |
| 2012 to 2018 | <u>3,984,000</u>   |
|              | <u>\$6,829,000</u> |

**Note 5 Postretirement Health Benefits:** The Corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they attain retirement age while working at the General Service Office. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the Corporations, 25% of the cost of which is borne by the retirees.

For employees hired after January 1, 2004 there is a three-tier structure in the level of group medical insurance premiums paid for on behalf of employees who retire directly from GSO. For employees with 5-9 years of service the corporations will pay 25%, 10-15 years 50% and more than 15 years 75%.

The assumed health care cost trend rate used to measure the expected cost of benefits covered by the plan is 6.0%. A discount rate of 6.0% has been used to measure the accrued postretirement health benefit obligation shown on Exhibit B.

In prior years the Plan was unfunded. However, as described in Note 1, a Postretirement Medical Fund was created by the Board in 2006 with the purpose of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the postretirement health benefits liability after ten years.

The following table sets forth the information regarding the Plan for 2006:

|                                     |                    |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Benefit obligation (at December 31) | <u>\$4,028,210</u> |
| Benefit cost                        | \$ 114,703         |
| Benefits paid                       | \$ 205,125         |

The excess of payments for benefits over cost of benefits of \$90,422 has been reported on Exhibit C as a non-operating expense (recovery) since it does not affect the current outlay of cash.

The Plan provides a drug benefit to retirees which qualifies under the Federal Retiree Drug Subsidy. The calculation of the Plan's benefit obligation has been determined net of the anticipated reimbursements. The amount of the subsidy claimed for 2006 was \$19,911. The overall effect of the subsidy on the calculation of the Plan's benefit obligation at December 31, 2006 was a reduction of \$319,561.

The expected postretirement benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

|             |                  |
|-------------|------------------|
| 2007        | \$ 217,433       |
| 2008        | 230,479          |
| 2009        | 244,308          |
| 2010        | 258,966          |
| 2011        | 274,504          |
| 2012 - 2016 | <u>1,640,245</u> |

**Note 6 Tax Status:** The Corporations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, and are classified as public charities. They are also exempt from New York State franchise and sales taxes.

# The Budget Highlights

## 2007 G.S.O. Budget

This budget describes the "OPERATIONS" of the General Service Office. It includes expenses of A.A. World Services (the Publishing operation) and the General Fund (Service activities). It excludes any activities reported separately in the Reserve Fund, Convention Fund, or the Capital Projects Fund. The Grapevine operations are described below in a separate report.

**Income:** The 2007 budget projects net sales of \$12,000,000, approximately flat when compared with the 2006 actual results of \$12,007,000 and which were below the \$12,655,000 estimated for the 2006 budget. The 2007 budget includes an expected return to "normal" levels of sales, after the two recent sets of price adjustments (7/1/04 & 7/1/05).

Manufacturing costs are budgeted higher than 2006 as we have begun to see higher paper and manufacturing component costs in the latter half of 2006. Royalties are budgeted at \$170,000.

Shipping and warehousing costs are budgeted approximately 6% higher than the 2006 results. While our warehousing group had shifted warehouse facilities over a year ago, and anticipated more cost effective operations, we have seen increased fuel cost passalongs from the shipping industry.

After subtracting manufacturing costs, royalties and shipping expense, gross profit is budgeted at \$6,560,000 or 56.3%. This is about \$300,000 less than 2006. The Gross profit compares with \$6,875,000 (58.8%) for 2006. It should also be remembered that as we continue to strive to have literature available — for our Service Conference in the Spanish and French languages as well as English — lower print runs in those languages could result in higher production costs. Because we strive to have similar selling prices regardless of our manufacturing cost, lower gross profits for individual items may occur that will affect the overall gross profit. Thus price increases may become necessary as things progress.

Prudence dictates that even though contribution revenue has seen favorable upward movement over the last several years, other actions have been necessary to control costs and reinforce the revenue stream so as to provide sufficient funds to continue providing services. Trusted Servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations, as well as assess the services supplied.

**Contributions** for 2007 have been budgeted at \$6,200,000 in total. Contributions received for the year 2006 were \$650,000 (12%) greater than 2005.

During 2006, contributions from groups and individuals of \$5,922,000 were \$517,000 (10%) greater than budget and \$640,000 (12%) greater than 2005. Contributions received from World Service Meeting countries toward the World Service Meeting International literature fund amounted to \$145,000, approximately \$20,000 more than 2005. In total, contributions received for 2006 were just over \$6,068,000. In addition to the work trusted servants are doing to carry the message of the necessity for voluntary contributions, historical evidence suggests that usually in the year following an International Convention, we enjoy a healthy increase in contributions.

**Total Operating Revenue** for the 2007 is anticipated at \$12,763,000, approximately even with the 2006 budget and 1.5% less than the 2006 actual results.

**Total Operating Expenses** for 2007 have been budgeted at \$12,525,550, approximately \$231,000 or 2% more than 2006, and \$242,000 or 2% more than the 2006 budget as well. The 2007 budget includes a decrease for the G.S.O. USA net expense for the World Service Meeting, but an increase in funding cost for the pension plan following recent Congressional action requiring changes in funding policy for pension plans.

For 2007, the G.S.O. budget anticipates an excess of revenue over expense of \$237,450. This compares with an actual income for 2006 of \$657,884 and the \$474,975 net income budgeted for 2006 (including mid-year adjustments).

The expected 2007 operating income, the 2006 actual income, as well as other transfers, assist in maintaining the Reserve Fund balance.

## 2007 Grapevine Budget

The 2007 Grapevine Budget calls for an average circulation of 103,000, approximately 2,500 copies less than the 2006 budget, and approximately 900 copies less than the 2006 paid circulation of 103,878. Circulation for the last several years was as follows: 2005, 104,356, 2004, 108,203, 2003, 112,614, 2002, 115,753, 2001, 115,034, 2000, 115,734, 1999, 116,000, and 1998, 117,300.

**Income:** Magazine income of \$1,964,200 is expected, about \$69,000 greater than 2006. Other Publishing Income from books, cassette tapes, and miscellaneous items is budgeted at \$724,700, approximately \$107,700 higher than 2006. The increase in the "other items" category anticipates sales of new products.

**Total Gross Profit:** Combining the magazine and other publishing items, a gross profit of \$1,639,059 is budgeted for 2007, compared with \$1,519,000 achieved for 2006 and the 2006 budget of \$1,635,715.

**Total Operating Expenses:** Total Operating Expenses for 2007 are budgeted at \$1,787,500, approximately \$151,500 more than the 2006 expenses of \$1,636,050.

**Net Income:** For 2007 the Grapevine anticipates a loss of \$81,300. This compares with a 2006 budgeted profit of \$19,883 and an actual loss from operations of \$48,875.

## 2007 La Viña Budget

Following the 1995 General Service Conference Advisory Action #7, the publication of the Grapevine magazine in Spanish was approved by the Grapevine Board of Directors and the trustees' Finance Committee of the General Service Board. Recognizing this publication as a new venture, both boards were to review the financial impact on the Fellowship and the progress of circulation and continue to monitor the viability of this venture. In 2001, the General Service Board recommended and the 2001 Conference approved that the La Viña magazine continue to be published by the Grapevine but Funded by the General Service Boards General Fund instead of continuing to draw funds from the Reserve Fund.

For 2007 La Viña expects a gross profit on the magazine of \$25,258, compared with \$20,460 achieved in 2006. Circulation for 2007 is estimated at 10,100, slightly lower than the 10,223 average for the year 2006. Other Publishing income is estimated at \$37,940 which after deducting cost of product of \$9,353 expects to contribute \$28,587 to revenue. Total costs and expenses are estimated at \$126,178 for 2007, approximately \$13,000 (11%) higher than 2006. The 2007 budget projects a net loss of \$72,333, approximately even with the 2006 loss of \$72,000.

To date the La Viña magazine has incurred start-up costs/operating losses of approximately \$1,071,000 as follows: \$29,500 in 1995, \$138,290 in 1996, \$102,140 in 1997, \$66,182 in 1998, \$59,224 in 1999, \$49,570 in 2000, \$119,385 in 2001, \$103,815 in 2002, \$111,638 in 2003, \$111,592 in 2004, \$107,739 in 2005, and \$72,000 in 2006.

## The General Service Office 2007 OPERATING BUDGET

| <b>INCOME</b>                          | <b>2006 Budget</b>  | <b>2006 Actual</b>  | <b>2007 Budget</b>  |
|----------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| <b>GROSS SALES</b>                     | \$12,655,600        | \$12,006,989        | \$12,000,000        |
| Discounts allowed                      | 352,800             | 325,971             | 350,000             |
| <u>Net Sales</u>                       | 12,302,800          | 11,681,018          | 11,650,000          |
| Cost of Literature Distributed         |                     |                     |                     |
| Manufacturing                          | 3,600,000           | 3,164,182           | 3,360,000           |
| Royalties                              | 175,000             | 169,591             | 170,000             |
| <u>Gross Margin</u>                    | 8,527,800           | 8,347,245           | 8,120,000           |
| <b>DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING</b> | 1,292,400           | 1,472,008           | 1,560,000           |
| <u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>    | 7,235,400           | 6,875,237           | 6,560,000           |
| Contributions Received                 | 5,520,000           | 6,068,172           | 6,200,000           |
| Interest Income                        | 3,000               | 8,765               | 3,000               |
| <u>Total Revenue</u>                   | 12,758,400          | 12,952,174          | 12,763,000          |
| <b>OPERATING EXPENSES</b>              |                     |                     |                     |
| Salaries                               | \$5,106,500         | \$4,918,233         | \$5,271,000         |
| Payroll taxes                          | 361,500             | 359,658             | 374,000             |
| Insurance                              | 776,100             | 788,495             | 865,200             |
| Retirement expense                     | 892,800             | 928,560             | 1,275,200           |
| Other program printing                 | 400,100             | 411,853             | 406,000             |
| Mailing, labor, etc.                   | 113,500             | 133,156             | 115,300             |
| Postage & express                      | 451,200             | 462,354             | 400,750             |
| Writers' fees                          | 274,700             | 208,460             | 102,500             |
| Other literature assist                | 207,500             | 271,594             | 117,700             |
| Selling expenses                       | 146,950             | 219,634             | 162,750             |
| Professional fees                      | 262,500             | 298,192             | 171,100             |
| Contracted services                    | 889,600             | 884,653             | 821,600             |
| Occupancy                              | 693,600             | 704,751             | 727,100             |
| Telephone                              | 91,050              | 90,221              | 91,100              |
| Equipment maintenance                  | 38,800              | 83,928              | 86,400              |
| Furniture & equipment                  | 80,000              | 89,486              | 126,000             |
| Stationery & office expense            | 173,300             | 197,762             | 180,150             |
| Office service & expense               | 334,825             | 274,046             | 258,600             |
| Travel, meals, & accommodations        | 978,900             | 959,218             | 963,100             |
| Bad debts                              | 10,000              | 10,036              | 10,000              |
| <b>TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES</b>        | <b>\$12,283,425</b> | <b>\$12,294,290</b> | <b>\$12,525,550</b> |
| <b>INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD</b>        | <b>474,975</b>      | <b>657,884</b>      | <b>237,450</b>      |

# The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

## 2007 BUDGET

|                                         | ENGLISH          |                  |                  | SPANISH         |                 |                 |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|
|                                         | 2006 Budget      | 2006 Actual      | 2007 Budget      | 2006 Budget     | 2006 Actual     | 2007 Budget     |
| <b>PAID CIRCULATION —</b>               |                  |                  |                  |                 |                 |                 |
| <b>AVERAGE # OF COPIES</b>              | <u>105,500</u>   | <u>103,878</u>   | <u>103,000</u>   | <u>9,700</u>    | <u>10,223</u>   | <u>10,100</u>   |
| <b>INCOME FROM MAGAZINE</b>             |                  |                  |                  |                 |                 |                 |
| Subscription income                     | \$1,813,794      | \$1,752,376      | \$1,820,564      | \$70,125        | \$72,948        | \$79,140        |
| Single copies and back issues           | 62,614           | 95,643           | 87,566           | 13,546          | 16,132          | 16,132          |
| Digital Archives Project subs           | 47,679           | 40,498           | 40,467           |                 |                 |                 |
| Audio Grapevine                         | 8,910            | 6,932            | 15,600           |                 |                 |                 |
| <u>Total magazine income</u>            | <u>1,932,997</u> | <u>1,895,449</u> | <u>1,964,197</u> | <u>83,671</u>   | <u>89,080</u>   | <u>95,272</u>   |
| <u>Total direct costs</u>               | <u>729,326</u>   | <u>744,084</u>   | <u>763,622</u>   | <u>65,763</u>   | <u>68,620</u>   | <u>70,014</u>   |
| <b>Gross Profit on Magazine</b>         | <u>1,203,671</u> | <u>1,151,365</u> | <u>1,200,575</u> | <u>17,908</u>   | <u>20,460</u>   | <u>25,258</u>   |
| <b>OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME</b>          | 644,536          | 616,983          | 724,674          | 18,000          | 27,740          | 37,940          |
| <u>Total direct costs</u>               | <u>212,492</u>   | <u>249,344</u>   | <u>286,190</u>   | <u>3,848</u>    | <u>6,953</u>    | <u>9,353</u>    |
| <b>Gross Profit on Special Items</b>    | <u>432,044</u>   | <u>367,639</u>   | <u>438,484</u>   | <u>14,152</u>   | <u>20,787</u>   | <u>28,587</u>   |
| <b>Total Gross Profit</b>               | <u>1,635,715</u> | <u>1,519,004</u> | <u>1,639,059</u> | <u>32,060</u>   | <u>41,247</u>   | <u>53,845</u>   |
| <b>COSTS AND EXPENSES</b>               |                  |                  |                  |                 |                 |                 |
| <b>EDITORIAL COSTS</b>                  |                  |                  |                  |                 |                 |                 |
| Salaries, including temporary help      | 260,778          | 278,499          | 276,337          | 68,265          | 70,176          | 73,343          |
| Payroll taxes and benefits              | 102,808          | 95,483           | 117,591          |                 |                 |                 |
| Occupancy costs                         | 78,900           | 76,538           | 65,057           |                 |                 |                 |
| Office supplies and expenses            | 17,393           | 21,454           | 25,000           | 1,000           | 295             | 295             |
| Product development & Web               | 67,217           | 31,899           | 50,465           |                 |                 |                 |
| <u>Total Editorial</u>                  | <u>527,096</u>   | <u>503,873</u>   | <u>534,450</u>   | <u>69,265</u>   | <u>70,471</u>   | <u>73,638</u>   |
| <b>CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS</b>         |                  |                  |                  |                 |                 |                 |
| Salaries, including temporary help      | 451,079          | 430,914          | 460,168          | 17,444          | 21,366          | 21,600          |
| Payroll taxes and benefits              | 142,807          | 141,593          | 179,097          | 3,789           | 2,802           | 2,802           |
| Kable fulfillment                       | 129,233          | 133,917          | 138,668          | 6,555           | 8,563           | 8,861           |
| Occupancy costs                         | 76,856           | 72,493           | 61,619           |                 |                 |                 |
| Office supplies and expenses            | 49,102           | 53,541           | 50,000           |                 |                 |                 |
| Selling expense-regular                 | 108,700          | 87,277           | 156,500          | 10,200          | 4,500           | 13,725          |
| -GvR program                            | 27,900           | 19,103           | 22,200           |                 |                 |                 |
| Postage                                 | 6,814            | 10,325           | 11,109           | 1,000           | 426             | 475             |
| <u>Total Circulation and Business</u>   | <u>992,491</u>   | <u>949,163</u>   | <u>1,079,361</u> | <u>38,988</u>   | <u>37,657</u>   | <u>47,463</u>   |
| <b>GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE</b>       |                  |                  |                  |                 |                 |                 |
| Employee's Severance                    |                  |                  |                  |                 |                 |                 |
| Computer Consulting                     | 29,000           | 29,284           | 39,589           |                 |                 |                 |
| Leasehold Improvements                  |                  |                  |                  |                 |                 |                 |
| Insurance                               | 6,184            | 7,708            | 8,093            | 500             | 437             | 437             |
| Professional fees                       | 42,850           | 46,671           | 37,438           | 240             |                 |                 |
| Meetings and conferences                | 54,483           | 58,975           | 55,000           | 3,500           | 3,793           | 3,500           |
| Furniture and equipment                 |                  | 6,268            | 6,134            | 100             | 530             | 530             |
| Canadian exchange and other             | 2,552            | 4,488            | 2,552            |                 |                 | 250             |
| Bank service charges                    | 6,105            | 8,881            | 9,905            |                 |                 |                 |
| Bad debts                               | 12,571           | 20,738           | 15,000           | 166             | 363             | 360             |
| <u>Total General and Administrative</u> | <u>153,745</u>   | <u>183,013</u>   | <u>173,711</u>   | <u>4,506</u>    | <u>5,123</u>    | <u>5,077</u>    |
| <b>TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES</b>         | <u>1,673,332</u> | <u>1,636,049</u> | <u>1,787,522</u> | <u>112,759</u>  | <u>113,251</u>  | <u>126,178</u>  |
| Interest earned                         | 57,500           | 68,172           | 67,135           |                 |                 |                 |
| <b>NET INCOME (Loss) FOR PERIOD</b>     | <u>19,883</u>    | <u>(48,873)</u>  | <u>(81,328)</u>  | <u>(80,699)</u> | <u>(72,004)</u> | <u>(72,333)</u> |

# 2006 Contributions From Groups, Individuals, Specials, Special Meetings — by Delegate Area (in U.S. Dollars)

| AREA # | GENERAL SERVICE<br>CONFERENCE AREA | #GPS.<br>REPORTED | #GPS.<br>CONTRIB. | % OF GPS.<br>CONTRIB. | TOTAL GROUP<br>CONTRIB. | MEMBERSHIP | CONTRIBUTIONS<br>PER CAPITA | INDIVIDUAL<br>MEMBERS | MEMORIAL | SPECIALS | SPECIAL<br>MEETINGS | TOTAL AREA<br>CONTRIBUTIONS | PER<br>CAPITA |
|--------|------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------|------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------|----------|----------|---------------------|-----------------------------|---------------|
| 01.    | Ala./N.W. Fla.                     | 427               | 224               | 52.5%                 | 40,061                  | 8,681      | \$4.60                      | 1,018                 |          | 620      |                     | \$41,698.31                 | \$4.80        |
| 02.    | Alaska                             | 188               | 88                | 46.8                  | 15,763                  | 3,277      | 4.81                        | 998                   |          | 850      | 52                  | \$17,663.79                 | \$5.39        |
| 03.    | Arizona                            | 900               | 451               | 50.0                  | 120,662                 | 21,320     | 5.66                        | 5,303                 | 160      | 1,057    |                     | \$127,181.57                | \$5.97        |
| 04.    | Arkansas                           | 264               | 152               | 57.5                  | 21,401                  | 4,692      | 4.55                        | 1,986                 |          |          |                     | \$23,386.96                 | \$4.98        |
|        | <b>California</b>                  |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                             |                       |          |          |                     |                             |               |
| 05.    | Southern                           | 1,172             | 427               | 36.3                  | 123,535                 | 40,919     | 3.01                        | 17,168                | 50       | 7,166    | 1,089               | \$149,008.49                | \$3.64        |
| 06.    | N. Coastal                         | 1,832             | 1,083             | 59.0                  | 247,520                 | 55,508     | 4.46                        | 7,589                 | 2,050    |          | 408                 | \$257,566.71                | \$4.64        |
| 07.    | N. Interior                        | 829               | 400               | 48.2                  | 83,898                  | 23,710     | 3.54                        | 2,501                 | 125      | 1,861    | 145                 | \$88,530.24                 | \$3.73        |
| 08.    | San Diego/Imp.                     | 857               | 391               | 45.5                  | 80,841                  | 25,186     | 3.21                        | 3,023                 | 102      | 2,779    | 430                 | \$87,173.53                 | \$3.46        |
| 09.    | Mid-South.                         | 1,808             | 793               | 43.9                  | 186,527                 | 56,075     | 3.33                        | 4,491                 | 75       | 5,730    | 380                 | \$197,202.68                | \$3.52        |
| 10.    | Colorado                           | 678               | 402               | 59.3                  | 109,142                 | 16,048     | 6.79                        | 7,099                 | 275      | 7,489    | 21                  | \$124,026.91                | \$7.73        |
| 11.    | Connecticut                        | 1,508             | 671               | 44.4                  | 119,472                 | 36,295     | 3.29                        | 8,319                 | 1,230    | 19,177   | 130                 | \$148,327.65                | \$4.09        |
| 12.    | Delaware                           | 218               | 125               | 57.2                  | 35,266                  | 3,513      | 10.04                       | 283                   |          | 625      |                     | \$36,174.26                 | \$10.30       |
| 13.    | D.C.                               | 422               | 186               | 44.0                  | 41,119                  | 13,907     | 2.96                        | 945                   |          | 2,432    |                     | \$44,495.99                 | \$3.20        |
|        | <b>Florida</b>                     |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                             |                       |          |          |                     |                             |               |
| 14.    | North                              | 780               | 382               | 48.9                  | 89,837                  | 16,472     | 5.44                        | 13,223                | 1,050    | 12,598   | 146                 | \$116,854.76                | \$7.09        |
| 15.    | South/                             | 1,698             | 863               | 50.8                  | 201,010                 | 37,038     | 5.43                        | 10,716                | 125      | 85,349   | 189                 | \$297,388.04                | \$8.03        |
| 16.    | Georgia                            | 710               | 442               | 62.2                  | 89,171                  | 16,842     | 5.29                        | 3,328                 | 100      | 1,421    | 100                 | \$94,120.27                 | \$5.59        |
| 17.    | Hawaii                             | 292               | 159               | 54.4                  | 36,383                  | 5,393      | 6.74                        | 1,619                 | 50       | 201      |                     | \$38,253.14                 | \$7.09        |
| 18.    | Idaho                              | 214               | 98                | 45.8                  | 19,207                  | 3,817      | 5.02                        | 624                   |          | 3,690    | 100                 | \$23,621.18                 | \$6.19        |
|        | <b>Illinois</b>                    |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                             |                       |          |          |                     |                             |               |
| 19.    | Chicago                            | 1,156             | 315               | 27.2                  | 81,391                  | 28,100     | 2.89                        | 2,839                 | 50       | 9,809    | 32                  | \$94,121.52                 | \$3.35        |
| 20.    | North                              | 1,139             | 428               | 37.6                  | 58,528                  | 23,485     | 2.48                        | 3,681                 |          | 16,122   | 241                 | \$78,572.17                 | \$3.35        |
| 21.    | South                              | 490               | 142               | 28.9                  | 22,792                  | 8,724      | 2.60                        | 514                   | 175      | 260      | 50                  | \$23,790.66                 | \$2.73        |
|        | <b>Indiana</b>                     |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                             |                       |          |          |                     |                             |               |
| 22.    | North                              | 647               | 260               | 40.2                  | 34,790                  | 9,528      | 3.65                        | 1,411                 |          | 2,273    | 62                  | \$38,535.19                 | \$4.04        |
| 23.    | South                              | 612               | 290               | 47.4                  | 39,202                  | 10,767     | 3.64                        | 1,414                 |          | 91       | 100                 | \$40,806.69                 | \$3.79        |
| 24.    | Iowa                               | 648               | 291               | 44.9                  | 48,278                  | 13,587     | 3.54                        | 346                   | 55       | 2,135    | 139                 | \$50,952.91                 | \$3.75        |
| 25.    | Kansas                             | 371               | 174               | 46.9                  | 35,011                  | 9,753      | 3.58                        | 95                    | 325      | 8,509    | 52                  | \$43,992.32                 | \$4.51        |
| 26.    | Kentucky                           | 659               | 305               | 46.2                  | 67,967                  | 10,508     | 6.47                        | 4,166                 | 6,018    |          |                     | \$78,151.65                 | \$7.44        |
| 27.    | Louisiana                          | 579               | 176               | 30.3                  | 38,004                  | 12,031     | 3.15                        | 454                   |          | 1,100    |                     | \$39,558.39                 | \$3.29        |
| 28.    | Maine                              | 484               | 170               | 35.0                  | 19,384                  | 7,983      | 2.42                        | 2,798                 |          | 1,320    | 99                  | \$23,601.13                 | \$2.96        |
| 29.    | Maryland                           | 975               | 420               | 43.0                  | 81,148                  | 15,582     | 5.20                        | 2,342                 |          | 1,575    | 221                 | \$85,286.18                 | \$5.47        |
|        | <b>Massachusetts</b>               |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                             |                       |          |          |                     |                             |               |
| 30.    | East                               | 1,420             | 527               | 37.0                  | 123,598                 | 48,373     | 2.55                        | 8,198                 | 151      | 2,270    | 44                  | \$134,261.34                | \$2.78        |
| 31.    | West                               | 264               | 151               | 57.1                  | 20,294                  | 4,853      | 4.17                        | 713                   |          |          | 150                 | \$21,156.22                 | \$4.36        |
|        | <b>Michigan</b>                    |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                             |                       |          |          |                     |                             |               |
| 32.    | Central                            | 576               | 245               | 42.4                  | 37,869                  | 12,962     | 2.92                        | 3,815                 | 65       | 1,232    |                     | \$42,980.90                 | \$3.32        |
| 33.    | Southeast                          | 837               | 323               | 38.5                  | 66,399                  | 19,396     | 3.42                        | 3,406                 | 20       | 247      |                     | \$70,071.96                 | \$3.61        |
| 34.    | West                               | 549               | 213               | 38.7                  | 37,250                  | 11,427     | 3.25                        | 392                   |          | 1,432    | 50                  | \$39,123.64                 | \$3.42        |
|        | <b>Minnesota</b>                   |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                             |                       |          |          |                     |                             |               |
| 35.    | North                              | 531               | 239               | 45.0                  | 27,936                  | 8,896      | 3.13                        | 1,312                 | 700      |          | 45                  | \$29,992.27                 | \$3.37        |
| 36.    | South                              | 1,030             | 411               | 39.9                  | 79,784                  | 25,224     | 3.16                        | 1,256                 | 500      | 6,578    | 38                  | \$88,155.51                 | \$3.49        |
| 37.    | Mississippi                        | 252               | 91                | 36.1                  | 20,560                  | 4,881      | 4.21                        | 1,147                 |          | 788      |                     | \$22,495.48                 | \$4.61        |
|        | <b>Missouri</b>                    |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                             |                       |          |          |                     |                             |               |
| 38.    | East                               | 514               | 244               | 47.4                  | 54,195                  | 10,322     | 5.25                        | 3,384                 |          | 220      |                     | \$57,799.02                 | \$5.60        |
| 39.    | West                               | 223               | 103               | 46.1                  | 21,040                  | 6,668      | 3.16                        | 710                   |          | 209      |                     | \$21,959.30                 | \$3.29        |
| 40.    | Montana                            | 272               | 127               | 46.6                  | 23,182                  | 4,407      | 5.26                        | 2,520                 |          | 767      |                     | \$26,468.67                 | \$6.01        |
| 41.    | Nebraska                           | 722               | 349               | 48.2                  | 57,534                  | 15,973     | 3.59                        | 1,635                 | 100      | 1,180    | 41                  | \$60,490.06                 | \$3.79        |
| 42.    | Nevada                             | 504               | 209               | 41.5                  | 37,984                  | 12,510     | 3.03                        | 1,102                 |          | 1,154    |                     | \$40,240.02                 | \$3.22        |
| 43.    | New Hampshire                      | 564               | 259               | 45.9                  | 34,416                  | 11,090     | 3.10                        | 864                   |          | 2,059    | 75                  | \$37,414.77                 | \$3.37        |
|        | <b>New Jersey</b>                  |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                             |                       |          |          |                     |                             |               |
| 44.    | North                              | 1,245             | 553               | 44.4                  | 107,395                 | 33,460     | 3.20                        | 7,041                 | 100      | 2,210    | 95                  | \$116,840.79                | \$3.49        |
| 45.    | South                              | 500               | 274               | 54.8                  | 64,329                  | 8,625      | 7.46                        | 2,149                 | 2,817    | 194      |                     | \$69,489.09                 | \$8.06        |
| 46.    | New Mexico                         | 353               | 167               | 47.2                  | 35,687                  | 6,475      | 5.50                        | 3,617                 |          | 1,654    |                     | \$40,957.97                 | \$6.33        |
|        | <b>New York</b>                    |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                             |                       |          |          |                     |                             |               |
| 47.    | Central                            | 732               | 238               | 32.4                  | 38,496                  | 11,407     | 3.36                        | 2,850                 | 100      | 605      |                     | \$42,051.48                 | \$3.69        |
| 48.    | H./M./B.                           | 740               | 297               | 40.1                  | 34,185                  | 11,267     | 3.03                        | 2,950                 | 1,020    | 1,250    | 25                  | \$39,430.01                 | \$3.50        |
| 49.    | Southeast                          | 1,771             | 728               | 41.0                  | 209,868                 | 56,885     | 3.69                        | 8,514                 | 4,300    | 150      | 65                  | \$222,896.76                | \$3.92        |
| 50.    | West                               | 338               | 91                | 26.8                  | 11,596                  | 5,968      | 1.93                        | 199                   | 20       |          |                     | \$11,815.04                 | \$1.98        |
| 51.    | N. Carolina                        | 960               | 498               | 51.8                  | 96,741                  | 15,660     | 6.17                        | 3,758                 | 25       | 1,535    | 104                 | \$102,163.57                | \$6.52        |
| 52.    | North Dakota                       | 132               | 56                | 42.3                  | 6,203                   | 3,159      | 1.95                        | 5                     |          | 315      |                     | \$6,522.65                  | \$2.06        |
|        | <b>OHIO</b>                        |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                             |                       |          |          |                     |                             |               |
| 53.    | Cent. & S.E.                       | 706               | 186               | 26.3                  | 30,217                  | 10,244     | 2.95                        | 2,941                 |          | 322      |                     | \$33,479.75                 | \$3.27        |
| 54.    | Northeast                          | 1,456             | 329               | 22.6                  | 47,669                  | 22,103     | 2.15                        | 1,778                 | 92       | 285      |                     | \$49,823.88                 | \$2.25        |
| 55.    | N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.               | 286               | 108               | 37.7                  | 11,377                  | 4,164      | 2.72                        | 352                   |          | 554      |                     | \$12,283.07                 | \$2.95        |
| 56.    | S.W. Ohio                          | 532               | 246               | 46.1                  | 45,536                  | 10,251     | 4.43                        | 3,101                 |          |          | 30                  | \$48,666.65                 | \$4.75        |
| 57.    | Oklahoma                           | 389               | 185               | 47.5                  | 30,426                  | 6,779      | 4.48                        | 92                    |          | 589      |                     | \$31,106.74                 | \$4.59        |
| 58.    | Oregon                             | 929               | 415               | 44.7                  | 78,812                  | 18,172     | 4.33                        | 5,671                 |          | 2,257    | 324                 | \$87,065.11                 | \$4.79        |



|                                             |                          |        |        |      |                |           |      |              |             |              |            |                |        |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------|--------|------|----------------|-----------|------|--------------|-------------|--------------|------------|----------------|--------|
| 59.                                         | Pennsylvania             | 1,444  | 733    | 50.8 | 150,887        | 31,480    | 4.78 | 3,668        | 150         | 6,309        | 1,380      | \$162,393.76   | \$5.16 |
| 60.                                         | West                     | 823    | 417    | 50.7 | 54,253         | 11,642    | 4.65 | 2,489        |             | 1,062        | 100        | \$57,903.70    | \$4.97 |
| 61.                                         | Rhode Island             | 249    | 113    | 45.3 | 25,280         | 5,284     | 4.77 | 713          |             | 8,451        | 175        | \$34,618.89    | \$6.55 |
| 62.                                         | South Carolina           | 319    | 178    | 55.7 | 46,845         | 7,084     | 6.60 | 284          |             | 1,522        | 238        | \$48,889.36    | \$6.90 |
| 63.                                         | South Dakota             | 177    | 75     | 42.4 | 14,513         | 5,307     | 2.72 | 27           |             | 557          |            | \$15,097.47    | \$2.84 |
| 64.                                         | Tennessee                | 525    | 259    | 49.2 | 48,464         | 12,595    | 3.85 | 5,166        | 100         | 62           | 100        | \$53,891.49    | \$4.28 |
| Texas                                       |                          |        |        |      |                |           |      |              |             |              |            |                |        |
| 65.                                         | Northeast                | 515    | 222    | 43.0 | 67,642         | 20,301    | 3.33 | 6,203        | 347         | 2,238        | 300        | \$76,730.34    | \$3.78 |
| 66.                                         | Northwest                | 208    | 76     | 36.4 | 14,636         | 5,228     | 2.79 | 538          | 15          |              |            | \$15,189.18    | \$2.91 |
| 67.                                         | Southeast                | 571    | 255    | 44.7 | 54,854         | 17,159    | 3.19 | 5,355        | 2,400       | 3,215        |            | \$65,824.52    | \$3.84 |
| 68.                                         | Southwest                | 520    | 233    | 44.7 | 62,436         | 11,812    | 5.28 | 2,307        |             | 5,099        | 245        | \$70,087.44    | \$5.93 |
| 69.                                         | Utah                     | 262    | 154    | 58.7 | 28,136         | 5,274     | 5.33 | 1,620        |             | 325          | 41         | \$30,122.81    | \$5.71 |
| 70.                                         | Vermont                  | 262    | 117    | 44.6 | 16,673         | 4,784     | 3.49 | 4,468        |             |              | 20         | \$21,160.18    | \$4.42 |
| 71.                                         | Virginia                 | 1,209  | 678    | 56.0 | 135,038        | 22,612    | 5.96 | 10,177       | 1,100       | 5,280        | 418        | \$152,013.33   | \$6.72 |
| 72.                                         | Western Washington       | 1,197  | 580    | 48.5 | 124,359        | 26,684    | 4.65 | 6,014        |             | 7,099        | 144        | \$137,616.07   | \$5.16 |
| 73.                                         | West Virginia            | 315    | 135    | 42.9 | 15,537         | 3,424     | 4.54 | 223          | 50          | 600          |            | \$16,409.94    | \$4.79 |
| Wisconsin                                   |                          |        |        |      |                |           |      |              |             |              |            |                |        |
| 74.                                         | N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich. | 664    | 255    | 38.4 | 28,691         | 10,492    | 2.72 | 480          | 50          | 1,077        | 35         | \$30,333.23    | \$2.89 |
| 75.                                         | South                    | 951    | 443    | 46.6 | 55,685         | 17,978    | 3.10 | 3,641        |             | 1,173        | 276        | \$60,775.72    | \$3.38 |
| 76.                                         | Wyoming                  | 105    | 61     | 58.1 | 11,219         | 1,957     | 5.72 | 40           |             | 274          |            | \$11,532.44    | \$5.89 |
| 77.                                         | Puerto Rico              | 131    | 73     | 55.7 | 7,433          | 1,447     | 5.14 | 25           |             | 26           |            | \$7,483.75     | \$5.17 |
| 78.                                         | Alberta/N.W.T.           | 507    | 250    | 49.3 | 64,874         | 8,413     | 7.71 | 2,450        |             | 3,404        | 13         | \$70,741.72    | \$8.41 |
| 79.                                         | B.C./Yukon               | 741    | 380    | 51.3 | 96,205         | 14,005    | 6.86 | 21           |             | 45           | 22         | \$96,293.57    | \$6.88 |
| 80.                                         | Manitoba                 | 141    | 52     | 36.9 | 8,359          | 3,841     | 2.18 |              |             |              |            | \$8,358.85     | \$2.18 |
| 81.                                         | N.B./P.E.I.              | 195    | 91     | 46.6 | 12,619         | 3,682     | 3.43 | 36           |             | 878          |            | \$13,532.71    | \$3.68 |
| 82.                                         | N.S./Nfld./Lab.          | 246    | 89     | 36.2 | 10,064         | 3,215     | 3.13 |              |             | 2,899        |            | \$12,963.12    | \$4.03 |
| Ontario                                     |                          |        |        |      |                |           |      |              |             |              |            |                |        |
| 83.                                         | East                     | 561    | 251    | 44.6 | 56,418         | 14,322    | 3.93 | 2,239        |             | 10,558       | 194        | \$69,409.25    | \$4.85 |
| 84.                                         | Northeast                | 150    | 61     | 40.6 | 13,246         | 1,900     | 6.97 | 17           |             | 2,235        |            | \$15,497.97    | \$8.16 |
| 85.                                         | Northwest                | 71     | 17     | 23.9 | 2,046          | 1,137     | 1.79 | 292          |             | 1,049        |            | \$3,387.35     | \$2.98 |
| 86.                                         | West                     | 558    | 204    | 36.6 | 53,249         | 10,148    | 5.25 | 892          | 89          | 16,536       |            | \$70,765.42    | \$6.97 |
| Quebec (1)                                  |                          |        |        |      |                |           |      |              |             |              |            |                |        |
| 87.                                         | Southwest                | 542    | 528    | 97.3 | 15,081         | 15,101    | 0.99 | 1,588        |             | 12,763       |            | \$29,432.56    | \$1.95 |
| 88.                                         | Southeast                | 198    | 129    | 65.0 | 915            | 3,122     | 0.28 | 237          |             | 12,955       |            | \$14,106.40    | \$4.52 |
| 89.                                         | Northwest                | 317    | 317    | 99.9 | 831            | 6,500     | 0.12 | 277          |             | 37,969       |            | \$39,077.74    | \$6.01 |
| 90.                                         | Southwest                | 365    | 318    | 87.0 | 2,044          | 6,597     | 0.30 | 3,741        |             | 43,997       |            | \$49,782.06    | \$7.55 |
| 91.                                         | Saskatchewan             | 282    | 129    | 45.7 | 16,463         | 3,460     | 4.76 | 81           |             | 2,549        | 169        | \$19,261.98    | \$5.57 |
| 92.                                         | Washington East          | 453    | 188    | 41.5 | 25,180         | 6,286     | 4.00 | 162          | 50          | 1,537        |            | \$26,928.22    | \$4.28 |
| 93.                                         | Central Calif            | 881    | 391    | 44.4 | 87,574         | 24,097    | 3.62 | 507          | 2,102       | 2,948        | 385        | \$93,516.39    | \$3.88 |
|                                             | Total U.S./              | 58,539 | 26,622 | 45.5 | \$5,105,641.91 | 1,308,712 | 3.90 | \$251,741.00 | \$28,476.74 | \$422,985.36 | \$9,528.93 | \$5,818,373.94 | \$4.45 |
| Canada                                      |                          |        |        |      |                |           |      |              |             |              |            |                |        |
| Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings |                          |        |        |      | \$289,746.67   |           |      |              |             |              |            |                |        |
| Specials                                    |                          |        |        |      | \$422,985.36   |           |      |              |             |              |            |                |        |
| Total for U.S. & Canada                     |                          |        |        |      | \$5,818,373.94 |           |      |              |             |              |            |                |        |
| FOREIGN AND OTHER                           |                          |        |        |      |                |           |      |              |             |              |            |                |        |
| On Line Meetings                            |                          |        |        |      | \$712.10       |           |      |              |             |              |            |                |        |
| Correctional & Hospital facility groups     |                          |        |        |      | \$262.00       |           |      |              |             |              |            |                |        |
| Foreign                                     |                          |        |        |      | \$246,992.86   |           |      |              |             |              |            |                |        |
| Loners                                      |                          |        |        |      | \$772.00       |           |      |              |             |              |            |                |        |
| Birds of a Feather                          |                          |        |        |      | \$1,060.00     |           |      |              |             |              |            |                |        |
| Grand Total                                 |                          |        |        |      | \$6,068,172.90 |           |      |              |             |              |            |                |        |

# CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON - 2006-2005 (in U.S. dollars)

|                     | #GPS.<br>REPORTED | #GPS.<br>CONTRIB. | % OF GPS.<br>CONTRIB. | TOTAL GROUP<br>CONTRIB. | MEMBERSHIP | CONTRIBUTIONS<br>PER CAPITA | TOTAL PER CAPITA<br>INCLUDING<br>SPECIALS ETC |                                  |        |
|---------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------|------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------|
| U.S. & Canada       |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                             |                                               |                                  |        |
| 2006                | 58,539            | 26,622            | 45.5%                 | \$5,105,641.91          | 1,308,712  | \$3.90                      | \$4.45                                        |                                  |        |
| U.S. & Canada       |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                             |                                               |                                  |        |
| 2005                | 58,067            | 25,067            | 43.2%                 | \$4,559,542.44          | 1,294,678  | \$3.52                      | \$4.05                                        |                                  |        |
| Increase (Decrease) | 472               | 1,555             | 2.3%                  | \$546,099.47            | 14,034     | \$0.38                      | \$0.40                                        | EST. COST OF SERVICES PER CAPITA |        |
|                     |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                             |                                               | \$6.32                           | \$5.83 |

<sup>1</sup> Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed through their Conference Areas (per info from areas)

## 2007 Conference Committees

### Conference Agenda

Hari Boggs  
Kelly Carew  
Tim Donaldson  
Bill Fifield  
Maurice Holman  
Debbie Johnson  
<sup>1</sup>Eric Knudsen  
<sup>2</sup>Bobbi Padden

Secretary: Rick Walker

### Finance

Bobby Fryer  
Francis Gilroy  
George Possley  
Luc Rainville  
Linda Seamon  
<sup>2</sup>Tony Tunison  
Andrew Ware  
<sup>1</sup>Jamie Wheelless

Secretary: Donald Meurer

### Policy/Admissions

Becky Brown  
Sharon Buckley  
Gus Henry  
France Jolicoeur  
<sup>2</sup>George Master  
Phil Momerak  
Hugh Neavill  
<sup>1</sup>John Staebell  
Chuck Walters

Secretary: Eva Sanchez

### Treatment Facilities

Pat Basinger  
Moe Bradley  
Bob Conley  
Bruce Henry  
Darryl Miller  
<sup>2</sup>Pat Milligan  
Kiki Roddy  
<sup>1</sup>Jimmy Sell

Secretary: Mary Clare Lynch

### <sup>3</sup>International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

<sup>1</sup>Becky Brown  
Moe Bradley  
Charlie Hanna  
Pat Long  
John Mastrull  
Larry Sanford  
Julie Simiskey  
<sup>1</sup>Mike Sumpter

Co-secretaries:  
Rick Walker  
Valerie O'Neill

### Cooperation With the Professional Community

Barbara Bolt  
Nora Bromley  
Mike Doheny  
<sup>2</sup>Marianne Hawkins  
Chuck Leck  
Murdo MacKay  
Mike Maynard  
<sup>1</sup>David Schaffner  
John Wighton

Secretary: Irene Kontje

### Grapevine

Jerry Clarkson  
Jorge Flores  
<sup>1</sup>Glenn Harrison  
Fred Heyne  
Ron Hubbard  
<sup>2</sup>Pat Long  
Liz Olmstead  
Mary Swart

Secretary: Hernán Marea

### Public Information

<sup>1</sup>Diane Dixon  
Janet Hollabaugh  
Dale Kendall  
Trish La Nauze  
Claude Matteau  
Larry Sanford  
<sup>2</sup>Tito Torres  
Gustavo Trujillo

Secretary: Julio Espailat

### Trustees

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<sup>2</sup>Denny Owen  
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Gayle Solheim Riese

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<sup>1</sup>Estelle Grote  
Gail Harris  
Rick Horstmann  
Patricia McDonald  
Perry Marquis  
Bob Neal  
Bill Ouchie  
<sup>2</sup>Larry Stiff

Secretary: Mary Dargan

### Literature

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Sharon Farnsworth  
Vernon Gosney  
Ted Kroll  
Jerry Saari  
<sup>1</sup>John Sanders  
<sup>2</sup>Mike Sumpter

Secretary: Adrienne Brown

### Report and Charter

Paul Alexander  
Becky Collette  
John Fraser  
Charlie Hanna  
<sup>2</sup>El Nault  
Julie Simiskey  
Leo Smith  
<sup>1</sup>Tom Vida  
Jim Withrow

Secretary: Warren Stafford

### <sup>3</sup>Archives

Nora Bromley  
Dot Dykstra  
Francis Gilroy  
<sup>2</sup>Marianne Hawkins  
John Sanders  
<sup>1</sup>Mary Swart  
Andrew Ware  
Jim Withrow

Secretary: Amy Filiatreau

## 2008 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS<sup>4</sup>

| Committee                                        | Chairperson                           |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Agenda                                           | Tim Donaldson, Alabama/NW Florida     |
| Cooperation With the Professional Community      | Nora Bromley, Arkansas                |
| Corrections                                      | Bill Neal, NE Texas                   |
| Finance                                          | Andrew Ware, Montana                  |
| Grapevine                                        | Fred Heyne, North Florida             |
| Literature                                       | Vernon Gosney, Hawaii                 |
| Policy/Admissions                                | Gus Henry, SE Texas                   |
| Public Information                               | Trish La Nauze, B.C./Yukon            |
| Report and Charter                               | Leo Smith, Northern Indiana           |
| Treatment Facilities                             | Patricia Basinger, Eastern Missouri   |
| Trustees                                         | John Mastrull, Northern New Jersey    |
| <sup>3</sup> Archives                            | Francis Gilroy, Eastern Massachusetts |
| <sup>3</sup> International Conv./Regional Forums | Moe Bradley, NE Ontario               |

### Alternate

Bill Fifield, Colorado  
Mike Maynard, Iowa  
Gail Harris, Western Washington  
Francis Gilroy, Eastern Massachusetts  
Liz Olmstead, Central New York  
Sheila Dunne, Eastern Pennsylvania  
Phil Momerak, North Dakota  
Janet Hollabaugh, Western Pennsylvania  
Julie Simiskey, Utah  
Kiki Roddy, District of Columbia  
Newton Pritchett, North Carolina  
Jim Withrow, West Virginia  
Julie Simiskey, Utah

<sup>1</sup>Chairperson

<sup>2</sup>Alternate Chairperson

<sup>3</sup>Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

<sup>4</sup>The 2007 committee chairs rotated at the end of the 57th General Service Conference.

# 2007 Trustees' Committees\*\*

## Archives

Herb Goodman, *chairperson*  
 Chuck Barta  
 Roberta Lindeman  
 Howard Lowery  
 George Martin  
 Ray Massey  
 Mike Perry  
 John Skilton  
 Amy Filiatreau, *secretary*

## Audit

Vince Keefe, *chairperson*  
 Allen Ault  
 Herb Goodman  
 Howard Lowery  
 Arnold Ross  
 Don Meurer, *secretary*

## Conference

Tom Kraemer, *chairperson*  
 Bill Clark  
 Vince Keefe  
 Gary Kluksdahl  
 George Martin  
 Ray Massey  
 Mike Perry  
 John Skilton  
 Rick Walker, *secretary*

## Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities

Alan Ault, *chairperson*  
 Bill Clark  
 Ward Ewing  
 Dorothy Hurley  
 Tom Kraemer  
 Bob Mayer  
 Murray McIntosh  
 \*Andy Talbert  
 Irene Kontje, *secretary* —C.P.C.  
 Mary Clare Lynch, *secretary*  
 —Treatment Facilities

## Corrections

Chuck Barta, *chairperson*  
 Allen Ault  
 Dorothy Hurley  
 Roberta Lindeman  
 \*Bill Noonan  
 Madeleine Parmley  
 \*Bill Thomson  
 Jane Tolar  
 Jeanne Woodford  
 Mary Dargan, *secretary*

## Finance & Budgetary

Vince Keefe, *chairperson*  
 Paul Cleary  
 Herb Goodman  
 Gary Kluksdahl  
 Howard Lowery  
 George Martin  
 Arnold Ross  
 John Skilton  
 Kevin Sunkel,  
*consultant/independent auditor*  
 Donald Meurer, *secretary*

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Murray McIntosh, *chairperson*  
 James Branscome  
 Vince Keefe  
 Madeleine Parmley  
 Dorothy Wilson  
 Jeanne Woodford  
 Doug Richardson, *secretary*

## International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Ray Massey, *chairperson*  
 Paul Cleary  
 Herb Goodman  
 Howard Lowery  
 Bob Mayer  
 John Skilton  
 Jane Tolar  
 Rick Walker, *secretary*  
 —International Conventions  
 Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*  
 —Regional Forums

## Literature

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 James Branscome  
 \*Lizz Hudson  
 Dorothy Hurley  
 Murray McIntosh  
 Madeleine Parmley  
 Jane Tolar  
 Christopher Cavanaugh, *consultant*  
 Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*  
 Adrienne Brown, *secretary*

## Nominating

Gary Kluksdahl, *chairperson*  
 Allen Ault  
 Chuck Barta  
 Ward Ewing  
 Tom Kraemer  
 Bob Mayer  
 Arnold Ross  
 Dorothy Wilson  
 Gayle Solheim Riese, *secretary*

## Public Information

Ward Ewing, *chairperson*,  
 James Branscome  
 \*Larry Fennelly  
 \*Paul Hutchinson  
 Roberta Lindeman  
 George Martin  
 Mike Perry  
 Dorothy Wilson  
 Jeanne Woodford  
 Julio Espallat, *secretary*

## General Sharing Session

Jeanne Woodford, *chairperson*  
 Eva Sanchez, *secretary*

All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."



## Officers of the General Service Board

Chair  
 Leonard Blumenthal  
 First vice-chairperson  
 Allen Ault  
 Second vice-chairperson  
 Herb Goodman  
 Secretary  
 Gary Kluksdahl  
 Treasurer  
 Vincent Keefe  
 Assistant secretary  
 Eva Sanchez  
 Assistant treasurer  
 Donald Meurer

The new slate of officers  
 is given on page 12

\*Denotes appointed committee members

\*\*Leonard Blumenthal and Greg Muth are ex officio members of all committees.

# 2007 Conference Members

## NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

**Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D.** (23205 Hwy 623, Rolly View, Alberta TOC 2KA, Canada) was elected chairman of the board in April 2005, and has served as a Class A trustee since 2000. In 1998 Len retired as chief executive officer of the Alberta Alcohol and Drug Abuse Commission, where he had worked for 30 years. He remains active in the alcoholism field as speaker, consultant and a resource person.

**\*Allen L. Ault, Ed.D.** (College of Justice and Safety, 354 Stratton Bldg., 521 Lancaster Ave., Richmond, KY 40475-3102) was elected a Class A trustee in 2001. Allen is dean of the College of Justice and Safety, University of Eastern Kentucky, Richmond, KY. Prior to this position he served as chief for the National Institute of Corrections in Washington, D.C. During his career, Allen has been a director of corrections for five governors in three states, warden of a maximum security prison, a rehabilitation counselor, director of State Programs for the Mentally Retarded, and president of a national criminal justice consulting firm. Allen chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee and serves on the Audit, Corrections and Nominating Committees.

**William D. Clark, M.D.** (143 Temple Road, Woolwich, ME 04579) was elected a Class A trustee in 2004. He is a graduate of Harvard University and Harvard Medical School, and is board certified in internal medicine. Bill was medical director of the Addiction Resource Center (Brunswick, ME) and an attending physician at Mid Coast Hospital in Brunswick until he retired from patient care activities in 2004. He has taught in medical schools and post-graduate programs (residency), as well as presenting seminars and programs on alcoholism. He chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the Conference, and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committees.

**Ward B. Ewing, D.D.** (The General Theological Seminary, 175 Ninth Avenue, New York, NY 10011) was elected a Class A trustee in 2004. Ward is a graduate of the General Theological Seminary, where he is now dean and president. For over 30 years he served as pastor of Episcopal congregations in his native Tennessee, and in Florida, Kentucky and Buffalo, New York. He is involved in community ministries and is the author of several books and articles. Ward chairs the Public Information Committee and serves on the Nominating, and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committees.

**Herbert I. Goodman** (5710 Tecumseh Circle, Houston, TX 77057) was elected a Class A trustee in 2003. Herbert holds degrees in chemistry, international economics and business from the University of Pittsburgh, Harvard, and the University of Besancon in France. Herbert is CEO of an international corporation involved with petroleum products and energy conservation. He chairs the Archives Committee and serves on the Audit, International Conventions/Regional Forums and Finance & Budgetary Committees. Herb is also a member of the Grapevine Board.

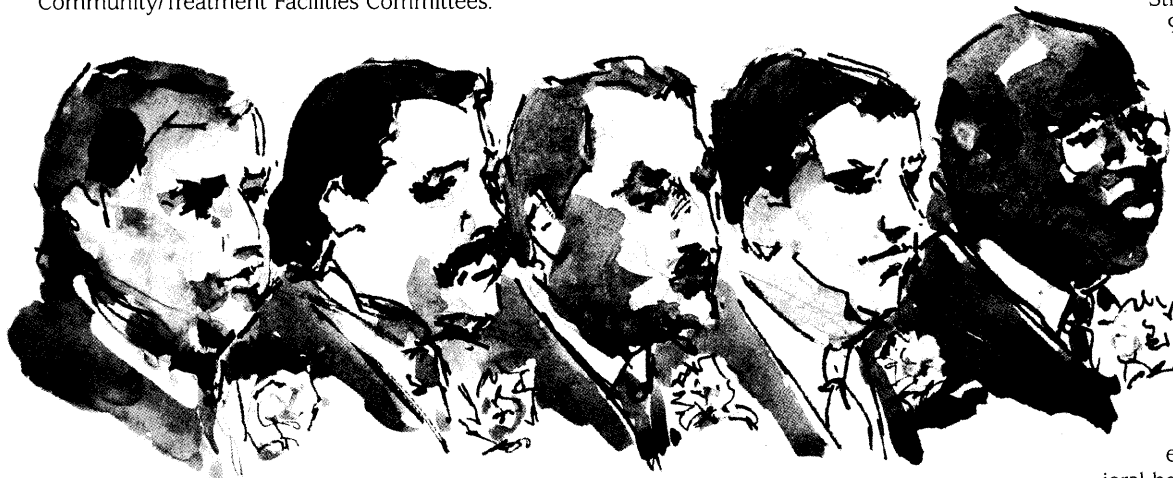
**Vincent E. Keefe** (9889 West 145 St., Orland Park, IL 60462) was elected to the board in April 2002. Vince is a CPA and holds an MBA from the University of Chicago. Now retired, he has been the CEO of a large packaging corporation and currently serves as a director on the boards of five companies. Vince chairs both the Finance & Budgetary Committee and the Audit Committee. He also serves on the Conference and International Committees.

**Jeanne S. Woodford** (San Francisco Adult Probation Dept., 880 Bryant St., Rm. 200, San Francisco, CA 94103) was elected a Class A trustee in April 2005. Jeanne's background is in criminal justice and she has served in various positions, from correctional counselor to warden at the California State Prison, San Quentin. She was the former undersecretary, California Department of Corrections and Rehabilitation, Sacramento. She is currently the Adult Chief Probation Officer for the city and county of San Francisco. Jeanne chairs the General Sharing Session and serves on the Corrections, International, and Public Information Committees.

## ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

**Charles Barta** (1320 43rd St. SE, Cedar Rapids, IA 52403) was elected West Central regional trustee in April 2004. A former Panel 51 delegate, Chuck is active in his region and area and in district correctional and treatment facilities meetings. He currently works in the construction industry as an electrician. Chuck chairs the Corrections Committee and serves on the Archives and Nominating Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

**Paul E. Cleary** (2963 Butler Street, Oceanside, CA 92054) was elected general service trustee in April 2005. Paul started in service work in young people's groups. As a Panel 42 delegate he chaired the 1993 Conference Literature Committee, and was a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board from 2002-2005. A clinical social worker, Paul is currently an account executive for a behavioral healthcare firm. He chairs



\* Rotating at the close of the 2007 Conference meeting.

the A.A.W.S. Board and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

**\*Gary Kluksdahl** (11187 Tamarron Place, Parker, CO 80138) was elected Southwest regional trustee in May 2003. A former Panel 43 delegate, Gary is active in local, area and regional A.A. He has been in the oil and gas exploration and production industry for 33 years. Gary chairs the Nominating Committee and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Conference Committees.

**Tom Kraemer** (Box 121, Vibank, Saskatchewan S0G 4Y0, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in April 2004. A Panel 48 delegate, Tom's service background includes longtime involvement with Regina Intergroup. He has served on a number of other A.A. service committees as well. He has been employed by Canada Post Corp. for over 32 years. Tom chairs the Conference Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities and Nominating Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

**Howard Lowery** (P.O. Box 684, Columbia, MS 39429) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 2005. A former Panel 42 delegate, Howard is actively involved in his home group, sponsorship, and district and area A.A. activities. He owns and manages a local retail store. Howard serves on the Finance & Budgetary, Archives, Audit, and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

**\*Murray McIntosh** (426 Cuyler Street, Thunder Bay, Ontario P7A 1B2, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in May 2003. A Panel 49 delegate from Northwest Ontario, Murray is active in group and area activities. Now retired, he was a professor in human services at a local college. Murray chairs the International Committee and serves on the Literature and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committees.

**Raymond Massey** (79 Edenwold Place NW, Calgary, AB T3A 3T8, Canada) was elected general service trustee in April 2005. A former Panel 44 delegate, Ray has been involved in Canadian Remote Communities and Young Offenders meetings. He has served as nontrustee director on the Grapevine Board. He owns and operates a Painting and Decorating Contracting business and is a member of the Alberta Apprenticeship & Industry Training Board. Ray chairs the International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee and serves on the Archives and Conference Committees. He is a member of the Grapevine Board.

**Robert Mayer** (Box 405, Oak Creek, WI 53154-0405) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 2005. A Panel 50 delegate, Bob has been treasurer of the East Central region, actively sponsors, and remains active in area, district and group activities. A forester by profession, he has worked for the U.S. Forest Service for our 25 years. Currently Bob is a resource specialist, working as the regional fire planner for the U.S. Forest Service, focusing on planning of wildlife resources and program budgeting. Bob serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums, Nominating and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committees. He is also a member of the Grapevine Board.

**Madeleine Parmley** (9242 N. Sunset Dr., Pocatello, ID 83201) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 2006. She served as a Panel 52 delegate and has long been active in carrying the message into jails and prisons, and has volunteered as a camp counselor for incarcerated mothers and their children. Madeleine is a trauma care nurse. She serves on the Corrections, Literature and International Committees.

**\*Michael D. Perry** (11 Mechanic Street, Fair Haven, VT 05743) was elected Northeast regional trustee in May 2003. A Panel 50 delegate, Mike has continued to serve his area as the convention chair on the area committee. He has taught high school biology for over 30 years. Mike serves on the Archives, Conference and Public Information Committees.

**\*Arnold L. Ross** (227-G East Northern Parkway, Baltimore, MD 21212) became a general service trustee in May 2003, after having served three years as a nontrustee director on the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board. A former Panel 46 delegate, Arnold is chief of financial administration for a nonprofit organization. Arnold chairs the Grapevine Board and serves on the Audit, Nominating, and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

**Dorothy Wilson** (2602 Walker Avenue, Indianapolis, IN 46203) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 2005. A Panel 44 delegate, Dorothy had remained active in her group, district, area and region. She has worked with children in a variety of educational programs. Dorothy serves on the International, Public Information, and Nominating Committees.

### *Trustees elected by the General Service Board following 2007 Conference*

**The Hon. Rogelio R. Flores** (Superior Court of the State of California, Santa Maria Div., 312-M East Cook St., Santa Maria, CA 93456-5165) was elected Class A trustee in April 2007. A graduate of the UCLA School of Law, Judge Flores now serves on the Superior Court of Santa Barbara. He is assigned to various specialty courts, including the Substance Abuse Treatment Court and is on the faculty of the National Drug Court Institute.

**Conley F. Byrd, Jr.** (Box 3, 1506 S. Hwy. 365, Redfield, AR 72132) was elected Southwest regional trustee in April 2007. A Panel 43 delegate, Conley is active in his group, district and area. A graduate of LSU School of Veterinary Medicine, he is owner and sole practitioner of a Veterinary Hospital.

**Dorothy L. Hurley** (304 Donna Dr., Plymouth Meeting, PA 19462) was elected general service trustee in April 2007. Dorothy served as a nontrustee director on the Grapevine Board (2004-2007) and has been active in her group and intergroup. With a professional background in education, she is now a university professor.

**John J. Kane, Jr.** (549 Grant Ave., Collingswood, NJ 08107-1926) was elected general service trustee in April 2007. A Panel 46 delegate, he currently serves on committees in Area 45 and is an active sponsor. A mechanical engineer by profession, John is currently Community Development Director of his town.

**Jo-Anne Lowenberger** (303 Regal Ave., Winnipeg, MB R2M 0P4, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 2007. A Panel 52 delegate, Jo-Anne spearheaded the Canadian Archives Display for the 2005 Spiritual Homecoming. Active throughout her area, Archives is a special interest. She has been the head of File Maintenance (pricing) in a major store, since 1979.

**John C. Skilton** (201 Kerby Hill Rd., Fort Washington, MD 20744), a Panel 47 delegate, was elected general service trustee in April 2007. From 2003 to 2007 he was a nontrustee director of the A.A. Grapevine Board. Now retired, John has been a researcher and teacher at several universities.

## A.A. World Services Directors

Paul Cleary, *chairperson,*  
*general service trustee*  
 Chuck Barta, *regional trustee*  
 Roberta Lindeman, *director*  
 Howard Lowery, *regional trustee*

George Martin, *director*  
 Greg Muth, *G.S.O. general manager*  
 Jane Tolar, *director*  
 Eva Sanchez, *G.S.O. staff member*

## A.A. Grapevine Directors

Arnold Ross, *chairperson,*  
*general service trustee*  
 James Branscome, *director*  
 Robin Bromley, *executive editor*  
 Herbert Goodman, *Class A trustee*

Dorothy Hurley, *director*  
 Tom Kraemer, *regional trustee*  
 Raymond Massey, *general service trustee*  
 Robert Mayer, *regional trustee*  
 John Skilton, *director*

## General Service Office Staff

Greg Muth, *general manager*  
 Tom Jasper, *senior adviser*  
*to general manager*  
 Adrienne Brown  
 Mary Dargan  
 Julio Espallat  
 Irene Kontje

Mary Clare Lynch  
 Valerie O'Neill  
 Doug Richardson  
 Gayle Solheim Riese  
 Eva Sanchez  
 Warren Stafford  
 Rick Walker

## Grapevine Staff

Robin Bromley, *executive editor*  
 Maggie Keogh, *GV, director*  
*of Internet operations*

Hernán Merea, *La Viña editor*

## Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Militza Alma-Noyola, *staff assistant*  
 Susan Ankudavich, *GV senior editor*  
 Daniel O. Brown, *digital media manager*  
 Janet Bryan, *GV office mgr./admin. asst.*  
 Shawn Bunkley, *general office clerk*  
 Angel Calvillo, *Spanish translator*  
 Christopher Cavanaugh, *publications director*  
 Sheila Coppin-Thorn, *staff assistant*  
 Daniel DeFilippis, *asst. controller/business admin.*  
 Joseph Dennen, *staff assistant*  
 John DeStefano, *Spanish-language editor*  
 Amy Filiatreau, *archivist*  
 John Hackett, *associate editor*  
 Karen Hale, *manager, support services*  
 Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*  
 John Kirwin, Jr., *A.A. events consultant*  
 Elsa Lathan, *staff assistant*  
 Fern Leclerc, *French translator*  
 Marsha Levine, *GV assoc. editor*  
 Pamela Lewis, *staff assistant*  
 Natalya Malamud, *staff assistant*  
 Ayleen Martinez, *staff assistant*  
 Donald Meurer, *C.F.O., G.S.O.*  
 Michelle Mirza, *asst. archivist*  
 Eugene O'Brien, *GV controller*  
 Luis Oquendo, *copy room clerk*  
 Lise Payette, *French-language editor*  
 Ivelisse Rivera, *asst. to Regional Forums coordinator*  
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*  
 Sharisse Seabury, *staff assistant*  
 Frank Segui, *financial secretary*  
 Charlie Shell, *consultant, project management office*  
 Robert Slotterback, *accounting department manager*  
 Kevin Sunkel, *independent auditor*  
 Yee Tully, *staff assistant*  
 Andre Washington, *purchasing agent*  
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*  
 Nannie Williams, *staff assistant*

### Trustees emeriti

Michael Alexander  
 W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.  
 Gary Glynn  
 Elaine McDowell, Phd.

## Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 57th Conference includes Panel 56 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 57 (new delegates).

## UNITED STATES

| State                                            | Area no. | Panel |                                                                           |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Alabama/N.W. Florida                             | 1        | 57    | Tim Donaldson<br>18193 Alabama Hwy 52<br>Opp, AL 36467                    |
| Alaska                                           | 2        | 56    | Richard (Rick) Horstmann<br>HC 89, Box 560H<br>Willow, AK 99688           |
| Arizona                                          | 3        | 56    | John Staebell<br>700 N. Virginia Ave.<br>Willcox, AZ 85643                |
| Arkansas                                         | 4        | 57    | Nora Bromley<br>5523 N. Maple St.<br>North Little Rock, AR 72118          |
| California                                       |          |       |                                                                           |
| <i>Southern</i>                                  | 5        | 57    | Gustavo Trujillo<br>137 N. Rosemont Ave., #9<br>Los Angeles, CA 90026     |
| <i>Central</i>                                   | 93       | 57    | Debbie Johnson<br>8214 Kentland Ave.<br>West Hills, CA 91304              |
| <i>Northern Coastal</i>                          | 6        | 57    | Sharon Buckley<br>2660 Melendy Dr., #1<br>San Carlos, CA 94070-3661       |
| <i>Northern Interior</i>                         | 7        | 56    | Marianne Hawkins<br>310 Rosa Ave.<br>Winters, CA 95694                    |
| <i>San Diego/Imperial</i>                        | 8        | 56    | Jerry Clarkson<br>9970 Mesa Madera Dr.<br>San Diego, CA 92131             |
| <i>Mid-Southern</i>                              | 9        | 56    | Bruce Henry<br>22420 Ocean Ave., #30<br>Torrance, CA 90505                |
| Colorado                                         | 10       | 57    | Bill Fifield<br>Box 366<br>Conifer, CO 80433                              |
| Connecticut                                      | 11       | 57    | Patricia (Pat) McDonald<br>848 Long Hill Ave.<br>Shelton, CT 06484        |
| Delaware                                         | 12       | 56    | George Master<br>237 Landau Way<br>Bear, DE 19701                         |
| District of Columbia                             | 13       | 57    | Carroll (Kiki) Roddy<br>9880 Hollow Glen Place<br>Silver Spring, MD 20810 |
| Florida                                          |          |       |                                                                           |
| <i>North</i>                                     | 14       | 57    | Fred Heyne<br>3833 Millpoint Dr.<br>Jacksonville, FL 32257                |
| <i>S. Florida/<br/>Bahamas/V.I./<br/>Antigua</i> | 15       | 57    | Bill Ouchie<br>5306 Rosecrest Circle<br>Tampa, FL 33617                   |
| Georgia                                          | 16       | 56    | David Schaffner<br>24 Rose Hill Dr.<br>Savannah, GA 31419                 |
| Hawaii                                           | 17       | 57    | Vernon Gosney<br>55 Mahalani St.<br>Wailuku, HI 96793                     |
| Idaho                                            | 18       | 56    | Anthony (Tony) Tunison<br>22658 Caitlin Lane<br>Middleton, ID 83644       |

| <b>State</b>         | <b>Area<br/>no.</b> | <b>Panel</b> |                                                                         | <b>State</b>                        | <b>Area<br/>no.</b> | <b>Panel</b> |                                                                      |
|----------------------|---------------------|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|---------------------|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Illinois</b>      |                     |              |                                                                         | <b>Montana</b>                      | 40                  | 57           | Andre Ware<br>3214 Cummins Way<br>Missoula, MT 59802                 |
| <i>Chicago</i>       | 19                  | 57           | Maurice Holman<br>Box 392<br>Hines, IL 60623                            | <b>Nebraska</b>                     | 41                  | 56           | Charles (Charlie) Hanna<br>5345 Lillibridge<br>Lincoln, NE 68506     |
| <i>Northern</i>      | 20                  | 56           | Larry Stiff<br>9913 Forest Lane<br>Union, IL 60180                      | <b>Nevada</b>                       | 42                  | 57           | Mike Doheny<br>Box 3794<br>Tonopah, NV 89049                         |
| <i>Southern</i>      | 21                  | 57           | Hugh Neavill<br>Box 225<br>Fairfield, IL 62837                          | <b>New Hampshire</b>                | 43                  | 56           | Dale Kendall<br>17 School Lane<br>Woodsville, NH 03785               |
| <b>Indiana</b>       |                     |              |                                                                         | <b>New Jersey</b>                   |                     |              |                                                                      |
| <i>Northern</i>      | 22                  | 57           | Leonard (Leo) Smith<br>1303½ Clay St., #2<br>Laporte, IN 46350          | <i>Northern</i>                     | 44                  | 57           | John (J.J.) Mastrull<br>10 Lund Court<br>Woodsville, NH 03785        |
| <i>Southern</i>      | 23                  | 56           | Charles (Chuck) Leck<br>1816 E. Edgewood Ave.<br>Indianapolis, IN 46227 | <i>Southern</i>                     | 45                  | 56           | Jimmy Sell<br>19 E. Pine St.<br>Audubon, NJ 08106                    |
| <b>Iowa</b>          | 24                  | 57           | Mike Maynard<br>1320 Wenig Rd.<br>Cedar Rapids, IA 52402                | <b>New Mexico</b>                   | 46                  | 56           | Lori Padilla<br>62 Isleta Dr.<br>Los Alamos, NM 87544                |
| <b>Kansas</b>        | 25                  | 56           | Michael (Mike) Sumpter<br>5928 N.W. Brickyard Rd.<br>Topeka, KS 66618   | <b>New York</b>                     |                     |              |                                                                      |
| <b>Kentucky</b>      | 26                  | 56           | Darryl Miller<br>409 Depot St.<br>Greensburg, KY 42743                  | <i>Central</i>                      | 47                  | 57           | Elisabeth (Liz) Olmstead<br>17 Wren St.<br>Johnson City, NY 13790    |
| <b>Louisiana</b>     | 27                  | 57           | Linda Seamon<br>340 Kimbro Dr.<br>Baton Rouge, LA 70808                 | <i>Hudson/Mohawk/<br/>Berkshire</i> | 48                  | 56           | Robert (Bobby) Fryer<br>15 Deerfield Place<br>Ballston Spa, NY 12020 |
| <b>Maine</b>         | 28                  | 56           | Thomas (Denny) Owen<br>Box 153<br>Morrill, ME 04952                     | <i>Southeast</i>                    | 49                  | 57           | John Wighton<br>210 Lakeshore Dr. East<br>Carmel, NY 10512           |
| <b>Maryland</b>      | 29                  | 56           | Barbara Bolt<br>7464 Players Blvd.<br>Seven Valleys, PA 17360           | <i>Western</i>                      | 50                  | 56           | Bruce Akin<br>10 Juliet St.<br>Jamestown, NY 14701                   |
| <b>Massachusetts</b> |                     |              |                                                                         | <b>North Carolina</b>               | 51                  | 57           | Newton Pritchett<br>Box 3794<br>Cary, NC 27519-3794                  |
| <i>Eastern</i>       | 30                  | 57           | Francis Gilroy<br>181 Littleton Rd., #215<br>Chelmsford, MA 01824       | <b>North Dakota</b>                 | 52                  | 57           | Phillip (Phil) Momerak<br>7700 58th Ave. NW<br>Minot, ND 58703       |
| <i>Western</i>       | 31                  | 56           | Roberta (Bobbi) Padden<br>26 S. Winthrop St.<br>Chicopee, MA 01201      | <b>Ohio</b>                         |                     |              |                                                                      |
| <b>Michigan</b>      |                     |              |                                                                         | <i>Central Southeast</i>            | 53                  | 57           | Sharon Farnsworth<br>716 5th St.<br>Marietta, OH 45750               |
| <i>Central</i>       | 32                  | 57           | Larry Sanford<br>6775 S. Adrian Hwy.<br>Adrian, MI 49221                | <i>Northeast</i>                    | 54                  | 57           | Jeff Your<br>1076 Woodview Rd.<br>Cleveland Heights, OH 44121        |
| <i>Southeast</i>     | 33                  | 57           | Robert (Bob) Conley<br>27855 Barkley<br>Livonia, MI 48154               | <i>NW Ohio/SE Mich.</i>             | 55                  | 56           | Kelly Carew<br>878 Quigley St.<br>Holland, OH 43528                  |
| <i>Western</i>       | 34                  | 56           | Charles (Chuck) Walters<br>67101 N. M66<br>Sturgis, MI 49091            | <i>Southwest</i>                    | 56                  | 56           | Mary Swart<br>1215 Beacon St.<br>Cincinnati, OH 45230                |
| <b>Minnesota</b>     |                     |              |                                                                         | <b>Oklahoma</b>                     | 57                  | 57           | Paul Alexander<br>402 E. Jefferson<br>Tecumseh, OK 74873             |
| <i>Northern</i>      | 35                  | 56           | Gerald (Jerry) Saari<br>5917 Long Lake Rd.<br>Makinen, MN 55763         | <b>Oregon</b>                       | 58                  | 56           | Eric Knudsen<br>2324 SW Mitchell St.<br>Portland, OR 97239           |
| <i>Southern</i>      | 36                  | 57           | Samira Anderson<br>904 Greenvale Ave.<br>Northfield, MN 55057           | <b>Pennsylvania</b>                 |                     |              |                                                                      |
| <b>Mississippi</b>   | 37                  | 56           | Glenn Harrison<br>1220 Meadowood Rd.<br>Columbia, MS 39429-2576         | <i>Eastern</i>                      | 59                  | 57           | Sheila Dunne<br>61 Regents Court<br>Bensalem, PA 19020               |
| <b>Missouri</b>      |                     |              |                                                                         | <i>Western</i>                      | 60                  | 57           | Janet Hollabaugh<br>199 Wilson Rd.<br>Worthington, PA 16262          |
| <i>Eastern</i>       | 38                  | 57           | Patricia (Pat) Basinger<br>106 W. School St.<br>Bonne Terre, MO 63628   |                                     |                     |              |                                                                      |
| <i>Western</i>       | 39                  | 57           | Ronald (Ron) Hubbard<br>309 A NW 16th St.<br>Blue Springs, MO 64015     |                                     |                     |              |                                                                      |



| <u>State</u>                     | <u>Area<br/>no.</u> | <u>Panel</u> |                                                                      |
|----------------------------------|---------------------|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Rhode Island                     | 61                  | 56           | Jorge Flores<br>74 Lenox Ave.<br>Providence, RI 02907                |
| South Carolina                   | 62                  | 56           | Eleanor (El) Nault<br>588 Crowe Mountain Rd.<br>Walhalla, SC 29691   |
| South Dakota                     | 63                  | 56           | Estelle Grote<br>Box 1162<br>Aberdeen, SD 57402                      |
| Tennessee                        | 64                  | 56           | Rebecca (Becky) Brown<br>204 Nancy Lane<br>Clinton, TN 37716         |
| Texas                            |                     |              |                                                                      |
| <i>Northeast</i>                 | 65                  | 57           | Bill Neal<br>326 Faircrest Drive<br>Arlington, TX 76018              |
| <i>Northwest</i>                 | 66                  | 56           | Diane Dixon<br>Box 51502<br>Midland, TX 79710                        |
| <i>Southeast</i>                 | 67                  | 57           | E. A. (Gus) Henry<br>108 Brookwood Dr.<br>Silsbee, TX 77656          |
| <i>Southwest</i>                 | 68                  | 56           | Jamie Wheelless<br>12603 Silver Spur<br>Austin, TX 78717             |
| Utah                             | 69                  | 57           | Julie Simiskey<br>260 W. 530 North<br>La Verkin, UT 84745            |
| Vermont                          | 70                  | 56           | Rebecca (Becky) Collette<br>675 Route 4A<br>Castletown, VT 05735     |
| Virginia                         | 71                  | 57           | Theodore (Ted) Kroll<br>5731 N. 6th St.<br>Arlington, VA 22205       |
| Washington                       |                     |              |                                                                      |
| <i>State East</i>                | 92                  | 56           | David (Dave) McCallum<br>618 East 17th Ave.<br>Spokane, WA 99203     |
| <i>Western</i>                   | 72                  | 57           | Gail Harris<br>Box 909<br>Preston, WA 98050                          |
| West Virginia                    | 73                  | 57           | Jim Withrow<br>4111 Staunton SE<br>Charleston, WV 25304              |
| Wisconsin                        |                     |              |                                                                      |
| <i>No. WI/<br/>  Up. Pen. MI</i> | 74                  | 56           | Jeffrey (Jeff) Campbell<br>4095 Cherry Rd.<br>Sturgeon Bay, WI 54235 |
| <i>Southern</i>                  | 75                  | 57           | George Possley<br>N2694 Bridge Rd.<br>Hingham, WI 53031              |
| Wyoming                          | 76                  | 56           | Patrick (Pat) Milligan<br>Box 2661<br>Jackson, WY 83001              |
| Puerto Rico                      | 77                  | 56           | Alberto Luis (Tito) Torres<br>Box 372<br>Aguadilla, PR 00605-0372    |

## CANADA

| <u>Province</u>                   | <u>Area<br/>no.</u> | <u>Panel</u> |                                                                            |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Alberta/N.W.T.                    | 78                  | 56           | Patricia (Pat) Long<br>8203-149 St.<br>Edmonton, AB T5R 1B1                |
| B.C./Yukon                        | 79                  | 57           | Patricia (Trish) La Nauze<br>3534 Cambridge St.<br>Vancouver, BC V5K 1M4   |
| Manitoba                          | 80                  | 56           | John Sanders<br>162 Parkville Dr.<br>Winnipeg, MB R2J 2J1                  |
| New Brunswick/P.E.I.              | 81                  | 56           | *Hari Boggs<br>304-22 Murch Dr.<br>Stratford, PEI C1B 1S2                  |
| Nova Scotia/<br>Newfoundland/Lab. | 82                  | 57           | Murdo MacKay<br>33 Beech Hill Dr.<br>Falls River, NS B2T 1H7               |
| Ontario                           |                     |              |                                                                            |
| <i>Eastern</i>                    | 83                  | 57           | Dot Dykstra<br>15 Heron Lane<br>Belleville, ON K8N 4Z3                     |
| <i>Northeast</i>                  | 84                  | 57           | Maurice (Moe) Bradley<br>1188 Marcel St.<br>Sudbury, ON P3E 4G1            |
| <i>Northwest</i>                  | 85                  | 57           | Perry Marquis<br>Box 361<br>Sioux Narrows, ON P9X 1N8                      |
| <i>Western</i>                    | 86                  | 56           | Thomas (Tom) Vida<br>105-780 Elm St.<br>Port Colborne, ON L3K 4R4          |
| Quebec                            |                     |              |                                                                            |
| <i>Southwest</i>                  | 87                  | 56           | Luc Rainville<br>5055, boul. Laurier Ouest<br>St-Hyacinthe, PQ J2S 3V4     |
| <i>Southeast</i>                  | 88                  | 57           | Claude Matteau<br>2525, De La Laurentie, Apt. 13<br>Sherbrooke, PQ J1J 1L3 |
| <i>Northeast</i>                  | 89                  | 57           | France Jolicoeur<br>82 du Plateau<br>Beauport, PQ G1E 2M9                  |
| <i>Northwest</i>                  | 90                  | 56           | Lynda Bergeron<br>197 Hector Lanthier #5<br>Saint Eustache, PQ J7P 1Z8     |
| Saskatchewan                      | 91                  | 57           | John Fraser<br>Box 171<br>Colonsay, SK S0K 0Z0                             |

